The Sūtra Called the Tantra of the Vajra Array, the Essence of the Meaning of the Secret Wisdom of the Mind of All the Tathāgatas; the Scripture of Accomplishment in Yoga; the Sūtra of the Knowledge That Gathers All; the Discourse of Dharma That Arrays the Clear Realization of the Great Vehicle

Sarvatathāgatacittajñānaguhyārthagarbhavyūhavajratantra Siddhiyogāgama Samājasarvavidyāsūtra Mahāyānābhisamaya Dharmaparyāyavivyūha Nāma Sūtra · Toh 829 · Derge Kangyur

དེ་བཞིན་གཤེགས་པ་ཐམས་ཅད་ཀྱི་ཐུགས་གསང་བའི་ཡེ་ཤེས་དགོངས་པ་རྡོ་རྗེ་བཀྲམ་པ་ཞེས་བྱ་བ་ཐེག་པ་ཆེན་པོའི་མངོན་པར་རྟོགས་པ་རྣམ་པར་སྣང་མཛད་ཅེས་བྱ་བ་རྒྱུད་ཀྱི་རྒྱལ་པོ།། ཀཱན་ཏི་ཤ་ཀྲི་ཏ་པཱ་ལི་ཏ་ཨ་ཙཱ་ར་ཡ་ཀ་ལ་ཤ་ཨ་ཛ

In the language of Drusha: Hon pan ril til pi bu pi til ti ta sid un ub hang bang ril ub bi su bad ri zhe hal pai ma kyang kui dang rong ti.

In the language of Tibet: The Sūtra Called the Tantra of the Vajra Array, the Essence of the Meaning of the Secret Wisdom of the Mind of All the Tathāgatas; the Scripture of Accomplishment in Yoga; the Sūtra of the Knowledge That Gathers All; the Discourse of Dharma That Arrays the Clear Realization of the Great Vehicle.

The first fascicle, with which the text begins.

Homage to the Blessed One, the glorious Liberator, the King of Compassion, the one who is utterly and completely free.

Thus did I hear it discussed at one time. The Blessed One of all the tathāgatas, the Lord of Secrets, the great Vajradhara, that lion of speech, the person who expounds exactly as it was spoken, is present in this way in inconceivable buddha fields and dwells among the various classes of sentient beings. There the dhāraṇī without coming together or parting, praised by all the victors of the inconceivable, unthinkable and immeasurable Dharma, the essence of secret mantra that knows all, as it is in all its extent, the very mirror of all phenomena, is heard without contradiction and taught without error. The exposition is as follows.

In the buddha field of the Buddha Akṣobhya called Abhirati, adorned with the light rays of vajras, on the mountain Vajra Heap, the great being called Sattvavajra, with a retinue of a million koṭis of bodhisattvas, listens to his own teacher on that very essence of secret mantra, the luminous maṇḍala of mind, and teaches it in the same way to his own close retinue. And even after the teacher has passed into complete nirvāṇa, he expounds it by recounting it as suchness.

In the buddha field of the Buddha Ratnasambhava called Śrīmat, arrayed with heaps of jewels, on the mountain called Lofty Beryl Light, the great being called Vajraratna, with a retinue of a million koṭis of bodhisattvas, listens to his own teacher on that very essence of secret mantra, the luminous maṇḍala of mind, and teaches it in the same way to his own close retinue. And even after the teacher has passed into complete nirvāṇa, he expounds it by recounting it just as it is.

In the buddha field of the Buddha Amitābha called Padmavatī, beautifully arrayed with lotuses, on the mountain Lotus Heap, the great being called

Dharmamegha, with a retinue of a million koṭis of bodhisattvas, listens to his own teacher on that very essence of secret mantra, the luminous maṇḍala of mind, and teaches it in the same way to his own close retinue. And even after the teacher has passed into complete nirvāṇa, he expounds it by recounting it just as it was.

In the buddha field of the Buddha Amoghasiddhi called Utterly Pure, adorned with a net of sapphires, on the mountain called Summit Arrayed with Various Jewels, the great being called Vajrakarma, with a retinue of a million koṭis of bodhisattvas, listens to his own teacher on that very essence of secret mantra, the luminous maṇḍala of mind, and teaches it in the same way to his own close retinue. And even after the teacher has passed into complete nirvāṇa, he expounds it by examining it without error.

In the buddha field of the Buddha Vairocana called Possessing the Essence of Awakening, adorned with various minds, on the mountain called Lofty through Dharma, the great being called Vajradhara, with a retinue of a million koṭis of bodhisattvas, listens to his own teacher on that very essence of secret mantra, the luminous nature of mind, and teaches it in the same way to his own close retinue. And even after the teacher has passed into complete nirvāṇa, he expounds it by ascertaining it as reality.

In the buddha field of the Buddha, the Lord of Sages, the realm of aspiration called the Ten Directions of the Six Sahā Worlds, adorned with the Vajrāsana, in the palace of Alakāvatī, the abode of the yakṣas, the great being called the Lord of Secrets, with a million koṭis of bodhisattvas and a retinue of many of the yakṣa class, listens to his own teacher on that very essence of secret mantra, the luminous nature of mind, and teaches it in the same way to his own close retinue.

Likewise, in the immeasurable, inconceivable buddha fields, countless beings called great beings, with retinues of bodhisattvas numbering millions of koṭis beyond all telling, listen to their own teachers on that very infinite essence of secret mantra, the luminous nature of mind, and teach it in the same way to their own close retinues. And even after their teachers have passed into complete nirvāṇa, they expound it by examining it with certainty.

Likewise, in the buddha field of the dharmakāya called Essence of Awakening, the one called the Regent Being, together with a retinue of inconceivable regent beings, definitively comments on the intention concerning that very essence of secret mantra, the nature of mind, which is awakened from the

very beginning.

Likewise, inconceivable sentient beings, persons of the class of gods, the class of asuras, the class of nāgas, the class of humans, the class of yakṣas, the class of rākṣasas, the class of animals, the class of pretas, the class of hell beings, and so on, appearing in the various ten directions of the worlds in various forms as persons who are various guides, each together with the various retinues of their own kind, listen to their own Lords of Sages on that very essence of secret mantra, the luminous mirror of mind, in their own languages and signs and according to their various inclinations, and teach it in the same way to their own close retinues by way of conceiving it in names and signs.

Among such bodhisattvas, some are of the awakening lineage, some are awakened, some are bodhisattvas, some are bodhisattva great beings, and some are of great awakening.

Likewise, the different designations known on the basis of the five bases are as follows: those who rejoice; those who have attained acceptance of unborn phenomena; those whose Dharma eye regarding phenomena is free of dust, free of stain and pure; those who abide on the ground of irreversibility; those turned toward it through aspiration; those devoted to it through faith; those who abide in complete reverence; those bound to one more birth; those in their final existence; those who enter the path; those who go; those who have gone; those who return; those who abide; aspirers, those who rise up, those who enter, those who abide, those who perfect, those who strive, those in training, those beyond training, those who have become habituated, those for whom it has become manifest, those in whose continuum it has arisen, those certain in their family, those who know it as Dharma, those of the Dharma tradition, regents, those of all the families, practitioners of dhāraṇī mantra, practitioners of vidyā mantra, practitioners of secret mantra, those of the three, four and five families, those of accumulation, those of application, those of seeing, those of meditation, those of culmination, yogins of aspiration, yogins who open the great family, yogins who draw the great breath, yogins who attain the great prophecy, yogins who perfect great skill, and the collections of phrases, the collections of letters, the collections of names, the collections of signs, the collections of conventions, and so on: all of these.

Of these, the third base enters the very essence of secret mantra: conduct, abiding, attainment, looking back, and complete perfection. All of these are

solely those who abide in sound, abide on the ground, abide in life, the great mudrā, and those who have become spontaneously accomplished.

Thus, in the inconceivable different world systems, in the inconceivable koṭis of different Jambudvīpas, together with the ten directions of the six worlds, infinite koṭis of lamps of the world have arisen without end. And these too, from beginningless and endless saṃsāra, in realms beyond all telling, at times beyond all telling in beginningless and endless eons, constantly appear in a continuous cycle. Performing the work of a lamp, they dispel the darkness of the world of gods and humans and make the maṇḍala of mind clear; and then, like the disks of the sun and moon setting, they are renowned everywhere and in every way as "passing into complete nirvāṇa," and so they appear.

This is the first chapter of the Great Sūtra That Gathers the Intentions of All the Buddhas, on the common setting.

Then it came about as follows. The Teacher, the Vajra Lord of Sages, who dwells in the world system called Sahā, appeared when the lifespan of beings was a hundred years. Having remained for no very long time, he intended to pass into complete nirvāṇa, and he stayed in the land called Vaiśālī together with a great retinue. When the three months of summer had passed, in order to establish three instructions for the disciples of the world, he spoke to Mahāmaudgalyāyana in the midst of the gathered retinue: "Master of miracles, today gather all my disciples who dwell in the ten directions of the six worlds, as many as are turned toward this place. There are things that must be definitively established."

That master of miracles, in a single instant of Dharma, proclaimed it so that it was understood, and gathered them all, in these words:

"Whoever are in the Victor's fields, the six classes of transformation,
all who are certain of this and turned toward it, listen!
Today here the Victor will set down the three nectars;
all who wish to conquer the three poisons, assemble!"

When he had proclaimed this, all the others assembled, except for the five of the sacred lineage, such as the great exhorter, the Lord of Laṅkā, Matyaupāyika, who was settled perfectly within the great meditative concentration of mantra.

Then the Blessed One said to those assembled: "O friends, understand this! All phenomena are impermanent. All wealth ends in decline. All things are certain

to perish. Because the life faculty of persons is subject to birth and death, I shall pass into complete nirvāṇa. So whoever has not cut off their doubts, ask your questions!"

When he had said this, the king of vidyādharas called Kuñjara, who had gathered in that assembly, rose from his seat, looked into the Teacher's face with the gaze of a lion, and said:

"You are the nature of space;
passing away and not passing away have never applied to you.
In keeping with worldly beings,
you intend to tame them completely by passing away.
You arose as the lamp of the world;
having dispelled the whole maṇḍala of darkness
of all the worlds of gods and humans,
you have made the maṇḍala of mind clear.
Upon the three guiding vehicles,
through which awakening will be attained
by practicing the grounds and the liberations,
beings have been set in stages;
yet the definitive Great Vehicle,
the supreme means beyond measure,
in which one acts through equality without accepting or rejecting
and does not seek awakening elsewhere,
you have never taught.
If the three words of the Victor's intention
are not set down as instruction and scripture,
on what will those of small mind, deluded by darkness,
fix a certain understanding?
The three vehicles of liberation:
which is gathered, into which, and by what?
When the sun that lights the world has set,
who will act as the lamp?
The perverse factions who destroy the teaching,
those opponents: by whom will they be defeated?"

When he had made this request, the Blessed One said: "Excellent, great vidyādhara! It is very good that you have asked these five questions. It is like this. The Great Vehicle that is definitive as reality arises in twelve situations. It arises when the torment of delusion is dispelled. It arises when the lamp of the

world is fully set forth. It arises when certainty is found. It arises when one is certain of the essence of awakening itself. It arises when the intention is definitively commented upon. It arises for the sake of those to be tamed when their occasion has come. It arises when it appears through blessing. It arises when the lineage is renowned through skillful means. It arises when it is done for someone's sake. It arises when the great scripture is definitively taught. It arises when the continuum of karma is completely cut. It arises when the intention is discussed. All of these appear completely, everywhere and in every way. They will appear. They will appear."

When he had said this, the uncertainty of the first question was cut off.

Then the Teacher again spoke on the second question: "Great vidyādhara, be endowed with intelligence. Decide through counsel. Hold it with skillful means. Make your intention pure.

Make your speech straightforward. Make your conduct good. Seek the meaning. Examine the purpose. Find certainty. Speak the truth. Do not let your word change. Act just as you have spoken. Be skilled in the three doors. Train in the three mantras. Destroy the three cities."

When he had said this, the uncertainty of the second question was cut off.

Then the Teacher again spoke on the third question:

"Vidyādhara, it is like this.
The lamp that I have set down
appears as the three baskets:
calm abiding, insight, and action, these three ends.
First it was for the three continua of knowing,
and then for the collections of letters themselves.
Because there are minds of greater and lesser degree,
so too are the stages of the vehicles;
and gathering, too, is by both the great and the small.
Because of the distinction between the two kinds,
the domain one enters is just that:
it is whatever one has devotion for."

When he had said this, the uncertainty of the third question was cut off.

Then the Teacher spoke on the fourth and the fifth questions in a single verse:

"Moreover, the last two questions
are settled entirely by one.

Listen, vidyādhara,
you who have been made a brother in Dharma!
The work of acting as a lamp, too:
the heroes in the bodies of beings,
prophesied before,
will appear, will illuminate, and will refute the perverse."

When he had said this, the uncertainty of the fourth and fifth questions was cut off, and he passed into complete nirvāṇa.

This is the second chapter of the Great Sūtra That Gathers the Intentions of All the Buddhas, on the definitive setting down of the instructions.

At that time, on that occasion, the great beings rested in absorption within, free of torment. The childish were tormented: their minds became bewildered, they were utterly dazed, and they wept without ceasing. Some worldly people came to the point of death; some fainted and swooned; some, their elements failing, became like corpses. Likewise all of them, like many orphans whose father has died, cried out in anguish, "Alas! Alas!" In the world with its gods, the vessel too became unpleasant, and in its contents, the maṇḍala of mind grew dim. The complexion of those turned toward this Dharma grew dark. The faces of those who sided with Māra and of the factions of others grew bright, and all of them proclaimed words of mockery.

Then, when eight and twelve years had passed, the great beings of the sacred lineage arose from their absorption. Since the teacher of the world had set, they were as if struck by a wound, and all of them, each through his own clairvoyance, by the work of miraculous power, gathered manifestly upon the summit of Malaya, where there is meteoric iron, on the lake island of a town in the land of Laṅkā. Having fully assembled, all of them with one voice, with utterly anguished cries, poured out their grief in this lament:

"Oh! Alas! Oh, how bewildered we are!
Now that the light of the Teacher's lamp has set,
who will dispel the darkness of the world?
Since that face of valid authority is no longer present,
will not the beings who wish to enter
the teaching spoken by that authority
enter it wrongly?
When persons who claim to be authorities

interpret the word
to benefit persons who have not found it,
how will it ever be settled?
With the eye that discerns good from bad closed,
and the fault of disregarding the word itself
having reached its very peak,
will not the power of the perverse increase?
With clouds of perverse teaching gathering,
the sun and moon of the two truths have set;
will not the beings who seek the path
wander in darkness?
Now that the Teacher has passed into nirvāṇa,
who will tame the māras, the rākṣasas, the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas),
the yakṣas, the bhūtas, the nonhumans,
the savage and the vicious?
If this nectar of the stainless teaching
were to set, how utterly terrible!
What person endowed with skill
will make it blaze and shine?
If we are parted from the jewel of the sacred training,
how utterly terrible!
What holy person
will uphold its ways?
Now that the Teacher is no longer present,
of all the Teacher's disciples,
the noble ones and the various ordinary persons,
who will receive a prophecy?
When the teaching that is like space
is held according to different inclinations,
with each taking the side of 'it is' or 'it is not,'
will not disputes increase?
That which is certainly of a single family,
when practiced divergently as discordant families,
will not that single family be corrupted and altered
into separate families?
Will not the priceless jewel,
by various unskilled persons

led by the force of afflicted desire,
be exchanged for poison?
The Teacher, the King of Dharma,
was present until now;
if the savage now do harm,
will not viciousness spread?
How long will the teaching endure here?
For how long will it remain as one?
Whatever arose here first, whatever arose first,
how will it be in this later age?
At the end of the Teacher's teaching,
how will it surely be?
The disciples who uphold the training,
how will they be at the end?
Having passed into nirvāṇa from here,
in what way, and as whose teacher, has he gone?
In which direction, in which buddha field, does he dwell?
What teaching does he proclaim there?
For us, protectorless in the world,
who will be protector and refuge?
If we lose that magical intelligence and counsel,
where shall we seek intelligence and counsel?
If we do not find this definitive meaning,
from whom shall we receive the definitive meaning?
If the object of worship, the support of our minds, is no longer present,
what will become of his relics?
To what shall we make offerings hereafter?
Now that the Teacher has passed away,
will a person arise to take his place?
Oh! Alas! Oh, how bewildered we are!"

Thus they poured out their grief.

This is the third chapter of the Great Sūtra That Gathers the Intentions of All the Buddhas, on the first lament poured out by the sacred ones.

When they had spoken thus in their anguish,
the sole friend of the beings of the three realms of existence,
the ocean of victors, heard them.

All those lords of compassion
gathered in the palace of Alakāvatī,
at the abode of the Lord of Secrets,
and spoke this great exhortation:
"You, lord of the guhyakas, the keepers of secrets,
has your armor of old faded away?
Do you not know the suffering of the world?
Having descended onto the ground of compassion,
it is fitting that you dispel the anguish of the world.
Taking on the guise of each one's own kind,
tame all those who are vicious;
with words that lead them by what they desire,
in keeping with their share of karma and their conduct,
transform their perceptions,
and then, having set forth the discourse of the Word,
it is fitting that you establish them in the genuine meaning."

When he had been exhorted thus,
the hero, the king Vajradhara,
skilled in taming those hard to tame,
supreme victor over all the world,
vajra bearer who holds the secret emblem,
rose delighted from his seat
and displayed every great miracle.
"The chiefs of a world gone astray,
prophesied as fortunate,
fully endowed with karma and fortune,
whom the Victor prophesied would appear,
the fortunate ones of great merit,
just as the emanation prophesied,
now that the time has come here,
in order to give prophecy in the very heart of saṃsāra,
through the blessing of miracles,
a sacred essence of the teaching,
just as it was explained and prophesied,
I shall discuss with those who are fortunate.
The mountain called Ferocious,

this site of a great hermitage,
is the place where the secret of the Great Vehicle arises
for those who possess the essence of wisdom.
Throughout time without beginning or end
it has been praised by the sacred ones.
By the countless victors
without beginning or end,
in that great and sacred hermitage,
the maṇḍala of mind, like a mirror,
was taught; and just so, I too,
without beginning or end,
whenever the time of exhortation comes,
I too shall likewise appear in miraculous display."
Thus he deliberated.

This is the fourth chapter of the Great Sūtra That Gathers the Intentions of All the Buddhas, on deliberating how to dispel their anguish.

Then, at that time, in that very place,
the King Who Tames the Harmful, having spoken thus,
in the world realm that is the abode of humans,
in Jambudvīpa among the four continents,
upon the mountain called Ferocious,
which is the gathering ground of yakṣas,
at the place of accomplishment of the lineage of Dharma holders,
came in manifest emanation onto the ground of compassion.
The whole earth shook,
and through wondrous miracles
all was purified and appeared in bliss.
To the fortunate ones who had appeared before,
those of sacred lineage who held inferior bodies,
and among humans to the great one of royal caste,
Prince Gift of the Victor, it dawned as an omen.
Then those of sacred lineage,
joyful, yet with doubt arising,
asked their question with great boldness:
"How wonderful! How marvelous, how amazing!
Great being, who are you?

Where have you come from, and how did you appear?
On what do you rely, and where are you going?
What is your purpose?" they asked.
The one of great miracles spoke thus:
"I am not moved by anything at all;
I am the unperturbed Vajrasattva.
Yet because I am stirred and moved by compassion,
I am the sole friend of the three realms of existence.
Great emptiness is my homeland;
the great vajra family is my lineage;
my father is supreme skillful means, beyond measure;
my mother is wisdom beyond expression.
In a time without beginning
I lost my wish-fulfilling jewel.
That precious jewel, that nectar:
not knowing I had it, I felt that it was lost.
Then, utterly impoverished,
tormented by a sickness without release,
I wandered in darkness, in pitch-black gloom,
and lost even the path I was to travel.
Though I suffered anguish, I did not know it was there.
Then my supreme spiritual friend,
a sacred and loving protector, showed me:
'Ah! Do you not know?
The precious jewel from which great wealth arises,
bringing happiness for as long as it is seen,
have you not lost it?
Or do you not know that you have it?
What is this? Are you dwelling in annihilation?'
So that supreme friend told me.
Then I in turn told him:
'That from which great wealth arises,
not knowing I had it, I felt that it was lost.
The means to meet with it,
friend, reveal to me!'
That sacred one gave his instruction:
'If you wish to meet with it quickly,

you must strive in the means of searching.'
The sacred guide who knew the land pointed it out:
'Though you travel the realm of darkness and light, the regions of the earth,
and all manner of paths,
and search, you will not find it elsewhere;
it comes from your very own land.
That is the home of the sacred ones
who found the jewel before;
it is the place of finding
of all that was found before.'
Having heard this, then I,
for the sake of the search,
looked to that sacred one for the way,
resolved with sacred understanding,
mounted that thoroughbred steed of the Great Vehicle,
and came out of the realm of both darkness and light.
I crossed the four rivers and their perilous gorges,
traveled various paths and searched everywhere,
entered the path of the sacred ones,
traveled the grounds and the path of liberation,
and reached the city of nirvāṇa.
When I traced the precious jewel to its source,
unarisen and unfound, in my own
home, the expanse of the nature of reality, I found it.
In the very finding there is no finding;
even in emptiness there is no emptying or parting.
Neither existent nor nonexistent, there is no losing or finding.
That it does not come from elsewhere but arises of itself:
knowing this is labeled 'finding', and not knowing it
is merely given the conventional term 'losing'.
The times of having, of losing and of finding
are from time without beginning.

Thus, out of the nature of reality, which is nothing at all,
now, at this time when emanations appear,
I have come to this realm of both darkness and light.
I am the ferryman of skillful means;

I have vowed to carry the three realms of existence
across the endless river of saṃsāra:
you who wish for liberation, come onto this path!
I am the eye doctor of skillful means;
I have vowed to remove the cataracts
of the countless blind of the world:
whoever wishes to see, come onto this path!
I am the physician of skillful means;
I have vowed to cure the chronic illness
of the sick in the three cities:
whoever wishes for happiness, come onto this path!
I am the guide of skillful means;
I have vowed to lead without error
the beings who have strayed onto wrong paths and lost the way:
whoever wishes for the genuine path, come onto this path!
I am the watchful eye of compassion;
I have vowed to protect all
from the terror of saṃsāra's hostile armies:
whoever wishes to be free of fear, come onto this path!
I am the great vajra fortress;
I have vowed to be the refuge of beings
from the armies in saṃsāra's great battle:
whoever wishes for a stronghold, come onto this path!
I am the merchant captain of skillful means;
I have vowed to give a great treasure
to those an ocean of desires cannot satisfy:
whoever wishes for treasure, come onto this path!
I am the lamp of skillful means;
I have vowed to dispel the pitch darkness
for those who wander in pitch-black gloom:
whoever wishes for light, come onto this path!
I am the wish-fulfilling jewel;
I have vowed to fulfill as they wish
those who truly wish for what they desire:
whoever wishes for spontaneous accomplishment, come onto this path!
I am the key to the Word;
I have vowed to open up

the secrets locked within the casket of the Word:
whoever wishes to be freed, come onto this path!
I am the commentary on the Word;
I have vowed to unravel with certainty
the profound volumes of the teachings:
all who wish to know, come onto this path!
On this great and pure path that liberates all,
whoever among the fortunate abides here,
the precious jewel blazing with light
will surely dawn for you; so strive!
It is the mirror of the mind;
the moment it is realized clearly in direct perception,
in the body of a being one is a buddha.
The supreme treasuries of the sacred definitive meaning
of the secret of the great vajra secret,
being discussed and clearly explained here,
will pass in succession through the vidyādharas
of gods and of humans and become renowned.
All the anguish of darkness
of every world of gods and humans will be dispelled,
and the maṇḍala of the mind will become clear.
Why have you entered into the anguish of darkness?
You grieve that the Sage has passed into nirvāṇa,
yet he possesses a body of space;
for him there is neither passing away nor not passing away,
for he is without transition or change, like space."

When the voice of the emanation had sounded thus,
those of noble lineage who had appeared before
were filled with supreme joy,
and with delighted, glad and rejoicing minds
they bowed their bodies with the greatest reverence,
sat before him, and said:
"Like lightning flashing in the sky
out of the dark clouds of night,
from the very expanse of suchness
that is without beginning or end,

upon that very great and pure path
you have appeared, being who accomplishes the aim.
Because you hold the secret of the sacred ones,
you are renowned as lord of the guhyakas.
Because you are praised for discoursing on the Word,
you are renowned as the Great Commentator on the Word.
Because the sun of the secret of the three treasuries
has risen upon every maṇḍala of the mind,
to dispel all the darkness of what is to be known,
you are renowned as the Radiant Sun.
Because you tame all who are hard to tame, without exception,
crush the demonic hosts of Māra and the māras,
and crush as well the hosts of terrors,
you are renowned as the Māra of Māras.
Because the essential nature of suchness,
the mind itself, luminous by nature,
lets all phenomena appear as reflections,
you are also renowned as the Mirror of Phenomena.
With the medicinal maṇḍala that destroys poison,
unsurpassed in drawing out the thorn,
because you have become the enemy of every disease,
you are renowned as the King of Physicians.
Because you make us delighted, glad and rejoicing,
you are renowned as the Dispeller of Anguish.
Because you fulfill desires as they are wished,
you are renowned as the Wish-Fulfilling Jewel.
Act in harmony with the sacred ones,
and for us, the vidyādharas,
tell how the sacred emanation has set,
how the sacred lamp is to be established,
and how the sacred secret scripture will arise.
Please discourse on the secret tantras;
please discourse on the three words of the intention;
please discourse on the vajra of space."
Thus they made their request.

This is the fifth chapter of the Great Sūtra That Gathers the Intentions of All the Buddhas, on the request to discourse on the sacred scripture.

When they had made this request,
the Lord of Secrets declared:
"You heroic beings in the bodies of beings,
prophesied to appear before,
listen, and I shall untie your illusory thoughts,
together with your laments and your questions.
The maṇḍala of the mind is suchness;
like space, it never sets.
Since its nature is luminous from the very beginning,
it itself dispels whatever obscures it.
Whatever is measured by the two valid cognitions,
that knowable too becomes valid.
The root of good and bad is also that very thing,
so in itself it does not change.
Since the nature of the mind is luminous,
there is no sun or moon whiter than it.
The Buddha never passes into nirvāṇa,
and the Dharma too will not decline;
it is to benefit the lazy
that the emanations display the manner of passing away.
Only if space itself were destroyed
would he then pass into nirvāṇa.
Those who are malicious and vicious
are tamed by the power of selflessness and emptiness.
The ocean of the teaching, luminous by nature,
free of elaboration, is that very thing as well;
the self-arisen lion endowed with prowess
makes it blaze and shine everywhere.
Since it is the very mind of the higher training,
this, supreme among all practices,
will be held by the heroic beings in the bodies of beings
who will appear later on the ground of Supreme Illumination.
Since sentient beings without end
abide primordially in the essence of awakening,
and their continuums are certain in suchness,

it declares that all are beyond training.
Whether the mind itself exists or does not exist,
over this the childish dispute.
The wise are free of dispute from the very beginning;
they do not utter words conceiving existence and nonexistence.
This secret of my secret mantra,
because it is the secret of all the buddhas,
when others conjecture about what cannot be conjectured,
in the secret, a single sound comes out as many.
This secret scripture of the sacred ones,
when those who do not know, brandishing their delusion,
exchange poison and nectar,
brings ruin, and both will be burned.
That great light, the all-illuminating mirror,
the Teacher, unmixed and perfectly complete,
is without transition or change, like space,
so harm is absent too, as with lightning flickering in the clouds.
As long as the essence of awakening exists,
so long will the teaching remain.
Since it arose from what is without beginning or end,
there is no earlier and no later.
Since its beginning is said to arise from nonexistence,
its end too becomes inexpressible and nonexistent.
The first of the lineage holders is suchness,
and the last will be nothing other than that.
From here he has gone into this suchness
and abides in the field of the great all-pervading expanse.
The luminous maṇḍala of the mind
appears clearly in suchness.
For the sake of the childish, as a miracle,
in the world called Array of Flowers
he appears as one called Unrenowned.
Yet even in appearing there is no appearing.
Likewise, in whatever buddha fields
the emanated buddhas make their appearance,
just like the magic of an illusion,
though not appearing here, their light appears elsewhere.

The supreme mind, the immovable vajra, too,
through the blessing of its compassionate emanations,
fills world realms beyond measure.
Darkness and light are self-arisen in nature.
The expanse of unborn wisdom itself,
from the primordial essence of the sugatas,
is obscured by adventitious thoughts through karma.
That itself is the great refuge, the protector of beings.
The three words of the Victor's intention
are magical intelligence and supreme counsel;
out of great and lasting wealth
they appear as the domain of sacred understanding.
For the minds of all the victors to enter in,
one sets the mind on the essence
that is certain as suchness itself,
exactly as it is: that is certainty itself.
All phenomena have the characteristic of space.
The victors whose bodies are wisdom,
since their bodies have no substantial being,
how could bodily relics arise?
For the benefit of sentient beings,
out of nonexistence itself, emanated
illusory relics the size of mustard seeds
were shown, set down through compassion and skillful means.
To want relics in a definitive sense
is like wanting butter from sand.
When rice is sown and sesame seeds ripen,
then there will be relics.
Images that appear, proclaiming scriptures, things containing the essence,
things containing the essence of body, speech and mind:
these are sacred objects of offering and supports for the mind,
so Vajrasattva, protector of beings, has explained.
The countless victors
arise from the continuums of the sentient beings of saṃsāra;
if the stream of the sentient beings of saṃsāra were cut,
the stream of the buddhas too would be cut off.
For example, a rainbow in the sky

did not come from elsewhere at the beginning,
and does not go elsewhere at the end;
just as it arises by itself and subsides by itself,
so emanations arise by themselves and subside by themselves,
and that itself never sets within itself.
Though he has passed away, he is not separated and not different;
and when he has not passed away, he is not one with us either.
Since he is beyond passing away and not passing away,
how could there be separation or non-separation?
So for what, and why, do you grieve?
Grief is delusion and error.
How wonderful! How amazing this is!
How mistaken this is!"

When the Lord of Secrets had sung this song in the manner of the lion's gaze, those who had been anguished by delusion became delighted, glad and rejoicing. Their anguish was entirely cleared away, they rested in uncontrived mind, and likewise all the maṇḍalas became luminous.

Then the Lord of Laṅkā asked the Lord of Secrets, "Great Lord of Secrets, do you dispel all anguish, or do you dispel only the anguish of the Sahā world?"

The Lord of Secrets said, "Lord of Laṅkā, I am the dispeller of all anguish. I have dispelled all the anguish there was in past times. Now I dispel the anguish of this Sahā world realm as well. I also dispel the anguish of other world realms as numerous as atoms. And I will dispel all the anguish there will be in the future. Therefore, those who are utterly anguished are only the unknowing, the deluded, those whose wits have not opened; but those who know, the undeluded, the learned whose wits have opened, have no anguish anywhere; they are free of anguish."

When they heard this, the Lord of Laṅkā and the other heroic beings in the bodies of beings were cleared of their anguish.

This is the sixth chapter of the Great Sūtra That Gathers the Intentions of All the Buddhas, called "Dispelling the Anguish of the Deluded."

From the Mode of the Definitive Emergence of the Great Vehicle: the account of dispelling the anguish of the deluded, a discussion of the wisdom of the Dharma seal. This is the first part, showing how it came about.

Then, in order to inquire fully into the prophecy he had been given before, the second of the twelve statements, "It will also arise when the lamp is fully set in place," the Lord of Laṅkā asked the Lord of Secrets, "Lord of Secrets, I heard before, without error, that the sacred treasury of the understanding of the great bodhisattvas, which dispels the anguish of the deluded and makes clear the maṇḍala of the minds of sentient beings; the intention of the tathāgatas, suchness, the sacred secret, the unmistaken correct view, praised by all the buddhas, the way of upholding that Great Vehicle, would arise once the Authoritative One had set. Is it so?"

The Lord of Secrets said, "Lord of Laṅkā, what do you think of this? Do you not know? The Authoritative One himself declared, speaking to Kuñjara, his brother in the Dharma: 'Vidyādhara, as to this question of yours: that sacred secret, suchness, arises on twelve occasions. It arises when the anguish of the deluded is dispelled. It arises when the lamp of the world is fully set in place. It arises when certainty is found. It arises when there is certainty in the essence of awakening itself. It arises when the intention is definitively explained. It arises for the sake of those to be trained, when their time has come. It arises when it appears through blessing. It arises when the lineage becomes renowned through skillful means. It arises when something is done for someone's sake. It arises when the great scripture is definitively taught. It arises when the continuum of karma is completely cut. It arises when the intention is discussed in detail. All of these, in every way, from every side and in every direction, fully appear, have appeared, and will appear.' Do you not know where this prophecy was proclaimed?"

The Lord of Laṅkā said, "How wonderful! Lord of Secrets, I have heard what is sacred to hear; I have heard the supreme of all that may be heard. Lord of Secrets, if the anguish of the utterly deluded has been cleared away, then it is just as was proclaimed: 'It will also arise when the lamp is fully set in place.' Will this one who has now passed away in this Sahā world realm be called 'the setting in place of the lamp'? And is this one who has passed away the lamp of this field of the Sahā world alone, a buddha who has passed into nirvāṇa? Or will the buddhas who have set in place the lamps of all the fields there are in every world realm pass into nirvāṇa?"

The Lord of Secrets said, "Lord of Laṅkā, what do you think of that? This too is called a lamp. As for the one who has now passed away, leave aside the buddhas of all the fields; leave aside even the buddhas of a million koṭis of Jambudvīpas. Understand it as the complete nirvāṇa of one buddha of a single

Jambudvīpa. Why is that? Because this field is the field of one single emanated buddha. In the same way, the inconceivable buddhas, as many as there are, perform the work of lamps in immeasurable world realms. Just as it is with them, so you should regard the emanated buddhas as numerous as atoms."

Then the Lord of Laṅkā, the bodhisattva, the great being, asked, "Lord of Secrets, this single emanated buddha of a single Jambudvīpa in the Sahā field who has passed into nirvāṇa: as the emanation of which buddha should I take him to be?"

The Lord of Secrets said, "Lord of Laṅkā, understand him to be no more than a single portion of emanation from among the inconceivable emanations of Vajrasattva."

He said, "Lord of Secrets, since in this field he is renowned as Śākyamuni, how should this be understood?"

He said, "Lord of Laṅkā, that is merely a designation for the emanation of Vajrasattva. Lord of Laṅkā, why is that? Because the inconceivable emanations of Vajrasattva have utterly conquered the inconceivable armies of saṃsāra, they are renowned as Great Sages. And the way in which they are renowned as Great Sages in the ten directions of the six worlds is this. In the abode of the gods the Great Sage is renowned as Holder of Mastery over Existence. In the abode of the asuras the Great Sage is renowned as Vijaya. In the abode of humans the Great Sage is renowned as Śākyasiṃha. In the abode of animals the Great Sage is renowned as Subjugator. In the abode of the hungry ghosts the Great Sage is renowned as Vairocana. In the abode of the hells the Great Sage is renowned as Dharmarāja.

"O Lord of Laṅkā, and not only there. Just as in the ten directions of the six worlds of Sahā the lamps of the six sages fully appear, so too in the boundless ten directions of the six worlds of inconceivable world realms as numerous as atoms, boundless lamps of the six sages, as numerous as atoms, appear, as follows. In the east, beyond twelve thousand world realms of four continents, there is a world realm called Stainless. That entire field is made of various jewels. The beings who dwell there are equal in life span and in every enjoyment to the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three. There is no untimely death; all of them are born miraculously, and every desire is fulfilled merely by thinking of it. There, there is no giving, no giving away, and no one who receives or begs; when they hear talk of other world realms where giving and begging exist, they long for that. There, the Lord of Sages, the emanation of

Vajrasattva, appearing as the Tathāgata Śākyamuni Stainless Voice, makes the Dharma of the Great Vehicle, the luminous maṇḍala of the mind, the great lamp of the essential nature of secret mantra, fully appear. In the ten directions of the six worlds of that very realm, too, the lamps of the six sages appear and make the maṇḍala of the minds of the six classes of beings fully clear.

"Again, that Lord of Sages, in the south, beyond a hundred thousand world realms, in the world realm called Source of Qualities, emanates as the Tathāgata Śākyamuni Ratnamegha and makes that very essence of secret mantra, the luminous maṇḍala of the mind, fully appear.

In the ten directions of the six worlds of that very realm, too, the lamps of the six Great Sages appear and make clear the maṇḍala of the minds of the six classes of beings.

"Again, that Lord of Sages, in the west, beyond twenty thousand world realms, in the world realm called Fully Spread with Ornaments, where every person is born miraculously, in that field where the life span is eighty-four thousand years, appears as the Tathāgata Śākyamuni Source of Qualities and teaches that very essence of secret mantra, the luminous maṇḍala of the mind. In the ten directions of the six worlds of that very realm, too, the lamps of the six sages appear and make clear the maṇḍala of the mind.

"Again, that Lord of Sages, in the north, beyond thirty thousand world realms, in the world realm called Free of Shyness, appears as the Tathāgata Śākyamuni Lion's Roar and teaches that very essence of secret mantra, the luminous maṇḍala of the mind. In the ten directions of the six worlds of that very realm, too, the lamps of the six sages appear and make the maṇḍala of the minds of the six classes of beings luminous.

"Likewise, that Lord of Sages, in the southeast, beyond eighty-four thousand world realms, in the world realm called Thoroughly Beautiful, emanates as the Tathāgata Śākyamuni Crest of Beauty and teaches the Dharma as above. In the southwest, beyond seventy thousand world realms, in the world realm called Fully Illuminated, that Tathāgata Śākyamuni appears as Ornament of Splendor and teaches the Dharma as above. In the northwest, beyond fifty thousand world realms, in the world realm called Utterly Clear, that Tathāgata Śākyamuni appears as Glorious Supreme Sandalwood Fragrance and teaches the Dharma as above. In the northeast, beyond forty-four thousand world realms, in the world realm called Dispeller of Anguish, that Tathāgata

Śākyamuni appears as King of Compassion and teaches the Dharma as above.

"Likewise, in the world realm called Illumination, he appears as the buddha called Swift Holder and teaches the Dharma. Again, in the world realm Array of Jewels, he appears as the buddha called Cloud of Joyful Eyes and teaches the Dharma just as it is. Again, in the world realm called Fully Spread, he appears as the tathāgata called King of Perfect Intention and teaches the Dharma just as it is. Again, in the world realm called Essence of Beryl, he appears as the buddha called Golden Light Rays and teaches the Dharma just as it is. Again, in the world realm called Sacred Light, he appears as the tathāgata called Glorious Light and teaches the Dharma just as it is. Again, in the world realm called Fully Pacified, he appears as the tathāgata called Lord of Peace and teaches the Dharma just as it is. Again, in the world realm called Array of Clouds, he appears as the tathāgata called Glorious Cloud and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the field called Delight of the Mind, he appears as the buddha called Pleasing Melody and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the one called Thoroughly Polished Disk of the Mirror, he appears as the buddha called Mirror Light Appearing and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the field called Adorned by the Moon, he appears as the buddha called Glorious Moonlight and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the field called Adorned with Sunbeams, he appears as the tathāgata called Glorious Essence of the Sun and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the field called Filled with the Scent of Incense, he appears as the buddha called King of Incense and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the field called Ornament of Display, he appears as the buddha called King of Manifest Delight and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the field called Jewel Display, he appears as the buddha called Jewel King and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the field called Source of Light Rays, he appears as the buddha called Glorious Light Rays and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the field called Practice of Hardship, he appears as the buddha called King of Austerity and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the field called Array of the Crown, he appears as the buddha called Essence of the Crown and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the field called Possessed of Certainty, he appears as the buddha called Gone with Certainty and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the field called Certainly Exalted, he appears as the buddha called Spoken with Certainty and teaches the Dharma

genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the field called Conduct of Bliss, he appears as the buddha called Great Bliss and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the field called Strewn with Flowers, he appears as the buddha called Melody of the Lord of Flowers and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the field called Universally Renowned, he appears as the buddha called Glorious Renown and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the field called Magical Display, he appears as the buddha called King of Emanation and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the field called Thoroughly Purified, he appears as the buddha called Inexhaustible Melody and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the field called Adorned with Medicine, he appears as the buddha called King of Medicine and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is.

Again, in the field called Golden Radiance, he appears as the buddha called Golden Light Rays and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the field called Array of Light Rays, he appears as the buddha called King of Arrays and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the field called Source of Gold, he appears as the buddha called Golden Upright One and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the field called Source of Glory, he appears as the buddha called King of Glory and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the field called Sublime Light, he appears as the buddha called Glory of Heaped Light and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the field called Sorrowless, he appears as the buddha called Sorrowless Glory and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the field called Radiance of Joy, he appears as the buddha called Glory of Supreme Joy and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the field called Source of Splendor, he appears as the buddha called Glorious Splendor and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the field called Gathering of Many Buddhas, he appears as the buddha called Spiritual Friend of All and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the field called Thorough Purification, he appears as the buddha called Purifier of All Lower Realms and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the field called Diverse Conduct, he appears as the buddha called Teacher of the Whole World and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the field called Armlet of the Victory Banner's Crest, he appears as the buddha called Vijaya and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the field called Ornament of Beautiful Flowers, he appears as the buddha called King of the Array of Flowers and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the

field called Beautiful Appearance, he appears as the buddha called All-Illuminating and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the field called Sandalwood Array, he appears as the buddha called Sandalwood Fragrance and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, in the field called Source of Lions, he appears as the buddha called Hundred Thousand Lion Forms and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. Again, here in this great trichiliocosm called Sahā, he appears as the buddha called Great Sage and teaches the Dharma genuinely, just as it is.

In the same way, in koṭis of millions of world systems, he shows koṭis of millions of names of Vajrasattva and illuminates the Dharma genuinely, just as it is. In some he has become fully and perfectly awakened. In some he still dwells in his mother's womb. In some he dwells in the abode of Tuṣita. In some he has passed into complete nirvāṇa. In some, having shown the manner of passing away, he appears as a lamp for others, from one world system to another. In some, in the guise of a universal monarch, he teaches the Dharma of the Great Vehicle. In some, in the form of a śrāvaka, he teaches the Dharma of the Lesser Vehicle. In some, through the miraculous powers of one in the form of a pratyekabuddha, he teaches the Dharma. In some he sits at the seat of awakening. In some he proceeds to the ground of exhortation. In some he appears in the guise of liberation, that is, as a renunciant. In some, in the guise of a householder. In some, in the form of a god. In some, in the form of a nāga. In some, in the form of an asura. In some, in the form of a māra. In some, in the form of a yakṣa. In some, in the form of a rākṣasa. In some, in the form of a bhūta. In some, in the form of a garuḍa. In some, in the form of a wondrous being. In some, in the form of an animal. In some, in the form of a hungry ghost. In some, in the form of one endowed with patience. In some, in the form of a butcher. In some, in the form of a prostitute. In some, in the form of a young girl. In some he appears as bodily remains. In some he appears as relics. In some he appears as Vajrasattva himself. In some he appears as Vairocana. In some he appears as Ratnasambhava. In some he appears as Amitābha. In some he appears as Amoghasiddhi. And these too teach the Dharma genuinely, just as it is.

Furthermore, in order to liberate the king of delusion, he appears in a form like that of Brahmā. In order to liberate the king of aversion, he appears in a form like that of Viṣṇu. In order to liberate the lord of attachment, he appears in a form like that of Rudra. In order to liberate the lord of pride, he appears like Gaṇapati. In order to liberate the lord of jealousy, he appears like Indra.

Likewise he appears in the forms of all kinds of births: he takes on the forms of the god called Eager to Enter, of Nara, of Īśvara, of Balabhadra, of Vasudhara, of a monkey, a goat, a sheep, a dog, a bee, a crow, a firefly, and any creature whatsoever, and in each such guise he appears to beings according to their inclinations. Just as the reflections of the disks of the sun and moon, without moving from their celestial palaces, appear as different reflections in different waters, so the Buddha, without moving from being Vajrasattva himself, appears as limitless buddhas in immeasurable fields.

Thus, even if the beings dwelling in the limitless buddha fields designated by various names were to speak for inexpressible eons of the various names by which they know the Buddha Vajrasattva, they would not reach the end even of the characteristics of the one who dwells in the buddha fields of the eastern direction alone. Likewise, even if the beings dwelling in the buddha fields of all ten directions were to speak for inexpressible eons, they would not come to the end of his names. When beings of slight aspiration hear of Vajrasattva's immeasurable fields and limitless names, their minds are left dumbfounded and they become as though intoxicated.

Thus, in all those fields of Vajrasattva, he teaches nothing but the luminous maṇḍala of mind, the very essence of secret mantra, genuinely, just as it is, wholly without distortion, both gradually and all at once. Why is that? Because the great beings dwelling in Vajrasattva's fields are of various dispositions of mind, with understanding that is very deep or not deep, broad or narrow, stable or changeable, sharp or dull, quick or slow. So that all of them, on hearing the discourse on the very essence of mantra, gradually or all at once, may be neither frightened nor alarmed by it, but become delighted, pleased and satisfied, he appears in various ways.

The span of life of those dwelling there is short, long, or immeasurable; it lasts a hundred years, or as much as eighty-four thousand. There are some whose enjoyments come about just as they wish, and there are some who acquire them through hardship and some who do not. All of them, without exception, have received prophecy. Whoever hears the name of the Buddha Vajrasattva has served many victors in the past. They will surely be born in the very fields of Vajrasattva. They are blessed by the victors. They will surely go forth in the Great Vehicle. They are endowed with the higher perceptions. They are certain to be children of the Buddha. They are endowed with the eye of insight.

O Lord of Laṅkā, therefore, this single buddha of the one continent of Jambudvīpa has passed into nirvāṇa. Likewise, among all the emanated buddhas of Vajrasattva, there are some who have passed into nirvāṇa and some who have not.

When this had been said, that embodied being was wholly satisfied in mind.

This concludes the seventh chapter, the Complete Array of Vajrasattva's Miracles, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then the Lord of Laṅkā asked, "Lord of Secrets, to what does the name Vajrasattva refer?"

The Lord of Secrets said, "Lord of Laṅkā, Vajrasattva refers to the luminous maṇḍala of mind, the suchness of the essence of secret mantra just as it is."

The Lord of Laṅkā asked, "O Lord of Secrets, what is meant by maṇḍala of mind? Likewise, to what do luminous, essence of secret mantra, and the just-as-it-is, the thus, suchness, refer?"

The Lord of Secrets said, "Lord of Laṅkā, mind is that which, unmade and uncontrived, arises in various ways. Maṇḍala is whatever is the bindu, the sphere itself. Light is appearance. Clear means unobscured by anything at all other than unknowing. Secret refers to what has not become the domain of speakers. Mantra refers to what is declared a source of qualities. Essential nature refers to the ground from which everything arises, without entity and without reference. Just as it is refers to what is uncontrived and unadulterated. Thus refers to what is unmade and unimputed. Suchness refers to what is unmistaken and unchanging."

Again the Lord of Laṅkā asked, "Lord of Secrets, what is meant by unmade and uncontrived? What is meant by arising in various ways?"

The Lord of Secrets said, "Lord of Laṅkā, it is unmade because there is no agent and it cannot be sought out as an action. It is uncontrived because the ground is just as it is. That from which, though it is nothing, there continually arise in diverse ways beings going to different domains, good, bad, and neither, that very thing is like space. What arises from it continually is like clouds, mist, rainbows and so forth."

Again he asked, "Lord of Secrets, why is that called Vajrasattva?"

He said, "Lord of Laṅkā, that suchness just as it is is in every respect without antidote, without transference or change, without arising or ceasing; it is suchness, mind aware of itself. Because, as the Explanation of the Intention makes clear, it conquers the various miracles that arise as being without entity, it is called Vajrasattva.

"Lord of Laṅkā, it is also called the unsurpassed awakening mind. It is also called the nature of reality of phenomena, suchness. It is also called the emptiness of mind. It is also called that which transcends extremes. It is also called that which is not apprehended even as a middle. It is also called the actual basis of all buddhas. It is also called the source of all emanations. It is also called the spiritual friend of all buddhas. It is also called the lamp of all fields. It is also called the source of compassion and skillful means. It is also called the appearance of the reflections of all phenomena.

"Lord of Laṅkā, these too are designated in that way for a purpose, but in suchness itself there is no designation by name; they should be understood to be mere figurative designations. Therefore, Lord of Laṅkā, buddha is a figurative designation. Dharma too is a figurative designation. Awakening too is a figurative designation. Likewise, all that is designated and clung to as the expanse, wisdom, the Dharma body, the different bodies, sentient beings, the world, and so on, should be understood to be nothing but figurative designations.

"Lord of Laṅkā, whatever is a figurative designation is adventitiously imputed; it is not primordially present. Lord of Laṅkā, if it were primordially present, then everything adventitious would not arise. Lord of Laṅkā, the adventitious is like clouds: it is not permanent, not primordially present, and does not withstand examination. Therefore, Lord of Laṅkā, names, signs, conventions, marks, imputations, karma, and the ripening of karma should all be understood to be adventitious, arising and clearing away, obscuring and becoming clear.

"Lord of Laṅkā, if karma, the ripening of karma and so forth were not adventitiously imputed, then what is called suchness could not be so. Lord of Laṅkā, that suchness should be understood to be a figurative designation that does not fall under the power of anything. Therefore, Lord of Laṅkā, all phenomena are nameless, wordless, inexpressible; the path of words is cut off."

He said, "Lord of Secrets, is there not even the conception of a mere meaning as a basis for what is designated by a name?"

He said, "Lord of Laṅkā, there is no conception even of a mere meaning as a basis. There is no conceptualization at all."

"Why is that? Because even the Buddha himself, though he searches, does not find any mere meaning as a basis of which one could say, 'This is it.' Therefore, conceptualizing adventitiously and not conceptualizing are merely designated as sentient being and buddha; in suchness itself there is not the slightest buddha or sentient being. Yet childish beings, obscured by the clouds of the adventitious, make adventitious phenomena their concern and conceive of saṃsāra and awakening as two. They conceive of sentient beings and buddhas as two."

He said, "Lord of Secrets, then how should these two, sentient beings and buddhas, be understood?"

He said, "Lord of Laṅkā, they should be understood as emptiness."

He said, "Lord of Secrets, in what does emptiness abide?"

He said, "Lord of Laṅkā, emptiness abides in all phenomena."

He said, "Lord of Secrets, in what do all phenomena abide?"

He said, "Lord of Laṅkā, because all phenomena are nothing but emptiness, they abide in nothing at all."

He said, "Lord of Secrets, abiding in emptiness, in what does one abide?"

He said, "Lord of Laṅkā, to abide in emptiness is to abide in great loving-kindness; it is to abide in that emptiness by which the welfare of sentient beings is brought to complete fulfillment. Why is that? Because for buddhas and sentient beings there is no meaning whatever apart from emptiness."

He said, "Lord of Secrets, if buddhas and sentient beings are all empty, whose great compassion acts upon whom, and how? Of what is that great compassion a figurative expression?"

He said, "Lord of Laṅkā, because all phenomena abide by their very nature in emptiness, they are not seen as two, and so compassion has no object. This is great compassion, because it delivers all beings completely to the heart of awakening. But if, with the compassion of childish beings, one were to rescue the lives of the beings of a great trichiliocosm and bring them out to freedom,

that should be understood to be lesser compassion. Lord of Laṅkā, therefore one should abide by abiding continually in great compassion.

"Lord of Laṅkā, those who abide in great compassion neither liberate any being nor bind any; theirs is a killing with the vajra weapon in which there is no actual killing at all. Why is that? Because, from the absence of sentient beings, sentient beings are designated. That great compassion should be understood to be a figurative expression for the distinction between suchness and the adventitious.

"Lord of Laṅkā, therefore it is like this:

All phenomena designated by limitless names,
Seen as existent, appearing and renowned,
Are merely designated as figurative labels:
How could there be any actual basis in them?

The basis on which names are designated
Is a nonexistent cause; imputed, clung to and pursued, it is accomplished,
And appears wherever one looks.
Therefore, with nothing to be done, all is already done.

From what does not appear, all things appear;
Each and every thing appears adventitiously.
Appearance itself is the heart of nonexistence,
And is not apprehended as either existent or nonexistent.

From the absence of buddhas, the various figurative names
Such as buddha, awakening,
The nature of reality, and so forth,
Are designated in order to teach the ignorant and deluded.

In that very thing, the figurative names
Of convention such as buddha,
Awakening, the nature of reality, and so forth,
Are without name and are not expressed in words.

From the vast center of the sky of the nature of reality,
The sun body of wisdom, shining clearly,
With the light rays of the lamp of compassion,
Dispels the darkness of delusion and illuminates all."

When he had said this, the Lord of Laṅkā and the other embodied beings found relief, without hope or striving toward anything else.

This concludes the eighth chapter, Showing the Very Essence of Secret Mantra, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

From the Way of Going Forth in the Great Vehicle, the account of the Complete Array of the Lamp, a discussion of the wisdom of the Dharma seal: this is the second part, showing how it came about.

Here the second fascicle begins.

Then the Lord of Laṅkā again questioned the Lord of Secrets about what had been taught earlier as the third of the twelve statements about past events, that "it has also arisen when someone gains certainty." He asked, "O Lord of Secrets, when you yourself showed the way the supreme secret of the Great Vehicle came about and told it in your prophecy, you set out that 'it has also arisen when someone gains certainty.' In what way is that gained, so that it is spoken of?"

He said, "Lord of Laṅkā, this refers to that very suchness in which someone gains unmistaken certainty about the suchness of Vajrasattva, the essence of secret mantra."

He said, "Lord of Secrets, from where did Vajrasattva, the essence of secret mantra, arise? Where does he abide? Where does he appear? How did he arise?"

When he had asked this, the Lord of Secrets said, "O Lord of Laṅkā, Vajrasattva, the very essence of secret mantra, arose from the element of both saṃsāra and nirvāṇa. He abides in the heart of all buddhas and the mind of all sentient beings. He appears in limitless fields. He is self-arisen as primordially just as he is and as purified in the mindstream."

Again the Lord of Laṅkā asked, "Lord of Secrets, on what should one settle with certainty as Vajrasattva himself?"

The Lord of Secrets said, "Lord of Laṅkā, Vajrasattva is free from any essential nature of being one or different. The nature of reality of phenomena, uncontrived and unadulterated, abiding primordially at the heart of awakening, is designated Vajrasattva primordially just as he is. The occasion on which one sees the nature of reality of the minds of all sentient beings is designated Vajrasattva of the purified mindstream. Likewise, all buddhas too appear as buddhas primordially just as they are and as buddhas of the purified mindstream. Therefore certainty about Vajrasattva should be settled on the suchness of all things, primordially just as it is."

Again the Lord of Laṅkā asked, "Lord of Secrets, what is the nature of reality of the minds of all sentient beings? Seeing what, does one see it?"

When he had asked this, the Lord of Secrets said, "Lord of Laṅkā, if one sees the way all sentient beings are, one sees it. The way all sentient beings are is unsurpassed awakening. In it not even an atom of any phenomenon is apprehended. It has the characteristic of space. In it there is no one who awakens and nothing to be awakened to. In it there are no sentient beings and no designation as sentient beings. There is no bearer of qualities and no designation as a bearer of qualities."

"Why is that? Because all phenomena have the characteristic of awakening, and awakening has the characteristic of space, and space is free of all characteristics. Therefore awakening is to be sought in the mind. Because that mind is by nature completely pure, it is not within, it is not outside, and it is not apprehended in between the two. That mind has not been seen, is not seen, and will not be seen even by the buddhas.

"How is it that they have not seen it? They have not seen it as a color. They have not seen it as a shape. They have not seen it as darkness. They have not seen it as light. They have not seen it as male or female. They have not seen it as neuter. They have not seen it as having the nature of the three realms. They have not seen it as the mind of a god. They have not seen it as the mind of a nāga. Likewise they have not seen it as the mind of any of the different classes of beings: the mind of a yakṣa, the mind of a gandharva, of an asura, a garuḍa, a kinnara, a mahoraga, a human or a nonhuman, an animal, a hungry ghost, a hell being and so forth. It is free of all thought and conceptuality. Why is that? Because the nature of mind is the self-arisen wisdom of Vajrasattva, and that wisdom has the nature of space, since it has no intrinsic nature."

Again the Lord of Laṅkā asked, "O Lord of Secrets, why is the mind of sentient beings the self-arisen wisdom of Vajrasattva?"

The Lord of Secrets said, "Lord of Laṅkā, the suchness of sentient beings and the suchness of Vajrasattva are not two and cannot be made two. How is that? It is like this. The suchness of a mind of attachment is the suchness of Vajrasattva. The suchness of Vajrasattva is reality. The suchness of a mind without attachment is the suchness of Vajrasattva. The suchness of Vajrasattva is reality. The reality of a mind of aversion is the suchness of Vajrasattva. The suchness of Vajrasattva is reality. The suchness of a mind of loving-kindness is the suchness of Vajrasattva. The suchness of Vajrasattva is

reality. The suchness of a mind of delusion is the suchness of Vajrasattva. The suchness of Vajrasattva is reality. The suchness of great wisdom is the suchness of Vajrasattva. The suchness of Vajrasattva is reality. The suchness of a mind of doubt is the suchness of Vajrasattva. The suchness of Vajrasattva is reality. The suchness of a mind of certainty is the suchness of Vajrasattva. The suchness of Vajrasattva is reality. The suchness of a mind of darkness is the suchness of Vajrasattva. The suchness of Vajrasattva is reality. The suchness of a mind of light is the suchness of Vajrasattva. The suchness of Vajrasattva is reality. The suchness of a mind of pride is the suchness of Vajrasattva. The suchness of Vajrasattva is reality. The suchness of a mind of jealousy is the suchness of Vajrasattva. The suchness of Vajrasattva is reality. The suchness of a mind of gathering in is the suchness of Vajrasattva. The suchness of Vajrasattva is reality.

"Likewise, the reality of a mind of sending out, the reality of a mind of dividing, the reality of an agitated mind, the reality of a peaceful mind, the reality of a mind of fighting, the reality of a mind of joining together, the reality of a mind of disputing, the reality of a mind in harmony, the reality of a speaking mind, the reality of a mind without speech, the reality of the mind of a god, the reality of the mind of a nāga, the reality of the mind of a māra, the reality of the mind of an asura, the reality of the mind of a yakṣa, the reality of the mind of a human, the reality of the mind of a mahoraga, the reality of the mind of a bhūta, the reality of the mind of a garuḍa, the reality of the mind of a gandharva, the reality of the mind of a kumbhāṇḍa, the reality of the mind of a man, the reality of the mind of a woman, the reality of the mind of a neuter, the reality of one's own mind, the reality of another's mind, the reality of a father's mind, the reality of a mother's mind, the reality of a child's mind, the reality of a sibling's mind, the reality of an enemy's mind, the reality of the mind of Īśvara, the reality of the mind of Brahmā, the reality of the mind of Desiring Inclusion, the reality of the mind of Indra, the reality of the mind of Gaṇapati, the reality of the mind of a wandering ascetic, the reality of the mind of a merchant, the reality of the mind of a farmer, the reality of a mind like a river, the reality of a mind like a pond, the reality of a mind like a well, the reality of a mind like an array, the reality of a mind like a wheel, the reality of a mind like a water wheel, the reality of a mind like boiling water, the reality of a mind like molten gold, the reality of a mind that guards everything, the reality of a mind like stinginess, the reality of a mind like giving, the reality of a mind like a cat, the reality of a mind like a descending flame, the reality of a

mind like lightning, the reality of a mind like a cloud, the reality of a mind like a mouse, the reality of a mind like a dog, the reality of a mind like a song,

the reality of a mind like a dance, the reality of a mind like cymbals, the reality of a mind like a peacock, the reality of a mind like the sound of a drum, and a mind like seasonal thunder, a mind like a lion, a mind like a bumblebee, a mind like a bee, a mind like a sea monster, a mind like a turtle, a mind like an emanation, a mind like a buffalo, a mind like an owl, a mind like a monkey, a mind like a crow, a mind like a horse, a mind like a goose, a mind like a heron, the mind of a wolf, the mind of a fox, a mind like an elephant, a mind like a sheep, a mind like a hawk, the mind of a householder, the mind of the homeless, the mind of the liberated, the mind of the unliberated, the mind of a rākṣasa, the mind of a wild man, the mind of a young girl, the mind of a king, the mind of a prostitute, the mind of a harlot, the mind of a brahmin, the mind of a butcher, the mind of a hungry ghost, the mind of a hell being, the mind of a thorn, the mind of cotton, the mind of the underworld, the mind of the sky, the mind of a net, the mind of a snare, the mind of a noose, the mind of a ligri, the mind of a hook, the mind of a hammer, the mind of a ladle, the mind of a vessel, the mind of a khrimön, the mind of a flame, the mind of an ember, the mind of a lamp, the mind of the sun, the mind of the moon, the mind of silver, the mind of gold, the mind of a spark, the mind of wind, the mind of water, the mind of a spear shaft, the mind of a pestle, the mind of a door, the mind of a plank, the mind of fire, the mind of earth, the mind of mud, the mind of muddy water, the mind of pigment, the mind of a jewel, the mind of poison, the mind of medicine, the mind of food, the mind of a pit, the mind of an arrow, the mind of a sword, the mind of a wheel, the mind of a bow, the mind of a fetter, the mind of wood, the mind of salt, the mind of a razor, the mind of a measuring line, the mind of a vajra, the mind of Mount Meru, the mind of the ocean, the mind of a boulder, the mind of a maternal uncle, the mind of a cave, the mind of birth, the mind of a flower, the mind of fruit, the mind of a root, the mind of a branch, the mind of a stalk, the mind of sweetness, the mind of bitterness, the mind of sourness, the mind of pungency, the mind of mildness, the mind of astringency, the mind of letters, the mind of a clay votive image, the mind of a key, a mind like a jagak bird, a mind like a park, a mind like a summer cloud, a mind like a mirror, a mind like sesame oil, a mind like winter beer, and so on: the suchness of all these limitless minds is the suchness of Vajrasattva. The suchness of Vajrasattva is reality just as it is.

"O Lord of Laṅkā, why is that? Because the suchness of Vajrasattva is uncontrived and unadulterated, unmade and unexamined, just as it is; and the suchness of the minds of all sentient beings too is uncontrived, unadulterated, unmade and unexamined, reality just as it is. Even the eye of omniscience has not seen, does not see, and will not see the natures of these two as separate. Even the discerning wisdom of the regent beings has not distinguished, does not distinguish, and will not distinguish them as separate.

"O Lord of Laṅkā, those who wish to gain certainty about secret mantra should recognize the reality of mind. Why is that? Because the minds that appear as different, as they do for a yogin of ritual activity, appear as the single reality of mind, as they do for a yogin beyond activity; and since that single reality is the supreme secret reality, even Vajrasattva, the heart of all buddhas, gained certainty about secret mantra by realizing the reality of mind. How is that? The reality of mind is the gateway of complete purity. It is the gateway of the light of the Dharma. It is the expanse of phenomena. It is the great volume of the Dharma. It is the great samādhi of the stream of the Dharma.

"O Lord of Laṅkā, it is also like this:

Whoever finds the reality of mind,
That secret essence,
Even if it is not explained in the words of the Guide,
Has dharmas arising in the mind by countless hundreds of thousands;
At the doorway of speech all becomes clear.
The reasons that bring certainty about the meaning
They are able to express and bring forth in words.
They have attained the samādhi of the stream of the Dharma.

"O Lord of Laṅkā, thus the reality of mind is great awakening, and great awakening is that of Vajrasattva. It is also the nectar of all buddhas, like this:

Without the water of the awakening mind,
Even the victors would dry up.
This river of the awakening mind
Moistens the parched banks of former clinging to extremes.

Because the nature of mind is emptiness,
All that arises from it is empty.
Because that is empty, awakening too
Is nothing but the essence of emptiness.

The great water of self-arisen wisdom:
From the center of the expanse of the wondrous ocean
Flows the water of the nectar of awakening,
Which cools all the victors.

This is the secret essence,
The very nature ascertained
As the reality of Vajrasattva,
Praised as supreme by all the victors.

"Therefore, Lord of Laṅkā, to recognize the reality of mind is the great affair of the realm."

When the Lord of Secrets had spoken thus, everyone entered the path of complete liberation into the reality of Vajrasattva.

This concludes the ninth chapter, Showing the Reality of Vajrasattva, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then again the Lord of Laṅkā asked the Lord of Secrets, "Lord of Secrets, whose domain of experience is that essence of secret mantra, the reality of mind?"

He said, "Lord of Laṅkā, it is the domain of experience of the buddhas, the blessed ones, but not of those who dwell on the grounds, one after another. Why is that? Because it is thus difficult to examine, difficult to teach, and free of all conventions of expression."

Again the Lord of Laṅkā asked, "O Lord of Secrets, if that reality of mind, the essence of secret mantra, is not shared with others, apart from being the domain of experience of the sublime ones, then consider the yogins who engage in practice. When they too look at the reality of mind and search throughout the mind stream, at that time they do not see an inner mind, they do not see an outer mind, and they do not see a mind both inner and outer. They do not see mind in the aggregates, they do not see it in the elements, and they do not see it in the sense sources. Not seeing mind in this way, when they look into where this mind comes from, they reflect thus: mind arises because there is an object of focus. And they reflect further:

Is that object of focus one thing,
and that mind something else?
Is the object of focus itself the mind?
Is the mind itself the object of focus?

If the object of focus is one thing,
and the mind is something else,

then reality is not one but becomes two. But if they are one, then it is not reasonable that mind should follow and look at mind, or that mind should see mind. Just as, for example, a sword cannot cut itself, and the tip of a finger cannot touch itself, so that mind cannot take that mind as its object. When they look in this way, they see it thus: it is independent; mind has no location and no support; it is not annihilated and not permanent; it is not heaped together; it does not arise from causes and is not produced by conditions; it is not from itself and not from another; it is not the same and not other; it has no class and no cause; it does not radiate and does not appear; it is without essential nature. They see it just as it is. It is genuine, unmoving and secluded. They see not even the slightest thing, and do not see anything distinctly. They do not conceive and do not discriminate; they do not stir, do not think, and do not emanate. Mind is formless, and whatever arises is also formless. Since in that there is no form, awakening too has no form. The nature of mind is awakening. The nature of awakening is all phenomena. The nature of all phenomena is reality.

"This mind is thus swift, extremely swift, unabiding, roving, like a monkey, like the wind, like a mirage, like a stream of water, like a lamp, like the image of a body; it travels far, it moves nowhere at all, it turns back, it dwells on objects, it ranges over the six, it knows everything, it is capable of one-pointedness, it does not arise, it arises as everything, it abides in calm, it is diverse yet one, undistracted and wholly distracted. They know mind to be equal in the three times, and know mind to be reality. Just as they know their own mind, so they fully know the minds of others. Just as their own mind is empty, so they fully know the minds of all to be empty. Just as they know their own mind to be equal, so they fully know the minds of all to be equal. Thereby they fully know all phenomena to be equal. Because all phenomena are equal, they fully know awakening to be equal. Thereby they fully know mind as the expanse of all phenomena. 'That expanse of all is not something common to all,' they know. Since they thus abide in mind, practice in mind, have mastery over mind, look at mind, see mind, and recognize mind, Lord of Secrets, why do you say that it is the domain of experience of the sublime ones alone, and not the domain of experience of those on the grounds?"

The Lord of Secrets said, "Lord of Laṅkā, that is indeed so; but all of them, in every respect, have ascertained the reality of mind only in terms of the characteristic of the cause, and do not fully know it as the result itself. Why is that? It is like this. Those on the grounds, one after another, are entirely caught within the mesh of four nets. What are the four? The great net, the net, the half net, and the single net. These are none other than the childish, the mad, those of small perception, and those of single perception. Those on the grounds, because they know nothing beyond mind as cause alone, are those of single perception. They are caught in the net, purely bound by the net, and so it is extremely difficult for them to find certainty in the result. Why is that? Lord of Laṅkā, that which is the reality of mind as result cannot be spoken even by the buddhas, and cannot be indicated even by Vajrasattva; what need is there to mention bodhisattvas?"

Again the Lord of Laṅkā asked, "Lord of Secrets, have even you yourself not found certainty in the reality of mind as result?" When he had asked this, the Lord of Secrets said, "Lord of Laṅkā, since I myself have not yet found certainty, it is extremely difficult to teach it to others. Why is that? Because it has become the domain of the intention of the Blessed One Vajrasattva alone."

When the Lord of Secrets had spoken thus, the awestruck presumption of all who were mistaken about awakening was utterly cut off.

This concludes the tenth chapter, The Supreme Distinction, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then the Lord of Laṅkā and the other beings embodied among the destinies were amazed and astonished, and they said this: "O Lord of Secrets, as all the buddhas, the blessed ones, have declared, the Lord of Secrets is the one who cuts off all doubts concerning the unerring reality, the sublime secret of Vajrasattva, the lord of all tathāgatas. If, then, you neither teach nor practice the secret reality of the result, which is so extremely wondrous, when will we ever find certainty?"

The Lord of Secrets said, "O beings of inferior bodies, even Vajrasattva himself, sovereign of all tathāgatas, until he found the reality of secret mantra, practiced immeasurable austerities for some three countless eons, and yet did not know it in all its aspects."

"How is that so? Just as the countless buddhas of fully purified mind stream who have appeared and will appear practice austerities until they find certainty in reality, so it is. Thus, after this Fortunate Eon, sixty degenerate

eons of barbarism will occur. After that, in the eon called Renowned, ten thousand buddhas will appear. After that, eighty thousand degenerate eons will occur. After that, in the eon Like Scattered Stars, eighty thousand buddhas will appear. After that, three hundred eons of darkness will occur. After that, in the eon called Beautiful Ornament, eighty-five thousand buddhas will appear. Likewise, without end, eons of lamps and eons of darkness follow one another forever, in a continuous cycle. Thus in this very Fortunate Eon one thousand and two buddhas appear.

"Before this Fortunate Eon there were a hundred eons of darkness. Before that, in the eon called Endowed with Perfection, a hundred koṭis of buddhas appeared. Before that had passed, there were a hundred eons of barbarism. Before that had passed, in the eon called Excellent Ornament, eighty-four koṭis of buddhas appeared. Before that had passed, there were five hundred eons of darkness. Before that had passed, in the eon called Delightful to See, ten koṭis of buddhas appeared. Before that had passed, there were seven hundred eons of darkness. Before that had passed, in the eon called Joy, sixty thousand buddhas appeared. In such a way, endlessly, eons of darkness and eons of lamps have followed one another and still follow one another, without beginning or end. And however many lamps have appeared and will appear, until they find the definitive reality of secret mantra, though they practice immeasurable austerities, they did not know, do not know, and will not know all its aspects. As soon as they find the definitive reality of secret mantra, they knew all its aspects, they know them, and they will know them.

"Likewise, many immeasurable and inconceivable eons ago, countless eons beyond even the reckoning of former eons, in the great eon called Manifest Joy, at the time when thirty-three thousand buddhas appeared, in the teaching of the last buddha, called Samantabhadra, five great supreme ones arose from the five castes, the royal caste, the commoner caste, the merchant caste, the brahmin caste, and the caṇḍāla caste. They were the boy called Bliss Protector, the boy called Tralita, the boy called Śūradatta, the boy Karmadatta, and the boy called Dumbur. At that time, on that occasion, the buddha Vajrasattva was the boy called Bliss Protector. At that time, on that occasion, the buddha Amitāyus was the boy called Tralita. At that time, on that occasion, the buddha Ratnasambhava was the boy called Śūradatta. At that time, on that occasion, the buddha Vairocana was the boy called Karmadatta. At that time, on that occasion, the buddha Amoghasiddhi was the boy called Dumbur.

"At that time, on that occasion, when those boys generated the mind of supreme yoga before that buddha Samantabhadra, at the worldly stage they generated eight minds, and, having traversed by way of the eight worldly paths, they dwelt on the ground of uncertain transformation. At that time, though they cut their doubts before thirty-three thousand buddhas, they did not find certainty. At the stage of the beginner they generated three minds, mastered the ten extremes, and, relying on this, dwelt on the ground of the basis. At that time, on that occasion, though they cut their doubts before forty-four thousand buddhas, they did not find certainty. At the stage of opening the great lineage, four minds were perfected; having mastered the ten extremes, they became bestowers of merit. At that time, though they cut their doubts before fifty-five thousand buddhas, they did not find certainty. Again, at the stage of attaining great confidence, one mind was perfected; having mastered the ten extremes and passed beyond the five fears, relying on this, they dwelt on the ground of special progress. At that time, by cutting their doubts before sixty-six thousand buddhas, they knew a mere portion and attained confidence. This is as follows:

That person who trains in illusion,
in the guise of a universal monarch,
with the seven precious things and with armies,
teaches the vehicle of the means of ruling with power.

"Again, at the stage of obtaining the great prophecy, seven minds were perfected; with the coexisting stains purified, they crossed beyond the mountain, and through focus dwelt on the ground where the result arises. At that time, by hearing the prophecy from seventy-seven thousand buddhas, they dwelt in great realization. This is as follows:

At that time that sublime being,
knowing the path within the result itself,
the limbs of the path perfected in bliss,
in order to bring others to maturity,
applies the supreme means just as is wished.

"Again, at the stage of perfecting great power, they generated three minds and, having mastered the six extremes, dwelt on the ground of not remaining fixed. At that time, having heard prophecies from eighty-eight thousand buddhas, they gained assurance. This is as follows:

Then that person, the regent
of whichever Dharma king it may be,
sustaining his line, teaches the Great Vehicle in Tuṣita,
and, unabiding, displays miracles in the ten directions and the times.

"Lord of Laṅkā, thus those beginner sons of noble family took birth in the five castes. Then, again, beyond inexpressible immeasurable eons, at a time without beginning or end, they generated the supreme mind of awakening before the five buddhas, and were born as the five sons of the universal monarch Vairocana, namely the five called Beautiful Flower, Inconceivable Glory, Holder of the Wealth Giver, Glory of the Crescent Moon, and Light Beautiful to All. Among them, as soon as they became yogins of the beginner's aspiration, they obtained what is called mental engagement. Through that they saw the sign of traveling through the sky. Then, as soon as they became yogins of the opening of the great lineage, they obtained the samādhi of radiating and gathering as one. Through that they saw the sign of themselves appearing as a garland of letters. Then, as soon as they appeared as yogins of great confidence, they obtained the samādhi of irreversibility."

"Through that they saw the sign of moving about in a world system filled with precious jewels. Then, as soon as they appeared as yogins of the great prophecy, they obtained the samādhi of suchness. Through that they saw the sign of riding upon lions and overpowering everything. Then, as soon as they appeared as yogins of perfected great power, they obtained the samādhi of total illumination. Through that they saw the sign of turning the wheels of the sun and moon and making everything bright with light.

"Lord of Laṅkā, even though they had become thus, they had not found certainty in the reality that is the essence of secret mantra. Why is that? Lord of Laṅkā, when those beginner sons of noble family became regent persons, they were renowned throughout all buddha fields as the holy being Vajrasattva, the holy being Vajraratna, the holy being Vajradharma, the holy being Karmavajra, and the holy being Vajradhātu. In some places they were spoken of and renowned as regent persons. In some places they were spoken of and renowned as those in their final existence. In some places they were spoken of and renowned as buddhas of the great ground. Yet that was because they had not yet experienced the sublime secret intention of the buddhas, and still needed to settle in equipoise.

"Why is that? Since those holy beings had not experienced the intention of the buddhas, for as long as they had not settled in equipoise, through genuine realization they made this request to the primordial buddha Vajrasattva: 'Blessed One, the buddhas, the blessed ones, have neither being settled in equipoise nor not being settled, and know all aspects. Yet although we have completed all the immeasurable austerities that are to be performed over immeasurable eons, we have not come to experience the intention of the buddhas, for as long as we have not settled in equipoise. This is a wonder. Sugata, this is a wonder.'

"When they had made this request, the Blessed One, that being of vajra essence, declared: 'O holy beings, those who wish to be spontaneously accomplished as the very state of a tathāgata must bring the qualities of a buddha to full completion in every respect by means of three things to be perfected. Of these, you have fully completed what is to be done, and you have fully purified your guarding; yet you have not yet brought your understanding to full comprehension. Therefore, bring your understanding to full comprehension of the primordial reality of the holy ones. As that becomes fully comprehended, you will experience the intention of the holy ones.'

"When he had declared this, the holy beings made a request: 'How wonderful, Blessed One! Since the Blessed One has spoken to us of something so extremely wondrous and marvelous, hard to fathom, giving rise to doubt and bringing about hesitation, please explain what this is that is called the reality of the holy ones, which brings understanding to full comprehension. Sugata, please explain it.'

"When they had made this request, that Blessed One of all the buddhas, the reality that is the essence of secret mantra, declared: 'O holy beings, this reality is great in means and wide in its gateways, small in hardship and great in purpose, near at hand yet hard to examine, great in danger and hard to guard. Therefore it is very difficult for me to teach it to you without distortion.' When he had declared this, those holy beings wept until they were utterly spent. Having wept with great intensity, the door of the secret was opened, and they came to know fully the eight topics of secret mantra."

This concludes the eleventh chapter, Showing the Lineage of Births of the Purified Mind Stream, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then the Blessed One of all the tathāgatas, Vajrasattva, the reality of the holy ones, spoke thus to those holy beings: "O holy beings, do not weep! Do not give rise to the torment of suffering! Why do you weep?"

Then those holy beings spoke thus to the Blessed One of all the tathāgatas, Vajrasattva, the reality: "Blessed One, how could we not weep? Has our search not come to nothing? Blessed One, what are we to do with our understanding? Please be our holy spiritual friend. Although we have practiced immeasurable austerities for countless ages, single-mindedly, wishing for full comprehension, if we still have not even the fortune to hear the mere name of the reality that is the essence of secret mantra, how can this be?"

When they had made this request, the Blessed One of all the tathāgatas, Vajrasattva, the reality, declared: "Holy beings, do not speak like that. Secret mantra is not common to all. Its meaning, reality, is the sublime intention of the buddhas alone: inexpressible, free of all thought and analysis, impossible to point out as 'this', difficult to examine, difficult to teach, free of all conventions of expression, beyond example, not comparable even to space, measureless, beyond measure, not to be gauged by valid cognition, by reasoning, or by inference. Just as you have neither known nor heard it, so even all the buddhas and bodhisattvas of fully purified mind stream have not yet directly seen, directly realized, or become manifestly and perfectly awakened to the reality that is the essence of secret mantra. Why is that? Because the reality that is the essence of secret mantra is completely pure, it is not perceived as 'buddhas' or 'bodhisattvas', and it cannot be sought. The holy beings who dwell on the tenth ground do not know that the sublime reality that is the essence of secret mantra, the buddha-nature, is present in themselves; they set it up as the nature of reality and are not free of analysis. The buddhas dwell unmoving in the state free of conceptual thought at the heart of awakening, dwelling without manifesting full awakening. So why do you weep?"

When he had declared this, those holy beings were delighted, overjoyed and elated, and, taking heart, they thought thus:

"If even the buddhas, the blessed ones, who have gone before have not yet actualized the reality that is the essence of secret mantra, what need is there to speak of the likes of us? But here is the Teacher, Vajrasattva, the reality, who is none other than the holy spiritual friend of all the buddhas; so there will surely be no delay in our understanding coming to comprehend this."

Then those holy beings made this request to that Blessed One, the reality: "Blessed One, it may be said that the sublime reality of secret mantra is beyond all expression and cannot be spoken, and so is extremely difficult to teach and to examine. Even so, since the Blessed One himself is certain as the domain of those of great understanding, cuts off all doubts, and is the most holy of the holy, please teach us the sublime side by which understanding definitively comprehends, in the sublime equality of the intention."

When they had made this request, that Blessed One, the reality, declared: "Holy beings, excellent! That is certain. It is like this. That sublime reality of secret mantra is free of all analysis. In it no extreme or middle is perceived. It is without superimposition or denial, without accepting or rejecting. It is beyond cause and result. It is primordially pure, primordially complete. There is nothing to do, nothing to seek, nothing to accomplish, nothing to undertake. It does not come from elsewhere. It is without antidote, without agent, unmade, unexamined, selfless, uncontrived, unadulterated, certain to be just that, unmistaken, as it is, unceasing, unborn, not setting, not perishing, not appearing, not arisen, not going, abiding primordially, pervading all, without name, without form, without sign, without convention, not to be looked at, not to be grasped, not to be indicated, without example, without measure, not to be examined, beyond speculation, immeasurable, unthinkable, inconceivable, the source of all, in every respect great equanimity, emptiness, nothing but one's own self-arisen awareness."

When he had declared this, the holy beings understood that in all phenomena there is no accepting or rejecting. Wonder arose in them, and then doubt. "How wonderful! As we heard before from the holy ones, the holy ones of old take up awakening and cast off the afflictions, and that is called the full comprehension of understanding. Having heard that, it is a wonder that this great being says that, since afflictions and awakening are not two, there is nothing to accept or reject." Thinking this, they remained without saying anything at all.

Then Vajrasattva, the reality, in order to clear away the thoughts of those holy beings, spoke again: "O holy beings, since you are wholly consumed by doubt, discern with certainty what the nature of the afflictions is and where they come from, and what the nature of awakening is and where it comes from. As soon as you see this fully, your doubt will be cut off."

When he had said this, those holy beings examined what the nature of afflictions and of awakening was and where they came from. They saw that their nature is empty. They saw that they arise from the root, the mind. Mind itself has not arisen; it is unborn and without birth, primordially as it is, its nature spontaneously accomplished. They came to understand with certainty that the root is nothing other than the sublime awakening mind, and they experienced the intention of the buddhas. It was like this: all mind and mental factors became like space. They passed beyond being settled in equipoise and not being settled, attained final confidence, and fully found genuine certainty; they came to find it. Having found it completely, those holy beings again wept until they were utterly spent.

Again Vajrasattva, the reality, though he knew, said to those holy beings: "O holy beings, why are you weeping?"

They replied, "Holy spiritual friend, it is like this:

The shortcut among the paths,
this sublime one among the means,
we had not heard of before: small was our fortune.
How wonderful, this marvelous Dharma!
Though a meaning of such lasting worth as this
depends on nothing else at all,
we hoped that others would bestow it. Alas, what error!
Worn out by the labor of things to be done,
distracted, chasing after signs,
we were wearied by pointless, endless words,
not gathered into summary, each of little meaning.
From you, holy spiritual friend,
having found certainty, we breathe a great sigh of relief:
equal to the buddhas, liberated into the expanse,
spontaneously accomplished as great suchness."

So they said. From their great wondrous joy, a light of wisdom arose like a hundred thousand suns. Through it those on the grounds trained the dynamism of awareness, and the greatness of the meaning came forth. All the lands shook, so that the yogins of conduct were amazed and asked their own teachers, "What is this extraordinary sign?" When they asked this, the countless individual teachers declared to their countless individual retinues: "Sons of noble family, this great sign is because, in the buddha field called

Great Pervasion, the spiritual friend of all the buddhas, called Vajrasattva, the reality, is teaching the Dharma called The Certainty of the Reality of Secret Mantra of the Great Vehicle. That buddha cuts off all doubts and has become the holy spiritual friend who prophesies that all buddhas and bodhisattvas will certainly awaken. Five holy beings, who had not found the certainty of secret mantra, have become fully, manifestly and perfectly awakened, because he cut their doubts concerning certainty and gave them prophecy. That is their sign." So they taught.

"Lord of Laṅkā, thus those holy beings, as soon as they found the experience of reality, were definitively known as the holy regent persons of the Dharma king."

This concludes the twelfth chapter, called Fully Attaining Great Confidence, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then the Lord of Laṅkā, the bodhisattva great being, asked this question: "Lord of Secrets, how are those holy beings renowned in the fields of the holy ones?"

The Lord of Secrets said, "Lord of Laṅkā, because those holy beings became the regents of the Dharma king in the fields of the holy ones, they became universally renowned as the regent persons."

"Why is that? Lord of Laṅkā, it is like this. For example, great personages who have become the crown of all, when they are born in the line of royal kings, possess the marks, know the law, have a retinue, and have gained power, receive the reverence of many. Just so, those holy beings too were born in the line of all the victors, possess the signs of all the major and minor marks, know the Dharma, have a retinue gathered to them, and have gained the ten masteries. Because they possess these qualities, they are renowned as the regent persons. Lord of Laṅkā, this is also as follows:

Just as one born in a royal line,
when the people entrust the kingdom to him,
rules the land with firm command,
having become the crown of all,
so when the victors are fully complete,
the world together with its gods
invests them with sovereignty as Dharma kings,
and then they manifestly awaken to awakening.

"Lord of Laṅkā, thus, at the very place where those holy beings endowed with the five qualities fully attained great confidence, countless victors from the endless fields of the holy ones gathered together, like masses of summer clouds in the sky, and all of them with one voice conferred on them the empowerment of renown, of the name Holy Regent Person, Dharma King.

"Thus some conferred empowerment by the empowerment into the vajra lineage and its line of succession. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment into the jewel lineage and its line of succession. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment into the lotus lineage and its line of succession. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment into the youth lineage and its line of succession. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment into the elephant lineage and its line of succession. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of the light rays of the major marks. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of the light rays of the minor marks. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of the light rays of the ornaments. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of the light rays of six colors. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of the unshared qualities. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of the ten powers. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of the four fearlessnesses. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of the individual perfect knowledges. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of concordance. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of gathering through impartiality. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of gathering through giving. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of gathering through conduct. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of concordant conduct. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of gathering through guidance. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of gathering through mastery. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of gathering through equality. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of gathering through dependence. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of gathering through the cause. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of gathering through the result. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of mastery wherever one may be. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of cognizance. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of joy coming under one's control. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of

complete array. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of entering everything. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of total swiftness. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of abiding just as things abide. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of acting just as things are. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of seeing without arising or ceasing. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of appearing as anything at all. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of the regent person. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of blessing. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of prophecy. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of the capacity of great power. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of the river of the continuum. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of the river of arising. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of the river of renown. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of the river of perfection.

"Lord of Laṅkā, as for those holy beings, some empowered them as Dharma kings. Some empowered them as lords of blessing. Some empowered them for the task of acting as lamps. Some empowered them as holders of the secret. Some empowered them after showing them to be like the Dharma king himself. Some empowered them after showing them to be like the buddha of the family. Some empowered them after showing them as many as the countless victors. Some empowered them after showing them to be like the two form bodies. Some empowered them because the time had come to ascend the royal seat. Some empowered them because the time had come to awaken in form. Some empowered them because the time had come to attain prophecy with certainty. Some empowered them because the time had come for certainty in the secret essence. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment like a jeweled crest. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment of the blazing vajra of sun and moon. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment like the seal of the family. Some conferred empowerment by the empowerment like a vajra diamond. Some conferred empowerment in settings purely like Tuṣita. Some conferred empowerment in settings purely like Akaniṣṭha. Some conferred empowerment at the very place of the heart of awakening. Some conferred empowerment as in the palaces of the heaven of mastery over others' emanations and the like. Some bestowed what is like the regency of the Dharma. Some bestowed what is like perfect enjoyment. Some bestowed what

is like being the very sovereign of the Dharma. Some bestowed what is like being the Lord of Secrets.

"Lord of Laṅkā, the meaning of empowerment:
cause, attainment, and non-attainment,
object, vessel, distinction, and sign;
by these seven its meaning is summarized.

"Lord of Laṅkā, of these, the cause is the five great yogas. They should be known as the yoga of aspiration, the yoga of opening the great lineage, the yoga of great confidence, the yoga of obtaining the great prophecy, and the yoga of perfecting great power.

"Lord of Laṅkā, the measure of attainment is this: full comprehension of the trainings, seeing reality, not being daunted by any object of knowledge, and freedom from all fear. What does not attain it is conceit, uncertainty, fixation on something as sublime, and that in which it does not arise.

"Lord of Laṅkā, the objects are the stūpa, the echo, valid cognition, and certainty.

"Lord of Laṅkā, what has become a vessel is one who is born in the lineage, who has perfected great power, in whom compassion has arisen, and who has brought others under his influence."

"Lord of Laṅkā, the distinction is this: what is obtained through power, and what is obtained through conferral.

"Lord of Laṅkā, what is obtained through power is this:

Whoever, having realized the secret mind of the victors,
Makes it clear to others,
Holds the supreme of all empowerments:
The three realms of existence empower that one.

"Lord of Laṅkā, what is obtained through conferral should be understood as being only as far as it benefits someone and as far as one is able.

"Lord of Laṅkā, the signs are these:

The arising of the sublime crown protuberance,
A vividness that rests on nothing,
Spontaneous and complete accomplishment,
And the spreading of infinite rays of light.

"Lord of Laṅkā, since this is so, those holy beings are renowned throughout the fields of the holy ones as 'sublime kings of Dharma.'

"Lord of Laṅkā, as for empowerment too,
Gather your mind to one point and understand it:
Its source and the river of its renown,
Its object, its faculties, and its purpose,
Its means, its basis, its signs, and its meaning:
With this summary it is complete."

This concludes the thirteenth chapter, on holy beings obtaining empowerment, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then Vajrasattva, suchness itself, prophesied the full perfection of those holy beings, as follows: "You holy beings have, from a time without beginning or end, been nothing other than fully and perfectly awakened buddhas. The holy being called Sattvavajra will become the buddha Akṣobhya in the world realm called Manifest Joy. The holy being called Vajraratna will appear as the buddha called Ratnasambhava in the world realm called Glorious. The holy being called Vajradharma will appear as the buddha called Amitābha in the world realm called Sukhāvatī. The holy being called Vajradhātu will appear as the buddha called Vairocana in the world realm called Adorned with Awakening. The holy being called Viśvavajra will appear as the buddha called Amoghasiddhi in the world realm called Utterly Pure.

"The qualities of all those buddha fields lie beyond any example by which they might be described, and since there is no example, they cannot be told. The measure of those buddhas' lives is simply immeasurable. The great beings who dwell in those buddha fields are great vidyādharas alone, and the measure of their lives is the life span of the vidyādharas of that very field. Countless vidyādharas who have ripened in other world realms also appear in those buddha fields. There, listening to the Dharma, teaching it, and moving about are samādhi alone. The Dharma, too, is nothing but the supreme secret: the actionless nature of reality, suchness. Their enjoyment, too, is the enjoyment of the profound nature of reality alone.

"All those vidyādharas belong only to the five families. Why is this? All arise from the five families, appear as five, and ripen as five; having come from five, they are definitely five. That is to say, they belong only to the family of anger, the family of pride, the family of desire, the family of jealousy, and the family of delusion; the Forbearing family, the All-Tormented family, the Six-Arising

family, the Lineage-Holding family, and the Abode-Holding family; the commoner caste, the royal caste, the merchant caste, the brahmin caste, and the caṇḍāla caste; the All-Illumining family, the family of a single family, the family of diversity, the family that performs action, and the family from which all arises; the vajra lineage and the families of its group, the jewel lineage and the families of its group, the lotus lineage and the families of its group, the youthful lineage and the families of its group, and the elephant lineage and the families of its group.

"In the same way, the countless buddhas and bodhisattvas who appear everywhere and in every way are also only of the five families, by the power of karma and of engagement. But by the power of things as they are, everywhere and in every way, there is no sign of family. There is no convention. There is no aspect. There is no object. There is no engagement. There is no becoming a buddha. There is no prophecy. There is no finding of certainty. Everywhere and in every way, it is awakening itself. It is emptiness itself. It is the essence itself. It is suchness itself. It is genuineness itself. It is the sublime certainty itself. It is non-otherness itself. It is non-arising itself. It is non-cessation itself. It is suchness. It is unerringness itself. It is the nature of reality. It is the expanse of phenomena itself. Being inconceivable, it is unthinkability itself. It is the equality of the limit of reality."

So he prophesied. And because the sound of the supreme secret of suchness resounded from the emptiness of the suchness of glorious Vajrasattva, the holy beings, everywhere and in every way, found certainty in the very heart of awakening.

"O Lord of Laṅkā, the supreme secret, the suchness of the awakening mind, is this difficult, this profound, this vast, this unthinkable. Because it is inconceivable, finding certainty in it is just this difficult."

Then the Lord of Laṅkā asked again: "O Lord of Secrets, is this supreme secret, the suchness of the awakening mind, something with continuity, or is it something whose continuity is cut off? If it has continuity, then great wisdom would be subject to arising and ceasing. But if its continuity is cut off, then there would be no distinctions of wisdom upon wisdom, and no level of intention upon intention."

When he had asked this, the Lord of Secrets said: "O Lord of Laṅkā, the supreme secret, the suchness of the awakening mind, has continuity without arising or ceasing."

He asked: "Lord of Secrets, what is it that has continuity?"

He said: "Lord of Laṅkā, wisdom has continuity. Compassion has continuity. Enlightened activity has continuity. Qualities have continuity. Blessing has continuity. Because aspiration has continuity, it is uninterrupted."

He asked: "Lord of Secrets, why are these called continuity?"

He said: "Lord of Laṅkā, it is because they arise as the very nature of continuity."

He asked: "What is the nature of continuity?"

He said: "Lord of Laṅkā, that very nonexistence is the nature of continuity. That is to say:

The awakening mind that has continuity,
though causeless, appears to the gaze of imputation and clinging.
Within the great suffering of appearance and desire,
its greatness and qualities are unbroken in continuity.
The supreme secret, suchness itself,
which is ever possessed of continuity,
is, through those supreme lamps,
for those holy beings,
that very continuum within great suchness.
Apart from the dawning of the intention,
it is not something shown by words.
What is seen as causeless and without appearance
is primordially released, unfabricated, just as it is.
That very certainty is suchness itself:
appearing as nothing at all, free of analysis,
beyond thought, beyond all objects.

O Lord of Laṅkā, one should abide in every way in this supreme secret essence of all buddhas. Why is that? Because those swollen with doctrines of action strive for ten million eons with immeasurable hardships, yet do not reach the supreme; whereas those who have not reached the supreme will, through the meaning of nonaction, without doubt attain the supreme secret merely by an instant's, a moment's devotion to this secret. Therefore, Lord of Laṅkā, one should abide in this. One should not stray from it."

When he had said this, the Lord of Laṅkā and the others found the certainty of supreme understanding.

This concludes the fourteenth chapter, the Prophecy of the Holy Beings, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

From the Way of Going Forth in the Great Vehicle, this is the third part, teaching how it came about: the account of those who found certainty, a discussion of the wisdom of the Dharma seal.

Then once more the Lord of Laṅkā put a full question to the Lord of Secrets about the prophecy given earlier, the fourth of the twelve statements, which said, "It will also come about when ascertained as the very essence of awakening." He asked: "O Lord of Secrets, when you yourself told how the supreme secret of the Great Vehicle came about, you set down the words, 'It will also come about when ascertained as the very essence of awakening.' In what way is it ascertained, and how does it come about?"

He said: "Lord of Laṅkā, it is that the holy ones appear in every way as the very essence of awakening."

He said: "Lord of Secrets, when those holy beings who have fully found certainty abide in the essence of awakening, how do they appear in every way? If it is something that appears, it cannot be unarisen and unborn. If it is something that does not appear, continuous wisdom and continuous compassion cannot arise. How then should this be understood?"

When he had asked this, the Lord of Secrets said: "O Lord of Laṅkā, it is like this. The holy being is just as the essence of awakening is. Whatever is the essence of awakening is that very holy being, and whatever is the holy being is the very essence of awakening. A 'holy being' is not seen, and an 'essence of awakening' is not apprehended."

He asked: "If it is not seen and not apprehended, this contradicts what the holy ones have taught: 'Whoever sees that itself sees all phenomena; whoever sees all phenomena sees the essence of awakening,' and 'Whoever finds certainty in suchness has found certainty.' How then should this be understood?"

When he had asked this, he said: "O Lord of Laṅkā, it is like this:

Whatever form or appearance is seen is no substance found;
not seeing is that seeing, that very certainty.
Of the inexpressible awareness whose experience is found,
'seeing' and 'finding' are spoken as mere conventions.
On that great and utterly pure path itself,
the holy beings who have come forth

find full certainty in the great meaning,
and within the very state of nonapprehension,
when they neither stir nor conceive,
there is the essential nature of the nonabiding dharmakāya,
self-arisen wisdom, vast as space,
unmixed, fully perfect and clear,
suchness, unborn and unceasing,
beyond speech, thought, expression and concept,
the domain of each one's own awareness,
center and edge unapprehended, just as it is.
In the essence of awakening, the Mother of all,
unelaborated, it is vividly present in bliss."

Again the Lord of Laṅkā asked: "Lord of Secrets, for how long does that suchness, the essence of awakening, abide? What are its characteristics and its nature?"

He said: "Lord of Laṅkā, it is not fixed at all: not by seasons, months or half-months, by nights or days, by sessions or half-sessions, by instants, moments or brief moments, by what immediately follows, by suchness itself, by eons or by immeasurable eons. For it is without characteristics and without nature. It is nonapprehended. It is made familiar. It is definitively examined. It is fully experienced. It appears as anything whatsoever. It is ascertained as being. It arises everywhere. It gathers all. It pervades the whole. It is spontaneously born. It is utterly pure. It is established nowhere at all. Since it is without pervading and without not pervading, without high and low, without great and small, without good and bad, without wide and narrow, without cause and effect, without male and female, without family lineage, without form, without karma and its ripening, without outer and inner, without birth, without transference or change, without darkness and light, without before and after, without edge and center, without self and other, without effort and accomplishment, without adopting and rejecting, naturally unfabricated, spontaneously luminous, uncorrupted, unarisen and unproduced, why, Lord of Laṅkā, do you ask what its characteristics and its nature are? The essence of awakening transcends appearance and nonappearance, and its characteristics and nature are not apprehended.

Thus, Lord of Laṅkā, those holy beings who abide in the essence of awakening and do not apprehend are wedded to that supreme suchness, Vajrasattva,

emptiness, and therefore this comes forth from it: 'O holy beings, do you see the essence of awakening?' And from the holy beings, from that suchness of the essence of awakening, this comes forth: 'O supreme spiritual friend, we see the essence of awakening without seeing it.'

He declared: 'How do you see without seeing?'

They replied: 'Not seeing anything as the essence of awakening, we see all as the essence of awakening.'

He declared: 'What is called the essence of awakening?'

They replied: 'Supreme spiritual friend, the essence of awakening is the name for the secret supreme intention of all buddhas.'

He declared: 'Holy beings, what is called the supreme intention?'

They replied: 'It is the suchness that is the nature of all.'"

He declared: "Why is the nature of all called secret mantra?"

They replied: "Because whatever is the nature of all is seen by no one, realized by no one, has never become anyone's domain, cannot be spoken, transcends expression, cannot be thought, is inconceivable, and is hard to examine and hard to teach."

He declared: "Holy beings, do you see the nature of all?"

They replied: "Supreme spiritual friend, we do not see the nature of all."

He declared: "Why do you not see it?"

They replied: "Because it is not apprehended."

He declared: "Holy beings, do you then not see the nature of all?"

They replied: "Supreme spiritual friend, we do see it."

He declared: "Holy beings, in what way do you see it?"

They replied: "Whatever is the nature of all, unfabricated, uncorrupted, unarisen, unborn, suchness just as it is, we see as the maṇḍala of what is primordially just as it is."

He declared: "Do you see the Buddha?"

They replied: "We do not see him."

He declared: "Why do you not see him?"

They replied: "Because he is not apprehended."

He declared: "Do you then not see him?"

They replied: "We do see him."

He declared: "In what way do you see him?"

They replied: "Because all are awakened as suchness and pervade everything, we see the maṇḍala of the spontaneously accomplished nature."

He declared: "Do you see all minds?"

They replied: "We do not see them."

He declared: "Why do you not see them?"

They replied: "Because they are not apprehended."

He declared: "Do you then not see them?"

They replied: "We do see them."

He declared: "In what way do you see them?"

They replied: "We see all as the maṇḍala of the root, the awakening mind."

He declared: "Holy beings, do you wish for the essence of awakening?"

They replied: "Supreme spiritual friend, it is already fully ripened."

He declared: "Why do you not wish for it?"

They replied: "Because what is called a holy being, and sentient beings, what are called sentient beings, have never moved from the essence of awakening. All, too, have never moved from suchness."

He declared: "Holy beings, where do you seek the essence of awakening?"

They replied: "We do not seek it anywhere at all."

He declared: "Why do you not seek it?"

They replied: "Because all is the very essence of awakening, and it abides nowhere."

He declared: "Do the holy beings wish to journey through all the buddha fields?"

They replied: "We do not wish to journey through them."

He declared: "Why do you not journey through them?"

They replied: "Because all the classes of sentient beings without exception are themselves the utterly pure buddha field."

He declared: "Holy beings, do you abide unmoving in nonconceptuality?"

They replied: "We do not enter nonconceptuality."

He declared: "Why do you not enter it?"

They replied: "Because, being ourselves nonconceptual, we have no need to enter nonconceptuality only now. If we were not nonconceptual from the very beginning, then we might enter nonconceptuality; but all is nonconceptual from the very beginning."

He declared: "Holy beings, do you wish great compassion to arise?"

They replied: "We do not wish it to arise."

He declared: "Why do you not wish it?"

They replied: "We are wholly unmoving."

He declared: "Why are you unmoving?"

"Because all is nothing but buddhahood itself, and so no object of compassion is apprehended."

He declared: "Holy beings, do you act for the benefit of sentient beings?"

They replied: "We do not act."

He declared: "Why do you not act?"

They replied: "Because all is from the very beginning nothing but suchness."

He declared: "Holy beings, do you wish to accomplish the spontaneously present dharmakāya?"

They replied: "We do not seek to accomplish it."

He declared: "Why do you not wish to accomplish it?"

They replied: "Because what is accomplished arises from what is compounded."

He declared: "Do the holy beings wish to make the full journey?"

They replied: "We do not make the full journey."

He declared: "Why do you not make the journey?"

They replied: "Because all, as buddhas, have already gone the whole way of the path."

He declared: "Holy beings, by what example is that essence of awakening shown?"

They replied: "Supreme spiritual friend, there is no example that matches it; it cannot be compared by any example at all."

He declared: "Can it not be indicated by an example?"

They replied: "If one takes examples that match it slightly, it is like space, the sun, a precious jewel, precious gold, a lamp, the elixir that transforms poison, the elixir that transforms metal into gold, beryl, the great ocean, the heart of stone, what overpowers by its prowess, what enters into objects, precious gold ore, and what arouses delight."

He declared: "Holy beings, how is that essence of awakening known by the names that indicate it?"

They replied: "Supreme spiritual friend, names are mere designations; there is nothing fixed in a name."

He declared: "Can it not be indicated by a name?"

They replied: "If one indicates it in terms of expression, out of what is wholly unapprehended, the various names that are conceived are known and held to according to however they are differently imputed. It is widely known as the essence of awakening, thatness, reality, suchness, the just-as-it-is, the unerring, the unfabricated, the not-other, dharmatā, the dharmadhātu, the inconceivable, the limit of reality, secret mantra, dhāraṇī-mantra, vidyā-mantra, and the Great Vehicle."

He declared: "Holy beings, how does that essence of awakening appear?"

They replied: "It is impossible for that essence of awakening to appear even for an instant."

He declared: "Does it then not appear anywhere at all?"

They replied: "However it is looked at, so it appears."

He declared: "How does it fully appear?"

They replied: "It is like this:
Because it pervades everything, it is without appearance.
Hidden nowhere, it is unseen.

Never separated from it from the very beginning, one does not recognize it.
Examined, it is not seen, yet it appears as anything at all.
Though it appears in variety, it is without substance.
Though one wanders for eons, it is never lost or parted from.
Though its doors are various, it is without change.
Without any particle, it pervades all that appears and exists.
From emptiness itself, variety arises.
Without any actual basis, it is imputed and clung to as anything at all.
Without striving or ground, whatever is accomplished is accomplished.
Without form or mark, it appears as whatever one looks at.
Being nothing whatsoever, it is aware as anything at all.
All-pervading and all-enveloping, it is one and limitless.
Free of all, it is singular, yet nothing is abandoned.
Without outer or inner, it is inner throughout.

Though it arises endlessly, it is inexhaustible.
Neither grasped nor examined, it is clung to wherever one is.
Without anything material, it is ever falling.
Without being lifted, it travels through the sky.
Without limbs, it journeys through the grounds.
Never moving anywhere, it has reached everywhere.
Without stirring, it is unobstructed and swift.
Though elaborated as distinct, it never moves from the one.
Never moving from the one, it appears as variety.
Because all enter by it, it is the path.
Because nothing is abandoned, it is saṃsāra.
Because of the confusion of not knowing, it is sentient beings.
Because it ferries across the four rivers, it is the boat.
Because it moves onward, it is the journey.
Because it has no reference point, it is awakening.
Because it has various aspects, it is mind.
Because it is skilled in all, it is wisdom.
Because all is clear, it is samādhi.
Because it arrives without journeying, it is the abode.
Because it has no equal, it is the highest.
Because it is wondrous, it is the supreme.
Because it is utterly exalted, it is the finest.

Because nothing has power over it and there is no antidote to it, it is unsurpassed.
Because its depth cannot be found, it is profound.
Because it is immeasurable, it is secret.
Because it is subtle, it is not evident.
Because all arises from it, it is Dharma.
Because it does not change, it is suchness.
Because it is the very station, it is the bodhisattva.
Because the buddhas pervade it continuously, it is the Buddha.
Because it has become the ground, it is the root.
Because it gives birth to all, it is the Mother.
Because it comes from her, it is the Father.
Because it holds the lineage, it is the Son.
Because it is self-arisen, it is the Sovereign Lord.
Because it is suchness, it is the great lineage.
Because it is hard to transgress, it is the great commitment.
Because it sustains life, it is the life force.
Because it knows no exhaustion, it is the great treasure.
Because it fulfills desires, it is wealth.
Because with continuous compassion it does the work of all, it is the servant.
Because it is majestic, it is body.
Because utterance and expression arise from it, it is speech.
Because it knows all, it is mind.
Because every wish arises from it, it is qualities.
Because it performs deeds, it is enlightened activity.
Because it goes toward objects, it is desire.
Because it enjoys suchness itself, it is the great enjoyment.
Because it has become the cause, it is the great requisite.
Because the intention is complete, it is the great gathering.
Because it is without effortful action, it is the accomplishment of all aims.
Because it conjures variety, it is miracle.
Because it has arisen as a sign, it is mudrā.
Because it is not sought elsewhere, it is approach.
Because it arises from oneself, it is close approach.
Because it is the essence, it is accomplishment.
Because it is the fruit, it is great accomplishment.

He declared: "Holy beings, how do you accomplish that essence of awakening?"

They replied: "It cannot be accomplished."

He declared: "How is it that it cannot be accomplished?"

They replied: "Because it is accomplished from the very beginning."

He declared: "How is it accomplished from the very beginning?"

They replied: "Because it does not arise from elsewhere, arises from itself, is without effortful action, and is self-arisen, it is ascertained as experienced from the very beginning."

Thus, as the sound came forth in this way from emptiness, suchness is ascertained as suchness, and in every respect there is nothing anywhere apart from the very essence of awakening.

Lord of Laṅkā, in this way, when the holy beings who are certain as the very essence of awakening rest, peaceful and vividly present, as nonconceptuality itself within the unmoving state, then, at that time, the sun of wisdom that explains the intention spreads through the sky of dharmatā and explains all as the very certainty of suchness.

Then, at that time, when, as the cause for the arising of secret mantra, there had appeared special disciples, burners of the three worlds, of wrathful manner, and the time for taming these disciples had surely come, all the buddhas of every direction and time gathered where the essence of awakening is and roused the holy beings: some they roused to great awakening, some to great miracles, some to complete the rites, some through samādhi, and some through the awareness of liberation. Thereby they rose from where emptiness is, and the complete enjoyment and the array of emanations appeared exactly as in the Complete Array of the Lamp, the magical display of Vajrasattva's certainty of suchness.

It is like this: buddhas, purely conceived, distinct beyond all telling, in distinct buddha fields; distinct universal monarchs; complete enjoyment in the distinct heavens of the Thirty-Three; regents and Dharma kings; emanations as distinct Śakras (Indra) and gurus of the gods; distinct miracles appearing at distinct final ages; secret bodies appearing distinctly in the distinct wombs of mothers of uṣṇīṣa wheel-turning monarchs; distinct emanated lamps appearing in distinct buddha fields; the mind unmoving in the essence of awakening; distinct bodies in distinct worlds entering the absorption of

meditative concentration and bringing their deeds to completion; going to distinct vajra seats, taming distinct māras, fully turning the wheel, and attaining full and perfect awakening: only this.

When he had said this, the Lord of Laṅkā and the other beings of inferior bodies became certain of the essence of awakening, the supreme secret, as suchness.

This concludes the fifteenth chapter, Certainty in the Supreme Secret as Suchness, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

From the Way of Going Forth in the Great Vehicle, this is the fourth part, teaching how it came about: the account of certainty as the very essence of awakening, a discussion of the wisdom of the Dharma seal.

Here begins the third fascicle.

Then the Lord of Laṅkā put a full question to the Lord of Secrets about the fifth of the twelve statements given earlier, which said, "It also came about at the Explanation of the Intention." He asked: "O Lord of Secrets, when you yourself recounted the prophecy teaching how the supreme secret of the Great Vehicle came about, you set down the words, 'It also came about at the Explanation of the Intention.' In what way is such an Explanation of the Intention known?"

He said: "Lord of Laṅkā, it refers to the very time and moment when those who are certain as holy beings held the essence of awakening in their intention."

He said: "Lord of Secrets, how do those who are certain as truly holy beings hold the essence of awakening in their intention? Of what are those words a designation?"

He said: "Lord of Laṅkā, 'essence' refers to the root. 'Awakening' refers to the nature. 'Intention' refers to dharmatā. 'Definitive' refers to the unerring. 'Explanation' refers to wisdom. These are designations for the just-as-it-is and the thus.

He asked: "Lord of Secrets, how is that wisdom explained?"

He said: "Lord of Laṅkā, it is explained as unmixed and fully perfect."

He asked: "Lord of Secrets, how should that be understood?"

He said: "Lord of Laṅkā, it is calm abiding and insight themselves. Everything is gathered into four births and explained as four births, as follows. Whatever the Tathāgata does, his intention, his speech and all his deeds are intended

toward something; and so he intends all phenomena as gathered into four miracles. Lord of Laṅkā, what are the four? When the miracle of birth arises with respect to phenomena that are unborn, there is the miracle born from the magical power of karma, the miracle born from the magical power of meditative concentration, the miracle born from the magical power of dharmatā, and the miracle born from the magical power of compassion.

Lord of Laṅkā, of these, the miracle born from the magical power of karma is everything that appears as the four kinds of birth. Lord of Laṅkā, what is the miracle born from the magical power of meditative concentration? It is everything born from the four alternatives of meditative concentration. Lord of Laṅkā, what is the miracle born from the magical power of dharmatā? It is everything that appears as the four miracles of nature. Lord of Laṅkā, what is the miracle born from the magical power of compassion? It is what appears as four miracles: everything that appears as the four miracles of magical power, of the appearance of the Dharma, of full declaration, and of subsequent instruction.

Lord of Laṅkā, of these, the miracle of magical power is the miracle of making something appear and the miracle of transforming into something. Lord of Laṅkā, the miracle of making something appear is the miracle intended to tame by indicating to whom, the miracle intended to tame by indicating through what, the miracle intended to tame by that into which it has changed, the miracle intended to tame by vehicles, and the miracle intended to tame by how it is beautiful.

Lord of Laṅkā, of these, the miracle intended to tame by indicating to whom is the intention to tame by the unfabricated and the intention to tame by transformation. Lord of Laṅkā, of these, the intention to tame by the unfabricated is like a conch, like a white lily, like the moon, and like the sun. Lord of Laṅkā, the intention to tame by transformation is like beryl, like kaṅkari, like lac dye, like refined gold, and like many colors.

Lord of Laṅkā, the miracle intended to tame by indicating through what is what has arisen, what appears, and how it changes. Lord of Laṅkā, of these, what has arisen is intended as two or six. Likewise, what appears is also intended as that. Lord of Laṅkā, how it changes is the unfabricated, the untransgressed, the unfixed, and the connected. Lord of Laṅkā, the unfabricated is the unborn and the unceasing. Of these, what is the unceasing? It is object, indication, sign, and close imputation. Lord of Laṅkā, the untransgressed is what is

complete, what is enacted, and what does not lean. Lord of Laṅkā, what is the unfixed? It is appearing as endlessly distinct by the power of taming. Lord of Laṅkā, what is the connected? It is the intention of connection as the holy, and the intention of connection through action.

Lord of Laṅkā, what is the miracle intended to tame by that into which it has changed? It is means, place, and manner. Lord of Laṅkā, what is means? It is the intention toward nature and the intention toward distinction. Lord of Laṅkā, what is place? Without outer or inner, it has become inner throughout. Lord of Laṅkā, what is manner? It is the manner of sitting, the manner of rising, the manner of going, the manner of gazing, the supple manner, the lithe manner, the entwining manner, the swaying manner, the youthful manner, the clear manner, the radiant manner, the manner of massive beauty, the manner of blazing splendor, the flashing manner, the contemplative manner, the steady manner, the relying manner, the soaring manner, the enchanting manner, the glittering manner, the soft manner, the vividly present manner, and the lucid manner.

Lord of Laṅkā, the miracle intended to tame by vehicles is turning the wheel of Dharma, journeying through the distinctions of the grounds, and the conquering greatness of qualities.

Lord of Laṅkā, the miracle intended to tame by how it is beautiful is this: because it is beautified by discrimination of phenomena, joy, pliancy, samādhi, mindfulness, equanimity, and diligence, it is intended as arrayed with great ornaments. Lord of Laṅkā, moreover, because it swells with body, speech, mind, qualities, and enlightened activity, it is intended as majestic in great attire. Lord of Laṅkā, moreover, because it is beautified by the flowers of the major marks and adorned with the fruits of the minor marks, it is fully ornamented by the host of heirs. Lord of Laṅkā, moreover, because it is coiled with samādhi, effort, speech, thought, the scope of action, view, livelihood, and mindfulness, it is intended as blazing with an auspicious coil.

Lord of Laṅkā, these are called the miracle of making something appear. In suchness they are each unmixed, and they are fully explained as one."

When the Lord of Secrets had said this, the Lord of Laṅkā and the other beings of inferior bodies came to see all phenomena as nothing but the appearance of miracles.

Then the Lord of Secrets spoke again: "Lord of Laṅkā, the miracle of transforming into something is the ten mountains of conceptuality.

What are the ten? They are the conception of application, the conception of clinging, the conception of the main part, the conception of generation, the conception of conditions, the conception of action, the conception of signs, the conception of manifestation, the conception of conduct, and the conception of marks.

Lord of Laṅkā, from these ten root conceptions come ninety, or eighty-one, mountains of conceptuality. Because they cut across the supreme path of yoga and make it hard to traverse, one should strive to purify them completely.

Lord of Laṅkā, what are the nine? They are the conception of names, the conception of signs, the conception of symbols, the conception of conventions, the conception of existence, the conception of nonexistence, the conception of doubt, the conception that settles certainty, and the conception of analysis. Because these become the cause of turning into ten kinds each, they are the mountains of ten times nine.

Lord of Laṅkā, what are the eighteen and the one? They are these: three in threes of three; four in threes of five; five in ones of four; six in ones of six; seven in ones of three; eight in twos of five and ones of six; nine in ones of twelve; and ten in ones of seven. Thus there are eighteen in general, and what is examined is the one conception.

Lord of Laṅkā, of these, what is the conception of application? It is the nonconceptual, the unconfused, and the unobstructing. Lord of Laṅkā, what is the conception of clinging? It is the unapprehended, the unestablished, and the unborn. Lord of Laṅkā, what is the conception of the main part? It is being of one cause, one conduct, and one nature. Lord of Laṅkā, what is the conception of generation? It is what has changed, into what it has changed, for what reason it has changed, and by what it has changed.

Lord of Laṅkā, what has changed is this: what has changed naturally, what has changed by force, what is accompanied by change, and what is fabricated as change. Lord of Laṅkā, into what it has changed is this: change into objects, change into places, the action of change, and the result of change. Lord of Laṅkā, for what reason it has changed is this: change for the sake of the cause, and change for the sake of the result. Lord of Laṅkā, by what it has changed is this: change by the cause, change by the place, change by means, change by action, and change by the result.

Lord of Laṅkā, what is the conception of conditions? It is crushing, destroying, devouring, and feeding.

Lord of Laṅkā, what is the conception of action? It is the action of gathering, the action of bliss, the action of appearance, the limitless action, the unobstructed action, and the unsupported action.

Lord of Laṅkā, what is the conception of signs? It is the untransgressed, play, and greatness. Lord of Laṅkā, of these, what is the untransgressed? It is not transgressing the disciples, not transgressing the nature, not transgressing wisdom, not transgressing means, not transgressing the commitment, not transgressing compassion, not transgressing the holy, not transgressing enlightened activity, not transgressing primordial wisdom, not transgressing dharmatā, and not transgressing the intention.

Lord of Laṅkā, what is play? It is accomplishment and deeds. What is accomplishment? It is the unborn, the unconfused, the unmoving, the unceasing, the unattached, the unbound, the unsupported, the unobstructed, the all-inclusive, and the untraversed. Lord of Laṅkā, what are deeds? They are the deed of gazing upon disciples, the deed of sending forth emanations, the deed of hearing whatever is asked, the deed of being the supreme protector and refuge, the deed of exhausting the great poisons, the deed of teaching the supreme vehicle, the deed of cutting off the four kinds of birth, the deed of drawing out the six continua, the deed of completing the six limits, and the deed of liberating by taking on actions.

Lord of Laṅkā, what is greatness? It is the greatness that has no antidote, the greatness that has no rival, the greatness of special exaltation, the greatness of sole might, the greatness of overwhelming waves, the wondrous greatness, the greatness undefeated anywhere, the greatness of complete dominion, the greatness victorious over all, and the greatness that never wanes.

Lord of Laṅkā, what is the conception of manifestation? It is the grandeur of body manifesting in tens of millions and millions, the grandeur of speech manifesting teachings like an ocean, the grandeur of mind manifesting as the sky of dharmatā, and the grandeur of power manifesting like the expanse of space.

Lord of Laṅkā, these are completed by sixteen modes. What are they? They are the mode like a mountain, just as it appears; the mode like a dance, changing into anything at all; the mode of overpowering, extraordinary; the mode of great majesty, swaggering in the fierceness of its strength; the mode

of the mouth, inhaling wherever it may be; the mode of the tongue, changing into anything at all; the mode of the teeth, cutting through completely; the mode of thunder resounding, proclaiming understanding; the mode of the intention, like the hosts of stars in the sky; the mode of enlightened activity, like the waves of the ocean; the mode of qualities, like the plants and trees of the earth; the mode of compassion, like a garland of dance; the mode of the charnel ground, the distinction of place, where things arise and are gathered in; the mode of intimidation, the distinction of subjugation; the mode of the unsurpassed, the distinction of field; and the mode accomplished all at once and unsupported, the distinction of conduct.

Lord of Laṅkā, what is the consideration of conduct? It is as follows: the splendor of body, like the form of a hundred thousand lions; the splendor of speech, like a thousand dragons roaring; the splendor of mind, like the great expanse of the sky; the splendor of qualities, like a precious jewel; and the splendor of enlightened activity, like a great maṇḍala. Lord of Laṅkā, these are complete with twelve splendors. And what are they? They are as follows: the splendor of a great body with robust limbs; the splendor of great numbers suited to conditions; the splendor of being seen as foremost and worthy of honor; the splendor of being distinguished and pleasing to the mind; the splendor of a great resonance that fills the three-thousandfold world system; the splendor of swift words that cut through doubts; the splendor of teaching as though to each one alone; the splendor of seeing special qualities; the splendor of vastness, free of hope and fear; the splendor of clarity that abandons the two extremes; the splendor of compassion that fulfills the sacred commitment; the splendor of taming by undeluded means; the splendor of never running out for those in want; the splendor of displaying, from one, whatever is wished for; the splendor of turning harmful deeds into benefit; the splendor of skillful means unstained by faults; the splendor of fearless, confident play; the splendor of never forgetting through long ages in saṃsāra; the splendor of continually acting as protector and refuge; and the splendor of spontaneously accomplishing the intended aim.

Lord of Laṅkā, what is the consideration of signs? It is as follows: the sign that the king of Dharma has attained the great power that is free of fear; the sign of great, confident play; the sign of being unafraid of any army; the sign of having attained lasting sovereignty; the sign of overpowering all others by strength; the sign of moving without abiding through miraculous power; and the sign of possessing an inexhaustible treasury. Lord of Laṅkā, the sign of

having attained great dominion is this: the complete perfection of the ten masteries. What are the ten? Mastery over birth, over requisites, over inclination, over miraculous power, over the Dharma, over wisdom, over mind, over life, over karma, and over aspiration.

Lord of Laṅkā, what is the sign of great, confident play? It is as follows: play in the four seals, that is, play in the equality of body, the drops of mind, the commentary of speech, and the waves of enlightened activity.

Lord of Laṅkā, the sign of being unafraid of any army is as follows: the mode of the alluring, the mode of the heroic, the mode of the terrifying, the mode of the scornful, the mode of laughter, the mode of compassion, the mode of the fierce, the mode of the wondrous, and the mode of the peaceful.

Lord of Laṅkā, the sign of having attained lasting sovereignty is as follows: the intelligence of loving-kindness, the counsel of compassion, the method of joy, and the sūtra of equanimity.

Lord of Laṅkā, the sign of overpowering all others by strength is as follows: the power of compassion, the power of the nature of reality, the power of nondifferentiation, the power of accomplishment, the power of not abandoning, the power of being unmoved, the power of aspiration, the power of emanation, the power of not giving up, and the power of attachment.

Lord of Laṅkā, what is the sign of moving without abiding through miraculous power? It is as follows: the miraculous power of the nature of reality, the miraculous power of wisdom, the miraculous power of compassion, and the miraculous power of emanation.

Lord of Laṅkā, what is the sign of possessing an inexhaustible treasury? It is as follows: fulfilling wishes, arising inexhaustibly, dispelling darkness, and never being interrupted.

Lord of Laṅkā, these are called the miracle of magical power. Lord of Laṅkā, all the infinite considerations, however many there are, gathered within the miracle of magical power, are fully explained as one, each distinct and unmixed.

When he had said this, the Lord of Laṅkā and the other bodhisattvas of inferior bodies saw all phenomena appearing as nothing but miracles of magical power.

This concludes the sixteenth chapter, the teaching of the miracle of magical power, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then again the Lord of Secrets called to the Lord of Laṅkā and said: "O Lord of Laṅkā, what is the miracle of the appearance of the Dharma? It is as follows. When the miracle was shown by which the Dharma definitely appears, through whomever and wherever, in each of those places all those world systems shook, shook strongly, shook strongly everywhere; moved, moved strongly, moved strongly everywhere; rocked, rocked strongly, rocked strongly everywhere; roared, roared strongly, roared strongly everywhere; quivered, quivered strongly, quivered strongly everywhere. When the edges rose, the center sank; when the center rose, the edges sank; when the east rose, the west sank; when the west rose, the east sank; when the south rose, the north sank; and when the north rose, the south sank. All outer and inner darkness was purified, and endless beings were filled with delight and wonder. The maṇḍala of the mind became luminous, and they tasted the joy of the nature of reality of the Great Vehicle. Each and every thing appeared as the sacred nature of reality, as follows:

In worlds as infinite as particles of dust,
Emanations infinite as dust were sent forth;
Darkness dispelled, all things were purified,
And all appeared, uncontrived, just as it is.
From the meaning of emanations numerous as dust
Come the gateways where the nature of reality surely appears;
What appears as fourteen from two
Appears clearly as clusters of letters and syllables.

Lord of Laṅkā, it is as follows: a is the gateway illuminating the very expanse of phenomena. hūṃ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of wisdom. hūṃ is the gateway fully illuminating the nature of reality of the unmoving. oṃ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of appearing as anything whatsoever. svā is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of the arising of variety. oṃḥ is the gateway illuminating the infinite nature of reality. hā is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of Amoghasiddhi. mūṃ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality beyond expression. lāṃ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality without arising or ceasing. rmāṃ is the gateway illuminating the inexhaustible nature of reality. phyāṃ is the gateway illuminating the faultless nature of reality. tāṃ is the gateway illuminating the unobstructed nature of reality. hrīṃḥ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality that holds speech. trāṃ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality that opens space. kṣa is the gateway

illuminating the nature of reality of seeing.

jrīṃ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of destroying. hūṃ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of the root, the mind of awakening. ṭāṃ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of arising as anything whatsoever. trīṃ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of proclaiming sound. a is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality that is not fixed as anything at all. mai is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of great loving-kindness. thlhīṃ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of great compassion. hūṃ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of great joy. mūṃ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of great equanimity. du is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of the miracle of meditative absorption. pu is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of the miracle of empowerment. vaṃ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of the miracle of blessing. hoḥ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of the miracle of offering. ya is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of the liberation of emptiness. tha is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of the liberation of signlessness. hriḥ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of the liberation of wishlessness. hūṃ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of the liberation of skill in means. jaḥ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of drawing forth the meaning. hūṃ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of expressing the meaning. vaṃ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of practicing the meaning. hoḥ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of according with the meaning. kṛṃ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of awakening. truṃ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of the powers. sruṃ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of the faculties. pra is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of miraculous power. kṣaṃ is the gateway illuminating the defining characteristic of abandonment. ye is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of mindfulness. bruṃ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of the empty. e is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of the wrathful. vaṃ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of the peaceful. ma is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of expanding to the limits. ya is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of gathering in. śva is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of arising outwardly and inwardly. dha is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of the source of phenomena. ma is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of mindfulness. hā is the

gateway illuminating the nature of reality of calling. pra is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of sending forth. kṣaḥ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of final exhaustion. jñā is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of knowing. te is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of the cause. saṃ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of the result. thaṃ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of the condition. ska is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of the aggregates. kra is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of karma. vaṃ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of the black. tra is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of the white. oṃ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of the self-accomplished. hūṃ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of the root. rmūṃ is the gateway illuminating the nature of reality of things just as they are.

Lord of Laṅkā, these are the illumination of phenomena through the miracle of letters. Why is that? Lord of Laṅkā, by way of letters, all phenomena come to be understood as being like space. One comes to obtain dhāraṇī, sound, mindfulness, intelligence, realization, and clarity. In the same way, letters also open the gateway to all phenomena. They also indicate the meaning. They also bring realization of the intrinsic nature. Lord of Laṅkā, these are the illumination as the nature of reality by way of the miracle of letters.

Lord of Laṅkā, what is the miracle in which phenomena appear uncontrived? It is as follows:

The natures of phenomena that appear as signs
Appear within the state of the nature of reality, free of signs.
The natures of sentient beings that appear as things
Appear within the state of mind itself, free of things.
The natures of all that appears in its multiplicity
Appear within the state of suchness, just as it is.
The natures that appear as the five poisons of affliction
Appear within the state of the five wisdoms of liberation.
The natures that appear as the root, the three poisons,
Appear within the state of the three bodies, spontaneously present.
The natures that appear as concepts of apprehended and apprehender
Appear within the state where expanse and wisdom are not two.
The natures that appear as act and agent
Appear within the state where means and wisdom are joined.
The natures that appear as the aggregates of the perishing collection

Appear within the state of the undefiled aggregates of liberation.
The natures of saṃsāra, thoroughly afflicted,
Appear within the state of nirvāṇa, completely purified.
The natures of the world, its moving dust and its unmoving,
Appear within the state of the forty-two victors.
The natures of nirvāṇa and of saṃsāra
Appear within that very state, unsought and uncontrived.

Thus it resounds everywhere and becomes renowned. Lord of Laṅkā, that is the miracle of the appearance of the Dharma, and these too are fully explained as one, each distinct and unmixed."

This concludes the seventeenth chapter, the teaching of the miracle of the appearance of the Dharma, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Lord of Laṅkā, what is the miracle of expressing all? It is as follows:

All phenomena, unmixed and fully complete,
The meaning of how they definitively are,
Expressed just as it is, without distortion:
That itself is the great path of utter purity.
The intrinsic nature of body, speech, and mind
Is nowhere at all; it is just that.
Though the victors are immeasurable and infinite,
They are nowhere else; they are that itself.

Delusion, unmixed, is total bewilderment;
Being fully complete, it is empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
Aversion, unmixed, is the tormenting mind;
Being fully complete, it is empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
Pride, unmixed, is a great mountain;
Being fully complete, it is empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
Desire, unmixed, is clinging to everything;

Being fully complete, it is empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
Jealousy, unmixed, is total turmoil;
Being fully complete, it is empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
Form, unmixed, is fear itself;
Being fully complete, it is empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
Feeling, unmixed, is experiencing itself;
Being fully complete, it is empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
Perception, unmixed, is grasping itself;
Being fully complete, it is empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
Perception, unmixed, is making manifest;
Being fully complete, it is empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
Consciousness, unmixed, is knowing things as distinct;
Being fully complete, it is empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
Suffering, unmixed, is torment everywhere;
Being fully complete, it is empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
The elements, unmixed, are the seed itself;
Being fully complete, they are empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
The sense sources, unmixed, are the door of arising;
Being fully complete, they are empty and selfless.

When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
Cause and condition, unmixed, are gathering and dispersing itself;
Being fully complete, they are empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
Non-attachment, unmixed, is giving itself;
Being fully complete, it is empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
Purity, unmixed, is free of torment;
Being fully complete, it is empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
The unmoving, unmixed, is undisturbed;
Being fully complete, it is empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
Diligence, unmixed, is unsurpassable;
Being fully complete, it is empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
Contemplation, unmixed, is gathering itself;
Being fully complete, it is empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
Cutting through, unmixed, is free of attachment;
Being fully complete, it is empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
The immeasurable intentions and the four absorptions,
Being unmixed, undisturbed, and fully complete,
Are the empty, selfless nature of reality,
Uncontrived suchness alone.
All things, too, unmixed, are arising itself;
Being fully complete, they are empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,

It is uncontrived suchness alone.
The liberation of emptiness, unmixed, is solitude;
Signlessness, unmixed, is peace itself;
Wishlessness, unmixed, dispels suffering;
Being fully complete, they are empty and selfless,
Uncontrived suchness alone.
Liberation, unmixed, is complete unfolding;
Being fully complete, it is empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
The powers, unmixed, are beyond doubt;
Being fully complete, they are empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
Fearlessness, unmixed, is supremely steadfast;
Being fully complete, it is empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
Compassion, unmixed, is protection itself;
Being fully complete, it is empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
Loving-kindness, unmixed, is bringing benefit;
Being fully complete, it is empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
Joy, unmixed, is without regret;
Being fully complete, it is empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
Equanimity, unmixed, is spaciousness itself;
Being fully complete, it is empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
Form, unmixed, is connection itself;
Being fully complete, it is empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,

It is uncontrived suchness alone.
Meditative absorption, unmixed, is undistracted;
Being fully complete, it is empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
Unmixedness itself cannot be stolen away;
Being fully complete, it is empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
Total liberation, unmixed, is directly evident;
Being fully complete, it is empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
Phenomena, unmixed, are manifold;
Being fully complete, they are empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
Wisdom, all-knowing, is without arising or ceasing;
Being fully complete, it is empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
The expanse itself, though nothing at all, is inexhaustible;
Being fully complete, it is empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
Emanations arise from nothing, their stream unbroken;
Being fully complete, they are empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
The enjoyment body, unmixed, is perfectly endowed;
Being fully complete, it is empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
The dharmakāya is utter purity itself;
Being fully complete, it is empty and selfless.
When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.

All things, unmixed, are distinct;
Being fully complete, they are empty and selfless.

When that very thing, unmixed, is fully complete,
It is uncontrived suchness alone.
From the miracle of expressing all phenomena
Uncontrived suchness appears.
Unobservable as the middle, it is secrecy itself,
The domain of experience of sublime beings.
This great vehicle of the vajra secret mantra
Is clear as the Tathāgata himself.
Why? Because the vajra secret mantra,
Sentient beings, and buddhas are not distinct.
The yogin of the vajra secret mantra
Is a being who has perfected means.
If one does not possess vajra yoga,
One is parted from means and wisdom.
Therefore the great yogin
Should never transgress
The nature of the four miracles
Of the sublime vajra secret mantra.

When this had been said, it resounded everywhere and became renowned: "Unmixed and fully complete, all phenomena are Samantabhadra himself." Lord of Laṅkā, these are the miracle of expressing all, and these too, each distinct and unmixed, are fully explained as the one reality.

This concludes the eighteenth chapter, called the teaching of the miracle of expressing all, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Lord of Laṅkā, what then is the miracle of instruction? The explanation of calm abiding as fully complete is as follows: everything, in all its multiplicity, is simply fully complete as things just as they are. How is that? It is as follows:

In that very unmoving sky,
However many distinct moving particles there are,
The great ocean of nonconceptual wisdom
Has no aspects whatsoever apart from one.
In the great maṇḍala, spontaneously present by nature,

Even the names of the lesser, of the bodhisattva,
And of the yoga of conduct do not exist.
From the spontaneous, equal heart of awakening,
Having found the equality of the definitive intention,
Just as it is, uncontrived, suchness itself,
The profound, sublime, definitive meaning,
By the great and sublime wonder
In the vajra essence itself, within itself,
Was explained thus as the meaning of the intention:

How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
From the unborn, all things are born;
In being born itself, there is no birth.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
From the unceasing, all things cease;
In ceasing itself, there is no cessation.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
From the unobservable, all things are observed;
In observing itself, there is no observing.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
From non-abiding, all things abide;
In abiding itself, there is no abiding.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
From no coming and going comes coming and going itself;
In coming and going itself, there is no coming and going.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
Uncontrived, unadulterated, nothing made,
Just as it is, the intrinsic nature is utterly pure.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
From the nature that has no nature

Great bliss is spontaneously present.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
Mind itself, without ground or root,
Is the root of all phenomena.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
Neither empty nor not empty,
The middle is not something to be observed.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
When definitively examined, it is permanence itself;
In permanence and annihilation themselves there is no antidote.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
When definitively cut off, there is no annihilation;
It is awakening itself, the stream of error cut off.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
The intrinsic nature of each and every phenomenon
Is buddhahood itself, the stream of error cut off.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
Any phenomenon other than buddhahood itself
Is not found by buddhahood itself.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
Nowhere in the boundless and infinite
Is the perfect buddha to be sought at all.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
Mind itself, conceptual thought, is the buddha;
It does not exist anywhere other than that.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
The three realms of existence are primordially the essence itself,
Unmistaken, uncontrived, spontaneously present.

How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
The expanse, spontaneously present by nature,
Is perfect buddhahood without any searching.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
From every side and in every way, the state is all-good;
All is primordially all-pervading, marvelously renowned.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
Apart from that very essence of awakening
Nothing whatsoever exists.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
Though all are buddhas,
Being obscured by concepts, they do not know it.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
Because in conceptual thought itself there is no conceptual thought,
The essence of the sugatas comes from nowhere else.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
In awakening, the essence of all,
The intention is primordially spontaneous.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
In the vajra secret essence
There is no accomplishing and nothing to be accomplished.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
In the primordial, sublime result,
How could there be anything to attain?
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
This secret essence of secret mantra
Is the secret of all buddhas and sentient beings.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,

The secret of all perfect buddhas:
The secret gathering, the marvelous source,
Is the vajra essence, the gathering itself.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
This essence of the sublime secret
Is the certainty of all buddhas.

How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
From the secret moon
The profound bindu of speech arose.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
Through union in equality with all buddhas,
Appearances of form are clear like rainbows in the sky.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
From the illusory wisdom of appearance and existence
The net of emanations arose like banks of cloud.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
From the net of emanations and means
The noose that seizes the two extremes arose.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The speech of all perfect buddhas:
Yoga free of activity, concordant engagement, conduct,
Union, means, and action: from these the tantras arose.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
Insight and calm abiding,
The two pure extremes, definitely arose.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
The sublime scriptures of the collections and treasuries
Are definitively established in their source.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,

The secret of all perfect buddhas:
However many the domains of those to be trained,
So many doors of speech arise.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
This, marvelously renowned throughout infinity,
Is the sublime lineage of the Word itself.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
Reality just as it is
Is the supreme essence from which the teaching arises.
How wonderful! The amazing, marvelous Dharma,
The secret of all perfect buddhas:
This reasoning of the profound gathering
Is the mother, the essence from which buddhas arise.
It makes manifold aspects appear:
The vajra mind, unchanging and unentering,
Immeasurable, its speech infinite,
From which manifold precious qualities arise,
All spontaneously present, beyond doubt.
In the vajra essence itself, within itself,
The sun, the maṇḍala of enlightened mind, has risen.

Beyond thought and inconceivable,
Are the immeasurable eighty-four thousand doors;
Though the renowned enumerations are beyond conception,
There is nothing but the one definitive vehicle.
So long as one has not entered the secret itself with certainty,
The doors of the vehicles are inconceivable;
As soon as the secret itself appears with certainty,
There is no door of any vehicle beyond it.
All enumerations of expression and teaching
Are provisional meaning, not that itself.
To find the meaning by uttering words and signs
Is like searching for gold in a dark pit with a lamp.
Breaking open the treasury of the secret essence,
One brings forth the great treasure of the sublime ones.

By a single bindu all is pervaded;
All the great scriptures are definitively taught.
If these are liberated in the state of that itself,
To see the secret mantra is to be buddha,
And all is great bliss, the mind of awakening,
Free of concepts, stainless, utterly pure.
In great bliss itself great bliss is perfected;
The essence, the sun of wisdom, has risen.
All without exception is sealed by the bindu;
Primordially unsought, it need not be sought.
Cause and result, indivisible, are that itself;
Yet in what is unmoving, nonconceptual, and beyond objects,
Through conceptual grasping at cause and result,
All are bound by illusion and delusion.
When the sun of self-arisen wisdom itself
Abides uncontrived, just as it is,
There is no going astray within the essence itself.
Since all things are the essence of awakening,
All abide in bliss without seeking.
Though one passes along the course of saṃsāra, of appearance and existence,
One goes nowhere from the expanse of the essence.
Though one traverses grounds without end,
One never moves from that essence.
Though all the immeasurable victors are brought together,
The essence does not increase at all.
Though endless sentient beings arise,
That itself does not diminish from it.
Whatever appears in the four modes of birth and the five streams
Is buddhahood itself, the body of wisdom.
Since all are one in that itself,
Primordially buddha, great bliss itself,
It is the essence without arising or ceasing.
The three maṇḍalas, without act or agent,
Are primordially accomplished, spontaneously present.
Whoever abides in this practice,
That yogin is fortunate.
However one meditates, practices, or acts,

It is that itself, the supreme meaning.
From the very essence of all victors
Wondrous blessings arise in vast measure.
The mother of the ocean of victors,
Buddha, great bliss, arises from it.
This essence of all without exception,
Abiding as the unelaborated bindu,
For the sake of the victors' heirs and all sentient beings
Teaches itself and explains itself.
Calm abiding is nonconceptual, pervading space;
Insight is undeluded, clear as the colors of the rainbow.
From the unmixed and the fully complete,
The definitive explanation of the intention is taught.

Lord of Laṅkā, since such an echo arose from emptiness, the explanation of all things as unmixed and fully complete is Samantabhadra himself. Lord of Laṅkā, thus all those definitive explanations of the intention should be understood as ground, entry, application, and root; as having come about from certainty alone; and as appearance, expression, and teaching.

When he had said this, the Lord of Laṅkā and the other bodhisattvas of inferior bodies rejoiced. Understanding all things as unmixed and fully complete, they were liberated without center or edge, and found relief.

This concludes the nineteenth chapter, the explanation of what is fully complete, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

This concludes the fifth teaching on how it came about, the full deliberation on wisdom, the seal of Dharma relating the account of the definitive explanation of the intention of all buddhas, from the Way of Going Forth in the Great Vehicle.

Then again the Lord of Laṅkā, that bodhisattva great being, put a question to the Lord of Secrets about the sixth of the twelve phrases given earlier, the one that says, "It occurred when the occasion for those to be tamed had arrived." He asked: "O Lord of Secrets, when you yourself told the account showing how the supreme secret of the Great Vehicle came about, you set down the words, 'It also occurred when the occasion for those to be tamed had arrived.' Which worldly being is renowned as having been fully tamed when the occasion for

his taming had arrived?"

He said: "Lord of Laṅkā, the special one to be tamed, who is the cause for the arising of secret mantra, is the wrathful one of terrifying form who burns up the world. When the time for his taming had definitely arrived and he was fully tamed, all the buddhas of every direction and time gathered at the place of the essence of awakening and urged on the holy beings. And so, in just the ways it happened, he was tamed by terrifying clouds of wrathful ones, as many as there are atoms, like the Complete Array of the Lamp, the emanation of Vajrasattva. It is renowned that this occurred at that very time, at that very moment."

He said: "Lord of Secrets, where did that one to be tamed come from? What were his actions and his births? How did he become the cause for the arising of secret mantra?"

When he had asked this, the Lord of Secrets said: "O Lord of Laṅkā, it was like this. In a time gone by, immeasurably beyond memory, there was a buddha called Akṣobhya, who appeared in the eon called Complete Joy, in the buddhafield called Manifest Joy. Within his teaching there appeared a monk who had gone forth, called Youthful Hard to Subdue, who turned the wheel of the Dharma of the Great Vehicle just as it is, who dwelt in yoga that was unfabricated and unadulterated in each and every respect, and who had come to be a holy being. He saw all sentient beings as children of the Victor and devoted himself solely to urging them on.

At that time, at that period, the actions of beginningless and endless saṃsāra, of beginningless and endless births, and the immeasurable births, could never be fully told. But if we take one portion of birth brought about by one occasion of karma, it was like this. Nearby there lived a householder called Keukaya, who had a son called Black Liberation, and that son had a servant called Denbak.

At that time, at that period, the people who had learned the path of yoga from the monk Youthful Hard to Subdue all abided on the path of yoga and practiced yoga. At that time, at that period, Black Liberation thought this over. He had heard that this monk Youthful Hard to Subdue teaches everything just as it is, and he wondered, 'Are there teachings with a path in which one practices everything just as one pleases?' He asked various people, and all of them said that it was so.

Then, together with his servant, he went to where the monk was. Arriving at his dwelling, with earnest longing he made this request: 'Great monk, I have heard that you are skilled in the means of teaching a path in which one acts in everything just as one likes. Is that certainly so?'

When he had asked this, the monk said: 'Son of good family, it may well be that there are things that happen in just that way.'

When he had said this, Liberation and his servant were delighted, glad and overjoyed, and said: 'Please accept me and my servant as subject to your command. I too wish to take from you the path in which nothing whatever is blocked, and to abide in yoga, so please definitely accept me as your foremost disciple.'

So he requested, and the monk said: 'Yes, excellent! Let it be so.' Having given his consent, he let Black Liberation go forth and took him as his foremost disciple. Denbak he took on as the keeper of the hours, and made him the servant of the monk Liberation.

Then the monk Liberation asked: 'Great monk, what is that supreme path in which all things are just as they are?'

He said:
'When suchness itself is left unfabricated,
Even if one dwells in and practices the four things,
It is like clouds in the sky:
This is the path of supreme yoga.'

When he had said this, Liberation and his servant rejoiced and said: 'How wonderful! You are skilled in means! It is certain! So it is! I entrust myself! I shall abide fully in that in everything.'

Then, because he practiced according to the words exactly as they sounded, the monk Liberation did not find certainty of understanding. Turned toward the words alone, he practiced only the four things and clung to them; he dressed his body in the attire of a holy one, but with his mind he entered the path to the lower realms. The servant Denbak, having found certainty about the meaning on which the words rest, was joined to supreme understanding. Turned toward the meaning alone, he practiced only suchness and held to it; being a thorough yogin, he dressed his body in the attire of a lowly person, but with his mind he entered the path of certainty in what is supreme.

Then Liberation and his servant disagreed in their views. Liberation said: 'We two have one master, and the same words came to us both. How is it that we disagree with each other about this?'

Denbak said: 'I have heard nothing other than this very conclusion that I now hold.'

Liberation said: 'I too have now found certainty, and I have heard nothing other than this conduct.'

When he had said this, it turned into a great dispute. Because their views disagreed, he parted from his servant, swore that they would never see or meet each other again, drove the servant away to a distant land, and cast him off.

Then a mountain of wrong, overweening pride arose in the monk Liberation, and he asked the master which of them had found the right conclusion. The monk Youthful Hard to Subdue, practicing the natural state unfabricated and unadulterated, without pretense, speaking straightforwardly of the nature of things, declared: 'It is as Denbak holds.' At this Liberation was utterly enraged and said: 'If the master were impartial, he would have said we are both alike. But not treating us as equals, he has surely humiliated and refuted me. So I will not let this master stay in this land either; I will make these lands my own domain.' Having vowed this, great pride arose in him, and he drove the master too away to a distant land and cast him off completely.

Then, because the enumerations of the Tathāgata's speech are many and vast, and because the Teacher's way of teaching in every respect is hard to fathom, that Liberation did not fully comprehend it. Without weighing it with the two measures, he drew it toward his own measure of what was valid and clung to it, and so he twisted everything into falsehood. He himself plunged into an ocean of wrongness and took up fierce, wrong austerities and a great, wrong discipline. He took human corpses from the charnel grounds and made them his food, flayed their skins and wore them as his garments. As his companions he kept many living creatures: black jackals, foot-stamping wolves, hand-striking bears, predatory killer birds, charnel-ground kaṅka birds, devouring charnel pigs and the like. He took the life of every creature and feasted on flesh and blood. He gathered a great crowd of prostitutes and indulged in great passion. Never departing from the four things, he passed entirely beyond the suchness that is the true nature of those four things.

Then that birth came to an end. In the births that followed, he took five hundred births in the body of a black jackal, engaged only in the action of killing living beings, and ate their flesh and warm blood. In the births after that, he took five hundred births in various bodies, such as dogs and the like, whose action is vicious killing and whose food is flesh and blood; he was killed by others, and passing from birth to birth he became nothing but flesh. In the births after that, he took various bodies, such as the flesh-eating nele bird, the blood-drinking red-beak, the charnel-ground kaṅka bird and the leg-licking rutsé bird; he was killed by others, and passing from birth to birth he became nothing but flesh. In the births after those, he took births in the bodies of various insects and very large insects, such as flies, puka worms and corpse-eating leg-suckers; these too were killed by their enemies, and passing from birth to birth he became nothing but flesh. In the births after that, he took five hundred births as a creature living in a swamp of filth and vomit; he was killed by enemies, and passing from birth to birth he became nothing but flesh. In the births after those, he took five hundred births as a creature that lives in the bodies of living beings and also feeds on them; he was killed by enemies, and passing from birth to birth he became nothing but flesh. Again, in the births after that, he became a creature living inside the flesh of the slain, the corpses of the dead, putrefying matter, the stones of various valleys, cliffs, great tree trunks and the like; dwelling there and living on them as food, he was killed by enemies, and did nothing but pass from birth to birth. In the births after that, he dwelt five hundred births as a creature living in the city of the womb, and made his dwelling and his livelihood from it.

Again, in the birth after that, he dwelt in the abode of Avīci, in what is called the Vajra Hell, for eighty thousand of its own lifespans. The measure of the suffering in that hell cannot be told. Why is that? If one were to tell the measure of that suffering before anyone, whoever heard it would faint. At that time, at that period, in the single instant in which he cried, "Alas, what wrong is this?", he passed through that hell. When Vajrasattva, the lord of sages, the king of Dharma, taught him the Dharma, saying, "This is your very own karma," he brought that karma to mind, fully understood it, and was filled with remorse. By that remorse alone he passed from that place, and then dwelt in the abode of the hell Pratāpana, again for eighty thousand of its own lifespans, just as in Avīci. Then, passing on again, he dwelt in the abodes of the hells Lesser Heat, Mahāraurava, Raurava, Saṃghāta, Kālasūtra, Blazing, Saṃjīva and the rest, again for eighty thousand of their lifespans each, just as in Avīci

and Pratāpana. Whenever those came to an end, he was likewise thrown into the hells of other world systems. Passing from those as well, he was born wherever there was an eon of destruction by famine, disease or weapons. Whenever those destructions had emptied such places, he would again take birth wherever else there was a time of destruction. Freed even from those, for eighty thousand eons he took birth and died in species that are killed for their flesh and bones. Freed from that, he was tormented for five hundred births in the world of Yama. Passing from there, he took birth in the race of pūtanas. In the birth after that, he took birth in the race of piśācas. In the birth after that, he took birth in the race of pūtanas, born as the pūtana called Desiring Inclusion, son of the pūtana called Stiff Neck.

In the birth after that, he was conceived in the womb of a prostitute in the land called Laṅkāpura, and ripened toward birth. He was born there, and in the ninth month his mother died. People then said among themselves, "If we raise this orphan bastard, the whole land will be defiled, so it is right to put him in his mother's armpit." There was a poisonous tree called Nalabi; at its root a charnel pig of delusion had its nest, in its middle a venomous snake of hatred had its coils, and at its top a poison bird of desire had its nest. At its foot they all built a tomb for the mother. They carried her corpse on a bier, placed it inside, and put the child too in his mother's armpit.

That orphan clung to his mother's corpse and sucked at her breasts, drawing out lymph, and lived on that for seven days. Then, sucking out blood, he lived on that for seven days. Then he ate her breasts and lived on that for ten days. Then he ate her entrails until they were gone, and lived on them. Then he ate her flesh until it was gone, and lived on that for seven months. Then that youth grew strong and lived on the corpses of the charnel ground. Then, when he had grown very strong, he ate corpses as his food and wore shrouds and skins. Through the power of the nature he had gained by eating the raw flesh of human corpses, the mātṛkās of the charnel grounds, the piśācas, the hosts of pretas and the many hosts of nonhumans came under his control. He became lord of all the vicious beings of the charnel grounds, a savage of utterly terrifying form who stole the splendor of others, devouring people alive, whoever they were, and stealing their vitality. Because he had eaten his mother's raw flesh, people everywhere knew him by the name Mother-Eater Mataṅka.

From the breath of that great preta's mouth came fevers of heat, which spread through the elements, so that every embodied being was tormented by fierce,

piercing pain. From his nostrils came diseases of cold, which spread through the elements and afflicted everyone. Anyone struck by his malice was certain to die. By reciting the nail mantras of Rudra, he brought everything under his power. His huge body was ash-colored and bluish gray, adorned with dots of blood and fat. He wore a garland of skulls as a necklace, and was clad in skins smeared red with blood. He constantly drank from a skull ladle filled with blood. His matted hair was dun and black, bristling and split in two. He ate oil, grain and skull bones as his food. His body was adorned with ashes, red lac and collyrium. Bird wings grew from his body, so that he moved through the sky like a bird. Naked and unhindered, he moved without obstruction, like a fish in water. Whoever saw him, his eyes glaring and flickering, was struck with fear and fainted. His body was rough, with the bristles of a pig; his limbs had become snakes, and he was adorned with snakes. His nails had grown into the claws and beaks of kaṅka birds, so that he crushed the flesh and bones of any embodied being he seized. Through the power of past habituation, he set his mind on killing every kind of embodied being. He was attached to gathering in every woman's sense faculties. He terrified all embodied beings, overpowered them, and left them trembling and quaking. The worldly mātṛkās, bhūtas and powerful yakṣas bowed to him and regarded him as their chief. All the vicious ones served him as his agents, messengers, servants and under-servants, slaves and under-slaves, and he became Maheśvara, the great lord who wields power over all.

This concludes the twentieth chapter, the teaching of the impure line of births, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then that fierce preta let out a savage cry of pride, and loudly proclaimed in a voice of arrogance: "How wonderful! I am the great lord of all! If there is any lord or domain other than me, that too shall become mine. I have become the one and only great and mighty one, without rival!"

At that time the ways of beings came to be like this. All their understanding was dulled, and because Māra had blessed them, all of them became entirely void and cut off, nothing but those who fall to the extreme of nihilism. Clinging to a self, they were nothing but eternalists. Entering cessation, they were nothing but those who are stopped and gone beyond. Becoming vicious and savage, they were nothing but those who fall into Raurava. Holding wrong views, they were nothing but those who fall into Avīci. Becoming greedy and miserly, they were nothing but those who fall into the world of Yama. Becoming greatly distracted, they were nothing but those who fall into the

states without leisure. Becoming deluded by great bewilderment, they were nothing but those who fall into the state of animals. Becoming intoxicated with great passion, they were nothing but those who go into the realm of the womb. The tree of awakening had withered, and they were nothing but those in whom the root of mind was burnt.

Lord of Laṅkā, this too was renowned, renowned again, and became renowned:

In times gone by, long ago,
In the scriptures of the Tathāgata,
The great being, the eternal one,
The way of beings was once like this:
At that time all sentient beings
Strove exceedingly at emptiness.
Through annihilation into emptiness,
They became the great realm of annihilation.
Then, when they passed on again,
The path of freedom and liberation was cut off.

In times gone by, long ago,
In the scriptures of the Tathāgata,
The great being, the eternal one,
The way of beings was once like this:
At that time all sentient beings
Strove exceedingly at the view of a self.
Through the great self, enduring and eternal,
Everything became eternal.
Then, when that came about once more,
They became deluded about the holy.

In times gone by, long ago,
In the scriptures of the Tathāgata,
The great being, the eternal one,
The way of beings was once like this:
At that time all sentient beings
Came to strive exceedingly at cessation.
Through the practice of extreme cessation,
They came to be stopped and wholly gone beyond.

In times gone by, long ago,
In the scriptures of the Tathāgata,
The great being, the eternal one,
The way of beings was once like this:
At that time all sentient beings
Became exceedingly wrathful, savage and vicious.
Being exceedingly wrathful, savage and vicious,
They fell into Raurava.
Then those beings, passing on from there,
Linked to rebirth by the karma of their habitual tendencies,
Became exceedingly vicious.
Their minds too were blessed by Māra:
Poisons, diseases, fevers and sorceresses
Shot forth harmful, piercing pains and stabbing arrows.
Māras and vināyakas harmed liberation.
Exceedingly savage, fierce and brutal,
They destroyed the three worlds,
Devoured the sacred commitments,
Turned back the river of the holy at its source,
And caused the worlds of gods and humans to pass away.

In times gone by, long ago,
In the scriptures of the Tathāgata,
The great being, the eternal one,
The way of beings was once like this:
At that time all sentient beings
Came to abide in wrong view.
Through exceedingly wrong view,
They fell into the great hell of Avīci.
Then, if they came forth again,
The holy path itself was cut off.

In times gone by, long ago,
In the scriptures of the Tathāgata,
The great being, the eternal one,
The way of beings was once like this:
At that time all sentient beings
Became exceedingly greedy and miserly.
Through being exceedingly tormented, miserly and greedy,

They fell into the realm of the pretas and Yama.
Then, when they came forth again,
They became exceedingly withered and poor.
Exceedingly tormented by hunger and thirst,
They came to kill and destroy one another.

In times gone by, long ago,
In the scriptures of the Tathāgata,
The great being, the eternal one,
The way of beings was once like this:
At that time all sentient beings
Became exceedingly distracted by laziness.
Through the laziness of great distraction,
They came to fall into the states without leisure.
Then, when they came forth again,
They were caught in the eon of the three eons.

In times gone by, long ago,
In the scriptures of the Tathāgata,
The great being, the eternal one,
The way of beings was once like this:
At that time all sentient beings
Became exceedingly bewildered by delusion.
Being exceedingly bewildered by delusion,
They fell into the state of deluded animals.
Then, when they came forth again,
Even the path of seeing and appearance was cut off.

In times gone by, long ago,
In the scriptures of the Tathāgata,
The great being, the eternal one,
The way of beings was once like this:
At that time all sentient beings

Became exceedingly intoxicated with passion.
Being exceedingly intoxicated with passion,
They fell into the very city of the womb.
Then, when they came forth again,
They were tormented by the fire of desire.

So it resounded everywhere.

This concludes the twenty-first chapter, called "What Happened in the Past," from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then the Lord of Secrets said: "Lord of Laṅkā, in this way that fierce preta crushed the greatness of every person who came under his power, and, deeming himself supreme, said, 'How wonderful! Who is there greater than me, the lord? Who is there at all?'

Now in the land of Laṅkā, in its town, on the island of Tsoko Katangmar, on the slopes of Kinnara's Leap, at the peak called Where the Sky Iron Is, there was one called the Lord of Laṅkā, king of the rākṣasas, a disciple of the Buddha called Munīndra, the Lord of Sages. His power and prowess were extraordinary and most wondrous; his understanding was complete, and his skillful means, like an ocean, arose like clouds. He was renowned in the world as a great one. When that winged preta heard of this, he became utterly agitated and furious, blazed up as a mass of Rudra's fire, and by his own miraculous power and skill in flight he alighted on the summit of the mountain of Kinnara's Leap. When he proclaimed in a savage voice of pride, 'rutra matra maratra!', the towns of the land of Laṅkā shook and shook, shook violently and shook, and swayed back and forth. All the rākṣasas and rākṣasīs of Laṅkā were frightened and terrified. 'How wonderful! What is this?' they cried, their eyes flickering, trembling with fright. They saw and heard that a savage, fierce and furious winged yakṣa was settled in their lair.

Then the great Lord of Laṅkā and the host of rākṣasas gathered an army and strove and strove to overthrow him. But that winged rākṣasa displayed a miraculous feat called Cowing the Rākṣasa Host, and proclaimed in a savage voice of pride:

'I am Maheśvara, the Great Lord.
The Four Great Kings are my servants;
The eight classes of gods and spirits are my slaves.
Since I am the master of the supreme secret,
Who is there who could rival me?
rutra matra maratra!'

At this the rākṣasas were overpowered and cowed. Some proclaimed, 'This is one who makes the realm of the rākṣasas victorious; he is worthy to be our chief.' Some proclaimed, 'This is one who destroys the world; he will be our adversary.' Some proclaimed, 'This is a great worldly lord.' Some proclaimed,

'This is the Gaṇapati of the hosts of ḍākinīs.'

The king of the rākṣasas, the Lord of Laṅkā, ordered them: 'This is the son of a bhūta, called Desiring Inclusion. He terrifies the three worlds; apart from suchness, he ruins everything and brings it under his power. He is a perverse lord of hosts, and no one else can tame him. The buddhas, the blessed ones, will be the ones to counter him: their emanation, the Vajra Holder, will tame him and establish him in the supreme certainty. Since this has been truly prophesied, it is certain that through him, as the cause, the wondrous Dharma of the Great Vehicle, the certainty of the supreme secret mantra, will arise in the world. We too, by becoming his servants, will see the face of the Buddha Vajragarbha and will find the certainty of the supreme secret mantra. So you must definitely set your hearts on him.'

The hosts of rākṣasas rejoiced, and, not disregarding whatever their own commander said, they set their hearts on him in that way. All of them went to become servants of that winged rākṣasa, and all of them said, 'We too set our hearts on the Great Lord himself.' So they declared, and they held him as their supreme chief, and he took them as his retinue.

Then, again, that winged rākṣasa, the one renowned as the leader of the rākṣasas, called Mataṅka Rudra, was crushing others with the greatness of his pride, crying out, 'Who is there greater than me? Who could it be? rutra matra maratra!' It was then reported that the leader of the gods, called Mataṅka Runa, was outstanding in power, miraculous ability, skillful means and greatness, and could match him. At this the black māra Rudra became utterly furious and enraged and proclaimed a savage cry of pride. By his own miraculous power and skill in flight he alighted at the abode of Mataṅka Runa and challenged him again to a trial of strength. Since they were not alike, like tea and butter churned together, and since both were embodied beings, they roared and came to blows. In the onslaught, Rudra blew out hot and cold breath and sent forth the weapons of disease, which spread through that other one's whole body. His body was covered with pustules of black flame, and tormented by unbearable piercing pain, that very being was killed in the fight. His corpse fell upon Jambudvīpa and appears there as the eight lands of the abodes of virtue.

The wives, children and retinue of the one Rudra had killed in the fight went over to become the retinue of that winged yakṣa. The asuras, piśācas and vetālas all went over to that māra's side. The four kings, though they ran to all

sorts of refuge, were not freed, and became his slaves. Śakra, Brahmā, Viṣṇu, Rudra and all the rest, though they ran to all sorts of refuge, were not freed, and became his slaves. He seized all their wives as well: some he made his wives, some his handmaidens, some his concubines, some his mistresses, some his slave women, and some his messengers and envoys. He utterly ruined the existence of gods and humans, and everything became a realm of lusterless black.

And this too was renowned, renowned again, and became renowned.

Black, with garuḍa wings and skill in flight,
Savage, fierce and utterly brutal,
With ugly face and ugly form,
With harsh and grating cries,
On heaps of flesh, heaps of bones, worms and pus,
On blood and the fluids of excrement and urine
He feasts, and lives on them always.
That fierce leader of the perverse
Ruined the existence of gods and humans here.
He slew the very person of Karuna,
The leader of the gods,
And made his retinue his own encampment.
Through the blazing fire of vicious, piercing pain,
All of them went to the four leaders.
Those, in turmoil and great terror,
Went to the Indras for refuge.
Then the gods together with the Indras
Went to Brahmā for refuge.
Brahmā too, with gods and Indras,
Went to Desiring Inclusion for refuge.
Brahmā, Desiring Inclusion, gods and Indras
Went to Rudra for refuge.
Brahmā, Desiring Inclusion and the Indras,
Utterly frightened and terrified,
Went to the Vajra Holder for refuge.
Likewise, though they ran to whoever
Might offer refuge, they were not freed,
And became the slaves of that terrifier.

So it became renowned everywhere.

Then, behold the black māra Rudra! He brought all moving gods and humans under his power, and made his lair in the land of Laṅkā, in its town, on Tsoko Katangmar, on the mountain of Kinnara's Leap, at the place called Corpse Mountain, Skull Fortress. He planted the banner of Māra in the cave, raised the battle standard of Māra at the door, and surrounded himself with his own encampment. Fierce Rudra produced his miraculous power, and by that power he set Mount Meru on the tip of his finger and twirled it arrogantly above his head, proclaiming his savage cry of pride like this:

"rutra matra maratra! In the realms of the earth, who is greater than me? Who is there? How wonderful! Long ago, when the glorious one called Śākyamuni tamed the māra Lord of Death, the great supreme śrāvakas who appeared in his teaching spoke with words meant to pacify everything, saying, 'Listen to my command!' But I told them, 'Little boys with your robes slung over your shoulders, stay at ease in your own austerities!' I did not listen, and so even he could not bring me under his power. In his presence a god, the glorious Vajragarbha, lord of speech, emanated in various forms and, crying 'hri', tried to bring me under his control. But I myself snapped my fingers at him and commanded, 'Little rival, you too stay at ease!' So he too cut the cord and went back. In the fourteen tiers of the heavens I heard of a god, the glorious Vajragarbha, who had no rival, and him too I brought under my power. I have gathered them all in and laid them bare!"

So he proclaimed, and regarded himself as the one and only sovereign lord, without rival.

In just the way that the one who was Black Liberation ripened into Black Rudra, at that time, at that period, the one who was Youthful Hard to Subdue became, at the essence of awakening, the suchness of Vajrasattva. The one who was Denbak at that time, at that period, became the holy being of great and perfected prowess called Vajradhara.

This concludes the twenty-second chapter, called "The Teaching of the Sphere of Black Rudra," from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Here begins the fourth fascicle.

Then all the tathāgatas gathered at the essence of awakening, dissolved into emptiness, and made the holy being appear within emptiness. The sound of suchness itself resounded to him: "Holy being, why do you think of becoming

completely and fully awakened when the work of your buddhafield is not fully complete? Why do you think of awakening when the deeds of a buddha are not complete? Why do you think of becoming completely and fully awakened without making diverse manifestations?"

When this had resounded, from that emptiness these words resounded: "O all tathāgatas, by the force of what aim will the work of the buddhafield be fully completed, and likewise the deeds of a buddha and the making of diverse manifestations?"

When this had resounded, there resounded again, from the suchness of all, the first of the three exhortations, in these words:

"You who have gone to bliss, unshakable,
In the unmoving sky of emptiness,
Suchness without reference or concept:
Please give rise to manifold conceptions!"

So it resounded. To that, from the holy being himself, these words resounded:

"From the state of nonconception, constantly,
Whatever emptiness arises through examination
Is itself the great conception:
Nonconception is the cause of conception."

So it resounded. Again, from the suchness of all, these words resounded:

"From the essence of the sphere of space,
The light of the nature appearing everywhere,
All-pervading, the domain of compassion:
Please give rise to boundless kingdoms!"

So it resounded. Again, from the holy being himself, these words resounded:

"The origin of all, the ground of all, the dharmadhātu,
Unborn, unceasing, appearing everywhere,
Inexpressible, beyond the reach of speech and thought,
Is the mother who gives birth to the boundless, the boundless."

So it resounded. Again, from the suchness of all, these words resounded:

"When you make diverse manifestations,
From the wisdom of the seal of speech
The victors appear as letters:
Please give rise to the wisdom of letters!"

So it resounded. Again, from the holy being himself, these words resounded:

"Suchness is the nature of letters:
Self-arisen wisdom shines as muṃ.
Mind itself is the nature of letters:
The manifold letters appear as hūṃ.
The nature of the letters of the victors
Is the seal letters, oṃ and the rest.
All things are the nature of letters:
The unborn secret letter a."

So it resounded. Again, from the suchness of all, these words resounded:

"Through wisdom perfected beyond,
Indicating the door of the awareness of yoga,
Making the signs of mind appear,
Please give rise to the wisdom of liberation!"

So it resounded. Again, from the holy being himself, these words resounded:

"The wisdom of all the buddhas
Always arises from nonconceptuality.
The nonconceptual mind of liberated wisdom
Appears to conception as conceptual signs."

So it resounded. Again, from the suchness of all, these words resounded:

"From the nonconceptual mirror of emptiness
Appear forms, unborn and unceasing.
Like a rainbow appearing in the sky,
Please arise from the expanse as a mudrā!"

So it resounded. Again, from the holy being himself, these words resounded:

"Though nothing is apprehended in suchness,
The expanse in which the nature appears everywhere
Is unmixed and fully complete,
And so the supreme form of the mudrā appears."

So it resounded.

When that first exhortation had exhorted him completely, the holy being, suchness itself, from that expanse of emptiness, appeared as a body of emptiness, just as the disc of the moon appears in water or a rainbow appears in the sky. As he abided in the abiding of a wisdom fixed nowhere, all the

tathāgatas exhorted him decisively with this second exhortation:

"Nature unarisen and uncontrived, suchness,
State of great bliss, unmoving from the very beginning,
In which there is nothing at all to seek or to stir!
'Expanse of wisdom' is only a verbal convention;
That very thing is the source of things and of non-things.
Unassailable by anything, uncuttable, indestructible,
Primordial just as it is, unmoving supreme bliss,
Supreme Vajrasattva, great Ākāśagarbha,
Spiritual friend of the sugatas of the three times,
Noble lord, source from which many emanations arise,
Great luminous mirror, the nature of all,
Treasury, father and mother, that gives birth to infinite victors,
Equal to all who are the essence of awakening,
Mind of awakening unmoved from the self-pure expanse!

"There, in the beginning, all the pure buddhas,
Arisen from the three realms, the body of Vajragarbha,
Emanated manifold letters from infinite conceptions;
At the center, beautifully encircled by assemblies of heirs,
Please show yourself as a form body and purify the afflictions!

"There, in the beginning, Vajragarbha,
Arisen from the three realms, spontaneously present great bliss,
In order to liberate through skillful means the fierce, the hot-tempered and the malicious,
Emanated as hūṃ with a stainless, manifold intelligence;
At the center encircled by garlands in the manner of light rays,
By the power of your former commitment and aspiration,
Please reveal the form body that nothing can shake!

"There, in the beginning, Vairocana,
Arisen from the three realms, made all things appear;
In order to liberate through skillful means the darkness that deludes,
He emanated as oṃ with a pure awakened intelligence;
At the center encircled by garlands in the manner of many forms,
By the power of your former aspiration and commitment,
Please reveal the form body that appears as anything at all!

"There, in the beginning, the Source of Qualities,
Arisen from the three realms, the wish-fulfilling jewel,
In order to liberate through skillful means those deluded by desire,
Emanated as svaṃ with a pure intelligence that is a source;
At the center beautifully encircled by garlands of jewels,
By the power of your former aspiration and commitment,
Please reveal the form body from which all that is desired arises!

"There, in the beginning, Amitābha,
Arisen from the three realms, excellent speech, infinite light,
In order to liberate through skillful means those deluded by attachment,
Emanated as aṃ with a pure and stainless intelligence;
At the center encircled by garlands of melodious syllables of speech,
By the power of your former aspiration and commitment,
Please reveal the form body that displays all variety!

"There, in the beginning, Amogha,
Arisen from the three realms, accomplished all manner of things;
In order to liberate through skillful means those deluded about action,
He emanated as haṃ with a pure and diligent intelligence;
At the center encircled by garlands of deeds as a dance,
By the power of your former aspiration and commitment,
Please reveal the form body that accomplishes everything!"

When that second exhortation had exhorted him completely, from the illusion of the nature of reality there appeared the illusory body of wisdom, just as the disc of a face appears in the expanse of a mirror. As he abided as the self-appearance of wisdom, all the tathāgatas exhorted him with this third exhortation to manifest perfection, the perfection of enjoyment:

"You who have gone into suchness,
Please extend manifest perfection to the world,
And, just as the essence of awakening is,
Please appear for the sake of sentient beings!
In immeasurable world systems,
All the emanated buddhas
Of however many sugatas there are
Shine forth for the sake of every being.
For the sick of saṃsāra in the three realms
There is no other medicine that helps.

Compounding the medicine of genuine amṛta,
You purge saṃsāra's chronic disease.
Great and supreme physician who dispels
The sickness of suffering's piercing pain, come forth as the chief!
You who have become the enemy of every disease,
With an ocean of the medicine of amṛta
Please raise up all the multitudes of the sick
Tormented by the enemy, perverse disease!
You, the perfected being of great prowess,
Turn your mind to the essence of awakening,
Spread wide the radiance of your light rays,
And resolve to dispel the darkness!
Ah, being who has accomplished the aim,
Who has done what was to be done and completed the task,
Who has laid down the burden and attained his own aim,
The time has come to tame those who are here!
In the celestial palace Seen Through the Dharma,
In Akaniṣṭha, supreme among the Pure Abodes,
Come forth as the body of perfect enjoyment
And perform the deed for which the essence is exhorted!"

When he had been exhorted in this way,

Just as the disc of the sun
Rises through an opening in the clouds,
From the very expanse of the unmoving
The sun of the form body rose,

and he appeared in the celestial palace called Height of the Dharma.

This is the twenty-third chapter, on the exhortation of the miraculous display, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then that Dharma king of perfect enjoyment made the sign of the vajra opening that gathers all together, and from the boundless buddhafield Ghanavyūha, the Densely Arrayed, immeasurable victors gathered from every side.

At that time the assembly of buddhas of the playful display of compassion deliberated in unison:

"O, O, assembly from which buddhas of many kinds arise,
Appearing everywhere and fully arising here!
The malicious one, perverse in existence,
Propelled by the harsh seeds of saṃsāra,
And the hungry ghosts of great suffering
Have arisen in this world system through karma.
Rudra, through perverse austerities,
Has ripened into lord of the three realms of existence.
With the malicious splendor of arrogant Rudra,
This one who utterly crushes and destroys beings
Has become a wondrous, supreme field for taming.
Lords of compassion, all gathered together,
It is fitting that we cut the stream of his evil karma
And place him on the ground of great bliss."

So they deliberated. The assembly of the buddhas of the vajra lineage and their hosts deliberated as one:

"Ah! Assembled buddhas,
As happened before in times past,
So it has happened now, in this very time.
Burned upon the mountain of manifest perverse scripture,
Corrupted, his own being scorched,
Empowered by Māra,
A great and fierce maddened elephant,
With exceedingly unbearable great poison
He kills and destroys, bound for Raurava,
Clinging to the very end to corpse-lands and charnel grounds:
By what means can he be helped?"

So they deliberated.

The assembly of the buddhas of the jewel lineage and their hosts deliberated in unanimous accord:

"If this mad and malicious black one
Is left to do as he pleases,
With the waves of his unbearable ocean of poison
He will spread through the black realm;
He will cut off the lineage of the holy ones,
And the sun and the lamp will be destroyed.

Then, through the darkness of karma,
All will wander in pitch-black gloom."

So they deliberated. The assembly of the buddhas of the lotus lineage and their hosts deliberated in accord with a single voice:

"Just as what happened in times past,
When that Rudra of perverse understanding,
Propelled by the wheel of karma,
Arose from the expanse of the essence,
And through the application of the holy being
Māra was tamed by māra and set in order,
So what has arisen now, at this time,
This mountain of heaped-up, transforming poison:
The time has come for it to be destroyed and crushed
By the great hammer of the wrathful vajra."

So they deliberated. The assembly of the buddhas of the youthful lineage and their hosts deliberated in accord with a single voice:

"Great poison coiled within him,
Seized by an unbearable disease from which there is no release,
A corpse dead in the realm of eternalism and nihilism,
This blind man who has strayed from the path and lost it:
In order to crush the great gloom and pitch darkness
With the great, blazing, radiating and turbulent nails
Of the miraculous display of wrathful wisdom,
The ocean of victors has gathered, all of them,
From the domain of those who possess wisdom.
Here, where the cloud banks of the miraculous display
Of the wrathful vajra of wisdom have massed,
If the great ocean of poison is not dried up
By sorcery of manifold play,
In the guise of a child who enters in accord,
Is compassion here suited to the conditions?
For the sake of the holy commitment
Of the great compassion of the nature of reality,
Here the teaching of the four things is given."

So they deliberated. This is the twenty-fourth chapter, on the deliberation of the great assembly, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

When the deliberations of the great assembly had thus been fully concluded, they considered that the occasion had come to tame him by one of the four kinds of activity. In order to examine which one it should be, from the light rays of the Youthful Hard to Subdue, who had transformed into Vajragarbha, an emanation came forth as Munīndra, and all the tathāgatas commanded that emanation:

"Munīndra, this is the time!
By the blessing of truth just as it is,
Turn back the mass of fire of the four things,
And rouse the essence of awakening!"

Having been fully exhorted in this way, Munīndra appeared at the encampment of that lord of the charnel ground and spoke words that pacify everything. At that the lord of the charnel ground retorted scornfully and spoke these words: "Little boy, you have not tamed me. Formerly, when I was the yakṣa general called Rudra, many like you came and said, 'Enter my teaching! Listen to my command!', but even then I did not listen. So how should I now come under your power? Cast off your robe and your necklace, and then go happily about your own austerities!"

Having said this, and being utterly overwhelmed by the four things of Māra, Munīndra fell into the conceptions of the noble ones of the Pure Abodes and turned back.

Then all the tathāgatas again fully commanded Avalokiteśvara, the all-pervading emanation of the buddhas of the lotus lineage and their hosts:

"Lotus lineage, dharmakāya of all the victors,
Dharma lord Amitābha, Vajradharma,
Emanation of Avalokiteśvara, from hri display the great ferocious one!
Vāgīśvara, Lord of Speech, subdue him with the face of a horse!"

Exhorted thus, the emanation, the great Vajra Horse-Face, appeared at the abode of the great lord of the charnel ground and let out the cry of a fierce horse, piercing and shrill: "ha ha hi hi hri hu lu hu lu hu lu." At that, the encampment of the lord of existence was completely cowed and became somewhat timid. Yet that lord of the charnel ground himself proclaimed in the

fierce voice of his pride, "ru tra ma tra ma tra," puffed himself up with ostentation and swaggered, and was not overpowered. Then he in turn commanded: "Little Neck, before this too those like you did not overpower me, so you will not subdue me. Go happily back to wherever your own abode is!" So he scolded him.

Again, being utterly overwhelmed by the four things of Māra, the conceptions of the noble ones of the Pure Abodes arose in him, and he thought of turning back. But since for a tathāgata, who is like space, there is no clean or unclean, he did not turn back but pressed in again. That one himself sank down, and the Tathāgata Vāgīśvara entered him in accord, dissolving into his place of pleasure.

Then that Tathāgata made his head emerge at the crown of that one's head and his feet at the soles of that one's feet, and expanding with "Vajra hūṃ" he swelled through the whole of his body. Unable to bear it, that one at last let out a wailing roar: "Ah, the agony! Whatever you are doing, do it quickly!"

Then that Tathāgata purified that one's obscurations and, in bliss, emerged from the crown of his head and neighed a horse's cry into the sky. At this the hosts of rākṣasas were scattered in confusion, and overpowered and cowed they said, "We become subjects of the great hero. Please command us what to do." When they had made this request, that Tathāgata said: "I have not tamed you. Your antidote will arise, called Vajra hūṃ, empowered with the empowerment of all the tathāgatas: extremely fierce, ferocious, turbulent, savage and unbearable, a great māra of māras, the terrifying Blazing One. Go to him for refuge!" Having said this, he went, beyond all reference, to the palace of the dharmadhātu.

Then all the tathāgatas of the Guhyasamāja deliberated in great assembly. When they examined through which door of the four activities the occasion had come to tame him, since one who is tamed by pacifying and enriching is of a different kind, they decided definitively, in sacred deliberation, to tame him by magnetizing and wrathful activity, and they fully proclaimed the sūtras of their decision, as follows.

The assembly of tathāgatas whose conduct is liberation proclaimed the sūtra of the decree:

"For one pacified by complete cessation,
Wrath will bring no benefit.
From that very uncontrived yoga,

All you tathāgatas, act in peace!
If even by peaceful ones in the manner of yoga
The sprout of existence can be stopped,
What need is there to speak of rousing from cessation
By the power of a yoga empty of existence and nonexistence?
As if moistening utterly dry rocks,
In order to rouse those in cessation there,
From the nature of reality, unceasing emptiness,
Act just as it is, without obstructing variety!"

Thus they decided, definitively and sacredly.

Then the assembly of tathāgatas without essential nature proclaimed the sūtra of the decree:

"For one utterly empty, cut off in annihilation,
Things will bring no benefit.
From emptiness that is continuous awakening,
All you tathāgatas, act as nonexistence!
If even the empty, in the manner of emptiness,
Can come to abide in nothing at all,
What need is there to speak of turning back the extreme of utter extinction
By the power of a yoga arisen from nonexistence?
To turn back utter annihilation,
And since things there arise from nonexistence,
Within emptiness that possesses continuity
Expound the greatness of continuity!"

Thus they decided, definitively and sacredly.

Then the assembly of the unchanging essential nature of the tathāgatas proclaimed the sūtra of the decree:

"For one utterly fixed in permanent eternalism,
Nonexistence will bring no benefit.
From that very essence of awakening,
Make everything into the great self!
If even the permanent, in the manner of the unchanging,
Can make things stable and firm,
What need is there to speak of turning back eternalism
By the power of spontaneous presence as the great self?

To turn back clinging to a self,
And to divert the channel of grasping at things,
From the nature of reality, permanent selflessness,
Act as the very nature that is without agency!"

Thus they decided, definitively and sacredly.

Then the assembly of tathāgatas of the vajra lineage and their hosts proclaimed the sūtra of the decree:

"For the utterly malicious and fierce,
Peace will bring no benefit.
From the essence of wisdom and means,
All you tathāgatas, act as wrathful ones!
If even the wrathful, in the manner of wrathful ones,
Can terrify the three worlds,
What need is there to speak of the three realms without exception
Before the wrath of the buddhas' compassion?
To tame all the hard to tame without exception,
And to purify those hostile to the commitments,
From the nine dances of the great Blazing One,
Act as the mudrā of the charnel-ground dance!"

Thus they decided, definitively and sacredly.

Then the assembly of tathāgatas called Vajragarbha, Certainty of Suchness, proclaimed the sūtra of the decree:

"For one utterly attached to what is wrong,
Truth will bring no benefit.
From the hidden intent of the great secret union,
Make everything entry in accord!
If even conduct, in the manner of enacted conduct,
Can make all defy the command,
What need is there to speak of the sage on the wrong path
Before the enacted conduct of compassion that enters in accord?
To free things by means of things,
And to cure the disease of poison by poison,
Act as the mudrā of the dance of deeds,
Of supreme means beyond all measure!"

Thus they decided, definitively and sacredly.

Then the assembly of tathāgatas of the jewel lineage and their hosts proclaimed the sūtra of the decree:

"For the utterly miserly and greedy,
Giving will bring no benefit.
From the source of all, inexhaustible even in want,
Make everything an inexhaustible jewel!
If even ascetics, restrained in the manner of austerity,
Can sustain a single life,
What need is there to speak of the torment of the three realms
Before that which yields every wish amid want?
To satisfy the miserly,
And to dispel all torment,
From the enjoyment of the secret Great Vehicle,
Act as the mudrā of the sky treasury!"

Thus they decided, definitively and sacredly.

Then the assembly of tathāgatas of the youthful lineage and their hosts proclaimed the sūtra of the decree:

"For the utterly lazy and distracted,
Urging will not bring diligence.
From the nature of reality, with nothing to do or to entrust,
Make everything free of action!
If even one who abides in the manner of the unmoving
Cuts off the path of holy action,
What need is there to speak of the distracted world
Before great unmoving bliss, free of activity?
To cut off the paths and continuums of the unfavorable states,
And to conquer the enemy of laziness and distraction,
From the great yoga of equanimity,
Act as the mudrā of abiding without action!"

Thus they decided, definitively and sacredly.

Then the assembly of tathāgatas of the elephant lineage and their hosts proclaimed the sūtra of the decree:

"For the utterly deluded and bewildered,
Teaching will not bring understanding.

From the sameness of all, without any distinction,
Make everything great delusion!
If even the bewildered, in the manner of delusion,
Can make everything dark,
What need is there to speak of bewildering the three realms
By that which does not discriminate, with nothing to accept or reject?
To destroy the sense sources of darkness,
And to turn bewilderment into space,
From the wisdom that is delusion purified,
Act as the unmixed and fully complete mudrā!"

Thus they decided, definitively and sacredly.

Then the assembly of tathāgatas of the lotus lineage and their hosts proclaimed the sūtra of the decree:

"For the utterly attached and clinging,
Antidotes will bring no benefit.
From the wisdom of great and supreme passion,
Make everything great passion!
If even one who practices in the manner of attachment
Can turn the three realms to blood,
What need is there to speak of the clinging attachment of the three realms
Before passion practiced as desire purified?
To dry up the lake of blood of desire,
And to cut off passion through passion,
From the wisdom of desire purified,
Act as the mudrā of the dance of desire!"

Thus they decided, definitively and sacredly.

Then all the tathāgatas proclaimed the sūtra of the decree:

"For one utterly attached to things,
Prohibition will bring no benefit.
From the essence of wisdom and means,
Practice everything as entry in accord!
If even the accordant, in the manner of entry in accord,
Can pervert the three realms,
What need is there to speak of the perverted minds of the world
Before the enacted conduct of compassion's dance?

These, and others beyond number,
All worlds, the endless worlds,
Are drawn in by various means of taming
And joined to the genuine secret.
For the wrathful, act with love and in a wrathful manner;
For the peaceful, peace and the conduct of rousing;
For the violent, fierceness itself;
For the lustful, act with lust and with its antidote;
For the attached, attachment and renunciation;
For the distracted, gathering the mind and distraction itself;
For the deluded, pervasive sameness;
For the mountain, the very mountain of samādhi;
For the jealous, the manner of jealousy:
These, and others beyond number.
To the boundless limits of the expanse of space
Of the all-ground, the equal and the unequal,
For embodied beings who wish for distinctions,
The hero within the expanse of all, the all-ground,
Vajragarbha, fully abides.
The expanse of all sentient beings and buddhas
Is Vajrasattva, suchness.
When it is ascertained that this is so from the very beginning,
For sentient beings without limit,
Just as they wish for what delights them,
Unobstructed, uncontrived, just as it is,
Through the cloud banks of dance-methods of enacted conduct,
Supreme means beyond all measure,
That have become certainty itself,
However one acts, the hero within the expanse
Is unmoved from that very nature and unstained.
From the essence ascertained as that very nature,
Through endless and measureless doors,
Without obstructing anything,
Leading beings to bliss in whatever delights them,
Act as the certainty of the holy ones!
Here, with diligent violence,
From the inexhaustible blazing wisdom,

Act as the mudrā of the great and supreme Blazing One
Who utterly terrifies the lord of the charnel ground!"

Thus they decided, definitively and sacredly.

This is the twenty-fifth chapter, called the Sacred Decision of the Deliberation, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Lord of Laṅkā, at that time I, who had come together in that very assembly, knowingly, in order to bring about full awakening, questioned a bodhisattva also seated in that assembly, called Armor of Exhortation, Intelligence Endowed with Means: "O great being, from what cause did this great preta arise? From what condition did he arise? Into what result does he ripen? To what family does he belong? What conduct of his karmic lot does he engage in? If he is not tamed, what harm will there be? If he is tamed, what need will it serve?"

When I had asked this, that great Armor of Exhortation said: "Great being, Lord of Secrets, this great preta did not arise from any good causes and conditions; he arose from causes and conditions of wrongdoing alone. His cause arose from the mountain of darkness. His condition arose from fierce austerities that perverted the command. His result ripens into a mountain of suffering. As for his family, he belongs to the commoners, to saṃsāra, to the caṇḍālas, to the bhūtas and the pretas. As for the conduct of his karmic lot, he indulges unrestrained in the four things of saṃsāra. If he is not tamed, the fault will be that the essence of awakening of embodied beings is long eclipsed. If he is tamed, the maṇḍala of light, the essence of all, will dawn manifestly and near at hand."

When he had said this, I spoke these words to him: "How wonderful, great being! Then this time is the time that has come. This activity is the supreme of activities. This secret is the sacred secret of secrets. Tame him, tame him utterly, everywhere!

At this great occasion when the time has come,
For this being whose karma has fallen due,
To transform perception through compassion that has come to the destitute
Is the supreme of compassion.
Teaching the whole trichiliocosm without exception
Does not match even a hundred-thousandth part of it."

Thus I exhorted him.

Then all the tathāgatas fully commanded the holy being whose negative tendencies had been transformed, appearing as Vajradhara:

"Holder of the secret treasury of all the victors,
Lord of mind, Vajradhara,
You of great and fierce discipline,
Hero victorious over the three worlds,
By the power of your great armor of old,
Buddha of all the buddhas,
Who tames the fierce ones hard to tame,
Māra of māras, who conquers the māras,
Being with a blazing blue body,
Bearing a terrifying, heroic guise,
With your fierce, ferocious and turbulent essence
Utterly vanquish the lord of the charnel ground!"

Thus fully exhorted, that being Vajradhara knew that

This world with its gods
Had been brought under the power of the king of bhūtas;
By that extremely fierce, ferocious and turbulent one
The world of gods and humans was all but destroyed.
Faces and complexions were no longer clear;
All had grown dim and murky,
And untimely darkness too
Had turned to pitch-black gloom and covered all.
Heat and cold, disease and fever,
And every kind of misery spread everywhere;
Gales, thunder and hail,
And rains of pus and blood, of stones and of weapons,
Came everywhere out of season.
Even the livelihood of lowly beings had gone wrong.
It was a protectorless world,
Utterly exhausted and tormented
By malicious beings of every kind.

Knowing this and tormented by compassion, with utterly ferocious discipline he spoke these words in vajra speech to Vajradharma's Horse-Face:

"Vāgīśvara, Vajra Face,
In the town of the land of Laṅkā
Is the central mountain, Malaya,
Whose slopes and plains run down to the ocean's shore.
Go to its peak, where violence dwells!
In the domain beheld through vajra means,
Upon the lord of the charnel ground and his host
In his great haunt in the dreadful wilds,
Send forth clouds of vajra birds across the three realms!
Akṣobhya, being unshakable by anything,
Embodiment of all the buddhas,
Vajrasattva, suchness,
Vajragarbha, mother and protector of the three existences,
In the sky of great emptiness
Act as the great Blazing One in nine dances!
And having come to the ground of compassion,
Perform the conduct of the child who enters in accord!
Victors as you are,
From emptiness, the source of all within nonexistence,
And victors who have gone the pure path
In the buddhafield Ghanavyūha:
I am the servant of your command.
Since the time for the work of your command has come,
Those whom all the buddhas found hard to tame,
All of them without exception I shall tame.
Those not yet freed I shall free;
Those not yet liberated I shall liberate;
Those not yet relieved I shall relieve,
And establish them in the genuine itself.
In the gathering of all secret intentions,
Through the wondrous secret maṇḍala,
For sentient beings without limit
Bestow the blessing that rouses the essence!"

When Vajradhara had fiercely exhorted them in this way, from the palace of the dharmadhātu all the tathāgatas, the fire of their great wisdom blazing like the fire of the eon at the end of time, massed clouds of compassion to the limits of space, performed fierce rites in the nine dances of the great Blazing

One, and gave command to the host of vajra horses:

"Slay! Slay utterly, everywhere!
With the nine vajra gaits of the horse,
Show the world what all its minds desire!
To the black and fierce host of the world
Who dwell in the haunts of the charnel ground,
With the bird-lamps of vajra contemplation,
Until saṃsāra has been liberated,
Wearing the armor of your vow,
Through the entry into the contemplation of great compassion,
Cut through the very limits of saṃsāra!"

Thus fiercely commanded,

Vajradharma, the Wheel of Great Joy,
Avalokiteśvara, the Vajra Supreme Eye,
The Vajra Lotus, Most Joyful,
The host of Vairocana and of Vāgīśvara,
Great Awakening, chief of thoroughbred steeds:
Through the miraculous power of nine great means
The hosts of emanated Vajra Horse-Faces
Filled all the realms of space
And arrived upon the peak of Malaya.

Until saṃsāra is emptied,
Avalokiteśvara, by the power of compassion,
And the victors of Ghanavyūha too,
Gathered as one in secret intention.
Intending the essence that sets right the crookedness of the three realms,
They bestowed the blessing that shakes out the three times for good.
Saṃsāra is the nature of reality, Avalokiteśvara;
Suffering is made into the path of awakening;
Karma itself unfolds as self-arisen wisdom;
Ripening is refuted: it is the vajra itself.
Primordially just as it is, uncontrived,
They envisioned it as the great self-arisen maṇḍala.

The Lord of Secrets, Vajradhara, too,
From his vajra body, speech and mind,
Brought forth emanated supreme sons, Vajradharas,

Youths by the tens of millions and the millions,
All like massing summer clouds,
To the boundless limits of the expanse of space...

And arrived upon the peak of Malaya.
In the guise of means that enter in accord,
Through the conduct of a child here
He performed all the deeds of Māra's domain
And showed himself as a child in the world system.

This is the twenty-sixth chapter, called the Vajra Assignment of the Four Activities, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then, when that being who enters in accord
Looked with the eyes of accord,
That fierce preta of karma
Had seized things and made them his own.
These were the things of karmic ripening:
At the foot of his fortress of rotting corpses and skulls,
His encampment was ringed all around
By a swamp of blood, excrement and urine, human flesh,
Marrow, brains and brain fat,
Pus, lymph and the like.
He was encircled by a malicious retinue
Of worms and very great worms,
Flies, gadflies and bees,
Snakes, scorpions, spiders and the like,
Flocks of herons, crows, magpies and owls,
Jackals, wolves, tigers, lions and the like.
The daughters, wives and sisters
Of Karuna, general of the gods,
And the sisters, wives and daughters
Of the Great God (Śiva), lord of the world,
He had carried off and brought under his power
As his host of concubines, mistresses and slave women.
The twelve, the eight and the others,
Mātṛkās, phra men goddesses, yakṣiṇīs,
Rākṣasīs, piśācīs, blood-stealers,

Bearers of Māra's name, thieves of the life force,
Female ministers, generals and commanders,
Captains, messengers and envoys,
Each with her own support and her implements,
A retinue that obeys and awaits his command, asking "What shall we do?",
Sat ferocious, ready to be unleashed.
The eight rākṣasa daughters, the gandharvīs,
Hosts of tigers, lions, foxes, wolves and hyenas,
And flocks of vultures, ravens and owls
Sat ferocious, singing his praises.
The eight great attendants of the rākṣasa,
Gaurī, Caurī, Pramohā,
Vetālī and Pukkasī,
Ghasmarī and Śmaśānī,
Caṇḍālī and the rest,
A host of fierce and ferocious mothers,
Sat in utterly terrifying forms.
The four gatekeepers of the charnel-ground land,
The Striving One, the Faced One, the Backward Dancer,
And likewise the Entering One, these four great ones,
Hold the secret gates and guard the gates of command.
The lady of the charnel ground, the Boat-Lifter,
The Greedy One and the Utterly Greedy One,
The Drunken One and the Blood-Drinker
Sat with the glow of those intoxicated by lust.
In the center of the heaped corpses and skulls,
Firmly fixed by a great blazing nail of meteoric iron,
Was the lady of the inner chamber, the attendant Krodhīśvarī,
With a skull ladle filled with blood,
And beer mixed with grain, butter and the five substances,
Ever holding her own enjoyments.
Because she was intoxicated with lust and greedy,
She was known as the Greedy Mistress of Desire.

In order for the Blessed One to bring under his power
That encampment-town of Rudra
Through the nine dances of the great Blazing One,

The retinue of tamed generals gathered,
The mighty lords of the world.
While most of them were busy with their tasks,
The son of the great glorious Vajradhara,
Not that very reality itself,
Drawn forth from the youth's lap,
Vajrakumāra, Ucchuṣma,
Dark blue, with a wrathful frown and matted locks,
Performed the nine dances of the great Blazing One.
Exactly like the lord of the charnel ground,
He fashioned his head, hands and feet there.
Through the application of the five nectars,
He transformed the five impure substances into nectar
And purified all into the nectar of emptiness.
The female retinue, the attendant and the rest,
Through wisdom unattached to its conduct,
And activity that does not accumulate what it does,
Through the method of union that leads them in accord,
He gathered under his power and cleansed of their stench.
The emanations, a host of emanations of the being's wisdom,
Appeared as the host of mothers, Gaurī, Caurī and the rest,
And as lions, tigers and the like.

That Greedy Mistress of Desire,
Through the force of her lust, looked upon whom she saw
As, on the whole, her own husband,
But saw him blazing with a far greater splendor.
Through that thought a doubt arose:
"How wonderful! Compared with my own lord,
This one blazes with far more light and has greater splendor.
What kind of emanation is this?"
As she wavered in two minds,
Vajrakumāra, of supreme means,
Let out a rākṣasa cry three times,
And her doubting thoughts were cut off.
Under the power of her lust
She clung tightly to the buddha's body.

Just as, when a snake driven by heat
Coils about the trunk of a sandalwood tree,
The tree relieves the torment of heat without a thought,
So he, without attachment to anything,
Dispelled her torment completely.

Then that Ucchuṣma
Uttered this near-heart mantra,
The essence of the wish-fulfilling jewel
From which all arises as one desires,
Supreme in performing every action:
oṃ bhu ra kuṃ i ci ki phi u cchusma kro dha hūṃ phaṭ
Through this miracle that is not the real thing,
He gathered in the miracle of great Vairocana.
Bringing down the light rays of oṃ,
Which had been emanated first,
He placed them in the womb of the Greedy Mistress.
By the power of this manifest secret mantra,
That syllable too was transformed there
Into the very likeness of a rākṣasa,
And it was placed directly in her womb.
From the light rays of the vajra hook,
rakṣa śrī he ru ka
ru tra ma tra ha ha ha ma:
By the power of these syllables that generate, complete and destroy,
The blessing was made firm.
That being of awareness, not the real thing,
Was gathered into the body of the vajra father.
That violent and powerful being,
Through the miracle of the illusory vajra,
Having tamed those whom the buddhas find hard to tame,
Cast off that childish conduct,
The part of Māra and of the perverted world,
And with his mind upon the essence of awakening
Remained, definitively explaining the intention.
The emanated king Vajradhara
Was made Lord of Secrets, holder of the secret,

Of the great secret treasury, the sacred scripture
Renowned in the three abodes of the gods,
By the being who had formerly been regent.

Then that fierce preta
Came back to his own abode,
And his own abode, his enjoyments
And his retinue no longer appeared as before;
Things he had never seen before appeared almost everywhere.
He was utterly displeased
And thought, "Ah! What has become of this encampment of mine?"
At that time the attendant, the Mistress,
Turned to her own husband and said:
"Ah, my handsome hero!
Are you speaking words of evil suspicion
Here within the retinue?
Hero, what is your intention?
deṅ hun han phan ño pa ti
kho na am ca sma ra ca
My hero, my handsome one, is that so?
kun lan tra co pu thra tha
Where, what, how could it be mistaken?"
When she spoke these words,
Through lust for her radiance, and desire,
And thinking that she surely held his own lineage,
He took it as a means of delight.

Then from the Greedy Mistress,
As the sprout of a pu tra came forth,
A sound resounding three times rang out,
And by that fierce and glorious ferocious cry
Rudra, his consort and the others fainted.
When they came to and looked once more,
Upon the great Terrifier, the Blazing One,
With dark blue, ferocious matted locks...

With nine heads and eighteen arms,
His vajra wings spread over the sky;
His body hairs like red-hot iron hooks,

Spiders, scorpions, vermin and snakes,
In terrifying forms, spread over the ground.
A skull ladle, a stira, a noose of entrails,
Sun and moon, garuḍa, owl and hawk,
A vajra and a three-pointed spear,
A casket, a whisk and a drum;
Hurling Mount Meru round about the trichiliocosm,
Adorned and decked with a hundred thousand nāga kings,
Blazing like the fire at the end of the eon,
Frowning in wrath, with blazing eyes of fury,
Avalokiteśvara with twenty-seven eyes,
Treading down the eight gods with eight blazing feet,
Became the wrathful Vajra Rākṣasa,
Renowned above the gods and māras.

Then that preta Rudra,
His own mind's notions swelling,
With the savage cry of fierce pride
Roused the lords of his retinue:
"ru tra ma tra ma ra tra
Gather, gather, host of Maheśvaras!
Gather wholly, utterly, to your oath!
Deploy, deploy, host of Maheśvaras!
Deploy wholly, utterly, for the deed!
Close in, close in, host of Maheśvaras!
Close in wholly, utterly, upon this one!
Lords, here at my palace
Is this great malevolent one:
The time has come for you to destroy him.
If here you ponder what to do and what not to do,
You are on the very brink of destruction.
A friend who weighs what should and should not be done,
Better that there be none of those deliberations;
Since such a friend is but an illusion,
Who would call that one a friend?
A warrior who weighs what should and should not be done,
Better that there be none of those deliberations;

Since such a warrior is but an illusion,
Who would call that one a hero?
Pledges weighed as to keep them or not to keep them,
Better that there be none of those deliberations;
Since such a pledge is but an illusion,
Who would deem it sacred?
In all things, weighing what should and should not be done,
Better that there be none of those deliberations;
Since such conduct is but an illusion,
Who would call it doing?
For each one, here, the time has come for his deeds!"

When he had urged the Maheśvaras with these words, unable to bear the splendor of Māra, the armies of the sons of gods who belong to Māra's faction, tens of millions and hundreds of millions, together with the Maheśvaras, became utterly alarmed, agitated and ferocious, and went into a frenzy. Like a whirlwind of the poison of grief they gathered at Māra's palace and brandished Māra's standards. They massed clouds of weapons, spread the nets of Māra's magical illusion, raised their war cries, and charged.

Then the hosts of vajra horses, by the strength of their vajra stamping, with the fierce force of their swift and miraculous gallop, roused all the wrathful ones of the Great Vehicle with this galloping song of the horse that decides the race:

"hri With the blazing dance mudrās
That wholly transform the moods of the body,
Charming, heroic and terrifying,
Laughing, scornful and frightening,
Compassionate, fierce, peaceful and the rest,
Crush the lords!
hri Display a form more desirable than a thousand Madanas;
For the sake of taming, display a form more terrible than a thousand Yamas;
In peaceful form as well, show yourselves surpassing a thousand Brahmās;
Make all things appear as the three maṇḍalas!
hri Crush the arrogant ones to be tamed, crushing them through skillful means!
ho ho ha ha he he hi hi With joyous laughter,
Destroy all the lords, utterly destroy them!

By the power of supreme prowess crush the arrogant lord!
hri Great Mighty One, hu lu hu lu, draw forth from the Three-Eyed One the three accomplishments!
hri By the power of supreme prowess crush the arrogant Mighty One!
From the heart of Rudra Matra, Glorious Lady, draw forth, draw it fully forth!
By the power of supreme prowess crush the arrogant Brahmā!
From Brahmā draw forth Tārā, sma ra tha!
hri By the power of supreme prowess crush the arrogant Lord of Joy!
All you of great union, draw forth joy for me!
hri By the power of supreme prowess crush the arrogant Rudra!
Great union, draw forth the queen Krodhīśvarī, draw her fully forth!
Compassion that weighs what should and should not be done,
Better that there be none of those deliberations;
Since such compassion is but an illusion,
Who would call that compassion?
Those to be tamed, weighed as to whether to tame them or not,
Better that there be none of those deliberations;
Since such ones to be tamed are but an illusion,
Who would speak of taming them?
hri ha ha ho ho Emanate, emanate fully!
Emanate fully everywhere and make it appear!
Make the savage, fierce and furious tumult blaze!
Beings of many and various kinds who look with wrong views in wrath,
The many kinds of beings to whom wrath appears:
Skilled in taming the wrathful continua wholly, leaving none,
Supreme means of all the Victors, emanate illusion, fully emanate!
Unmoved by wrath, supreme of the four wisdoms, rise up everywhere and take hold!
Beings of many and various kinds to whom desire appears:
Skilled in taming wholly, leaving none, the continua of many kinds of attachment,
Supreme means of all the Victors, emanate as illusion, fully emanate!
Unattached to enjoyment, wisdom of supreme bliss, savor it everywhere, rise up and play!
Beings of many and various kinds to whom bewilderment appears:
Skilled in taming wholly, leaving none, the continua of many kinds of delusion,
Supreme means of all the Victors, emanate through illusion, fully emanate!

Unbewildered in sameness, wisdom unmingled and wholly perfect, rise up and contemplate!"

At these words, the fierce and joyful sound of the wrathful goddess, indignant and fearless, rang out like a thousand thunderclaps. The tens of millions and hundreds of millions of māras of Māra's faction drew in their four limbs and were overpowered. The massed clouds of weapons, the standards and the rest, cleared away into emptiness. Their harsh words became manifest as the sound of the Secret Mantra of the Great Vehicle, ringing out and resounding.

As for Black Rudra, lord of the charnel ground, his own retinue abandoned him entirely and went for refuge to that holy Lord. Bereft of every object of his intellect, dispirited, his intentions cut off and his means lost, wholly agitated and utterly confused, he brought forth the seeds of his own five Rudras, and said ru lu ru lu bhyo.

He took on a wrathful form
With three heads, six arms and four legs.
That Lord, Vajra Rākṣasa,
Did exactly the same there:
Making the five seeds that bring under control,
Blessed, indivisible letters,
He snatched away the emanations of his speech,
And Rudra's faculty of speech failed.
Then that lord of the charnel ground
Uttered ra la ra la bhyo,
And became nine-headed and eighteen-armed.
There that holy Lord
Cut off the emanations of his speech for certain.
Again that lord of the charnel ground
Uttered hu lu hu lu bhyo,
And became eight-headed and sixteen-armed.
That greatly glorious Lord, the Rākṣasa,
Did just the same there,
And there too he cut off his utterance.
Then that lord of the charnel ground
Uttered ha la ha la bhyo,
And with twenty-one heads
Became forty-two-armed.

Again Vajra Rākṣasa
Did just that there,
And cut off his faculty of speech.
Once more he himself
Uttered ra li ra li bhyo,
And from his vast, immeasurable body
Sent forth a whirlwind of the eon of disease
And loosed malevolent weapons from his body.
Lord Vajra Rākṣasa
Did just the same to him:
He snatched his speech, and the emanations of his speech were cut off.
Like a man
Whose tongue is cut and who is drenched in blood,
He was utterly stupefied and fell down.

When that great Sovereign of all
Proclaimed sa ma ya hūṃ,
Through a connection from times of old
His life faculty could not bear it.
There, facing him,
With a blazing trident khaṭvāṅga,
Displaying the mudrā of the lord who destroyed the mountain of the putra,
He purified him outright.
Through the force of attendants, which linked him
To his own holy ones and the rest,
To buddhas without end
And to boundless minds of awakening,
And through the might of seeing Ghanavyūha,
The darkness of clinging from beginningless time
Cleared away, and finding births without end,
He remembered the deeds he had done in the bodies he had taken.
Brought out, he sat at the Lord's feet;
Bowing in great joy, yet as one in pain,
There he wept bitterly and cried out:
"Alas! Alas! Alas once more!
Hero, divine lord, your compassion is small!
From a single abode of perfect bliss

To drive me out, your compassion is small!
Now whatever you will do, do it quickly!
If you liberate me quickly, the bliss will be lasting.
I come as your subject and offer my body;
Do not be harsh with your subject!
From this day on, as you command,
I will carry out the word of your command.
If we do not act as commanded,
Or if we go against the holy word,
May our heads, bodies and hearts
Rot, decay, wither and burn!
Our mothers, sisters, daughters and wives
We offer as subjects, no small tribute.
We who lack the fortune to come to the center,
Place us at the edge of the blazing maṇḍala!
We who lack the fortune to partake of the first portion,
Grant us the leftovers, the rinsing water and what is spat out!"
To the grieving mothers and sisters of his attendants he said:
"From now on you are subjects of the Victor,
So whatever you do, be agents of the command;
Always swiftly accomplish what the command requires.
I too, having acted until now on the wrong path,
Have passed through the boundless sufferings of saṃsāra.
Now that compassion and my karmic remainder have met,
I go swiftly to the realm of Sukhāvatī.
Do not fail in the command taught to you after me!
As a loving mother longs for her child,
Long deeply for those who hold the pledges.
As a loving sister longs for her brother,
Cherish those with the branches tenderly.
Just as a girl longs for her companion,
Cherish the yogins dearly.
As a loving servant holds his master dear,
Keep close to the holy ones for certain."

Having given this advice to his retinue and attendants, he went for refuge to the Great Hero, and in order to guard the great command fully, he offered his

own token, his life-essence, and swore an oath. With ru lu ru lu bhyo he staked his own life. Then the Blessed One gave his full consent, as follows: blessing him with oṃ ru lu ru lu bhyo ha, he burned, purified and tamed him, and remained at ease.

This was the twenty-seventh chapter, on the complete taming of Māra, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then, at that time, the hosts of Maheśvaras thought: "How wonderful! This great Rudra, so mighty, so arrogant, so deluded, so lustful, so proud, so savage, has been overpowered by this Great Hero: definitively and truly overpowered, completely and utterly overpowered." So they thought.

At that time, Rudra, knowing with his own mind the thoughts in their minds, said: "O holy attendants, do not think like that! All you holy attendants bound to the remainder of my former karma, having met that spiritual friend, know karma. Birth is known. Karma is seen. Birth is seen. Karma has become manifest.

Birth has become manifest, and I have come to despair of myself on account of my own karma. In an instant I saw the svastika palace of great bliss. When women are tormented by the suffering of pregnancy, they think, 'This suffering comes solely from the karma of having gone to men and indulged in them often.' Just so, I too, utterly despairing over my karma alone, am in great anguish, for it bursts forth with the force of a great torment, like a landslide rolling down from a steep mountain peak that nothing can turn back. You attendants too, take your own karma to heart! The force of anguish will come rolling down like a landslide."

Having said this, he wept until he was exhausted and cried out bitterly, and gave voice to his complete anguish, as follows:

"Blessed One of great compassion, Vajrasattva,
Stainless, conch-colored, supremely beautiful in form,
Spreading the pure clear light of a hundred thousand suns and moons,
Hero blazing and shimmering with a thousand rays of light,
Renowned as the preceptor and teacher of the three worlds,
Sole kinsman of all beings of the three realms,
Loving protector, god of compassion, think of me!
From beginningless time until now
I have wandered the wheel of existence on wrong paths, having lost the path.
In former lives I erred, living a life of wrong deeds.

Whatever evil deeds I have done, I deeply regret their harm.
The force of karma, swollen and arrogant, grew so strong
That I have sunk into the ocean of saṃsāra's suffering.
The blazing fire of aversion burns my own being;
The thick darkness of delusion blinds my wisdom;
My consciousness sinks into the mire of the ocean of desire;
The mountain of fierce pride presses me down into the lower realms;
The whirling gale of jealousy sweeps me about in saṃsāra;
I am bound by the tight knot of the view of a self;
I have fallen into the trench of desire, like a pit of embers;
Fierce suffering pours down like unending rain.
Suffering such as this is very hard to bear,
And as the force of evil karma blazes like a fierce fire,
The sprouts of consciousness and the faculties are scorched.
When this illusory body of aggregates cannot bear it,
Can you, loving protector, compassionate one, bear it?
I am foolish and deluded, of bad karma, a great sinner;
Through the force of karma I was born in the desire realm as Rudra.
Born, I regret it; I despair of my karma.
Yet though I despair and regret, the force of karma cannot be undone.
The force of karma is like the course of a river;
How could the river of karma's power be turned back at once?
Every ripening arises from one's own karma.
Driven by that fierce gale of karma,
I, from then until now, for countless eons,
Have wandered in the dark prison of saṃsāra.
Through the blessing of your compassion, my attendant,
Karma, afflictions and obscurations have been wholly purified,
And now I sit at the feet of the one who loves me like a mother.
Your face of compassion, blazing with light like the sun and radiant like the moon,
Of which one never tires of gazing,
Since beginningless time I have not seen
With the bubble-like eyes blinded by the cataract of ignorance.
Where have you stayed until now, protector of beings?
Through the fierce and unbearable force of karma,
I am utterly afraid, my flesh creeps in terror,

And I utter this piteous cry of deep anguish.
Since I send forth the voice of the wretched and destitute,
If you, loving protector, do not consider me with compassion now,
Then when one day I die and pass on, parted from this body,
Parted from kin, friends and companions, Yama will lead me away.
At that time the worldly time will not stand empty:
Through the force of karma one like me will be led away alone.
At that time I will have no protector and no refuge,
So without putting it off until some later time,
Perform the fierce rite now, right away,
Upon a being like me, tormented by karma!
Because I have held wrong notions since beginningless time,
I have not been freed from the abode of saṃsāra's three realms.
For countless eons, in as many births,
I have taken countless bodies of coarse matter, which have perished.
If their flesh and bones were heaped up, they would equal the height of the world;
If their pus and blood were gathered, they would be the size of the great ocean;
If the remnants of their karma were gathered, they would be beyond thought and past telling.
Though I have counted through the three realms, birth and death succeeding one another,
The deeds I have done have all been wasted, to no purpose.
In all those countless births, however many,
If the deeds of even a single birth
Had been devoted wholly to unsurpassed awakening,
Then the deeds done that much would have had a purpose,
And in truth I would long since have passed into nirvāṇa.
Since the force of karma is strong and the power of the afflictions great,
I have taken bodies, nets of flesh and blood, and wandered in saṃsāra,
Falling into the prison of existence, its sufferings hard to bear.
Fierce, unending suffering such as this,
All of this wrongdoing, has arisen from my own karma.
With great compassion, cut the stream of my bad karma,
And turn back this wind of afflictions and karma, I pray.
Since the force of karma from ignorance and error is strong,

If I wander forever in the darkness of unknowing,
Will you not light my way with the rays of the lamp of wisdom?
If I cannot bear the fruit of my wrongful deeds,
Will you not perform the activity of great compassion?
When I have fallen over the precipice of distorted views,
Will you not seize me with the swift and rapid hand of compassion?
When I am tormented by the unbearable disease of the three poisons,
Will you not heal me with the medicine of compassion, skilled in means?
When the fire of suffering, the ripening of karma, blazes,
Will you not let fall a stream of cool rain of compassion?
When I sink into the mire of saṃsāra's suffering,
Will you not draw me out with the hook of compassion, skilled in means?
If, after being purified again and again in the abode of saṃsāra's three realms,
I should one day attain the fruit on my own,
What need would there be for the compassion of the noble ones? There would be no point.
If you leave me be because my karmic remainder is strong, consider:
What is called compassion, for whom would it do anything?
Hero, you possess the power of compassion,
And since the remainder of my karma, our past connection, is strong,
Without being careless, indifferent or idle,
Look upon me now from your heart, compassionate god, Victor!"

Saying this, he broke the mountain of his own pride, manifestly emanated his body as a lion, and offered it as a throne for the feet of the Lord.

This was the twenty-eighth chapter, on giving voice to the anguish of the lowliest, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then, since that rākṣasa of karma had been refuted in his wrong views, in order to cut the stream of his karmic obscurations, Vajra Rākṣasa reviled him with the great eightfold reviling, as follows:

"This sinner, mighty in perversity,
Has surely wandered in the wheel of existence
From beginningless time until now.
That all of it arises from yourself,
The root of the wrongdoing, is surely the fault.
For as many countless eons,

Taking bodies in many births,
Countless heaps of form have perished;
Though their flesh and bones would fill the trichiliocosm
And their pus and blood would swirl into an ocean,
They were wasted to no purpose.
No one else did it: it is your own karma.
Had you spent even one portion of that for a purpose,
You would by now have attained buddhahood in truth.
The great mighty ones without attachment,
Who give away their bodies entirely,
Attain the undefiled bliss of liberation
Even by giving no more than flesh, bones and blood
To beings tormented by hunger;
What need to speak of seeing the profound meaning?
Not daring to give away your own body,
Clinging fixedly to the extreme of attachment,
You pass from one to another through saṃsāra's three realms,
Tormented by the disease of pain.
This falling into the prison of existence
Is surely the fault of tying knots in space.
This wandering in the expanse of darkness
Is surely the fault of delusion in particular.
This sinking into a mire without escape
Is surely the fault of craving and longing.
This torment by the heat of a wicked mind
Is surely the fault of heated deeds.
This being crushed by a mountain of suffering
Is surely the fault of piled-up pride.
This falling into the wind gate of saṃsāra
Is surely the fault of the wind of karma.
Rudra, you torment yourself:
If from the very beginning you are a child of the Victors,
Why do you circle in the wheel of existence?
It is therefore your own karma.
Mind itself is like the sky,
Obscured by the sudden clouds of appearing forms.
To purify the concepts of appearing forms,

Scatter them with the wind of the eon of wisdom.
First you erred by going against the command;
Then you piled up the mountain of the manifest;
Then you burned the wish-fulfilling jewel;
Finally, by engaging in the four acts,
The meaning of the yoga of the Great Vehicle
You did not realize, or realized wrongly,
Or realized partially, not realizing it truly.
Not practicing it as it is, through a mixed practice,
You bound yourself to the course of the paths of action of the lower realms,
And it ripened as the fruit of a perverse existence.
Alas, how pitiful is bad karma!
I am an agent of the command,
And since the time for the work of the command has come,
In order to draw out of the abode of saṃsāra
This one who wanders in the lower realms,
I shall cut the stream of bad karma.
This sin ripened into substance
I slay with the weapon of the vajra sky.
In the world of the eastern gateway of the path,
You who cut off the true path to liberation,
Savage bhūta, outcaste,
You obscure suchness.
With the intellect that is truly certain,
Your source cut and your root severed, you arose from self.
Through the distorted might and diligence
Of the concept of a self that clings to self,
You act as a caravan leader toward wretched states.
Since that very thing is the concept of a self,
I destroy it with the power of the sky of selflessness.
With the great means that dominates and subdues,
With the might that is manifest in cutting,
And with the blessing that torments,
I crush the lord of the obstructors of the three times.
a na ya mahā śūnyatā a ko ta ya nāṃ sarva pā paṃ ma taṅ kha ru tra naṃ sarva pā paṃ kha ṭvāṃ ka ru tra naṃ
Since all is emptiness and unborn,

In killing there is no one killed;
This miracle of purifying illusion
Is the pledge of great compassion.
This pledge of killing for certain
Is not killing that shows the meaning:
The consciousness, freed from form, is made a vajra.
To bring it back down is the supreme pledge:
Gathering the consciousness with hūṃ,
Bring that very same one down into its form,
And just as it abided before,
Purify it in sameness, as great bliss.
This vetāla vajra pledge
Is the heart pledge of all the Victors.
Whoever is slain with the vajra weapon,
His life, his wrong concepts, dies in the vajra.
Since there is never a time when he will rise,
How could there be any birth again?
If the consciousness is not separated from form,
It rises in liberation from the abode of saṃsāra.
The deathless vajra, the mind of awakening,
The nectar water of the wisdom of emptiness,
Heals all who have drunk great poison;
It is the supreme physician who raises all the dead."

When the Lord of Laṅkā had spoken thus, the being of Black Rudra was completely purified, and he saw for certain the higher meaning.

This was the twenty-ninth chapter, on the complete purification of his being, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then, in order to turn definitively toward that very one, with the longing to lift the wheel of his feet upon the crown of his head, he roused him with this song, renowned for having been transmitted everywhere, called Urging the Intention of All Buddhas, saying:

"oṃ Since all dharmas are pure by nature,
I too am utterly pure by nature.
The self that is the supreme essence
Of the heart pledge of all the tathāgatas

Is applied to accomplishing the supreme
For all limitless sentient beings without exception;
So, through the gathering of the whole ocean of Victors,
Bring me forth as the essence of body!
Supreme jewel crown of wisdom,
Unsurpassed mass of splendor,
In whom all the jewels of the buddhas are gathered,
To the Utterly Victorious One I pay homage!

Supreme chief, wisdom of the essence,
Holder of the supreme and holy vajra,
Since you are the lord of the pledge,
Empower me as a sovereign king!
Since I am directly empowered by the vajra,
All the buddhas empower me this very day.
I am the supreme of all the Blessed Ones,
And to accomplish the supreme I shall take up the vajra.
Since you abide as the vajra king,
Vajra of body, speech and mind,
Through the supreme vajra pledge
Empower me with perfect accomplishment!
All dharmas have the defining mark of the vajra,
Yet the vajra too has no defining mark.
For the yogin who is like a vajra,
All things shine forth as the vajra itself.
This is the very melody of the buddhas' speech.
Holding the pledge of the wisdom being,
The sacred austerity of Vajrasattva
I shall uphold always.
hūṃ Guard the sacred pledge of Vajrasattva!
Bring the wisdom being near!
King of awareness, consider me steadfastly!
Lord of secrets, I pray you, nurture me!
Giver of supreme realization, bring forth delight in me!
You who cherish all desires, take delight in me!
Primordial buddha, compassionate in sameness,
Turn my mind to virtue in all deeds!

Sugatas of the three times, in all my abodes
Accomplish the vajra holder and the pledge being!
O tathāgata, delighted, delighted,
Vajra, never abandon me either!
O Vajra, lady of the whole dharmadhātu,
Great Lady of non-abiding passion,
Supreme source of everything without exception,
You are the most sacred of supreme bliss.
You are the chief of all pledges,
Mother who gives birth to Vajrasattva;
In the activity that accomplishes the aims of beings,
Bring union with compassion to perfection!
Since all the qualities of the buddhas arise from it,
The jewel vajra is unsurpassed.
Since I have sung the song of Vajradharma,
May I become one who performs the vajra of activity!"

With sa ma ya ho he took up the pledge. With sa ma ya stvaṃ he was fully bound by the pledge.

Then the son of Vajra Ucchuṣma,
Who is no real entity,
Vajra Rākṣasa, tamer of Māra,
Gave him the sacred pledge of vajra force.
With hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ bi śva vajra kro dha jva la ma ṇa ḍa la phaṭ phaṭ ha la ha la raṃ he purified him in the maṇḍala of fierce taming and purification. With ta keṃ ta keṃ phaṭ ha la ha la raṃ tīkṣṇa tīkṣṇa khaṃ kro dha kro dha yaṃ he purified all entities as empty. With oṃ he led him into the maṇḍala of spontaneously present nature. With muṃ he was placed in the maṇḍala of primordial suchness. With hūṃ he abode in the maṇḍala of the root, the mind of awakening. With i dan ti na ra gan te ba ri hṛ da ye nā ma basti nāṃ sa ma ya rakṣa si si ti pi na vajra a mṛ to ta kaṃ he gave him the sacred pledge. With oṃ āḥ hūṃ he gave him the sacred blessing of body, speech and mind. With oṃ vajra a mṛ ta e hye hi sarva ma na hūṃ hrī tha he gave him the sacred empowerment.

Then that rākṣasa of karma prayed to the deity of his own family:

"You who are my attendant,
Connected with me since lives of old,
Through the remainder of my karma and through compassion,
May you descend right now!"

When he had urged him in this way, glorious Vajrasattva, from the expanse of space, as a sun disc with the essence hūṃ together with its rays of light, dissolved into that one's heart, and so he was certainly established as of his own sacred family. With haṃ his vision was completely purified, and he saw all things as unmingled and wholly perfect. He was given the name Vajra and placed at the secret door of the Vajra Vehicle.

This was the thirtieth chapter, on Urging the Intention of All Buddhas, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then, as for the great majority of the assembled host of attendants of that rākṣasa of karma: their own karma was purified, they saw many buddhas, and their beings were purified by the light rays of blessing, so that the stream of their karma and of karmic ripening, and their endless former and later births, passed away all at once. With their doubts cut off, Maheśvara and the other great gods wept bitterly and cried out, praying:

"Lord of Dance, listen and consider us!
We who cling to the extreme of Rudra
Have not loosened this net of saṃsāra, of body and of karma,
With the subtle reasoning of your command;
Not having opened it with the key of profound wisdom,
We lack the intelligence of self-aware wisdom;
Not having honored the counsel of the definitive good,
Not having been caught by the lightning noose of the means of dance,
Our consciousness is obscured amid the ocean of karma,
And we have not recognized that very nature as suchness.
We erred in grasping our own minds, in delusion, as a self.
Utterly remorseful, taking on the manner of the contrite,
We go for refuge to you, Great Hero.
To purify our substance, we offer our bodies as your seat;
With compassion skilled in means, please accept these bodies!"
Saying this, they offered their own bodies as a throne for his feet.

Then Black Throat and the other great nāgas wept and cried out, praying:
"King of splendor, sovereign, consider us!

We who wander in the net of existence
Are bound all round by the five bonds.
No one has bound us; there is no binder:
We are bound by the karma of concepts that grasp at a self.
In this prison of the three cities of self-grasping,
Our various bodies, our abodes of perception and the rest,
Consciousness is bound in the fetters of saṃsāra;
Since we have not loosened the knot of self-grasping,
The knots that bind us all round never cease.
From this suffering, indestructible and hard to untie,
Please untie the knot of compassion through skillful means!"
Saying this, they offered their bodies as ornaments for his body.

Then Shatrang Sengbu, king of the rākṣasas, and the others wept bitterly and cried out, praying:
"Great charming Hero, consider us!
We who wander in the land of sorrow
Are tormented and burned by a great blazing fire.
No one has burned us; there is no burner:
It arises from the fierce and inexhaustible ripening itself.
Aversion blazes and burns our own being,
And since we have not quenched the self-grasping blazing within,
The burning and torment all round never cease.
From this suffering, which cannot be turned back and is hard to quell,
Please let fall a stream of the cool rain of compassion!
Just as iron gathers to a lodestone,
From this day on we come as subjects of the Hero."
Saying this, each of them presented a skull cup filled with blood.

Then the host of those with perverse craving wept bitterly and, lamenting, made this request:
"O Lamp that illumines all and dispels the dark, please hear us!
We who wander in black and murky darkness
Have strayed from the way, lost the path, and are wholly confused.
No one has blocked us; there is no blocker:
We are veiled by the darkness of ignorance, deluded about a self.
Our consciousness is clouded over by the darkness of delusion,
And since, deluded about a self, we have not dispelled that darkness,

The black darkness that veils everything never ceases.
From this suffering of great murk, so hard to clear,
Please show us the bright lamp of supreme knowledge!"
Saying this, they went to him as their sublime refuge.

Then the host of humans and nonhumans also wept bitterly and, lamenting, made this request:
"O Physician of skillful means and compassion, please hear us!
We who wander in the three cities
Are in the grip of the chronic disease of saṃsāra.
No one has seized us; there is no seizer:
We are held by the disease of self-grasping, affliction and ignorance.
Our consciousness is tormented by unbearable piercing pain,
And since the chronic disease of grasping at things as real has not been cured,
The piercing pain that torments us all round never ceases.
From this suffering with no release, in which it is hard to live,
Please cure us with the medicine of skillful means and compassion!"
Saying this, they offered their bodies as his subjects.

Then the host of yakṣas wept bitterly and, lamenting, made this request:
"O Ship of skillful means and compassion, please hear us!
We who wander in the ocean of saṃsāra
Are sunk in the swirling depths of the waves of suffering.
No one has pressed us down; there is no presser:
We are pressed down by the mountain of thoughts that grasp at things as real.
We are swept about in saṃsāra by the river of karma,
And since the channel of grasping at things as real has not been diverted,
The fierce river of the force of karma never ceases.
From this suffering with no escape, so hard to stem,
Please carry us across in the boat of skillful means and compassion!"
Saying this, they went to him as their sublime refuge.

Then the host of bhūtas wept bitterly and, lamenting, made this request:
"O self-arisen King of Nectar, please hear us!
We who wander on the island of great poison
Are utterly intoxicated, drunk, and ruined.
No one has dosed us; there is no one who doses:
We are intoxicated by the poison of inverted views.
Our consciousness is tormented by the disease of great poison,

And since the root of the poison coiled within has not been cut,
The suffering of the blazing poison-disease never ceases.
Upon this inexhaustible suffering, so hard to bear,
Please anoint us with the pure, self-arisen nectar!"
Saying this, they went to him as their sublime refuge.

Then Vajra Rākṣasa spoke again:
"So it is! Excellent, children of good family!
It is the rudras that drive you round;
It is the rudras that crush you.
It is self-grasping that drives you round;
It is self-grasping that crushes you.
It is aversion that drives you round;
It is aversion that crushes you.
It is delusion that drives you round;
It is delusion that crushes you.
It is attachment that drives you round;
It is attachment that crushes you.
It is the four rivers that drive you round;
It is the four rivers that crush you.
It is wrong views that drive you round;
It is wrong views that crush you.
Since you are, in every respect,
Primordially children of the Victor,
Why do you circle in the three cities?
It is solely the karma of each one's own concepts.
Unless the waves of the ocean of karma,
The knot of self-grasping,
The great fire blazing within,
The black darkness that clouds everything,
The chronic disease of conceiving things as real,
The river of distraction,
And the roots of poison coiled within
Are dealt with by the self-arisen vajra,
Hoping in others, beseeching them and crying out in anguish
Is like chasing a mirage in want of water.
If you do not join yourselves to bliss right here,

How could another bring you to bliss?
While you abide in bliss primordially,
Where would you now go seeking bliss?
By seeking, you will never come to find it;
You only roam further into suffering.
Butter comes from milk,
Yet in that very milk there is primordially no butter;
Even the Victors, with their measureless supreme means,
Cannot obtain it except by churning.
Likewise, if even the Victors, seeking it in one's own suchness,
Do not find it there,
Would you look for bliss in something else?
How pitiful, you of small mind who do not understand!"

When he had spoken thus, Maheśvara, the Lord of Laṅkā, and the rest of the great assembled host said, "O great being, since we wish to see each our own suchness, how should we look at it?" To this request the great being replied, "O assembled host, children of the Victor, if you wish to see each your own suchness, you should enter solely through the gate of the three great maṇḍalas. And of these, you should enter solely through the gate of the root maṇḍala of the mind of awakening. Why is that? Because the three great maṇḍalas and each one's own suchness are not separate; they are not different. And that is because they are gathered in the root maṇḍala of the mind of awakening."

When he had said this, the great assembled host said, "Great Hero, please let us enter the three maṇḍalas. Great being, please let us enter them properly." When they had made this request, the great being said:
"You children entering yoga
Shall be drawn out of the six worlds
And placed on the ground where the power of change is not yet fixed,
At the border between the transcended and the not transcended."
So he spoke.

Then the assembled host made this request:
"Great Hero, please hear us!
We, the fortunate assembled host,
Wish to enter this gate,
So please accept us as children of the Victor!"

When they asked this, the great being said:
"You great and fortunate assembled host,
Welcome! You have come well!
Whoever has come to this secret gate
Of the scripture of accomplishment will not turn back."
So he spoke.

Then those assembled generated the superior intention toward awakening, thus:
"Though we, the limitless sentient beings,
Are in truth buddhas,
Through the power of concepts we are in saṃsāra;
So we generate the mind toward supreme awakening.
Though the mind itself is buddha,
Veiled by darkness, we have not known it.
From this path of the mind of awakening
We shall enter the ground of buddhahood."
So they declared.

Then again the assembled host made this request:
"In this spontaneously present palace of great bliss,
From the four gates of liberation,
Open the gate of immeasurable compassion
And show us the fair face of loving-kindness!"
So they requested. Then the great being spoke these words:

"How wonderful, fortunate assembled host!
To cut off every gateway to the paths of saṃsāra
And to lead you onto the path of awakening,
I shall open the secret vajra gate."
When he had said this, light rays issued from the radiance of his smiling face, and the gate of certain entry into the meaning was opened.

Then the assembled host, delighted and pleased, earnestly aspiring to yoga, made this request:
"In the wondrous palace, the celestial mansion,
Where the whole ocean of Victors resides,
We are devoted with special certainty to yoga
And go for refuge to the vajra lineage."

So they requested.

Then again the assembled host made this request:
"From the beginningless limit of time,
Under the power of ignorance and wrong thoughts,
Whatever evil we have done,
All of it we confess, each one."
So they requested.

Again that assembled host made this request:
"Just as the Victor, the vidyādhara Vajra,
Liberated saṃsāra,
So, in order to liberate us completely,
Please bestow the vajra sun!"
So they requested.

Then the great being said:
"In what do you take joy?
In what do you have faith?
To what are you devoted?
What is it that you desire?"
When he had said this, the assembled host replied:
"We, the fortunate, in great bliss,
Take joy in the supremely joyful mind.
In the supreme meaning itself we have faith.
How wonderful! In this pleasure grove of supreme bliss,
Having practiced the deeds of a buddha so hard to do,
We are devoted to liberating all beings."
So they declared.

Again the assembled host made this request:
"Supreme Victor, great being, as you are,
Just so shall we practice.
Wondrous conduct of vast intent
We shall practice for the benefit of beings.
The worldly ones to saṃsāra's farthest reaches,
Those not yet delivered, we shall deliver;
Those not yet freed, we shall free;
Those not yet relieved, we shall relieve,

And in the realm of nirvāṇa
We shall join them to the very heart of awakening."
So they declared.

Then again the assembled host asked him to urge them to the sacred commitment (samaya):
"Indivisible yogin of the secret,
Arisen from the expanse of nondual meaning:
The expanse is the indestructible vajra,
And since it is one, without meeting or parting,
In the very expanse of the three secrets
Please keep us earnestly in nonduality."
So they requested.

Then the great being said:
"You yogins of the vajra holder,
Since you are certainly one in the vajra holder,
And since you are equal in the three secrets,
I give you the indivisible vajra commitment.
The indivisible vajra commitment
Is drawn out from the expanse of the three secrets.
The commitment of the three maṇḍalas,
Once accomplished, has no time of destruction."
So he declared.

Again the assembled host made this request:
"Dharma siblings, never meeting and parting,
Though of differing families, have a single commitment.
Since we are bound together so that it is hard to transgress,
Please keep us earnestly as holders of the commitment."
So they requested.

Then again the great being spoke these words:
"If you should deceive
The sublime ones of the three secrets,
They will all be enraged, and the great blood
They will draw from the violator's heart and drink."
Thus he gave the sublime commitment.

Then again that sublime being said:
"You of intelligence, buddha of the future,
In order to give birth to unsurpassed wisdom,
Abide in the three secrets that purify the mind stream.
Look into your own mirror itself.
Arranged in the three places,
The great secret, the secret, the supremely secret:
By seeing it you become suchness itself.
It is nothing other than self-arisen reality.
Do not speak of it to those of small mind!
If you should speak of it,
Broken by the fierce oath,
You will burn in the place of great blazing fire."
Thus he proclaimed the sublime commitment.

Lord of Laṅkā, when that assembled host had thus come to abide in the sublime three secrets, at that time some came to abide wholly in the yoga of aspiration. Some came to abide wholly in the yoga of opening the great family. Some came to abide wholly in the yoga of great reassurance. Some came to abide wholly in the yoga of receiving the great prophecy. Some came to abide wholly in the yoga of perfecting great power.

Thus at that very time, that great assembled host was empowered with the vajra name empowerment. Some became known as Vajra Sprout. Likewise some became known as Dharma Sprout. Some became known as Jewel Sprout. Some became known as Moon Power. Some became known as Sun Radiance. Some became known as Lion Power. Some became known as Sky Vajra. Among them, some of the wild ones became known as Vajra Wolf. Some became known as Vajra Juncture of Time. Some became known as Vajra Tamer of the Directions. Some became known as Vajra Charnel Ground. Black Rudra himself became known as Vajra Vetāla, Lord of the Charnel Ground. He remains for the duration of the great Good Eon, and becoming the protector of all yoga, the upāsaka called Black Excellent One, he performs the task of guardian for all who protect the Dharma. He received the prophecy: "In the eon after that, in the world system of the nadir called Covered with Ashes, he will become fully and perfectly awakened as the Tathāgata called Voice of the Lord of Ashes."

Lord of Laṅkā, at that time the world system shook in six ways. It shook, shook strongly, and shook strongly all over. It moved, moved strongly, and moved

strongly all over. It rocked, rocked strongly, and rocked strongly all over. It roared, roared strongly, and roared strongly all over. It quivered, quivered strongly, and quivered strongly all over. When the edges rose, the center sank; when the center rose, the edges sank. When the east rose, the west sank; when the west rose, the east sank; when the north rose, the south sank; when the south rose, the north sank.

All the worldly ones too were amazed and offered praise. Some of the world with its gods rejoiced in the sublime secret of suchness. Some attained acceptance of unborn phenomena. For some, the Dharma eye became pure, dustless and stainless. Some came to abide on the ground of nonreturning. And some, every one of them, received prophecies.

At that time the Rudra Black Liberation and the other savage ones who bore human skulls prostrated to that great being, the Savage Vajra, in the manner of yoga, lowering the four points of the body to the ground. Joining their palms and bowing with the crowns of their heads, they said:

"a ho su kha kṣaṃ barya de ba śi śa. How wonderful, great being! A perfect quaking has occurred. Is it the blessing of the nature of reality? Perfect forms have appeared. Are forms purified in their own place? Are they forms of compassion? Perfect sounds have arisen. Are sounds purified in their own place? Are they sounds of wisdom? Perfect scents have arisen. Are scents purified in their own place? Are they the scent of the mind of awakening? Perfect tastes have arisen. Are tastes purified in their own place? Are they the taste of meditative absorption? Perfect touch has arisen. Is touch purified in its own place? Is it the touch of the sacred commitment? Perfect feelings have arisen. Are feelings purified in their own place? Is the feeling equanimity?

"We feel that our might and prowess have grown beyond what they were before. We feel that miraculous powers have arisen. We feel that we have gained mastery. We feel that awareness has dawned. Great being, you who have shown us this source of such things, this sublime secret of all the buddhas, so profound, so vast, supreme, sublime, splendid and excellent, you are our father. You are our mother. And not only you, great being: any person at all who abides in this sublime teaching is our father, is our mother. Even if existence itself were overturned, the command would not be overturned.

"O great being, what need is there to speak of you? Even a person who abides in this sublime teaching of yours we shall honor on the crowns of our heads, like the crest jewel of the lord of the gods. The spouses, sons, daughters,

wealth, servants and servants' servants, retinues, relatives, kin by blood, descendants, and the people of the districts and lands of all who protect the Dharma, we too shall guard, shelter and hide. Whatever humans and nonhumans harm those who protect the Dharma, we shall utterly destroy and annihilate. We shall seal off boundaries and bind them. Whatever they intend and whatever they entrust to us, we shall fulfill it all completely by doing the work of servants.

"And they too, protecting the Dharma and abiding in accord with the Dharma, for the sake of a connection with us, are to keep the secret mantras of the great gods, which accomplish for us whatever we wish, the source of worldly manifest signs, which Vajra Great Might declared to be endowed with manifest power, together with the sacred substances, the auspicious tokens and the supports of signs. Why is that? Because these are our sacred bonds.

"O great being, it is like this: this secret mantra of ours, endowed with manifest power, has approach and accomplishment with four limbs. What are they? They are as follows. oṃ bhur khuṅ mahā pra ṇa ya bhurci bhurki byi ga ge bi ma na se e ho śi mo u cchuṣma kro dha hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā. Great being, that is the limb of approach. oṃ bhu du gurma a pra ṇa bhurci ci kyi phyi man sye kha śo mo ga kro dha hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā. Great being, that should be known as close approach. oṃ bhu du ku ru i ci ki phyi u cchusma kro dha hūṃ phaṭ. Great being, this should be known as accomplishment. oṃ bhurku ti phaṭ. Great being, this should be known as great accomplishment.

"Great being, if one completes a hundred thousand recitations of each of these, and only then engages in whatever activity is to be done, it will be accomplished without doubt. Why is that? Because the buddhas of the three times too have praised them as endowed with manifest power. Vajra Great Might too acted by means of this worldly manifest sign. We too act by means of this manifest sign of miracles. Great being, if there were no manifest signs for whoever earnestly pursues this secret mantra, no happiness would ever come, and the authoritative words too would surely be void. And we, for having fallen from the sacred pledge of our own truthful words, would without fail have our heads split and vomit blood.

"Therefore, great being, there is no doubt about this secret mantra. The sublime ones have taught it as a means to accomplish benefit for whomever it may be, to produce wonder, and to bring fools to trust the word of the Buddha.

It is good if they always practice these four limbs."

When they had said this, that sublime being said: "a hoḥ! It is fitting. It is proper. It is so. It is certain. It is true. Excellent! You savage ones, together with your mothers, your wives, your sons and daughters, your servants and servants' servants: if you are not parted from love, you shall be made mothers. If you are not parted from ardent care, you shall be made sisters. If you are not parted from diligence, you shall be made servants. If you are not parted from the mind of awakening, you shall be made sons. If you are without meeting and parting, you shall be made disciples. If you are swift when urged, you shall be made messengers. If you act according to the command, you shall be bound by the command." So saying, he placed them in the ranks of great yoga and empowered them as guardians of the Dharma and of all who protect the Dharma.

This is the thirty-first chapter of the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas, the prophecy that Black Liberation, who had strayed, has not strayed.

From the account of how the Great Vehicle definitively arose, this is the sixth teaching on how it arose: the discussion of the wisdom of the Dharma seal, which tells the story of the complete taming of Rudra when the time had come for those to be tamed.

The fifth section begins.

Then again the Lord of Laṅkā, the bodhisattva, the great being, put a question to the Lord of Secrets about the seventh of the twelve phrases spoken earlier, "It also arose in appearing through blessing." He asked: "O Lord of Secrets, when you yourself, teaching how the sublime secret Great Vehicle arose, gave your explanation as a narrative, you said, 'It also arose in appearing through blessing.' How does that appear, and how is it known?"

He replied: "Lord of Laṅkā, it refers to suchness itself appearing fully to those persons who are to be tamed, wholly ripe as disciples now that the time for their taming has come.

The Lord of Laṅkā said, "Lord of Secrets, where and how do those holy beings appear, those who are to be tamed and are wholly ripe as disciples now that the time for their taming has come?"

When he had asked this, the Lord of Secrets said, "O Lord of Laṅkā, those holy beings who are wholly ripe as disciples come to appear in all things."

He asked, "How do they come to appear in all?"

He said, "Lord of Laṅkā, those holy beings are not other than suchness, the nature of reality of all phenomena, and from that they appear as all phenomena: as consciousness, wisdom, bodies, emanations, letters, words, teachings, bodily relics, sacred remains, and so forth. Lord of Laṅkā, they appear solely through the blessing of suchness. Lord of Laṅkā, just as the reflections of the sun, the moon and the hosts of stars in the expanse of the sky appear distinctly in clear water without moving from them, so all phenomena appear from the pure secret expanse, the nature of reality of phenomena. And all phenomena come down to just the five: body, speech, mind, qualities and activity. That is what appears as the gateway that illustrates the secret mantra of the Great Vehicle. Why is that? Because it is unerringly certain that the secret expanse, which is the nature of all phenomena, is itself the suchness of the secret mantra of the Great Vehicle. That is known, and has become known, as the essential body.

"Lord of Laṅkā, from the nature of reality of the mind there appear the four consciousnesses. The four consciousnesses are the root consciousness, the referential consciousness, the all-appearing consciousness and the engaging consciousness. From the four consciousnesses there appear the five great wisdoms. From suchness, the nature of reality of the mind, there appears the wisdom of the dharma expanse. From the root consciousness there appears mirrorlike wisdom. From the referential consciousness there appears the wisdom of equality. From the all-appearing consciousness there appears discerning wisdom. From the engaging consciousness there appears the wisdom that accomplishes activity. Lord of Laṅkā, this is not establishing as something what it is not, nor contriving what is unlike to be alike. Uncontrived, unadulterated, unmade and unfabricated, it simply appears so, by its nature, from the very beginning."

Then the Lord of Laṅkā asked, "Lord of Secrets, is this wisdom limited to just these five, or does it also appear as other, different forms?"

He said, "Lord of Laṅkā, depending on circumstances wisdom appears as five, and it is also inconceivable, sixteen instants, of a single family, threefold, the three suchnesses, the four yogas, and the one that is self-arisen. Lord of Laṅkā, from the five wisdoms, distinct and unmixed, there appear the five families, and from their complete perfection there appear the four bodies. That is to say: from mirrorlike wisdom, the root consciousness, there appear

buddhas of the vajra lineage and class, all of them. From suchness, the wisdom of the dharma expanse, the nature of reality of the mind, there appear buddhas of the elephant lineage and class, all of them. That itself appears as what is called the essential body, and from the union of those two wisdoms there appears the dharma body. From the wisdom of equality, the referential consciousness, there appear buddhas of the jewel lineage and class, all of them. From discerning wisdom, the all-appearing consciousness, there appear buddhas of the lotus lineage and class, all of them. From the union of those two wisdoms there appears the body of perfect enjoyment. From the wisdom that accomplishes activity, the engaging consciousness, there appear buddhas of the youthful lineage and class, all of them. From that itself there appear the secret body and the various emanation bodies. From the various emanation bodies there appear various letters, various words, measureless gateways of Dharma, and various bodily relics and sacred remains. These are what appear as illustrations of the gateway of the Great Vehicle of secret mantra.

"Lord of Laṅkā, therefore secret mantra appears by its nature in all phenomena and in every way, and holy beings manifestly show it as appearing through the blessing of secret mantra. Lord of Laṅkā, why is that? Because there is no phenomenon at all that is not pervaded by secret mantra, that does not abide in it, or that has not become secret mantra. For some holy beings who have found the certainty of secret mantra unerringly, everything becomes a mirror for those who wish to see secret mantra. In every respect, from buddhas down to tiny crawling creatures, and from space down to atoms, everything makes it vivid, clear and distinct. It cuts through doubts. It becomes a sublime treasury. It becomes a great volume. It is an explanation on a vast scale. It proclaims so that all may understand. Lord of Laṅkā, therefore secret mantra simply appears by its nature, and holy beings simply show it through blessing."

The Lord of Laṅkā said, "Lord of Secrets, is the appearing of everything secret mantra? Or is the nonappearing of the nature of everything secret mantra? Or is something that is neither secret mantra?"

The Lord of Secrets said, "O Lord of Laṅkā, the appearing of everything is not secret mantra. If it were secret mantra, the very term 'secret mantra' would be contradicted, and the perceptions of sentient beings and the intention of the buddhas would be without difference. Nor is there secret mantra anywhere apart from that. If only what is other than that were secret mantra, then not everything would be included in the nature of reality. If the nonappearing of

the nature of everything were secret mantra, then the nihilists, for their part, would have attained perfect completion. Nor is what is neither of the two secret mantra. If something that is neither of the two were secret mantra, then there would be no other place where something called secret mantra could be found by seeking.

The Lord of Laṅkā said, "Lord of Secrets, then what is it that is called secret mantra?"

The Lord of Secrets said, "Lord of Laṅkā, what is called secret mantra is that suchness which is the nonduality of appearing and not appearing, which is free from the essence of the two, and which is not apprehended even as a middle."

The Lord of Laṅkā said, "Lord of Secrets, then if the essence of secret mantra is so very hard to fathom and hard to see, by what should it be seen?"

The Lord of Secrets said, "Lord of Laṅkā, the essence of secret mantra should be seen by a mind that is extremely subtle, most subtle, extremely profound, most profound."

He said, "Lord of Secrets, what is a subtle mind, an extremely subtle, a most subtle one? And what is an extremely profound, a most profound one?"

He said, "Lord of Laṅkā, as for an extremely subtle, most subtle mind, it is like this. There are some who say: 'In this element of earth, in a single league there are one akṣobhya of niyutas, thirty hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas, a hundred times sixty koṭis, thirty-two koṭis, five hundred thousand and twelve thousand of the most subtle atoms.' And they then divide these further into the most subtle atoms of fire, water and wind, and calculate by reckoning how many of the most subtle atoms there are in one great trichiliocosm, a great world system. Again, examining the endless different shapes in this great outer earth, they analyze each one by virtue of the differences, saying, 'These elements are flickering, warped, slanting, bent, entwined, coiled, jutting, ranged in rows, crooked, drooping, bulging, clinging, contorted,' and so on. And again, following the various names, conventions, signs, designations and imputations, and following their endless individual characteristics, they say that these people of many kinds of thinking and far-reaching analysis are, by these very means, on their way to the causes of omniscience. Lord of Laṅkā, such people are not called extremely subtle and most subtle; they are called coarse and most coarse. Why is that? Like fools who, wishing to sift gold dust from sand, mistake glittering mica for gold dust and search for it, they will not see or find all aspects. Why is that? Because in that there are all the aspects,

but there is no wisdom.

"Lord of Laṅkā, a subtle, most subtle mind is like this: by knowing unerringly the suchness that is the nature of reality of a single phenomenon, one knows unerringly the suchness that is the nature of reality of all phenomena. The most subtle atoms, the various shapes, the names, conventions, signs, designations and imputations, all come to be known naturally. For in that, all aspects and wisdom are nondual and free from the essence of the two, and so there is not a single phenomenon that is not seen and not known.

"Lord of Laṅkā, what is a profound, most profound mind? There are some who seek and analyze the limits, depths, extremes and center of all phenomena. They are not called profound and most profound of mind; they are called those who have reached a dead end. Why is that? Like the deluded who mistake a mirage for water and chase it, or the blind who seek the edge of space, though they seek the limits, depths, extremes and center of all phenomena, they will not find them, and there is nothing to analyze either. Lord of Laṅkā, however, understanding that all phenomena are without limit and depth, without extreme and center: that is called a profound, most profound mind. Why is that? Because the whole intention of all the buddhas is free of conceptual examination and analysis. Lord of Laṅkā, therefore, since the essence of secret mantra is so very hard to fathom, it should be seen by a subtle, most subtle, profound, most profound mind."

He said, "Lord of Secrets, by relying on what example should that secret expanse be understood?"

He said, "Lord of Laṅkā, there is nothing in the world that can serve as an example for that secret expanse. For the time being, if one wants a directly perceptible example, one may take space. Not that space is comparable to it either; but since there is no directly perceptible example in the world beyond that, the sublime ones have explained that one should rely on space as an example and understand it from that."

He said, "Lord of Secrets, how should the secret expanse and space be matched in their qualities?"

He said, "Lord of Laṅkā, the secret expanse and space are not alike in every quality, because the one is self-aware emptiness and the other is emptiness without awareness."

He said, "Lord of Secrets, then is space something not included in that secret expanse?"

He said, "Lord of Laṅkā, what do you think? Space is included in the secret expanse, but the secret expanse is not included within space."

He said, "Lord of Secrets, what is space?"

He said, "Lord of Laṅkā, space is simply whatever gives room."

He said, "Lord of Secrets, then how is the secret expanse illustrated and understood by means of space?"

He said, "Lord of Laṅkā, it is taken as an example of similar qualities: whether there is room or not, it knows no exhaustion, and in emptiness everything arises. In part these qualities are similar, but as an example of self-awareness it has no part. Since that secret expanse is self-aware of everything, it is called self-arisen wisdom. In some contexts that wisdom is called nonconceptual wisdom. In some it is called the wisdom of emptiness. In some it is called the wisdom of the dharma expanse. In some it is called pure, luminous wisdom. In some it is called the wisdom of equality. In some it is called discerning wisdom. In some it is called the wisdom that accomplishes activity. Lord of Laṅkā, these are also called spacelike wisdom, mirrorlike wisdom, wisdom like the vast, wisdom of various arrays, and wish-fulfilling-jewel wisdom.

Lord of Laṅkā, the mirror is taken up as an example that shares certain qualities: it removes faults, it brings forth what is good, it makes things clear, reflections arise in it, it is effortless, it is free of deliberate formation, it is not conjoined, it is not unconjoined, it is not near, it is not far, everything arises in it, its measure is not delimited, it is not other, it is not obscured, it is not dark, and it is not remote. Lord of Laṅkā, although those qualities correspond in part, as an example of self-awareness itself there is no such part.

Lord of Laṅkā, the vast is taken up as an example that shares certain qualities: it is awareness itself, complete. It is complete without great or small, without long or short, without good or bad, without faults or virtues, without accepting or rejecting, without right or wrong, without pure or impure, without happiness or suffering, without high or low, without wide or narrow, without superimposition or denial, without mixing, and complete without division. Lord of Laṅkā, although those qualities correspond in part, as an example of self-awareness itself there is no such part.

Lord of Laṅkā, the array of variety is taken up as an example that shares certain qualities: abiding, engaging, being unmixed, clarity, distinctness, various enjoyments, appearance, and being utterly free of confusion. Lord of Laṅkā, although those qualities correspond in part, as an example of self-awareness itself there is no such part.

Lord of Laṅkā, the precious jewel is taken up as an example that shares certain qualities: it is nonconceptual, it performs activity, what is desired arises from it, it fulfills needs, it satisfies hopes, it is unceasing, it produces joy, it is inexhaustible, it establishes beings in happiness, it is accomplished in every way, it is unobstructed, it needs no support, it gives bountifully, and it accomplishes every purpose. Lord of Laṅkā, although those qualities correspond in part, as an example of self-awareness itself there is no such part.

He said, "Lord of Secrets, this word wisdom, by force of what meaning is it a designation?"

He replied, "Lord of Laṅkā, because it is so named from knowing all phenomena, in the unerring meaning of how they primordially are, as without arising or ceasing, it should be understood as a designation by force of that very meaning.

"Lord of Laṅkā, furthermore: being like space, being like a mirror, being like a rainbow, being like shape and color, being like clouds and mist, and appearing unfabricated; although those qualities correspond in part, as an example of self-awareness itself there is no such part.

"Lord of Laṅkā, illuminating everything, unobstructed gateways, the emergence of miraculous displays, gathering into one, and perfection: these should be understood as the performing of activity. Lord of Laṅkā, being unmixed, being complete, the totality of unmixed completeness, continuity, and nonreferentiality: these should be understood as what appears to be seen. Lord of Laṅkā, being unceasing, not projected outward, not sought, without remainder, and having become the cause: these should be understood as the potency of its dynamic power.

"Lord of Laṅkā, thus, from mind there is the appearance of mind, and appearance is to be recognized as wisdom. These too should be understood as the appearance of the blessing of the sacred secret suchness."

When he had said this, the doubts born of conceptual thought in the minds of the Lord of Laṅkā and the other beings in lowly bodies were cut off.

This was the thirty-second chapter, Arraying the Sacred Ornament of the Appearance of Enlightened Mind and Wisdom, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then again the Lord of Laṅkā, the bodhisattva, the great being, asked the Lord of Secrets, "Lord of Secrets, what is the suchness of mind? What is consciousness? What is wisdom? And what is called the body?"

The Lord of Secrets said, "Lord of Laṅkā, as to what you have asked, I have heard it thus. Mind is mind, the appearance of mind, and what arises from mind: that is, it itself, its engagement, and its continuity. Consciousness is the all-ground, the mentation that sets it in motion, and the five doors that arise in continuity. Wisdom is whatever is recognized as that itself. The body is the ground on which arising and engaging appear."

Again the Lord of Laṅkā asked, "Lord of Secrets, what is recognition? What is arising? What is engaging? What is appearance? What is the ground?"

The Lord of Secrets said, "Lord of Laṅkā, as to the five you ask about, I have heard it thus. Recognition is having grasped it without its having come from anywhere else. Why is that? Lord of Laṅkā, if it were something that came from elsewhere, it would be adventitious, and so it could not properly be what is called wisdom. Arising refers to the emanation. Why is that? The emanation is what arises in continuity wherever it has never arisen or been experienced before. Engaging is the perfect enjoyment. Why is that? It is that by which yoga engages what genuinely abides within. Appearance is the dharma body. Why is that? It appears as the nature of two arising from the union of two. The ground is the body of essential nature. Why is that? Because it is the essential nature without substance that is the ground from which all phenomena arise."

Again the Lord of Laṅkā asked, "Lord of Secrets, what is the emanation? What is the perfect enjoyment? What is the dharma body? What is the essential nature?"

The Lord of Secrets said, "Lord of Laṅkā, as to these four that you ask about, I have heard it thus. The emanation is what arises in continuity out of nonexistence. The perfect enjoyment is perfect maturation. The dharma body is complete purity. The essential nature is suchness just as it is."

Again the Lord of Laṅkā asked, "Lord of Secrets, what is arising in continuity? What is perfect maturation? What is complete purity? What is suchness just as it is?"

The Lord of Secrets said, "Lord of Laṅkā, the four you ask about are these. Arising in continuity is the unbroken continuity of what has transformed from mind. Perfect maturation is what arises from mind. Complete purity is the appearance of mind. Suchness just as it is is mind itself."

"Lord of Laṅkā, why is that? When the darkness of what has transformed is cleared, the emanation manifestly appears. When the darkness of what arises is cleared, the perfect enjoyment manifestly appears. When the darkness of what appears is cleared, the dharma body manifestly appears. As for the essential nature, because it has passed beyond darkness, appearance, clearing, and obscuring, it is entirely free of the pathway of words. Lord of Laṅkā, it should be understood that within these themselves there is purity and impurity, by virtue of the distinctions of the secret essence."

He said, "Lord of Secrets, what is purity? What is impurity?"

He replied, "Lord of Laṅkā, it is like this: localized purity, partial purity, complete purity, and the great purity that is pure in every way and in every respect.

"Lord of Laṅkā, among these, localized purity is this: the pacification of whatever appears as three is utter purity; the lord of Dharma is maturation; the regent of Dharma is continuity.

"Partial purity is this: self-awareness within what is unaware is utter purity; having entered into bliss is maturation; whatever appears is continuity.

"Complete purity is this: space itself is utter purity; enjoying bliss is maturation; complete transformation is continuity.

"The great purity that is pure in every way and in every respect is this: what appears as the ground, what is unadulterated, is suchness itself; the absence of a body is utter purity; complete perfection is maturation; arising as anything at all is continuity.

"Lord of Laṅkā, among these, localized purity, partial purity, and complete purity are called impure. Why is that? Because they hold that there is purity in what, in every way, has nothing to be purified, and they set about purifying it."

He said, "Lord of Secrets, then why are localized purity, partial purity, and complete purity called pure?"

He replied, "Lord of Laṅkā, it is because, from what was entirely obscured, they are cleared locally, cleared partially, and cleared completely. Lord of Laṅkā, what in every way and in every respect has nothing to be purified is what is called pure. Why is that? Because in it there is no cause whatsoever for purification."

Again the Lord of Laṅkā asked, "Lord of Secrets, what is continuity but not maturation? What is maturation but not continuity? What is both? What is neither?"

To this question he replied, "Lord of Laṅkā, the four questions you have asked are answered thus. Continuity but not maturation is one who, although passed beyond, benefits immeasurable saṃsāra through the power of the lotus. Maturation but not continuity is the stage prior to the grounds. Both is having passed beyond with remainder. Neither is utter purity."

Again the Lord of Laṅkā asked, "Lord of Secrets, what is their activity? What is their body? What is their intention? What is their ground?"

He replied, "Lord of Laṅkā, their activity is the activity of all buddhas: the action of continuity, appearing as anything at all. Their body is the body of all buddhas: complete maturation. Their intention is the intention of all buddhas: utter purity. Their ground is the source of all buddhas: suchness itself.

"Lord of Laṅkā, these are also called many, one, one and many, and beyond these. Why is that? Continuity is called many, because its variety is beyond measure. Maturation is called one, because it is one in all. Utter purity is called one and many, because it is the ground of continuity and maturation. Suchness is called beyond these, because it neither diminishes nor increases through their arising and entering."

Again the Lord of Laṅkā asked, "Lord of Secrets, are these permanent, or are they impermanent? Are they existent, or are they nonexistent? Are they one, or are they different?"

To this question the Lord of Secrets replied, "Lord of Laṅkā, the six questions you have asked are answered thus. They are permanent. They are not impermanent. Nor are they permanent as permanent and impermanent as impermanent. Nor are they neither permanent nor impermanent. They are existent. They are also nonexistent. They are also existent as existent and

nonexistent as nonexistent. They are also neither existent nor nonexistent. They are one. They are also different. They are also neither one nor different. They are also free from the essential nature of one and different.

"Lord of Laṅkā, why is that? It is like this. Because they are unchanging and without any antidote, because whatever arises is not apprehended, because they are the ground of all, because no extreme whatsoever is apprehended, because they are not everlasting, because they arise in continuity, because they are the sacred intention, because they are without substance, because they are the domain of a purified continuum, because they have passed beyond extremes and middle, because they have passed beyond conventions, because they are just as they primordially are, because they are unthinkable, because they are inconceivable, because they are the domain of each one's own experience, and because they are alike in every particular: take them as permanent, take them as impermanent, take them as existent, take them as nonexistent, take them as one, take them as different, and take them as free from the essential nature of one and different.

"Lord of Laṅkā, thus, because of the needs of those to be trained, the bodies have no fixed number: take them as inconceivable. Take them as five, take them as four, take them as three, take them as two, take them as one. In truth, they are merely designated by convention as body, speech, mind, qualities, and activity; but the body is space, speech is echo, mind is the nature of reality, qualities are illusion, and activity is emanation. These merely appear through blessing according to whoever is to be trained; in reality there is no appearance whatsoever.

"Lord of Laṅkā, their essence is consciousness; recognized, it is wisdom; made directly manifest, it is buddha. Lord of Laṅkā, thus, because the nature of secret mantra is so hard to fathom, those of the realm of darkness designate it consciousness, those of the realm of light designate it wisdom, and those whose eyes are clear designate it buddha.

And those with sacred eyes recognize it as secret mantra."

Then again the Lord of Laṅkā asked, "Lord of Secrets, what are their buddhafields? What is their retinue? What teaching do they proclaim? What is their time? What is their activity?"

The Lord of Secrets said, "Lord of Laṅkā, the five questions you have asked are answered thus.

"For what is without essential nature, the buddhafield is unproduced, the retinue is without any awakened one, the teaching is unthinkable, the time is beyond measure, and the activity is acting as anything at all.

"For utter purity, the buddhafield is the great all-pervading expanse, the retinue is an ocean-like assembly of wisdom, the teaching is the Dharma of nonaction, the time is in every way and in every respect, and the activity is illuminating all phenomena.

"For maturation, the buddhafield is Sukhāvatī, the retinue is an ocean-like assembly of the completely matured, the teaching is inexpressible, the time is whenever one dwells in the Pure Abodes, and the activity is sacred yoga itself.

"For the secret, the buddhafield is the Realm Possessing Lotuses, the retinue is an ocean-like assembly of victors, the teaching is the very ocean of secret mantra, the time is the very time when, as the Uṣṇīṣa Cakravartin wishes, the bodies of all the victors are assembled, and the activity is cutting the doubts of sacred beings concerning the sacred intention.

"For continuity, the buddhafield is the Realm Possessing Devotion, the retinue is an assembly of differing inclinations, the teaching is inconceivable, the time is when lamps are fully arrayed, and the activity is dispelling the darkness of whoever it may be.

"Lord of Laṅkā, these too should not be viewed as separate. Why is that? They merely appear in this way out of what is without essential nature; that is solely the appearance of the blessing of suchness, the sacred secret. Lord of Laṅkā, therefore, the sacred secret that is without essential nature is like the orb of the sun, and what appears from its blessing should be understood to be like its rays and light."

When he had said this, the doubts of the Lord of Laṅkā and the other beings in lowly bodies, which arose from conceptualizing the bodies, were cut off.

This was the thirty-third chapter, Arraying the Sacred Ornament of the Complete Appearance of the Bodies, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then again the Lord of Laṅkā, the bodhisattva, the great being, in order to gauge how the blessing of the Tathāgata's speech appears, put a question: "O Lord of Secrets, those whose appearances are arrayed from the blessing of mind and body: how should one gauge what appears from the blessing of their speech?"

When he had asked this, the Lord of Secrets said, "Lord of Laṅkā, the question you have asked is answered thus. In the secret, the sacred secret without essential nature, there is no convention of words and sounds; in every way and in every respect there is simply no speech at all. Should one try to gauge those secrets, even a sacred being who is completely pure cannot gauge them; for at the very moment one gauges it, it is ascertained to be the sacred secret without essential nature, and so it is extremely hard to gauge.

"Lord of Laṅkā, nevertheless, it should be understood in this way. The speech of what is without essential nature is like space. The speech of utter purity is like the orb of the sun. The speech of complete maturation is like a mirror. The speech of the sacred secret is like a lion. The speech that arises in continuity is called inconceivable, because from a single utterance branches arise beyond conception.

"Lord of Laṅkā, these inconceivable ones arise as four and appear as four, and they should be understood in detail from those four. What are the four? They should be understood as the nature of speech, its modes, its branches, and its reflections.

"Lord of Laṅkā, among these, what is its nature? It is like this: it is great in resonance, it is all-pervading, it is quickly understood, it cuts doubts, each one thinks it is looking at him alone, it teaches each in due measure, it enters everywhere, it arouses aspiration, it engages each in particular, and it tames all.

"Lord of Laṅkā, what are its modes? It is like this: like Brahmā, like cymbals, like song and dance, like the kalaviṅka bird, like the roar of thunder, and like an echo.

"Lord of Laṅkā, its branches are these: it generates understanding, it is intelligible, it is worth hearing, it is without discord, it is extremely profound, it is consistent, it cannot be overpowered by anyone, it is pleasing to the ear, it is untroubled, and it is extremely clear. In each and every gateway of the modes, wherever it arises, all the branches arise complete.

"Lord of Laṅkā, among these, what are its reflections? It should be understood that the reflections appear as collections of letters, and that the letters arise from the blessing of the sacred secret. Lord of Laṅkā, the blessing of the sacred secret is not confined to letters: all phenomena, letters and the rest, arise out of nonexistence and take shape just as they are designated, are accomplished just as they are practiced, and appear just as they are looked

upon wherever they are seen. Therefore letters too merely arise as the reflections of speech from the blessing of the unobservable expanse.

"Lord of Laṅkā, and yet, since everything is empty by its intrinsic nature, naturally unfabricated, and luminous, there is nothing to be sought; since it is primordially awakened, to pursue and strive for awakening is to undertake needless hardship."

He said, "Lord of Secrets, then why are sentient beings and buddhas two and different?"

He replied, "Lord of Laṅkā, that is because of conditions just as they are. Lord of Laṅkā, therefore it is like this: the cause of reflections, the gateway from which reflections arise, the dhāraṇī of reflections, the pledge of reflections, and the emanation of reflections.

"Lord of Laṅkā, among these, the cause of reflections is clarity that is not apprehended: from nothing at all, anything at all arises. Lord of Laṅkā, the gateway from which reflections arise is wherever two come together: from what is nothing at all, it brings awareness of anything at all.

"Lord of Laṅkā, although reflections indicate something, the actual basis neither arises from the reflections nor fails to arise, neither appears nor fails to appear, neither pervades nor fails to pervade. For example, everyone can utter the word 'space,' but if one asks what space is, no one at all can point it out, saying, 'It is just this.' Lord of Laṅkā, in the same way, reflections can indicate the actual basis, but they cannot point it out, saying, 'It is just this.' Why is that? Because reflections arise from the actual basis, they can indicate it; and because they are reflections, they become anyone's domain of experience. But the actual basis has become no one's domain of experience, and so it cannot be pointed out, saying, 'It is this.'

"Therefore, that secret intention of all buddhas, whether buddhas appear in the world or do not appear, whether sentient beings awaken or do not awaken, abides primordially as the nature of all and pervades all, yet it is not seen by all. Everything that arises from it may be known, and it may indicate that very thing; yet what arises from it cannot point out that very thing, saying, 'It is just this.'

"Lord of Laṅkā, the dhāraṇī of reflections is this: that very thing which is nothing at all and unseen arises as anything at all and is never separate from anything whatsoever. It is like this: whatever is a reflection is the actual basis.

Whatever is the actual basis is the reflection. Whatever is the actual basis and the reflection is the expanse of the sacred secret. Whatever is the sacred secret is the actual basis and the reflection.

"Moreover, the sacred secret is like the ocean, and all that arises from its blessing is like the waves. To see these two as nondual, freed from the extremes of two, not apprehended even as a middle, never becoming two: that suchness is the dhāraṇī. Likewise there are the dhāraṇīs of being indivisible and indestructible by anything, of being apprehended nowhere, of equality, of changelessness, of the nature of space, and of name, word, meaning, and secret mantra.

"Moreover, the nature of reflections is the unobservable expanse, and the nature of the actual basis is likewise nothing but the unobservable expanse; therefore that is the dhāraṇī of both. That unobservable expanse everywhere gives rise to all, sentient beings, buddhas, and the rest; and since it is their nature, they are one. Hence it is the dhāraṇī of nonseparateness.

"Lord of Laṅkā, the pledge of reflections is this: a reflection does not depart from that of which it is the reflection. However it may appear, it does not change from or depart from that actual basis. Thus, since there is no arising or entering, no outer or inner, no front or depth, no meeting or parting, it is the pledge. Because all things never depart from that state, it is called the pledge.

"Lord of Laṅkā, for example, Vajrasattva is the sacred intention, the domain of experience of the buddhas. If a reflection of him were set before some fool, what would that fool think?"

He said, "Lord of Secrets, he would think, 'This is not Vajrasattva himself; it is merely his likeness.'"

He said, "Lord of Laṅkā, therefore, when the sacred ones look, in the unobservable expanse Vajrasattva and his reflection do not abide separately as one thing and another. Why is that? Because the nature of both is suchness, just as it is. If he were something separate, it would not be right for a result to arise from focusing on him."

The Lord of Laṅkā said, "Lord of Secrets, is there no difference between them?"

He said, "Lord of Laṅkā, under the sway of unknowing they are merely spoken of, and merely appear, as a reflection and the meaning it indicates. But when the sacred ones apply themselves to suchness, there is not the slightest

difference between them."

He said, "Lord of Secrets, then what purpose do expression, indication, and convention serve for phenomena?"

He said, "Lord of Laṅkā, I have already dispelled that doubt."

He said, "Lord of Secrets, then what is the purpose of those of great mind striving with great hardship and fashioning images well?"

He said, "Lord of Laṅkā, that is so; yet it is in order to guide those attached to signs, and because those who, though of great mind, have not yet found the experience of attaining a great aim through a mighty means of little effort.

"Lord of Laṅkā, from suchness miraculous displays continuously appear. Like a jewel or a cloud, anything at all appears from nothing at all, and much spreads forth from little; therefore this appearance of all the phenomena of existence and nirvāṇa appears from nothing at all. Therefore these reflections of speech too should be understood as the nature of reality appearing from nothing at all.

"Lord of Laṅkā, the emanations of reflections are distinct. The reflection of speech is what appears as letters, and the emanations of letters are these: their names, their modes of origin, their forms, their natures, their sounds, their functions, their gateways, their synonyms, and their bases. One will see and know the suchness of these letters, the sacred secret, and through that one will become skilled in all phenomena and be liberated.

"Here, Lord of Laṅkā, the names of the letters are these: designations that indicate something, though it exists in nothing. The letter that indicates nonarising is designated by the name a. The letter that indicates action is designated by the name ka. The letter that indicates pervasion is designated by the name kha. The letter that indicates birth is designated by the name ga. The letter that indicates liberation is designated by the name gha. The letter that indicates grasping is designated by the name ṅa. The letter that indicates conduct is designated by the name ca. The letter that indicates meeting and parting is designated by the name cha. The letter that indicates nonabiding is designated by the name ja. The letter that indicates stain is designated by the name jha. The letter that indicates knowing is designated by the name ña. The letter that indicates suchness is designated by the name ta.

"The letter that indicates the agent is designated by the name tha. The letter that indicates pacification is designated by the name da. The letter that

indicates phenomena is designated by the name dha. The letter that indicates name is designated by the name na. The letter that indicates the path is designated by the name ṭa. The letter that indicates abode is designated by the name ṭha. The letter that indicates total delusion is designated by the name ḍa. The letter that indicates intrinsic nature is designated by the name ḍha. The letter that indicates the object is designated by the name ṇa. The letter that indicates the ultimate is designated by the name pa. The letter that indicates the result is designated by the name pha. The letter that indicates bondage and liberation is designated by the name ba. The letter that indicates existence is designated by the name bha. The letter that indicates mindfulness is designated by the name ma. The letter that indicates the changeless is designated by the name ya. The letter that indicates causes and conditions is designated by the name va. The letter that indicates dust is designated by the name ra. The letter that indicates the vanquished is designated by the name la. The letter that indicates peace is designated by the name śa. The letter that indicates the generating of knowledge is designated by the name ṣa. The letter that indicates knowledge of all aspects is designated by the name sa. The letter that indicates cause is designated by the name ha. The letter that indicates final exhaustion is designated by the name kṣa.

"The letter that indicates self is designated by the name a. The letter that indicates distraction is designated by the name i. The letter that indicates a mountain is designated by the name ī. The letter that indicates attachment is designated by the name u. The letter that indicates darkness is designated by the name ū. The letter that indicates torment is designated by the name e. The letter that indicates malice is designated by the name ai. The letter that indicates destruction is designated by the name o. The letter that indicates emptiness is designated by the name au. The letter that indicates setting is designated by the name a. The letter that indicates the body is designated by the name aṃ. The letter that indicates speech is designated by the name āḥ. The letter that indicates the mind is designated by the name hūṃ. The letter that indicates qualities is designated by the name sva. The letter that indicates activity is designated by the name hā.

"The letter that indicates summoning is designated by the name Hook. The letter that indicates gathering is designated by the name Boundless Light. The letter that indicates leading is designated by the name Hope. The letter that indicates joining is designated by the name Crescent Moon. The letter that indicates name is designated by the name Drop. The letter that indicates

cutting is designated by the name Staff.

"Lord of Laṅkā, these should be understood as the names of the letters.

"Lord of Laṅkā, among these, what is the mode of origin of the letters? It is like this:

The Teacher, the supreme secret himself,
Called out to the assembly and spoke:
'Further, if the yogins of the assembly
Infer the meaning by following the letters,
The meaning of the letters will be clearly shown.
Why does meaning itself appear as letters?
From the expanse arises a, and from a
Letters stream forth like wish-fulfilling massing clouds.

a is the letter of intrinsic nature;
Free of any support, it has no cause or condition;
Pervading all from within, it is like space.
Just as the profound, unborn nature of reality
Pervades, abides in, and holds all phenomena,
So, through the nature of a, which pervades and abides,
All letters are pervaded and all are held,
Transformed into various names and phrases.

From the glorious knot at the heart of the Great Being,
The ground of all, from which all things arise,
Dawns into the secret expanse of the throat.
The miracle that appears as five letters,
Sounds arising at the throat, resounding from the throat:
a ka kha ga gha ṅa

As rays of syllables stream forth from a,
The faculty of the tongue streams forth as a half-moon.
The miracle that appears as five letters,
Sounds arising at the tongue, resounding from the tongue:
ca cha ja jha ña

From the tips of the light rays of a
Streams forth the tip of the tongue's half-moon.
The miracle appears as twice five letters,
Sounds arising at the tip, resounding at the crown:

ta tha da dha na
ṭa ṭha ḍa ḍha ṇa

Likewise, from that arises this:
Swirling and blazing from the lips,
Likewise appearing as five syllables,
Arising at the door of the mouth, resounding from the mouth:
pa pha ba bha ma

That very supreme of all syllables
Arises there on the flowing path of speech;
Dawning toward objects as syllables of awareness,
The miracle appears as various letters:
ya va ra la
śa ṣa sa ha
kṣa
a ā i ī u ū e ai o au aṃ a
ṛ ṝ ḷ ḹ a ho

From the self-arisen, abiding, pervading expanse
Dawn the light rays of the garland of speech.
When fashioned from the wisdom of speech,
The seeds of the guides' emanations arise.
The body, speech, and mind of the countless victors
Are precisely the emanation of the letters.

It is the very mind of the unborn.
The first are the reflections of the throat;
The second are the reflections of the tongue;
The third are those that arise from the tip;
The fourth dawn at the lips where they arise;
The fifth are the flowing path of speech.

ya is the letter that gathers all;
ra is the letter from which burning arises;
la is the letter of great destruction;
vā is the letter that dispels darkness;
śa is the letter that purifies signs;
ṣa is the letter of great emptiness;
kṣa is the letter from which miracles arise;

sa is the letter of all aspects;
ha is the letter that suppresses saṃsāra;
a is the letter of all arising;
vā is the letter of all expression.

The sixteen letters of the immeasurables and the paths are complete.
The four letters of speech, from which arise the words
Of body, speech, mind, and qualities;
And seven and twelve, the flowing of speech:
These the Protector has taught as arising.'

Lord of Laṅkā, these should be understood as the way the letters arise.

Lord of Laṅkā, what here is the form of the letters? It is simply color and shape. Lord of Laṅkā, what is color? It is natural, of a class, various, and indeterminate.

Lord of Laṅkā, shapes are diverse. Thus even for a alone there are different shapes: a like a lion poised, a like a lion stretching, a like a lion roaring, a like a perfect drop, a resembling the mouth of an amokari, a like an öpak line, and so on. Likewise for ka there are different shapes: ka like a lute, ka like a trident, ka like a wolf, ka like a turtle, ka like a three-pointed banner, and so on.

Further, kha is like a donkey. Ga is like a rhinoceros. Gha is like a vase. Ṅa is like a kaṅka bird. Ca is like the beak of a blue jay. Cha is like a parasol. Ja is like a net. Jha is like a great net. Ña is like the top of a banner. Ta is like Jambudvīpa. Tha is like the mouth of a thabura. Da is like the mouth of a ḍākinī. Dha is like the beak of a goose. Na is like the mouth of a tola. Ṭa is like one eating with relish. Ṭha is like a boulder. Ḍa is like a fang. Ḍha is like a bow. Ṇa is like the mouth of a buffalo. Pa is like Mount Meru. Pha is like a garuḍa. Ba is like a marsh bird. Bha is like a khalaktse. Ma is like a begging monkey. Ya is like the new crescent moon. Va is like the mouth of a kartika. Ra is like the mouth of a kuñcita. La is like a crow tearing at flesh. Śa is like a hare. Ṣa is like the mouth of a shanta. Sa is like a begging brahmin. Ha is like a hāraka. Kṣa is like the mouth of a rākṣasa.

I is like crossed hooks supported by a repa. U is like stacked öpaks drawn out by a repa. E is like stacked repas drawn out by an öpak. O is like a strung bow. Oṃ is like an opened parasol. Aṃ is like a sage of steady discipline. Ṛ is like an iron chain drawn by a hook. Ḷ is like a goose drawn by a hook, and so on: each single letter has different shapes.

Accordingly, the drenpa is like a curved hook. The öpak is like a coiled anklet. The repa is like the raised horn of a rhinoceros. The crescent is like the horn of a naro. The drop is like the eye of a litsaktsik. The staff is like a javelin. Such are their various individual shapes. Lord of Laṅkā, these should be known as the shapes of the letters, that is, as the forms of the letters.

Lord of Laṅkā, what is the intrinsic nature of the letters? It is this: whatever is the intrinsic nature of a letter does not become the intrinsic nature of another letter, and no letter can indicate the intrinsic nature of other letters as a synonym. Lord of Laṅkā, what it is that does not become something else is this: the intrinsic nature of a is non-arising, and by no letter other than a alone does one come to know the intrinsic nature of non-arising. Likewise, the intrinsic nature of ka is action, and by no letter other than ka alone does one come to know action. Lord of Laṅkā, thus, although for whatever is designated by a name its actual referent may be known even by stating another synonym of that name, a letter cannot be known in that way; therefore the intrinsic nature of the letters should be understood to be simply unchanging.

Lord of Laṅkā, what is the sound of the letters? It is this: natural sound, transformed sound, combined sound, and derived sound. Of these, what is natural sound? It is this: although the shape, color, language, and convention of a letter differ, the sound designated by the name a, ka, and so on is known just as it is, according to reality. What is transformed sound? It is this: the sound into which any given letter is transformed, by which the meaning and the word become different. What is combined sound? It is this: the meaning that arises when, onto any given shape, it is joined as the form of any given letter. What is derived sound? It is this: the meaning that arises from the sound of whatever word is derived from any given letter.

Lord of Laṅkā, what here is the action of the letters? It is this: multiplying, and making known. Multiplying is this: from nothing arises one; from one, three; then five, forty, a hundred thousand, ten million, and a million, increasing so as to make everything known. Making known is this: reading names, reading words, reading forms, reading meanings, reading sounds, reading one, reading many, reading one as many, reading many as one, and reading one and many as distinct.

Again, Lord of Laṅkā, what here are the doors of the letters? They should be understood as these: the door of letters, the door of words, the door of meaning, the door of vowels, and the door of dhāraṇī. Lord of Laṅkā, what is

the door of letters? It is that by which one writes upon something. What is the door of words? It is the letters. What is the door of meaning? It is the collection of words. What is the door of vowels? It is the sixteen letters.

Lord of Laṅkā, what then are the sixteen letters? They should be known simply as gwar and cwang. These should be understood as long and short. From the two, short and long, the six limbs of the vowels should be understood to arise: two arise from the short, two from the long, and two from both together. The two limbs that arise from the short are these: the śata and the gardha. The two limbs that arise from the long are these: the drawn-out and the clipped. The two limbs that arise from both together are these: the cwangkadeu and the pwangkadeu.

Lord of Laṅkā, these six limbs, from the six doors of speech in the realms of the six destinies, when multiplied six by six, should be understood to be transformed into six and thirteen. By multiplying them into sixty, sixty limbs should be understood to arise.

By multiplying the six into sixty, three hundred and sixty limbs should be understood to arise.

Lord of Laṅkā, what is the door of dhāraṇī? It should be understood as this: the dhāraṇī of meaning, the dhāraṇī of words, the dhāraṇī of Dharma, and the dhāraṇī of mantra. Lord of Laṅkā, what is the dhāraṇī of meaning? One should not be separated from the very meaning that a letter shows. What is the dhāraṇī of words? It is whatever word arises from whatever letter. What is the dhāraṇī of Dharma? The letter should be understood as connected with all phenomena and as the door of not apprehending any phenomenon. What is the dhāraṇī of mantra? It is whatever words are powerfully obtained through the door of the letters. Lord of Laṅkā, these should be understood as the doors of the letters.

Lord of Laṅkā, what here are the categories of letters? They are the letters of intrinsic nature and the letters of miraculous display. Of these, what are the letters of intrinsic nature? That everything whatsoever is simply letters. What are the letters of miraculous display? They are the worldly, the transcendent, and the common. What are the transcendent letters? They are oṃ, hūṃ, māṃ, svaṃ, aṃ, haṃ, and a. Lord of Laṅkā, what here are the worldly letters? They are these: the root, the captured, and the renowned. What is the root? It is the six seeds. What are the captured? Simply that all the sounds and languages of beings are captured by letters. What are the renowned? They are those known

as the letters of the different worlds: the letters of the gods, the letters of the nāgas, the letters of the asuras, the letters of humans, the letters of the yakṣas, and so on. What are the common letters? They are a, ka, and so on.

Lord of Laṅkā, what here is the basis of the letters? a, oṃ, hūṃ, and mūṃ: these are the basis from which everything arises.

When the Lord of Secrets had said this, all the beings of inferior bodies, the Lord of Laṅkā and the rest, came to understand the wheel of the inexhaustible ornament of speech.

This is the thirty-fourth chapter of the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas, called The Array of the Wheel of the Inexhaustible Ornament of Speech.

Then again the Lord of Laṅkā, the bodhisattva great being, spoke thus to the Lord of Secrets and asked: "Lord of Secrets, how do the qualities and activities of the buddhas that appear from the blessing of secret mantra appear?"

The Lord of Secrets said: "Lord of Laṅkā, the qualities and activities of the buddhas that appear from the blessing of secret mantra should be understood to appear in this way. How? It is like this:

From examining as permanent what is beyond thought
Arises the blessing of thought.
The inexhaustible precious sky treasury,
The great blessing, flows without ceasing.

The blessing of the essence, secrecy itself,
Remains without conceptualization,
Yet performs every deed that arises as wished;
And in this there is no doing at all.

Just as, by the blessing of a single gourd,
A tongue is transformed into a thousand,
So in the instant of seeing the secret meaning
Everything becomes the secret essence.

Just as, by the blessing of a single lamp,
The darkness of an eon is dispelled,
So in the instant of knowing the meaning of the essence
Obscurations that have lasted for eons are dispelled.

Just as one who has a precious jewel
Has no fear of poverty,
So one who has awakened to the meaning of the essence
Has no fear of saṃsāra, the place of falling.

Beside a jewel blazing with the light of sun and moon,
Other jewels are not worth a hundred-thousandth part;
Beside a single instant of secrecy itself,
All merit perfected in whiteness is not a hundred-thousandth part.

However vast the ocean of milk of beings may be,
Just as a single drop of lion's milk poured in destroys it,
So in the ocean of karma, afflictions, and suffering,
By the appearance of secrecy itself for an instant, all is gone.

Just as one who relies on a universal monarch has no fear,
So one certain of secrecy itself does not fear hostile enemies.

Even a broken vajra outshines all jewels,
And, never lost as a jewel, it dispels the suffering of poverty.
Even if secrecy itself, the vajra essence, should decline,
It outshines the śrāvakas and the rest, and the Middle Way,
And the certain appearance of secrecy itself dispels poverty in Dharma.

Wherever the scent of a lion cub spreads,
All who cannot bear it take flight.
Even one without the power of knowing the meaning of the essence
Outshines the Middle Way merely by generating the mind of awakening.
Hostile enemies are overpowered and terrified,
And each, in his own place, is tormented by pain.

A person whose hands and feet are cut off, though maimed, still lives;
But just as with the heart torn out there is no chance of living,
So though the Middle Way, which is like a limb, should decline, one lives,
But without secrecy itself, which is like the heart, one perishes.

Whoever holds the secret, the vajra essence,
Is like one who rides seated in a chariot or on a horse:
Just as there is no other who does his work,
The Victors honor his mount in their midst.

Though one practice for eons the Middle Way and the three doors of liberation,
The Victors do not regard it or honor it.

But even from a mere instant of knowing the meaning of the essence,
The qualities of blessing could not be fully told even by the Victors.

All merit that reaches the limit of whiteness
Is like the dust on the tip of a fingernail;
Generating a single instant in the vajra essence
Is as great as the whole disk of the earth.

What reaches the limit of the white side
Is but a lamp in a dark house;
Knowing a single instant in the vajra essence
Is like the great fire of the eon at the end of time.

The sky that appears in the Middle Way
Is the sky within a crevice;
The sky of the vajra secret
Is like the sky that spans the great elements.

The pacifying deeds performed through waves of blessing
Appear like the eon of emptiness.
The deeds that enrich all things
Appear like the eon of abiding.
The deeds of bringing under control through compassion
Appear like the eon of formation.
The deeds of fierce subjugation
Are like the eon of destruction.

Lord of Laṅkā, these should be understood to appear from the blessing performed by the array of the inexhaustible treasury of qualities and by the waves of activity."

When he had said this, the beings of inferior bodies came to understand that everything appears from the blessing of the supreme secret, suchness itself.

This is the thirty-fifth chapter of the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas, The Array of the Wheel of the Inexhaustible Ornament of Conduct.

From the way of definite emergence of the Great Vehicle: the seventh teaching on the way things arose, the discussion of the wisdom seal that recounts the history of what arises also in the appearance of blessing.

Then again the Lord of Laṅkā, the bodhisattva great being, put a full question to the Lord of Secrets about the eighth of the twelve words given earlier, where it says, "It arose also when it became renowned through transmission by means." He asked: "O Lord of Secrets, when you yourself, teaching how the supreme secret of the Great Vehicle arose, set out your explanation as a historical account, you wrote, 'It arose also when it became renowned through transmission by means.' How was it transmitted, and where did it become renowned?"

He said: "Lord of Laṅkā, it was transmitted by intention, and becoming renowned in words, it came to appear in the worlds of gods and humans. Lord of Laṅkā, what is that? It is this:

Who transmitted what to whom?
'It is suchness itself':
The King of Dharma to his regent
Definitively transmitted the secret intention.
In the abodes of the gods and the world of humans,
What the Lord of Secrets discussed
Had been granted earlier to persons
Renowned as beings who hold inferior bodies.
And how did that renown arise?
In time past, long ago,
When the protector of beings, Vajragarbha,
Was ripening in the field of those to be tamed
The Black One, bound to saṃsāra by his own rope,
To the assembly of the ripened and unripened
That had gathered from every side
He spoke this meaning of the true secret.

Lord of Laṅkā, at that time and in that age, in order that those sons who had not recognized themselves as fully perfected might recognize themselves as fully perfected, he urged them in secret, declaring: 'Great gathered assembly, you who have not recognized that you are fully perfected: in order to recognize that you are fully perfected from the very beginning, take up the uncontrived samaya!'

The gathered assembly requested: 'Blessed One, in order to take up that very thing, what is this called the uncontrived samaya? How should we take it up?'

When they had requested this, the Blessed One declared: 'Great gathered assembly, the uncontrived samaya is this:

The unmistaken, uncontrived samaya
Is to set the mind on the nature of reality, suchness,
And not to stray from it:
That is the samaya of the Victors.'

When he had declared this, the gathered assembly were greatly frightened and terrified and utterly displeased. 'Alas!' they said, 'a lord of illusion has deceived us! He has blocked our various individual inclinations and handed us over to the great emptiness. With this, each of us is parted from our own samaya!' And they wept.

Then the Blessed One declared: 'O assembly of those who carry human skulls and the rest, take heart, and all of you offer your own samayas, whatever pleases each of you. Since nothing at all is blocked in the uncontrived samaya, it appears without obstructing anything.'

When he had declared this, the sons who had been taken in were pleased and delighted. Their radiance returned, and all of them eagerly offered the samayas each delighted in.

The Black Captain and his retinue said: 'Great Hero, our samaya is this:

By our own great austerities
We abide in our own dominion
And crush the factions of others:
That is our samaya.'

Then the lords of the lustful said: 'Maheśvara, our samaya is this:

With mother, daughter, and sister,
With women who may be approached and who may not,
To engage in passion out of desire:
That is our samaya.'

Then the lords of the hateful said: 'Great Terrifier, our samaya is this:

To snatch away the lives
Of each and every sentient being
And to feast on flesh and blood:
That is our samaya.'

Then the chiefs of the yakṣa hosts said: 'Great Terrifier, our samaya is this:

To take from all the lords of wealth
Their gold and other riches
And to enjoy them as we please:
That is our samaya.'

Then those given to conceptual rites said: 'King of wish-fulfilling thought, our samaya is this:

Having cut off someone's skull,
Whoever bears that auspicious sign
Becomes like a wish-fulfilling jewel:
That is our samaya.'

Then the host of the low-born marked with moles said: 'King of perfect dominion, our samaya is this:

Cow, dog meat, and horse meat,
Human flesh, elephant flesh, and the rest:
If one eats them, all qualities are accomplished:
That is our samaya.'

Then the blood-snatching rākṣasīs said: 'King of blood drinkers, our samaya is this:

The warm blood of every living creature
That has been slain,
If drunk, makes one blaze like a leopard:
That is our samaya.'

Then the sorceresses said: 'Lord of great miracles, our samaya is this:

Skull, bone, marrow, oil, and blood,
Mixed with beer and amṛta,
Are the sacred substances that accomplish magical power:
That is our samaya.'

Then the low-born vomit-eaters said: 'Great Fierce and Terrible One, our samaya is this:

Great flesh, feces, urine, semen, and blood
Are the sacred substances where amṛta swirls,
Which destroy all diseases without exception:
That is our samaya.'

Then the host of women said: 'Great Graceful One, our samaya is this:

With dance, song, poetry,
And alluring ways and poses we steal the mind,
And by skill in attending we engage in sex:
These are the samayas of delight.
That is our samaya.'

Then the host of gamblers said: 'Lord of Speech, our samaya is this:

So as to be hard for others to fathom,
We speak fittingly in emanations of speech:
This is the supreme great deception.
That is our samaya.'

Then the host of those with perverse craving said:

'Great True Being, our samaya is this:

If one knows everything within the state of the true,
Then whatever one does, great or small, of the two kinds of action,
One does not come under the sway of the two:
That is our samaya.'

Then the host who rely on secret words said: 'Yogin of the secret, our samaya is this:

Wearing a hundred or a thousand times
Garments of feces, urine, blood, and soot-water,
If one cuts the effigy, even the buddhas are afraid:
That is the secret samaya of secret mantra.'

Then the Blessed One declared the samaya that obstructs nothing, unmixed with anything:

'All you fortunate ones gathered here,
The samaya that is a wish-fulfilling jewel
For your various individual inclinations:
Take it up in its entirety!

Crushing the factions of others
And practicing the five deeds of immediate retribution,
Yet keeping the great self in view:
This, it is taught, is the vessel for accomplishing buddhahood.

With mother, daughter, sister,
And all women who move about,

If one engages in passion out of desire,
That, it is taught, is the vessel for accomplishment.

Those who delight in killing
Cut off the stream of the life faculty,
Eat flesh and bone and drink blood:
This is the true great samaya.

From the treasure mines of the lords of wealth,
Taking gold and the rest without its being given
And enjoying it as one wishes:
This is the true samaya.

For one with the mind of yogic awareness,
Cutting off someone's skull
And knowing the Dharma in the charnel-ground vessel
Is the samaya of true view,
The holy samaya of desire.

Cow, dog meat, and horse meat,
And elephant, the supreme great flesh:
Since they are the food of the great yoga,
Nothing else should be eaten.

Whoever drinks
From the ocean of the great red, of blood,
This is the samaya of all blood drinkers:
Drinking it to the last, one's splendor is great.

Attending all women
With dance, song, and the like,
And engaging in wrong conduct out of desire:
This is the great samaya of the nature of reality.

Because one is hard to fathom,
Saying "it exists" of what is not and "it is not" of what exists,
Telling lies that fit the object:
This is the samaya of the Buddha's word.

To those who from beginningless time
Have wandered, saying "It is their own fault,"
And speaking lies with the eight abuses:

This is the samaya of the Buddha's speech.

Since all distinctions are one,
Not coming under the sway of karma:
This is the unmistaken, uncontrived samaya,
The samaya without ripening.

Unmoving, unchanging, unshakable,
Though one does not apprehend existence or nonexistence by apprehending,
That which is never lost
Is the great samaya of the unmoving.

Since all is one in the great suchness,
There is neither taking up nor rejecting;
All phenomena that appear as two
Are entirely one in the great suchness.

Since in this, whether white or black,
Distinct causes and results
Do not exist, just like space,
This is the great samaya of equality.

From the king, the awareness of sameness,
There are no distinctions of any kind at all;
It is found by oneself and not through another:
This is the samaya of the great self-arisen.

Wearing garments of feces, urine, and defilement,
If one cuts off the continuity of the effigy's births,
And, reciting through some hundred kinds of births,
Joins that very one to that,
So that all the form bodies of the buddhas
Dissolve into the dharmakāya itself,
This is the samaya of vajra mantra.

The five enjoyments in which desire engages:
If one engages in them with passion out of desire,
This is the samaya of the ornament of the nature of reality,
The samaya of great bliss itself.'

When he had declared this, the hosts of the great assembly were utterly pleased and delighted, and all requested with one voice: 'How wonderful! King

who fulfills wishes, our hearts are delighted! You are our chief! You are our king! Please take us into the uncontrived samaya!'

When they had requested this, Lord of Laṅkā, the Blessed One declared: 'Aho! So it is! Excellent! It is entrusted! Take up that holy samaya! tiṣṭha vajra samaya stvaṃ.' Thus they were to hold it without straying from it.

Lord of Laṅkā, then again the gathered host requested of the Blessed One: 'Blessed One, since the Blessed One is our lamp, if we abide in these samayas of our own, what family will we hold, and where will we attain our state? Please teach us!'

When they had requested this, Lord of Laṅkā, the Blessed One declared: 'Gathered host, listen, and I shall explain what will happen if you abide in your own samayas.

How wonderful! Host of skull bearers,
These words that you have spoken
Are words bound by knots;
They will never become free.

Saying 'the true, the true':
Even the true itself is a knot.
Unless the knot is untied,
There will be no liberation or release.

Committing the deeds of immediate retribution and the like
And crushing the factions of others
Will not bring liberation:
This is called the work of Māra.

Acts of passion or of sexual union:
Deluded there by the power of passion,
Those beings pass into his city
And become his beings.

Where, out of hatred, the act of killing
Severs the life from someone's body,
One falls into the castes of butchers and slaughterers:
This is the root of suffering.

The Victors are utterly pure;
So when one has served before the face
Of the Sugata, the Victor,

Various despised substances,
Then through the ripening of that karma
One is seized by an illness with no escape
And sinks into a swamp of filthy vomit.

Food such as flesh and blood
Is great stolen bait;
Into the bodies of those who eat it
All the scent-eaters gather
And steal their radiance and their vital essence,
So that their splendor and glow fade away.

While one has a jewel of one's own,
To enjoy and seize the jewel of another:
These ways of wrong living by wrong means
Are tight knots.

Saying, "There is no difference between white and black actions,"
And acting in a motley way in everything,
Is the family-less, the cut-off family, the perverted family;
Its result is to pass into a perverted realm.

If in the acts that please the Sugatas
One is impure in limb and word,
Then because of that cause, the act of wrongdoing,
In every period of time
One's faculties and limbs will be incomplete,
And the essence of mindfulness will decline.

Meditating on and reciting the Sugata Victors
Like a contrived miracle that merely resembles them:
Whoever imagines it so and gains it so
Is a vidyādhara who is a rākṣasa of karma.

All ornaments and all attire:
If someone conceives of them as this and that,
He becomes a vidyādhara in the guise of an ugly brahmin,
And limbs of makaras, fish, and the like arise.

All the concepts of samādhi:
If someone conceives of them as this and that,

Conceiving of anything at all and clinging,
They become great kīlas of grasping.

All the causal syllables,
āḥ, hūṃ, and the rest:
If one conceives of each of them as that,
They are sandalwood, venomous snakes, and the like,
Great obstacles of conceptuality that make one fall.

The five great substances such as blood:
If one conceives of them as mere things,
One takes birth in the class
Of bhūtas who sniff the smell of blood.

If one's conception fixes on the guise
Of the fierce mātṛkās,
They wander in the land of Laṅkā
As rākṣasīs and ugly piśācīs.

Whoever conceives with certainty in that way
Of effigies of signs bearing ransom figures
Will take birth in the class of great predators
Of the toll-gate places and be found there.

If one conceives with certainty in that way
Of hosts of slave women ruled by karma,
One becomes a host of black yakṣiṇīs
Who harm the lives of others.

Therefore this tight knot
Is a load too heavy to carry.
Blinded by wrong view,
One loses the precious jewel of mind
In the realm of permanence and annihilation.'

When he had declared this, the gathered host realized that they were seized by the illness of conceptuality and had strayed from their own samayas. "Alas!" they said, "the lord of illusion has deceived us!" And they fainted and wept.

At that time and in that age, the Blessed One declared: "O sons of noble family, look closely at your own continuums!" When he had declared this, the

gathered host looked at what the continuum of their karma was like, and everything appeared like reflections in a mirror.

Lord of Laṅkā, they then requested of the Blessed One: "Alas, Blessed One! If it is certain that our samayas have become wrong austerities, please make these very ones into true austerities. Please make them into austerities of the nature of reality, so that we may practice our own samayas without their being blocked. Why is that? Because we are attached to our own austerities and cling to them. All phenomena are like illusions; they can become anything at all. The door of the Great Vehicle is like the mass of fire at the end of the eon; likewise it is like space, like the great earth, and like the great wind. Since the Buddha, the Blessed One, is lord of an ocean of means, please explain in accord with each one's inclination."

When they had requested this, Lord of Laṅkā, the Blessed One laughed with great delight and said: "O sons of noble family, it is good to ask in this way about the meaning of the Great Vehicle. Yet since even all the buddhas and bodhisattvas give rise to doubt about this, what need is there to speak of you?"

When he had declared this, the gathered host requested: "Blessed One, giving rise to doubt is a lack of certainty. Since the buddhas, the blessed ones, possess certainty, would they speak of what is uncertain here within this Dharma assembly?"

The Blessed One declared: "O gathered host, I say that all phenomena are without certainty. Why is that? Because there is no phenomenon whatsoever that is found to be permanent. Therefore your own samayas too are without certainty. When you took, and when you take, countless births other than this one, each birth was different; just so, your inclinations, karma, fortunes, places, groups, physiques, families, colors, livelihoods, views, and conduct are different. So to which of them will you now hold as certain? For this reason I say that all phenomena are without certainty.

Then the gathered host said, "If that is so, Blessed One, how is it when we hold our samayas as certain?"

The Blessed One declared: "O gathered host, it is like this:

The samaya of the five acts of immediate retribution
Is this: samaya, samādhi, wisdom,
Bodhicitta, and being endowed with compassion,

Never cutting their stream, with no interval between.
This is the samaya of the immediate acts.

The samaya of great passion
Is not to give up wisdom and compassion
Within saṃsāra and the nature of reality.
This is the samaya of passion.

Mother, daughter, and sister
Are the nature of reality, the five wisdoms,
And the self-arisen wisdom;
These are taught to be the dhāraṇī of suchness.

When non-arising is shown to someone,
The stream of births that no longer takes up the life faculty
Is cut off, and all is destroyed into emptiness:
That is what is called killing.

To show things out of what is no thing,
And to declare that what appears as things does not exist,
Is the word of all the victors;
It is the great samaya of deceiving.

To seize the wish-fulfilling jewel of others
With the light rays of devotion
And set it in awakening,
And to take suchness itself with the hook:
This is the samaya of taking what is not given.

Desiring that great suchness,
To turn away from clinging to signs
Is misconduct out of desire;
It is the great samaya of union.

Samaya, samādhi, wisdom,
The nature of mind, and great compassion are five;
Great flesh, feces, urine, semen, and blood:
This joining of the five kinds
Is the requisite of all dharmas.
If one is not endowed with these requisites,
The aims will not be accomplished.

The requisites of wrong livelihood, too,
Views and afflictions, karma and afflictions,
Joined with the seven and the five of desire,
Are proclaimed by that same name,
Yet they become saṃsāra itself.
The five views of wrong conduct
Are known as the five polluted meats;
Thus, since those views are impure,
Measured against the correct view, they are pollution."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those gathered hosts, seeing the meaning of non-arising, were utterly amazed and said, "Blessed One, are these samayas of ours not, then, admitted within the Great Vehicle?"

He declared, "The samayas of each of the gathered hosts are not excluded from the complete Great Vehicle."

They said, "Blessed One, please explain why they are not excluded."

The Blessed One declared:
"Just as, in the nature of space,
Appearance and existence appear without being blocked,
So in this space of the Great Vehicle
No view or conduct whatsoever is excluded.
Therefore all is the appearance of space."

When he had said this, the whole gathered host was satisfied and amazed, and they wept. Then the Blessed One, though he knew, declared, "Gathered host, what have you heard that you weep?"

They said, "Blessed One, that you did not teach us before so great a matter of lasting meaning as this shows little compassion!"

To this the Blessed One declared, "Gathered host, each of your own spaces is merely obscured by your own adventitious darkness. When it appears as your own space itself, what need is there for anyone to teach it to anyone?"

When he had said this, whatever had been unaware became aware. They drew in their four limbs, struck their limbs upon the ground, and offered their bodies as seats and thrones; thereby they purified the obscuration of the afflictions, and by listening to the Dharma with their ears they purified the cognitive obscuration. They fully performed the task of being the seats and thrones beneath the feet of the vidyādharas, in bodies of lions, horses, elephants, and

the like.

This concludes the thirty-sixth chapter, on dispelling delusion and liberating through concordant conduct, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Here the sixth section begins.

Then the Lord of Laṅkā, the bodhisattva great being, questioned the Lord of Secrets, saying, "O Lord of Secrets, please relate in full the narrative of how the supreme secret, renowned as handed down from one to another, was practiced in the past, as it has been told."

The Lord of Secrets said: "Lord of Laṅkā, the narrative of the past, renowned as the practice of the supreme secret, is this. The gathered host said to that Blessed One, the Lord of the Supreme Secret, 'Blessed One, how are we to understand the conduct by which practicing the supreme secret turns out well, and the conduct by which it goes wrong?'

"When they had asked this, Lord of Laṅkā, that Blessed One declared: 'Great gathered host, know that practicing the conduct of the supreme secret mantra is extremely difficult. Why is that? The supreme secret is very much like fire. When fire is kept constantly and used well, it constantly yields what one desires, just as one wishes. Yet that very fire, if misused, becomes a great mass of flame: it burns the one who uses it, it spreads from house to house and burns them too, and all goods and possessions are consumed.

"'Likewise, this secret mantra is like water. When water is held by skillful means, it flows just as one wishes; but for one who is unskilled in the nature of water and in means, the user himself is swept away.

"'Moreover, this supreme secret is like a savage beast of prey. Though a savage beast kills others and destroys others, one who is skilled in means brings it under control just as it should be; but if it is not held by means, it falls upon one's own life.

"'Moreover, this secret mantra is like the precious jewel on a serpent's head. If it is held by means, one may enjoy the delight of that jewel; but if it is not held by means, it robs one of life.

"'Moreover, it is like the henbane plant. If it is held by means, it cures even a violent fever; but if it is not held by means, it parts one from life.

"'So what is held by means, like the elixir that transforms poison, the elixir that transmutes into gold, and the lamp that dispels darkness, is able, though small, to overcome what is great; and through unmistaken certainty everything becomes suchness.

"'Therefore, great gathered host, since this supreme secret is difficult to practice, among those who practiced its conduct in the past there were also some who, not recognizing the supreme secret, went onto a wrong path.'"

"'But there were also those who, recognizing it through skill in means, went onto the unerring path. Therefore, great gathered host, become skilled in practicing its conduct with the great cloud of means that recognizes the supreme secret.'

"When he had declared this, the gathered host said, 'Blessed One, what in this is the wrong path of secret mantra, and what is the unerring path? Please explain it to us at length.'

"When they had asked this, Lord of Laṅkā, that Blessed One declared to the great gathered host: 'Great gathered host, it is like this:

Whatever is practiced as renowned through transmission,
This secret mantra, the heart of the secret,
Must be established just as it is.
This is the true secret path.

Since wrong dharmas
And secret mantra, the heart of the secret, these two,
Share the one sound of a designated name,
Grasp the sign that brings certainty.

Because this secret mantra of the Great Vehicle
Is taught in the language of means that accord with beings,
It may turn into something outer and other;
So do not set the meaning in words and sounds.

This intention of the holy ones
Cannot be realized
By example, by valid cognition, by logical reason,
Or by the wisdom of inference.

Whoever strives to speak
Of the intended meaning, the heart of the secret,
While his mind has not attained it,

Would he not live if he did not speak?

Likewise, those who take up its conduct,
Who practice it and who examine and investigate it,
Without having found certainty about the meaning,
What harm would there be if they did not practice it?

Why? Because in this ocean of secret mantra,
As with the spray scattered by a sneeze,
Even in each single word of the holy ones' speech
Many and various meanings arise.

Therefore whoever speaks
Without realizing the meaning of the supreme secret mantra
Commits the sin of false speech, heavier
Than that of one who has done the five acts of immediate retribution.

Those who go astray regarding the secret itself,
Who proclaim the secret with perverse craving,
Will arise and steer others wrongly, saying,
"If one is held by the rite of secret mantra,
Even if one cuts off a living being's life,
That does not become a fault."

If you ask what that is like,
It is like what came about in times past:
The brahmins of perverse craving for livelihood,
False speakers who held sway over the practice of causes.

Where wrong conduct spreads here,
Everyone enters into wrongness itself;
Labeling that with the word "secret,"
They make secret mantra into sorcery.

If you ask what that is like,
It is like what came about in times past:
Those of perverse craving in whom something other arose,
Who practiced another thing resembling it but not it.

Where, in this way, wrong dharmas
Take the words and sounds of the supreme secret mantra,
Which are one and yet not one, each distinct,

Whoever practices in the darkness of delusion,
That mantrin does the work of Māra
And after death goes to the great hell.

Why? Because, not held by the view,
They practice the conduct of māras and rākṣasas
With delight and pleasure, and indulge in every desire;
By the force of their clinging to those habitual tendencies
They fall into the great Vajra Hell,
Beyond even the eight burning hells.

If you ask what that is like,
It is like what came about in times past:
The wonder-workers endowed with perverse powers,
Crowned with the suffering of perverse clinging.

Ah, beings are not set free!
Why? Because in times to come,
Through the fabricated secret words of the deceitful,
The stainless secret teachings
Will be stirred up and altered, the word corrupted and the scriptures cast aside,
And meaningless wrong dharmas will spread.
They do not come from anywhere else;
They merely arise from the root itself.

If you ask what that is like,
It is like what came about in times past:
The corrupters through whom this was not passed on in between,
Who, by their evil lineage, corrupted that very thing.

Because this wish-fulfilling jewel of mine
Shows itself as anything at all and is hard to fathom,
In future times, through wrong conduct,
Many wrongly conceived, wrong schools will arise.

If you ask what that is like,
It is like what came about in times past:
The wrong path, the empty path, the evil path,
The lineages of the six wrong schools of perverse clinging.

Those who, under the sway of perverse clinging,
Hold perverse seeing foremost with perverse minds,
Do not enter any of the doors of the view,
And remain fixed in deluded views.

If you ask what that is like,
It is like what came about in times past:
Those whose minds cling solely to wrong view,
The Black Carakas, deluded in everything.

Those here who, bound by the five bonds,
Seize upon the means of their own greatness,
And do not engage in even the least examination,
Will arise like a deluded, maddened elephant.

If you ask what that is like,
It is like what came about in times past:
Those who proclaim the self alone as Dharma,
Who practice a single wrong side alone.

Just as one born blind who sets out on a road,
Gauging the measure of his steps with his mind,
Runs along a perilous path,
So those will arise who take mere guesswork as paramount.

If you ask what that is like,
It is like what came about in times past:
Those seized by darkness,
The fivefold school holding ascetic vows as supreme.

Meditating on yoga without scripture,
Proclaiming what is not Dharma to be Dharma,
And, in the mad ascetic vows of sinners,
Practicing glorious austerities to excess: this will arise.

If you ask what that is like,
It is like what came about in times past:
Those who have not measured by valid cognition,
The four schools of those who speak nonsense.

Striving at meaningless sitting,
And holding cast images and other likenesses
As the signs of the object of focus:

There a mountain of such reasoning will arise.

If you ask what that is like,
It is like what came about in times past:
Those who blocked all movement,
The seven schools of meditative absorption.

Those who turn the hidden meanings into mere sounds
And make them mere matters for analysis
Do not land on high but go astray;
They are hair-splitters of enlightened body, speech, and mind.

Lord of Laṅkā, in this way
Did that supreme secret one explain it.
Moreover, one endowed with means acted like this.
Then, among those gathered in that assembly,
To one called Light of Brahmā,
Who practiced the supreme vehicle of yoga,
A yogin called Renowned,
Who practiced with lesser inclination,
Earnestly put this question:

"Light of Brahmā, you who practice the supreme,
Saying, 'Here I practice the supreme,'
You practice exceedingly low acts.
Since their remedies are different,
Darkness does not become light;
How could the low become the supreme?

It is like someone wishing to go to a high place
Who goes down a path that slopes downward;
Wishing to see the great state,
You enter the stream of the terrible lower realms.

Just as one who wants water to drink
Is never satisfied by chasing a mirage,
Wishing the low to ripen into the supreme
Does not come about by practicing the low in the name of equality.

Though a garuḍa may brood a serpent's egg,
It cannot be turned into its opposite

And appears just as what it is;
So the low cannot become the supreme.

Those here who have turned away from the secret,
Who practice low and wrong conduct,
Say, 'Since all is empty, without intrinsic nature,
Affliction and awakening are equally empty.'

Medicine that sustains life and poison that kills
Have a single cause, being produced by the elements,
Yet their power to sustain life or to kill
Appears as distinct and opposed.

So would anyone here,
Saying, 'Set in motion by the elements, they are one and equal,'
Go so far as to eat and drink poison?
Likewise, though supreme and low acts
Are of one meaning in being without intrinsic nature,
Would one, saying 'They are equal,' set aside the supreme
And deliberately practice the low?

Thus, if you say that to make no distinction
Between the supreme and the low, the pure and the impure, the great and the small,
Good and bad, happiness and suffering, and the like,
As places to rely on and as things to practice,
Is the conduct that marks the union of equality,
How could poison and food, happiness and suffering,
Which are unequal, be leveled into equality?

In the uncontrived, equal nature of reality,
Things are made unequal by adventitious karma;
Yet stainless space is clear from the very beginning,
And this is like wishing to wash it to make it pure.

Medicine that overcomes illnesses
Becomes poison for those who are not ill.
The means for guiding a world of wrong views,
If practiced as the real thing, are certainly at fault.

The conduct that engages in accord with beings is a means of guidance,
Practiced for the sake of those one guides.
Just as one endowed with strength and knowledge
Corrects what is discordant and makes it concordant,
So the holy ones, whose words accord and are full of meaning,
Ascertain things just as is fitting.

Just as one who, from timidity, greedy for gain,
And wanting fame, without real confidence,
Enters battle and contends in strength and skill,
Falls into others' power and is destroyed,
So one who feigns being supreme,
Out of conceit about gain and fame,
Takes the concordant conduct meant to guide those of perverse craving
To be with certainty the true supreme,
And practices the very path of words as mere sound,
Certainly ruins himself, destroys others, and is low.

Apart from the measure of the guideline for all,
The measure of understanding, realization, and capacity,
And the measure of taming in each case,
If one passes beyond measure, there is no object;
Having passed beyond, one is simply lost.
Whoever passes beyond measure,
Just as even food turns into poison,
Is a madman eating deadly poison;
Even for the holy ones this is not fitting.

Those who, while not freed or liberated
From whatever binds them,
Claim to liberate all of everything:
What a great deception that is!

If one has not known that very thing and is not freed,
And one's mind has not become pure,
Even if one were set on the ground of a buddha,
What one sees there is the abode of hell.
If one knows it and possesses its meaning,
Those great hells are pure realms.

Though the heart of the secret pervades all,
If one does not know it and is not endowed with it,
It is like showing forms to the blind:
The darkness of delusion and of saṃsāra."

When he had earnestly asked this,
The sublime yogin of the Great Vehicle
Called Light of Brahmā
Spoke words of certainty about the supreme
To the one practicing yoga with lesser inclination,
Called Endowed with the Manner of Renown:

"You here who hold to lesser inclination,
Called Holder of the Manner of Renown:
This secret mantra, the heart of the secret,
Is the domain of none but the buddhas themselves,
And so it is not accomplished by mere outward likeness.

If here one is able in faith, devotion, and aspiration,
Then looking at that itself, in that, as that,
And joining that to that, is that itself;
Just this much is the measure of the vehicle.

The many vehicles taught here
Are not separate things;
To guide those of different inclinations,
Many doors of means are taught.
Since all of them are applied as means of mindfulness
That do not block any inclination,
One does not set the mind of certainty on them all;
Certainty lies in the one alone.

Because it is easy, holding all and entering all,
It is called the Great Vehicle.
Because the vehicle is great and its means many,
Nothing whatsoever is blocked.
Not blocking, its path of entry is easy;
Being easy, it is easy to practice.

Though the distinctions of means and vehicles
Are separate, discordant, and different,
Since one practices the certainty of means,

In certainty itself there is no difference.

Samaya, sādhana, and conduct,
And all the various and different views;
Animals, pretas, and nonhumans;
Foul vomiting, deliberate acts, and the like:
All these, looked at perversely,
Are in order to draw beings into the supreme meaning.
Though they are of various and different kinds,
Intending mind itself as one in the vajra,
In order to accord with all the various ones,
They are merely applied as means to join, to attend, to entice, to guide,
And to lead.

To guide the low of all the world
In various ways to the supreme,
He merely brings them to full completion
Through endless low views and conduct.

Though a serpent's egg does not become a garuḍa,
Like the elixir that turns things to gold by transmutation,
If one knows, uncontrived, the suchness
Of all that is low, it becomes supreme.

In the very expanse of suchness
There is no high or low of lower realm and lofty state.
Though fault, delusion, and awakening differ,
In emptiness those two do not exist.
Though poison and medicine are separate,
In the elements those two do not exist.
Though unmixed, various, and different,
The nature of all is fully complete.

If here one is certain to become supreme,
One deliberately practices low acts.
Those who have not seen that very thing,
Following the path of verbal convention,
Stray from the true path
And arise as nothing but followers of a wrong path."

Lord of Laṅkā, in this way
The one called Light of Brahmā
Cut through the doubts in the small question
Of the one endowed with the manner of renown.

When that Lord of Secrets had said this to the Lord of Laṅkā, beings of lesser inclination there were definitively liberated into the Great Vehicle itself.

This concludes the thirty-seventh chapter, on cutting through the doubts in the questions, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then again the Lord of Secrets spoke these words to the Lord of Laṅkā, the bodhisattva great being: "O Lord of Laṅkā, at the time of my earliest memory, my teacher, the Lord of the Supreme Secret, told within that holy retinue the renowned narrative of the transmission of the secret, as follows: 'Lord of Secrets, it is like this:

Once, in my contemplation,
Lord of Secrets, I saw that the unerring nature
Of these meanings had declined.
Though most practice mere contrived forms and paths
As though they were the meaning,
I did not see them certain of the meaning;
All of them practice a wrong path.

If you ask in what way they are wrong:
Not abiding in this, falling away from this,
Turning against this and practicing wrong ways,
Taking what is not the way, being uncertain here,
Or perversely contriving, by deceit and guile, a likeness of the truth.

If you ask what that is like,
It is like what came about in times past:
In the eon called Fully Arrayed,
After the buddha called King of Manifest Arising
Had passed into nirvāṇa,
The yogin Endowed with Excellence who then appeared
Taught a contrived and wrong mantra
To his retinue of ignorant, childish people;
And so he, together with his retinue of five hundred,
Strayed from the meaning and turned back into saṃsāra.

Such ways will arise: do not practice them.

Moreover, Lord of Secrets, listen:
At times when the authoritative masters of yoga
Of this wondrous heart of the secret
For the most part are not present,
The ignorant, given to evil notions,
Misconceive it, corrupt its meaning, and cast aside its scriptures;
Erring, they bring themselves to ruin,
And saying, "This is it; others have not realized it,"
Praise themselves and disparage others: this is wrong.

If you ask what that is like,
In the time of that same eon,
A yogin called Śrīdatta,
Whose understanding had not opened to the meaning,
Being unskilled in the methods of counsel,
Cast aside the scriptures of certain understanding
And practiced what is not Dharma as Dharma.
To others possessed of certain counsel
He said of such uncertain understanding,
"This is my understanding,"
And indulged in great manifest pride.
This is the wrong path of existence.
Such ways will arise: do not practice them.

Moreover, Tamer of the Harmful, it is like this:
Those who, remaining in the wake of a former lineage,
Are installed as masters though lacking confidence,
And, under the power of their arrogance in pursuing words,
Act the part of cotton-clad yogins though they do not know,
Pretenders with crooked minds,
Are sinners, fools with the methods of madmen.

If you ask what that is like,
It is like what came about in times past:
In that same eon renowned as Fully Arrayed,
A yogin who held to contrived ways,
Called Stainless Conduct,

Was authorized by learned ones of former times.
A retinue of a hundred thousand
Laid the heavy, great burden of words
Upon that meaningless yogin
Who had come in the wake of the lineage,
And installed him as master, holder of the family lineage;
Greater and greater grew his arrogance.
Though ignorant, he put on a show,
And by practicing a wrong dharma that only resembled the true,
He fell, with his retinue, into the state of an arrogant Rudra.
Such ways will arise: do not practice them.

Moreover, Tamer of the Harmful, Lord of Secrets:
Fearing that their fields, those who give them friendship or enmity,
And the retinue by whose gain and honor they live,
Might come under another's power,
They divide them into separate factions and groups, saying,
"These are the fields where I live
By the wealth of those I tame;
Let none of them join that one here,"
And they stand guard at the door with words of affliction: this is error.

If you ask what that is like,
It is like what came about in times past:
In that same renowned eon,
One called Nashina,
Together with a retinue of five hundred yogins,
Saying, "We greatly practice the most secret mantra,"
Dwelt in solitude in a range of wilderness.
All those who dwelt
In those great valleys
He treated as a field for his flattering schemes.
A yogin endowed with eyes, who belonged to another group,
Saw the meaning and came there for that purpose,
And began to teach at length
The very path of certainty of the ultimate.
But Nashina, claiming the wilderness range as his solitude,
Stood as a wrong, afflicted doorkeeper:

"This region is my field;
You there, get out now!"
By dividing his own faction from others,
He fell onto the path of affliction and saṃsāra.
Such ways will arise: do not practice them.

Moreover, what was meant to be dedicated
To the holy yogins who tame the hard to tame
They take as their own, indulge their desires, and hoard;
One mind draws out another,
And their wrong conduct never attains anything.

If you ask what that is like,
It is like what came about in times past:
In that same renowned eon, Fully Arrayed,
A yogin called Auspicious Bliss,
With his retinue full of attachment,
Followed after the sound of the mantra words.
A woman called Excellent Ornament,
Who had joined that retinue of his,
Was put in charge of the provisions;
Hoarding out of avarice,
She took the body of a dog among the pretas
And wandered forever in a lowly body.
Such ways will arise: do not practice them.

Moreover, Lord of Secrets, Tamer of the Harmful,
The yogin who practices wrongly,
Of wrong views, brazen, savage, and greatly wrathful,
Though his sinful conduct is devoid of meaning,
Says, "I alone am the certain one":
A reckless talker, a thief of the Word, a deceiver, a corrupter.

If you ask what that is like,
It is like what came about in times past:
A yogin who protected the Dharma,
Called Pramata,
Not seeing the meaning or the path,
Became widely renowned to all, saying,

"I alone am the guide."
Thief of the Victor's word, by the ripening
Of his having deceived whatever beings he did,
He sank into the lower realms;
And when freed from there, he became a worldling of wrong views
And fell into a state of practicing self-grasping.
Such ways will arise: do not practice them.

Moreover, Lord of Secrets, tamer,

Those whose sworn vows have lapsed and who are dull to the meaning,
Because their renown makes them lay claim to it,
And who wish to win a king's throne,
Are shameless, brazen, corrupt emanations of darkness.

If you ask what that is like,
It is like what came about in times past:
In that same renowned eon
There appeared a yogin who practiced the way of mantra,
Called Penapaya, with a following of a hundred.
His root vows lapsed and he was dull to the meaning;
With the pride of great arrogance,
Feigning to possess the meaning,
He took up in a big way the statecraft of kings.
As a mountain crushes living creatures,
So by the mountain of pride and arrogance,
The evil karma of saṃsāric conduct,
He fell into the body of a pig, the creature of delusion.
Such ways will arise: do not practice them.

Moreover, Lord of Secrets, listen:
Those who, without having grasped the very meaning of equality,
Bring forth the verbal path of "equality"
And openly indulge in both attachment and aversion,
Are yogins who by their karma make the path of saṃsāra.

If you ask what that is like,
It is like what came about in times past:
In that same renowned eon,
One called Giver of Bliss,

With a retinue of a thousand yogins,
Saying, "This is certainly the supreme secret,"
Indulged in attachment and aversion alike in those he relied on and those he led.
Through the full ripening of that very conduct
He fell into the realm of the rākṣasas.
Such ways will arise: do not practice them.

Moreover, Lord of Secrets, it is like this:
Yogins of small intelligence,
When other yogins discuss the meaning,
Grow afraid and terrified of it;
Fainthearted, displeased, they flee: fools.

If you ask what that is like,
It is like what came about in times past:
In that same renowned eon,
One called Devadatta,
At the time when he was a beginner in the activity of yoga,
When many other yogins of the definitive meaning
Discussed the definitive meaning, the meaning of the secret,
Fled from it, Devadatta with his retinue.
With a mistaken mind, jealousy arose in him;
He abandoned his own place and spoke ill of them.
Thereby, for countless eons,
He strayed from the true meaning and wandered in wrong ways.
Such ways will arise: do not practice them.

Moreover, Lord of Secrets, listen:
To shoot sharp, venomous, poisoned arrows
At yogins who are yogins in truth,
Is to be a yogin who destroys the samaya, mighty as a fortress:
Such a one is his own obstructor.

If you ask what that is like,
A yogin called Mati,
Holy in understanding, came
To where the yogin called Abhaya
Practiced meaningless contrivance.

Out of malice toward that patient one,
Abhaya slandered him and spoke words of reproach;
Thereby Abhaya fell into the Avīci hell.
Such ways will arise: do not practice them.

Moreover, Lord of Secrets, listen:
Those who, parted from the target of the view,
Are not clear about the path of the true Middle Way,
And practice relying on mere generic objects,
Are a host of blind yogins.

If you ask what that is like,
A king called Holder of Great Clarity
Followed the secret yoga;
But lacking the eye of the view of wisdom,
He took up the mere name and manner of yoga,
And by practicing its ways in the wake of the sounds he heard,
He fell into the realm of the darkness of delusion.
Such ways will arise: do not practice them.

These and endless others, supreme ones,
All fall to being travelers on the path of saṃsāra.
Therefore this heart of the secret
Is taught by the victors to have great pitfalls.
Therefore skill in means
And holy understanding are most precious.
The yogin endowed with skill in means and understanding
Is certainly excellent.

This account of the great adepts
Who came in times long past
Is the domain of holy beings.
Whoever hears the proclamation of their qualities
Attains happiness even by their mere names,
And by recollecting them is protected from the lower realms.

If you ask what that is like,
In times long ago, when this
Most secret heart had not yet appeared,
In the place renowned as the divine abode of the Thirty-Three,

There was a son of the gods, Endowed with Light.
When the time of impermanence and death befell him,
And the omens that come beforehand appeared,
He came to perceive unease.
Turning his attention to what was to come,
He saw with his own clairvoyance
That he would take the body of a stupid creature
That lives on unclean food.
With the perception of utter terror
He brought to mind an object of refuge.
Though nothing else came to mind there,
The name of the heart of the secret of the Great Vehicle,
Just as it was renowned in the path of words,
He had heard, and by bringing it to mind,
He turned back from going to the lower realms
And was placed in the abode of great bliss.
Such ways will arise: practice in the same way.

Moreover, Lord of Secrets, listen:
If one is thoroughly certain about the secret of the Great Vehicle,
Then even if violent karmic ripening hurls one somewhere,
Like a ball that is struck,
One rebounds, and by the power of the meaning does not stay there.
Why? Because all is emptiness:
The places of suffering too,
Together with their beings, are empty,
And so one does not come to touch and experience them.

If you ask what that is like,
It is like what came about in times past:
A yogin who held to conceptual focus,
Hearing the words of the profound Great Vehicle,
Was utterly afraid and terrified;
He disparaged it, turned his back, and his heart burst.
Yet without experiencing a fall into the Raurava hell,
He emerged into the happy realms, the state of liberation.
Know that such ways have come about.

Whoever delights in this secret of the victors
And gives rise to longing for it
Will, with no obstacles arising from others,
Swiftly attain whatever he aspires to.

If you ask what that is like,
It is like what came about in times past:
A brahmin called Endowed with Love
Saw this great secret, the heart of the secret,
And was drawn to it, and looked for it everywhere.
But he did not find it,
And remaining where he was,
He wept bitterly and cried out in grief:
"Ah, how wretched my karma is!
From my birth until I have grown old
I have sought the meaning of the true secret;
That I have not seen it, how evil my karma is!
How will I see it now?
It is not something found by searching;
Who is there to teach me?"
When he had said this, weeping loudly,
A voice came forth from the realm of space:
"You, endowed with fortune, of noble lineage,
Because your mind is so steadfast in certainty,
You are one who has a share in the meaning;
All the victors of the three times
Bestow their blessing upon you.
Therefore, without letting your aspiration slacken,
You must be skilled and diligent
In the means of meeting the meaning.
Once you have first cast off your material body,
If you look with certainty at the essential meaning,
You will see it immediately."
When he heard this prophecy,
His aspiration was greatly stirred by joy,
And looking just as he had been taught,
He became a son of the holders of the great family.
Such ways will arise: practice with aspiration.

Lord of Secrets, it is like this:
The fortunate who see it enter here,
And everywhere it is the same:
Like the finial at the top of a banner,
It never wholly declines.

And how was that?
One called King of Virtue,
Together with a hundred thousand young gods,
Toward the yogin of the secret essence,
The precious Endowed with Light, the Crown-Holder,
Was stirred to virtue with deep faith,
And taking many divine substances and requisites,
They went into the presence of that holy one.
With joy they took up the way of aspiration
And entered the meaning of the secret essence.
They obtained the four great miracles:
Traveling to every abode of the gods,
Emanating the great elements from the body,
Lifting mountains and hurling them,
And they obtained abiding in a long life.
Like the finial at the top of a victory banner,
The nature of reality of those who saw it
Did not decline for an eon.
Such ways have arisen: enter into it.

Furthermore, Lord of Secrets, it is like this:
By seeing, this Dharma is wholly pure.
Having found the eye of the lamp of wisdom,
One finds the path of those who possess the unsurpassed essence
And enters upon that path.
And how was that?
In times past it happened before:
One who had gained full certainty in the secret Great Vehicle,
Perfect in spontaneously present great dynamism,
Attained the very ground of a holder of the great family.
Such ways have arisen: see it.

Furthermore, holder of the great secret, listen:
Those who with joy rejoice

In the fierce rites of the Great Vehicle
Are just like those who perform them;
In the results there is no higher or lower.
And how was that?
In times past it happened before:
King Mighty Lord Endowed with Light,
Together with his retinue of yogins,
Entered the profound meaning of the Great Vehicle.
The blessings of the secret of secret mantra
And many wondrous miracles
At first became renowned everywhere.
Apart from them, there was a yogin,
A brahmin monk,
Who, giving rise to a mind of great joy,
Requested the holy and definitive training.
Because it is not the domain of the childish,
The great secret was taught in secret.
The brahmin, never turning back,
Dedicated his requisites to that one and applied them purely.
Toward the land of that holy being,
In his mind he voiced his aspiration in that direction.
Through the blessing of devotion to this,
The holy one certain in the essence
And the holy one who rejoiced, these two,
Became equal in their attainment.
Thus, without hardship and of great meaning,
Is the holder of the great family skilled in means.
Such ways have arisen: become skilled in them.

Furthermore, holder of secrets, it is like this:
Because the inconceivable victors,
Who pervade all with their minds, see this and know this,
One becomes a spiritual friend to the saṃsāra of the three realms of existence,
A holy lord of secrets.
And how was that?
In times past it happened before:

A householder called Bright Gift,
By abiding in this secret Great Vehicle,
Saw his own very secret,
Found certainty in the secret of the great secret,
And definitely saw the secret of all.
It is the secret of all phenomena;
From that, that arose, countless hundreds of thousands.
Having become a king of Dharma,
He became renowned in all buddha fields
As the Lion of All Speakers.
Such ways have arisen: train in them.

Furthermore, holder of secrets, Tamer of the Harmful, listen:
Compared with one who has come to understand
A single path of words of the secret Great Vehicle,
To spread great collections of offerings
Before inconceivable śrāvakas
And endless victors together with their heirs
Does not equal even a hundred-thousandth part.
Why is that? Because knowing this Great Vehicle
Is the supreme way of pleasing the victors.
The victors who pervade all of space
And the secret essence of the Great Vehicle, these two,
Are not separate; they are not different.
Therefore, by pleasing a single victor,
One pleases all the victors.
Body, speech, and mind are nothing but one;
It is only through differences in the capacities of those to be trained
That they are shown in inconceivable ways.
And how was that?
In times past it happened before:
In a fortunate and wholly pure family
There were two, called Endowed with Virtue and Endowed with Clarity.
Each was born according to where his inclination lay,
And here they made a pact with each other.
One practiced the lesser vehicle
And carried out the great work of ritual activity.

The other, from vast and certain understanding
Of the meaning of the secret Great Vehicle,
Endowed with Clarity, riding the Great Vehicle,
Was fully awakened as a single one of the great family,
While Endowed with Virtue, who performed ritual activity,
Was awakened only after three countless eons.
Therefore, in the secret Great Vehicle,
Such ways have arisen: practice properly.

Furthermore, lord, holder of secrets, listen:
Whoever always explains this secret
Obtains, like the constant great qualities
Of King Akṣobhya and the others,
Together with the dhāraṇī of meaning.
And how was that?
The householder called Agnidatta,
Together with a retinue of a hundred,
By always abiding in this Great Vehicle,
Attained, as one holder of the great family,
A state like that of the buddha King Akṣobhya
Together with his retinue.
Such ways have arisen: practice purely.

Furthermore, Lord of Secrets, it is like this:
Whoever, having realized those who definitely accomplish
For the sake of the vajra of body, speech, and mind,
Speaks of them,
Through habitual expression and aspiration
Becomes a king of Dharma
And becomes the very crown of qualities.
And how was that?
In times past it happened before:
The sage and yogin Kalya
Spoke praise of the secret Great Vehicle
To many different companies of sages.
Because he set out its meanings definitively,
Many attained the state of holders of the great family.
Whoever speaks praise of it there,

Lord of Secrets, becomes a king of Dharma.
Therefore, speak praise of this secret Great Vehicle to all.
By that, my intention is attained.
The heart commitment of all the victors, too,
Is the secret essence of the Great Vehicle.
If any yogin endowed with intelligence,
For an instant, a moment, a brief while,
Settles the great secret with certainty in secret,
All the victors too are fully certain
In the great secret of the holders of the family, in secret.
Lord of Secrets, thus it is:
Whatever the secret essence of the great secret,
The accounts of those definitively good
And the accounts of those definitively mistaken
Are the renowned lineage of what happened before.
Thus spoke the supreme secret itself.

When the Lord of Secrets had thus related how the tales of former times were handed down and became renowned, the doubts of the Lord of Laṅkā and the other beings of lesser body who had manifestly appeared, about what they had not been certain of, were completely cut off.

This concludes the thirty-eighth chapter of the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas, the full relating of the tales of former events. From the Way of the Definite Emergence of the Great Vehicle: the Dharma seal that discusses wisdom by relating the tale called "It arose again when the lineage became renowned through means," the eighth, the teaching on how it arose.

Then again the Lord of Laṅkā, that bodhisattva great being, fully asked the question about the ninth of the twelve words concerning what happened before, the one called "It also arose when it was enacted for someone's sake": "O Lord of Secrets, when you yourself, in showing how the supreme secret of the Great Vehicle arose, related the explanation in the form of tales, you set down the words 'It also arose when it was enacted for someone's sake.' In just what ways was that enacted, so that it became renowned?"

He said, "Lord of Laṅkā, it refers to enacting exactly what is unfabricated, just as it is."

He said, "Lord of Secrets, what is it to enact exactly what is unfabricated, just as it is?"

He said, "Lord of Laṅkā, it refers to the nature of reality of phenomena, suchness itself."

He said, "Lord of Secrets, in the nature of reality of all phenomena, in suchness itself, there are no buddhas, there are no sentient beings, there is no male or female, there is no family lineage. It has no form, it cannot be shown, it cannot be indicated, there is no example for it, and there is no activity; it is extremely hard to fathom, and no one is able to realize it. Lord of Secrets, from that in which there is nothing whatsoever, for whose sake do all these many things appear to be enacted: buddhas, sentient beings, male and female, family lineages, various forms, various teachings, indications, different examples, various activities, inferences, and so forth?"

When he had asked this in full, the Lord of Secrets said, "O Lord of Laṅkā, this great and thorough question is excellent! It is most excellent! This meaning, that from what is nothing whatsoever there appears anything at all, is so because that is its very nature. It is simply the appearance of different activities enacted for the sake of three great cities. What are the three cities? They are these: the city of half-appearance, the city of total appearance, and the city of non-appearance. Lord of Laṅkā, since the three cities themselves are the nature of reality, they are called the dharmadhātu, the expanse of phenomena. Why is that? Because what the expanse of phenomena is and what the nature of the three cities is are here one: they are simply the door from which everything arises and the place where it abides.

"Lord of Laṅkā, what appears as three doors for the sake of the three cities is this: the door of dhāraṇī, the door of awareness, and the door of the secret. Lord of Laṅkā, the door of dhāraṇī, too, is made to appear as three for the sake of the three cities, namely: by the condition of thatness itself, calm abiding; by the condition of holding it, insight; and by the condition of entering it, the limit of action. Lord of Laṅkā, for the door of awareness, too, three are made to appear for the sake of the three cities, namely: for the sake of non-appearance, calm abiding; for the sake of appearance, insight; and for the sake of attachment, the limit of action. Lord of Laṅkā, for the door of the secret, too, the making of three appearances for the sake of the three cities appears, namely: for the sake of appearance, calm abiding; for the sake of appearance, insight; and for the sake of attachment, the limit of action.

"Lord of Laṅkā, the making of three buddhas appear for the sake of the three cities is this: for the sake of non-appearance, the unconditioned buddha; for the sake of appearance, the conditioned buddha; and for the sake of attachment, the buddha of form. These are the three.

"Lord of Laṅkā, by the condition of the three cities there are three kinds of sentient beings: by the condition of straying from thatness itself, the formless sentient beings; by the condition of straying from holding it, the sentient beings of form; and by the condition of attachment to entering it, the sentient beings of desire.

"Lord of Laṅkā, by the condition of the three cities, the bodies that are shown as three are these: none, coarse, male and female, and neuter.

"Lord of Laṅkā, by the condition of desire, it appears as though there were fathers and mothers, lines of offspring, and enjoyment of the five objects of desire. Moreover, the Tathāgata himself acts as the mother of the tathāgatas, and the Tathāgata acts as the son of the tathāgatas: he enters the womb, and there too he brings about the cutting of doubts about the supreme secret of suchness, turning back, requesting, turning away requests, granting, and entering into ten millions, as many as ten millions.

"Lord of Laṅkā, for the sake of the three cities there are three teachings: by the condition of thatness itself, the Great Vehicle; by the condition of holding it, the various vehicles; and by the condition of entering it, the lesser vehicle is made to appear.

"Lord of Laṅkā, the three samādhis that appear for the sake of the three cities are these: for the sake of thatness itself, the samādhi of suchness; for the sake of holding it, the all-illuminating samādhi; and for the sake of entering it, the causal samādhi.

"Lord of Laṅkā, the three stūpas that appear for the sake of the three cities are these: the stūpa of the mind, the stūpa of the body, and the stūpa of the speech.

"Lord of Laṅkā, the three maṇḍalas that appear for the sake of the three cities are these: the maṇḍala of the intrinsic nature, the maṇḍala of samādhi, and the maṇḍala of images.

"Lord of Laṅkā, the three mantras that appear for the sake of the three cities are these: secret mantra, vidyā-mantra, and dhāraṇī-mantra.

"Lord of Laṅkā, for the sake of the three cities there are result, condition, and cause.

"Lord of Laṅkā, these and other activities are made to appear fully for the sake of the three cities; they are the full appearance of the activity of the mind."

This concludes the thirty-ninth chapter of the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas, the complete perfection of the activity of the mind.

Then again the Lord of Secrets said to the Lord of Laṅkā, "Lord of Laṅkā, furthermore, for the sake of the buddhas, this genuine secret was fully spoken:

The holy state of the buddhas,
Since it is not other than everything,
And since there is nothing at all to adopt or reject,
Is vajra space, without any doubt.

"Lord of Laṅkā, moreover, for the sake of the pratyekabuddhas, this teaching of the vajra of appearance was spoken:

The vajra of speech is without letters;
The vajra of body shows appearance.
Whoever places the mind here
Is fully certain as the secret itself.

"Lord of Laṅkā, moreover, that Lord of the Supreme Secret spoke this enactment of the vajra of training for the sake of the śrāvakas:

The vajra of the three doors, ten million in number,
The guarding, the limit of complete purity:
Placing the mind here, on the side of peace,
One is fully certain as the holy one itself.

"Lord of Laṅkā, moreover, that holy being spoke this secret vajra of the view for the sake of the yogic sattvas:

Everything is consciousness, appearing as delusion;
There is nothing else; that itself exists as the holy.
Placing whatever consciousness there is here,
One is fully certain as the holy secret.

"Lord of Laṅkā, moreover, that holy being spoke this enactment of the vajra of space for the sake of those who fully clear away extremes:

Here, definitively and fully clearing away
The two extremes of existence and nonexistence,
Placing whatever is the nature of mind here,
One is fully certain, without reference, in the Middle Way.

"Lord of Laṅkā, moreover, that holy being spoke this making of delusion into vajra for the sake of those possessed of delusion, such as Brahmā:

From the delusion of all the world
The vajra of the mind of awakening arises.
Having placed the mind in the vajra of delusion,
One is fully certain in the vehicle of the great secret.

"Lord of Laṅkā, moreover, that holy being spoke this enactment of the vajra of passion for the sake of those possessed of desire, such as Paśupati (Śiva):

All who move and dwell in the world, male and female,
As many as there are, are Paśupati and Umā themselves.
Having placed the mind in the vajra of passion,
One is fully certain in the vehicle of the great secret.

"Lord of Laṅkā, moreover, that holy being spoke this enactment of the vajra of killing for the sake of those possessed of aversion, such as Viṣṇu:

All sentient beings, as many as move and dwell,
Are slain by the single great vajra weapon.
Having placed the mind in the vajra of aversion,
One is fully certain in the Vajra Vehicle.

"Lord of Laṅkā, moreover, that holy being spoke this enactment of the vajra of turmoil for the sake of those possessed of envy, such as the yakṣas:

Piśācas always act on the desires of others;
Wearing the armor of the all-restraining vajra,
Having placed the mind in the all-agitating vajra,
One is fully certain in the essence of the great secret.

"Lord of Laṅkā, moreover, that holy being spoke this enactment of the vajra of slander for the sake of those given to slander, such as the nāgas:

The holy vajra, supreme in dividing,
Divides wrong view from right view.
Having placed the mind in the vajra of slander,
One is fully certain in the vajra secret.

"Lord of Laṅkā, moreover, that holy being spoke this enactment of the vajra hard to tame for the sake of those possessed of pride, such as the asuras:

The vajra that, without exception, the hard to tame
Holds down like a great mountain heaped upon them:
Having placed the mind in the vajra of pride,
One is fully certain in the Vajra Vehicle.

"Lord of Laṅkā, moreover, that holy being spoke this enactment of the vajra of menace for the sake of the flesh-eaters, such as the rākṣasas:

The vajra devouring, without exception,
Is itself what devours everything.
Having placed the mind in the vajra of menace,
One is fully certain in the Great Vehicle.

"Lord of Laṅkā, moreover, that holy being spoke this enactment of the vajra amṛta for the sake of the ḍākinīs and the others, the sorceresses:

The vajra feces and urine are amṛta;
Drinking them is the means for the uncertain.
Having placed the mind in the sorceress vajra,
One is fully certain in the vajra secret.

"Lord of Laṅkā, moreover, that holy being spoke this enactment of the infinite vajra:

In worlds infinite as particles of dust
Are wrong conceptions and discordances numerous as atoms;
By remedies that tame concepts, just as numerous,
They are joined to the expanse of the Vajra Great Vehicle.
Since to the infinite and various beings who move and dwell
Is taught whatever they are inclined toward,
Having placed the mind in the vajra of sentient beings,
They are fully certain as those whose vehicle is the nature of mind.

"Lord of Laṅkā, these are the activities of speech, done for the sake of whoever they are done for."

This concludes the fortieth chapter of the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas, the complete perfection of the activity of speech.

Then that Lord of Secrets said to the Lord of Laṅkā, "Lord of Laṅkā, furthermore, the ways in which means are enacted for the sake of others are

these: because the domains of beings are different and infinite, the activities too appear as different and infinite. Some domains are ripened by what is pure. Some are ripened by what is impure. Some by abandoning the pure. Some by instructions. Some by idle talk. Some by gentleness. Some by harshness. Some by both. Some by fear. Some by liberation. Some by mire. Some by turmoil. Some by obscuring. Some by fighting. Some by suppressing. Some by burning. Some by raising up. Some by not raising up. Some by harm. Some by not harming. Some by injury. Some by not injuring. Some by censure. Some by praise. Some by regret. Some by not regretting. Some by deceit. Some by boasting. Some by insistence. Some by cajoling. Some by giving. Some by taking. Some by contentment with anything at all. Some by mentioning a name. Some by mentioning a form. Some by showing a form. Some by speaking. Some by incense. Some by ornaments. Some by sound. Some by smell. Some by taste. Some by touch. Some are fully ripened by the Dharma. Some by unpleasant forms. In the same way, some are fully ripened by unpleasant sounds, smells, tastes, and touches. Some by prevailing over them. Some by speaking without interruption. Some by speaking for an instant. Some by saying nothing at all. Some by seeing the holy. Some by the sound of the holy. Some by the sound of a holy spiritual friend. Some by non-conceptuality. Some by conceptuality. Some by suffering. Some by happiness. Some by selflessness. Some by the existence of a self. Some by fierce rites. Some by pacifying. Some by enriching. Some by overpowering. Some by bringing to completion. Some are ripened by the sound that tells of experiencing the suffering of the three poisons. Some by the sound that tells of experiencing happiness. Some by the sound that tells of not experiencing happiness. Some by abandoning the enjoyments of existence and practicing fierce austerity. Some by taking up the enjoyments of existence and conducting themselves in a loose and unrestrained way. Some by the means of prohibition. Some by the means of touching nothing at all. Some by the means of completing the task. Some by giving. Some by pleasant speech. Some by harmony. Some by conduct. Some by giving up everything inner. Some by giving up everything outer. Some by giving up everything. Some are fully ripened by passion for everything. Some by distraction.

Some by settling correctly within. Some by restraining desire. Some by indulging desire. In this way he ripens fully those who act on different inclinations, by showing different forms, sounds, views, means, desires, and aims. Lord of Laṅkā, these should be understood as activities enacted through

means."

This concludes the forty-first chapter of the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas, the complete perfection of the activity of means.

Then again that Lord of Secrets said to the Lord of Laṅkā, "Lord of Laṅkā, furthermore, the activity of the body for someone's sake is this: it is simply that, just as an emanation of Vajrasattva, set forth in the world, appears in the form of all and so ripens all. That being so, in the doors of the intention of the tathāgatas enacted for someone's sake, in the doors of the speech of the tathāgatas, in the doors of the deeds of the tathāgatas, in the limits of the emanations of the tathāgatas, and in the ocean-like masses of clouds of the means of the tathāgatas, there is nothing at all that can be grasped as 'this' or as 'one.' Why is that? Lord of Laṅkā, it is like this:

Because sentient beings differ in their inclinations,
Infinite people are hard to satisfy;
Since even the Victor could not satisfy them,
He taught infinitely to whatever each was inclined toward.

"Lord of Laṅkā, of the realms of sentient beings, with their endless perceptions, and of their endless sounds, forms, and conduct, there is nothing at all that the holy ones, without moving from suchness, do not know, have not heard, have not seen, or do not explain. Why is that? Because everywhere and in every way they are fully perfected, unmixed, in the very heart of awakening. Therefore, between the nonconceptuality of one who is unmoving in the heart of awakening and a sentient being who dwells in a sesame seed, there is neither far nor near, neither one nor separate: because suchness is one, they abide without duality in a single expanse. Lord of Laṅkā, these are the activities of the body of the tathāgatas, enacted for someone's sake."

This concludes the forty-second chapter of the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas, the complete perfection of the activity of the body. From the Way of the Definite Emergence of the Great Vehicle: the Dharma seal that discusses wisdom by relating the tale of how it also arose when it was enacted for someone's sake, the ninth, the teaching on how it arose.

Then again the Lord of Laṅkā, that bodhisattva great being, fully asked the question about the tenth of the twelve words concerning what happened before, the one called "It also arose when the great prophecy was definitively taught": "O Lord of Secrets, when you yourself, in showing how the supreme

secret of the Great Vehicle arose, related the explanation in the form of tales, you set down the words 'It also arose when the great prophecy was definitively taught.' In what way was that prophesied, so that it became renowned?"

The Lord of Secrets said, "Lord of Laṅkā, your question is excellent! It is very excellent! It is most excellent! It is like this. In the expanse of beginningless saṃsāra, in times of eons without beginning or end, buddhas without beginning or end appear as lamps for beings. Through the work of a single means of theirs, those who are to be helped in one direction are ripened; and through the holy means, those who are to be ripened are helped without partiality, in no particular direction. Whoever has pledged to follow after whom, by that very pledge the prophecy that it would arise and appear becomes renowned. For no lamp illumines everything apart from its own domain. Lord of Laṅkā, as for how that prophecy was made, it is like this:

In eons without beginning,
All that has arisen cannot be told;
I shall tell here of one occasion that arose:
You who have donned the armor of the pledge, listen.
In the eon called Fully Arrayed
A billion buddhas arise.
The last of them all to arise,
The Sugata, King of Manifest Emergence,
Prophesied within his assembly:
'In one world or one continent,
In the course of a single eon,
In one land, at one vajra seat,
That two buddhas who complete their deeds
Should arise, I have never truly seen.
If they did, it would be impossible, contrary to the nature of things.
After the Buddha has passed into nirvāṇa,
The wondrous secret essence itself
Will become widely renowned.'
So all the buddhas give the great prophecy.
Just so is this one too:
'When I am no longer present, after my passing,
The very Gathering of the Intentions of All
Will appear for those to be trained at the end of a hundred years.'
So that holy one prophesied.

Further, listen to the great exhortation:
In the eon called Infinite
Thirty-five thousand buddhas arise.
The last of them all to arise,
The buddha Amitābha,
Prophesied within his assembly:
'Just as the earlier buddhas who have passed,
Thirty-five thousand who arose,
Prophesied that the holy one would arise
For the sake of those not ripened by them,
So here too, hold to it fully:
When I have passed and no longer appear,
After a hundred years its meaning will appear.'
The Fierce One gave the blessing and the prophecy.

Further, listen to another great exhortation:
In the eon called Renowned
Forty-six thousand buddhas arose.
The last of them all to arise,
That buddha, Friend of All,
Prophesied within his assembly:
'Just as the holy tathāgatas,
Forty-six thousand who arose,
Prophesied for someone's sake,
After I, the Sugata, have gone,
When fifteen hundred years have passed,
The very holy one, free of dust and stainless,
Who appears as having reached the result,
Here in this supreme and holy field,
A fortunate one who has gained its appearance,
A learned brahmin woman,
Through Tamer of the Harmful himself, will become renowned.'

Further, listen to the great exhortation:
In the eon called Excellent Ornament
Eight hundred million buddhas arose.
The last of them to arise,
The buddha Glorious Excellent Ornament,
Prophesied within his assembly:

'Just as the earlier tathāgatas,
Eight hundred million who arose,
Prophesied the arising of the vehicle,
When this light of mine has set,
At the time of fifty years,
A holy mirror of the Dharma,
By which this is accomplished in a single life,
Here in the world of this continent after I have passed,
A fortunate monk who will arise,
Called Sūryagarbha,
Will let fall the great rain of the teaching
And be renowned as harmonious with all.'

Further, listen to the great exhortation:
In the eon called Endowed with Perfection
A billion buddhas arose.

The buddha Ratnaśrī,
Who arose when all of them had come to an end,
Also prophesied within his assembly:
"Just as those tathāgatas,
The billion who arose,
Gave the holy and definitive prophecy,
After I no longer appear or remain,
In the eighty-second year,
This Gathering of the Secret, the essence of the Great Vehicle,
In the place called the Golden Isle of Sale,
Known as Possessing the Heart of Awakening,
For the fortunate King Protector of Bliss,
Will open the single eye of the Dharma
In accord with karma and compassion,
And all those of noble family will obtain it."

Further, listen to another great exhortation:
In this very Fortunate Eon,
Of the thousand buddhas who arise,
The lamp who arose as the fourth,
The Lord of Sages himself,
Prophesied within his assembly:

"Just as the great prophecy of all was taught,
That the eight hundred forty million
Kings of complete awakening themselves,
Having ripened the regions of beings,
Would make the Vajra Essence of the Great Vehicle itself
Widely renowned,
So, after I no longer appear here,
In the hundred and twelfth year,
A holy essence of the teaching,
Renowned in the divine abode of the Thirty-Three,
To the fortunate one of noble family among humans
In the eastern border region of Jambudvīpa,
To the one called King Ja,
Will be granted first in the form of omens.
On the summit called the Fierce One,
To the companion beings of lesser body,
The Lord of Laṅkā and the others,
Vajrapāṇi will appear."
So the holy one granted the prophecy.
These and others without end,
Without beginning and without end,
Have been renowned in such ways as these.

When the Lord of Secrets had spoken thus, the Lord of Laṅkā and the other beings of lesser body were utterly delighted.

This concludes the forty-third chapter of the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas, the prophecy of what would follow. From the Way of the Definite Emergence of the Great Vehicle: the wisdom discussion of the Dharma seal that relates the tale called "It also arose when the great prophecy was definitively taught," the tenth, the teaching on how it arose.

Then again the Lord of Laṅkā, that bodhisattva great being, fully asked the question about the eleventh word concerning what happened before: "O Lord of Secrets, when you yourself, in showing how the supreme secret of the Great Vehicle arises, related the explanation in the form of tales, you set down the words 'It also arose when the stream of karma was fully cut.' In what way was that renowned, and how did it arise?"

The Lord of Secrets said, "Lord of Laṅkā, your question is answered like this:

Among the domains that are to be lifted up,
Those that definitely appear as three
Are the attached to desire, the renunciant,
And the fierce and hard to tame: three to be trained.
The three powers by which they are lifted up,
The continuous wheel, the definitive ultimate,
And the manifest emergence of miracles, these three,
Appear by their nature from the very beginning.
As for the means by which they are lifted up,
Inconceivable, they appear as three;
And what that is, is this:
Nature, force, and the means of remedy,
Which are simply the cutting of the stream of karma.
The continuous wheel, too, appears
From the beginning as the five renowned buddhas.
All those to be trained and all who train
Arise as five, appear as five, are tamed and freed by five:
Producing, sustaining, and supporting;
Cause, condition, and abiding;
All arising in the state of nonconceptuality;
Nonexistent yet inexhaustible, in three aspects.
The expanse, the directly perceived,
That great self itself,
And, in all, no buddha at all.

"Lord of Laṅkā, it is like this:
Those that are awakened in their own expanse,
These that appear as the five great ones,
Are the blessed ones of the stream of the elements,
Buddhas of constant compassion,
Abiding by nature, pervading all.
As beings wish, so they appear as wished,
Renowned as lamps that show appearance and existence.
They are the permanence of the stream of the elements;
Empty of intrinsic nature, they show their deeds.

"Lord of Laṅkā, furthermore,
The buddha of direct perception is

The boundless expanse throughout the expanse of space,
All the things and non-things of the three realms,
The body and the abode of all directions and quarters,
The abode, empty yet present, that gives room to all,
The ground that supports the moving and the unmoving,
The abode where all things are born and arise,
That which joins all in joy:
It abides as the single wheel of an eon.
Kin and dear, producing others, clear by nature,
Holding apart, not turning back, its stream unbroken,
Moistening wilderness and all, moving everywhere:
It abides as the single wheel of an eon.
Ripening all, dispelling darkness, showing all, equalizing,
Burning, softening, making colors appear clearly,
Holding the essences, appearing fully ripened:
It abides as the wheel of a single eon.
Not abiding, unobstructed, it arises with force;
Formless, yet stronger than the power of form,
Light and moving, all-pervading, support of all:
It abides as the single wheel of an eon.

"Lord of Laṅkā, it is like this:
The buddha that is the great self
Is the all-containing, all-hovering Samantabhadra,
The all-bearing, spontaneously dense form of wisdom,
The all-gathering samādhi of equal union,
Insight that clears obscurations, wisdom ablaze,
Unobstructed, undeluded, complete in all that is to be known.

"Lord of Laṅkā, furthermore,
The buddha that is thatness itself is this:
Space is Vairocana;
Earth is the unmoving Vajradhara;
Fire is endowed with Ratnasambhava;
Water, soft and clear, is Amitābha;
Wind, which opens all, without doubt.

"Lord of Laṅkā, it is like this:
That in which there is no buddha here

Is all empty, primordially awakened;
Pervaded by that, unmixed, it is buddhahood itself,
Uncontrived and primordially awakened:
The great elements are the blessed ones.

"Lord of Laṅkā, these
Are the vehicle of the continuous wheel:
Naturally they arise as the continuous wheel,
And their nature abides in all, the stable and the moving.

"Lord of Laṅkā, furthermore,
The vehicle of the definitive ultimate
Definitely appears as three:
The vehicle that leads from the origin of suffering, the awareness of austerity,
And the vehicle of the means of mastery.
As for the leading here, it is this:
The three domains that definitely appear
Appear as lowest, middling, and highest.
Those who have become the lowest domain,
Abandoning extremely dreadful deeds
And taking up the pleasing way of discipline,
Training their own root there,
Appear on the path of individual liberation.
Those who have become the middling domain,
Seeing that all this is dependently arisen,
Selfless, and that not a single phenomenon exists,
Teach the inexpressible, emanated dharmas
And abide at ease through their own power.

Those who have become the highest domain,
Selfless, with love and equanimity, beyond concepts,
Objectless, unborn, and free of partiality,
Easily attuning to the grounds and liberations,
Attain the insubstantial body of essential nature.
Lord of Laṅkā, what more is there?
The vehicle of the awareness of austerity
Is threefold by way of its domains.
What appears to the lowest
Is austerity, vows, and ascetic observances;

Toward equality, unmoving and unborn,
Adopting the manner of reverence and aspiration,
They abide as the Vajradhara of the family.
What appears fully to the middling:
Practicing the karma of purified action,
If they are endowed with yoga and samādhi,
Directly, with an unmoving mind,
They abide as the Vajradhara of the four families.
What definitely appears to the highest:
Mind itself perfects its skill upon the object;
If by awareness one directly sees the object itself,
Having actualized suchness right there,
They abide as the holder of the vajra family.
Lord of Laṅkā, what more is there?
The vehicle of the means of mastery, too,
Appears in three aspects according to domain:
Generation, completion, and total completion.
What appears to the lowest as generation:
From pure skillful means and wisdom,
The dharmas of the five reliances and so forth;
From the five Victors, perfect buddhahood;
The ground of perfection, of great yogic skill.
What appears to the middling as completion:
If, through equality, one sees the meaning of equality,
Equal perfection, knowing the object, space and wisdom,
All-knowing, all-perfect, all-appearing;
The ground of the unchanging, all-pervading nature of reality.
For the highest, total completion is this:
Having realized as mere convention
The meaning called the space of wisdom,
Beyond skill, free of perfecting, beyond the domain of thought;
The ground of the universal mount, in which all is perfected.
Lord of Laṅkā, what more is there?
The vehicle of the manifestation of miracles, too,
Appears in three aspects of domain.
Bad karma of fixation, delusion, and turmoil,
And bad perceptions:

The activity that cuts off their stream and transforms them
Concerns the wheels of the net of the three realms of existence.
In order to cut off the stream of the wheel of karma,
Having turned the sacred wheel,
One will cut through the wheel of the eon.
Why is it that some sentient beings
Fixate through desire and are tormented?
When is it that some sentient beings
Become utterly deluded and benighted?
Through what do some sentient beings
Become extremely wrathful, fierce, and malicious?
Thus, for those in whom the three poisons have ripened,
Whom nothing can benefit,
Even when the characteristic of impermanence has been taught,
In order to cut the karmic stream of bad karma,
The natural miracle becomes manifest.
When wrathful, the five wrathful devourers
Liberate all without remainder and empty them;
Therefore space, the great wrathful devourer,
Empties all by dissolving it:
The supreme liberation into suchness.
By the eon of famine, deprived of the sustenance of existence and peace,
The karmic stream of attachment through fixation is cut.
By the eon of stupor that is endowed with patience,
The karmic stream of mind and mentation is cut.
By the eon of weapons that holds skillful means,
All things whatsoever are cut.
By the eon of fire that is insight,
All afflicted things are burned.
By the eon of water that is calm abiding,
All the stains of affliction are washed away.
By the eon of wind that is unobstructed,
All knowable things are set in motion.
By the eon of space that is wisdom,
All the aging and decay of signs is emptied.
If bad karma is swiftly cut off,
One is swiftly delivered from the bad states.

Among all methods and vehicles,
This is declared to be the last of the last.
In times that have become degenerate,
Because the two kinds of discipline have declined,
The afflictions appear as real things.
As for what is called "passed away and declined,"
That very thing, which has neither passed away nor declined,
Is, at that time, discipline by its own force.
Lord of Laṅkā, in this way,
All of this has never moved at all
From the space of the sacred secret.
From the very space of emptiness alone,
Empty dharmas have merely arisen.
Emptiness, the secret, is suchness;
That is the secret of the Great Vehicle.

When the Lord of Secrets had spoken thus, the Lord of Laṅkā and all the other beings of inferior bodies were left without any doubt that this is definitely the sacred secret.

This concludes the forty-fourth chapter, called "Miracles of the Past," from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

From the ways in which the Great Vehicle definitely arose: the telling of the account "It also arose when the karmic stream was entirely cut off," the discussion of the wisdom of the seal of the Dharma. This is the eleventh teaching on the manner of its arising.

Here the seventh section begins.

Then again the Lord of Laṅkā, that bodhisattva great being, asked a thorough question about what appears as "It also arose when the intention was discussed," the last of the twelve statements about what arose in the past: "O Lord of Secrets, when you yourself were teaching the way the sacred secret of the Great Vehicle arose, at the point where you recounted it in explanation, you set down the words, 'It also arose when the intention was discussed.' Was it discussed in some such way, and so became renowned?"

He replied, "Lord of Laṅkā, what you ask is profound in this way, exceedingly profound; it is difficult in this way, exceedingly difficult; it is not the domain of logicians, it is extremely hard to examine, and it is beyond inference. Since

even the buddhas whose continuum is completely purified, and those who dwell on the grounds, are unable to discuss it fully, what need is there to speak of my discussing it fully? It is not the domain of anyone at all."

When he had said this, the Lord of Laṅkā spoke as follows: "O great being, Lord of Secrets, in order to bring benefit and compassion to beings who appear as afflicted, the time has come for you, lion of speech, to discuss unerringly that very suchness: the domain of great persons, the perfect and complete awakening of all dharmas, the enjoyment of the unobstructed nature of reality, the sacred intention of the Great Vehicle of skillful means. Great being, the time has truly come. The time has come to discuss the sacred certainty. Why is that? Because you, great being, have been empowered by empowerment as the lord of the great secret word of all the tathāgatas. So that those who are deluded may have their understanding opened, and so that, with a net of cloud banks of means for guiding them, all who are bewildered may easily be guided, please unfold the body of the sacred intention." Thus urged, the Lord of Secrets spoke as follows:

You who wear the great armor of urging,
Because you are utterly loving toward all,
Since you strive to urge me on this,
You raise the discussion well. Excellent, excellent!
Thus: "Thus I myself" —
Suchness, the definitive meaning —
At the one time when hearing appeared,
I heard as arising, from all that is like space,
As self-appearance itself.
The secret words, "Thus" —
At the one time when they came to be heard,
Taught in keeping with the means of harmonious engagement,
I heard them as a means of guiding.
The reasoning of scripture, "Thus" —
At the one time when I heard it,
Taught by way of applying the hidden intention,
I heard it as a means of leading.
The words that serve a wish, "Thus" —
At the one time when they came to be understood,
What is wished for by those of great desire,
I heard as their being guided by skillful means.

Secret mantra, vajra, great space,
Is not the domain of words,
So it cannot be realized through expression;
For me to discuss it is extremely difficult.
By example, by valid cognition, by reasoning,
Or by the wisdom of inference,
It cannot be realized;
It is like a blind man measuring the height of the sky.
Nevertheless, entrusted with the charge of the Word,
In order to guide by skillful means those wrongly attached,
And because of your sacred pledge in urging me,
Through the power of the armor donned long ago,
For those who have not realized,
Pointing it out with mere words,
As the very means of guiding them in stages
To the pure grounds of liberation,
I shall discuss it as far as is fitting.
Nature, primordially awakened,
Is of two kinds, seen and unseen:
In an inferior situation it is not seen;
It is seen in a sacred situation.
As for the two, seeing and direct hearing,
The ultimate, sacred, direct perception
Belongs to those of intelligence, yogins endowed with the qualities of practice,
Because through hearing they come to see.
The Victor of Ghanavyūha, too,
Since he has become the essence of the dharmakāya,
Because his beings are not ripened,
Shows the form body and speaks in the way of words.
In the measureless times
Of the past, the future, and the present,
Whatever the intention of the Victors,
Listen to how it was discussed.

Lord of Laṅkā, it is like this. If one wishes to enter the intention of the sacred ones, one should enter the treasury. One should leave nature unfabricated. One should grow the tree. One should enter the sacred. One should keep the

lamp. One should go to the distinctive. One should enter the object. One should examine the mirror. One should enter in harmony. One should cure illness.

He asked, "Lord of Secrets, how are these ten enumerations of the Dharma to be fully understood?"

He replied, "Lord of Laṅkā, of these ten enumerations of the Dharma, the first, entering the treasury of the sacred ones, is this: by entering through the three doors, one enters the treasury that is inexhaustible in what does not exist."

He asked, "Lord of Secrets, what are the three doors?"

He replied, "Lord of Laṅkā, the three doors are these: the door that guides through conduct, the door of the application of skillful means, and the secret door of certainty. These are the three."

He asked, "Lord of Secrets, by what are those doors opened?"

He replied, "Lord of Laṅkā, know that those doors are opened by three keys. What are the three? They are these: opening, unraveling, and drawing out.

Lord of Laṅkā, furthermore, it is like this:
By the keys of the six branches, the four sūtras, and the three roots,
The treasury of the intention of all the Victors
Is definitely opened; so the Victor has declared.

Lord of Laṅkā, the opening of the door that guides through conduct by the three keys is this: the six branches, the four sūtras, and the three roots.

What, then, are the six branches? The branch of the cause, the branch of application, the branch of the result, the branch of the basis, the branch of retention, and the branch of the characteristic.

What, then, is the branch of the cause? It is this: the branch of arising and the branch of ripening. Lord of Laṅkā, what, then, is the branch of arising? It refers to that which, when fully assembled, gives rise to expression: valid cognition, intelligence, retention, the stūpa, assembly, and certainty. The branch of ripening is the cause of ripening into the sacred. What is it? It is this: the branches of awakening and the branches of the path.

Lord of Laṅkā, the branch of application is application to objects: application to the object of the intellect and application to the object of compassion. Lord of Laṅkā, of these, application to the object of the intellect is applying the root from which intelligence arises to the raising of topics, applying the root by

which intelligence is gained to the distinctions of the grounds, applying the root by which intelligence becomes certain to liberation, and applying the root by which intelligence is established to suchness. Lord of Laṅkā, application to the object of compassion, too, is this: application to its cause, application to its result, and application to their nature.

Lord of Laṅkā, the branch of the result, then, is that from which the sacred purpose connected with it arises: the sacred attainment, suchness.

Lord of Laṅkā, the branch of the basis, then, is that which definitively explains the intention. What is it? It is this: that in which dharmas are condensed into three bases. What are the three? The basis of nature, the basis of the root, and the basis of all.

Lord of Laṅkā, what, then, is the basis of nature? It is this: hearing, penetrating, retaining, and mastering.

Lord of Laṅkā, what is the basis of the root? It is this: designation, conduct, birth, abiding, bliss, affliction, purification, variety, agent, action, and ornament.

Lord of Laṅkā, what is the basis of all? As it appears in total affliction, it is this: compilation, engagement, person, and dharma. As it appears from complete purity, it is this: designation, effort, abode, bliss, skillful means, knowledge, the basis of knowledge, diligence, absence of pride, habitual tendencies, what is to be actualized, meditation, essence, aspect, the object of focus, investigation, distraction, nondistraction, seeking, qualities, stability, compilation, compilation by topic, realization, what is to be attained, general completion, and thorough reduction.

Lord of Laṅkā, these are called the branch of the basis.

Lord of Laṅkā, what, then, is the branch of retention? It is this: it should be known solely as taking up, the parental, downfall, nature, the nature of nonexistence, arising, and complete relinquishment. Lord of Laṅkā, these are called the branch of retention.

Lord of Laṅkā, what, then, is the branch of the characteristic? It is this: the conventional, the ultimate, the object of focus, aspect, nature, result, explanation, obstruction, concordance, disadvantage, and benefit.

Lord of Laṅkā, what, then, is the conventional? It is this: the person, imputation, and what is taught as action.

Lord of Laṅkā, what, then, is the ultimate? It is this: separation, stability, and perfection.

The object of focus is what is taught as everything.

Aspect is what is examined as everything: truth, establishment, fault, quality, approach, engagement, reasoning, condensation, and elaboration.

Lord of Laṅkā, what, then, is truth? It is whatever is suchness.

Establishment is the establishment of the person, of imputation, of oneness, of division, of questions, of establishment, of presentation, of the secret, of explanation, and of answers.

Lord of Laṅkā, what is fault? It is the enumeration of total affliction. What is quality? It is the enumeration of complete purification.

Lord of Laṅkā, what is approach? Meaning, attainment, explanation, the abandoning of extremes, the inconceivable, and intention.

Lord of Laṅkā, what is engagement? Time, assembly, and conditions.

Lord of Laṅkā, what is reasoning? It is this: dependence, the performance of function, proof, and the nature of reality.

Lord of Laṅkā, what, then, is dependence? It is that which has become the cause and condition for the arising of compounded things and for conventional designation.

What is the performance of function? It is that which has become the cause and condition for attaining some dharma, or for renown, or, once arisen, for performing an action.

What is proof? It is that in which armor has been donned: those things that have become causes and conditions for what is stated and for what is to be ascertained.

Lord of Laṅkā, furthermore, it is like this. Of the pure and the impure, the pure consists of observation, abiding, example, renown, and certainty. Lord of Laṅkā, of these, that all things are impermanent, suffering, empty, and selfless is observation. That all things are momentary, that there is another existence, that actions are impermanent, that there is abiding in action, and that there is abiding in its result is abiding. Applying what is renowned to all, and applying the observation, is example. Their being renowned is renown. That which appears as valid through valid cognition is certainty. Lord of Laṅkā, furthermore, it is certain as valid because it arises, is examined, cuts off, is

free, and appears. That is pure through direct perception, inference, and valid cognition.

Lord of Laṅkā, the impure is this: what is similar to something else, what is dissimilar, what is similar to all, what is dissimilar, applying the example of something else, what is not renowned, and what is not certain.

Lord of Laṅkā, of these, to observe a valid cognition that lacks the five characteristics of complete purity as similar to something else, and, regarding the characteristics of the compounded, such as impermanence, as they actually are, to observe them otherwise, as permanence, self, and so on, and so, viewing with the four inversions, to observe them as similar to the characteristics of the uncompounded: this is the similar. Being dissimilar to another valid cognition, and dissimilar to another characteristic of an object: this is the dissimilar to something else. To say, "All are the activities of the mind," is the similar to all. Dissimilarity in which, through the dissimilarity of one, they are mutually dissimilar: this is the dissimilar.

Lord of Laṅkā, furthermore, to say, "When a similar example is applied, there is similarity, and so it is uncertain," is the not renowned. To say, "When a dissimilar example is applied, there is similarity, and so it is uncertain," is also the not renowned. Whatever is examined on the basis of what is not renowned is impure. What is impure by nature is uncertain. Lord of Laṅkā, these are proof.

Lord of Laṅkā, what is the nature of reality? It is that which is unfabricated in any way.

Lord of Laṅkā, as for condensation and elaboration: through elaboration all things are condensed, and dividing the one through its distinctions, one brings it to completion.

Lord of Laṅkā, the object of focus is apprehending. Aspect is division. Awakening is nature. What is attained by abandoning something is result. What is understood and spoken of is explanation. What is unfavorable to its side is obstruction. What applies diligence on its side is concordance. What inclines under the power of what is discordant is disadvantage. What inclines in concordance is benefit.

Lord of Laṅkā, these are the branch of the characteristic. These six branches are the key of opening. Whatever is the door that guides through conduct, it is opened by this, and the intention is definitively explained just there.

Lord of Laṅkā, what, then, are the four sūtras? They are these: the sūtras of another intention, the sūtras of hidden meanings, the sūtras of the application of harmonious engagement, and the sūtras of the definitive ultimate.

Lord of Laṅkā, of these, the sūtras of another intention are those that intend nature, time, meaning, and object.

Lord of Laṅkā, of these, nature is like this. In order to remove the fixations of those who conceive in a certain way of whatever appears as distinct, one intends nature and declares uniformly, "Whatever that is, it is just this."

Lord of Laṅkā, time is like this. In order to arouse enthusiasm in those who are lazy, one intends the infallibility of cause and result and teaches, "By just this much, it will come about swiftly."

Lord of Laṅkā, meaning is like this:
For those who are conceited about something,
In order to dispel their darkness,
Intending that those who have not attained the path of seeing
Do not see suchness itself,
one proclaims, "These cannot be known unless they are explained by countless sacred ones."

Lord of Laṅkā, intending the object is like this. In order that understanding may arise in those who hold that a single aspect is sufficient, one sets out all aspects and speaks in praise of them, and, intending that a single aspect is not sufficient, one disparages the aspect to which they were previously habituated.

Lord of Laṅkā, of these, the sūtras of hidden meanings are these: joining, division, overpowering, and deception.

Lord of Laṅkā, of these, joining is like this. There are those who are frightened and terrified, those who strive to the point of exhaustion, and those who are fixated and do not engage in anything at all. In order to settle them definitively in the meaning, one intends that whatever has a result exists and that all things lack intrinsic nature, and says, "Everything exists," and, "It is emptiness," in order to instill the corresponding perception.

Lord of Laṅkā, division is like this. In keeping with what each one is inclined toward, one intends three things: explaining the imputed as without real existence, explaining the dependent as dependent origination, and explaining the perfected as unchanging and unerring; and so one teaches the three.

Lord of Laṅkā, overpowering is like this. In order to overpower those of excellent renown by teaching perfect enjoyments, one intends to tame them by becoming their antidote, and teaches what is vast.

Lord of Laṅkā, deception is like this. In order to transform definitively, by hidden means, those whose perceptions are mistaken, one intends the unchanging meaning and teaches a different cause.

Lord of Laṅkā, of these, the scriptures of the application of harmonious engagement are these: the scripture that attends to one's own conditions, the scripture that introduces skillful means by blending, the scripture of accordant application, and the scripture of earnest instruction.

Lord of Laṅkā, here, the scripture that attends to one's own conditions is like this: whatever condition suits whomever, one teaches that very thing to that one. The scripture that introduces skillful means by blending is like this: by a means of gathering them in, taking their part and leading them along, one transforms them. Accordant application is like this: by acting in keeping with someone's part, one applies it in this way. The scripture of earnest instruction is like this: whatever someone holds dear, one treasures it for them and establishes it.

Lord of Laṅkā, of these, the scriptures of the definitive ultimate are these: doubt, certainty, essence, and the crucial.

Lord of Laṅkā, what, then, is doubt? It is this: examining why things arose, and recognizing that they are so for that reason. Certainty is like this: finding certainty about whatever has been determined. One's own essence is like this: the basis for stating whatever has been examined. The crucial is like this: whatever someone makes crucial for someone.

Lord of Laṅkā, these are the scriptures of sacred certainty. These four sūtras are the key of unraveling. Whatever is the door that guides through conduct, it is unraveled by this and made clear just there.

Lord of Laṅkā, what, then, are the three roots? They are these: the root of the intellect, the root of counsel, and the root of skillful means.

Lord of Laṅkā, of these, the root of the intellect is like this: in suchness just as it is, it is nonconceptual, free of discursive thought, and vivid.

Lord of Laṅkā, the root of counsel is like this: clear nondelusion regarding what is in every way unmixed with anything.

Lord of Laṅkā, the root of skillful means is like this: purity within total completeness.

Lord of Laṅkā, these are the roots, and these three roots are called the key of opening. Whatever is the door that guides through conduct, it is opened by this and made clear just there.

This concludes the forty-fifth chapter, the chapter explaining the arrangement, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then again the Lord of Laṅkā, that bodhisattva great being, asked the Lord of Secrets a thorough question about the two doors: "O Lord of Secrets, how are the two doors opened, and how is their explanation opened?"

He replied, "Lord of Laṅkā, the two doors, too, are opened and made clear by three keys: the common branches, sūtras, and roots.

The six branches are these: the branch of activity, the branch of skillful means, the branch of application, the branch of conduct, the branch of awareness, and the branch of perfection.

Lord of Laṅkā, these six branches, too, are perfected as one by twelve branches and clearly explained by six branches. What are the twelve? They are these: the branch of the door, the branch of the sacred, the branch of certainty, the branch of intention, the branch of the object of focus, the branch of mantra recitation, the branch of application, the branch of conduct, the branch of attainment, the branch of abiding, the branch of the grounds, and the branch of the view.

Lord of Laṅkā, what are the six? They are these: the branch of the cause, the branch of the root, the branch of connection, the branch of guidance, the branch of certainty, and the branch of application.

Lord of Laṅkā, these should be known as common in every respect. Lord of Laṅkā, these are the branches. Know that those doors are opened by them and clearly explained.

Lord of Laṅkā, what, then, are the sūtras? They are these: those that explain nonarising, equality, things as they are, and the absence of seeking. Lord of Laṅkā, these are suchness itself, which is the nonarising of anything else, equality, things as they are, the absence of seeking, and what is unmixed.

Lord of Laṅkā, what, then, are the roots? They are these: whatever is suchness, sacred certainty, and complete embrace. Lord of Laṅkā, these are

the roots. Know that by them the way those doors truly are is definitively drawn out."

This concludes the forty-sixth chapter, the chapter explaining the compilation, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then again the Lord of Secrets called to the Lord of Laṅkā and said, "Lord of Laṅkā, beyond those, the opening of the secret door of certainty by three keys is especially this:
The secret door of the sacred ones:
By the opening, unraveling, and definitive drawing out
Of branches, sūtras, and roots,
Suchness itself is definitively seen.
Opening is cause, root,
The words of connection, certainty,
And application: these complete the branches,
And they definitely extend to all that arises as speech.
Because the four causes serve the purpose for which something arose,
The essence of the cause is blessed
And definitely appears as an explanation.
The branches of the root are those by which
One goes out to welcome, shows respect, and asks a question,
So that from the occasion a discussion arises.
The branch of connection is of four kinds:
Of expression, the expressed, connection, and intention,
The last two lead on to four.

Guidance here is of ten kinds:
Viewing itself, likewise the opening of doors,
Gathering in general, and leading to abundance,
One's own conditions, hidden intention, the crucial itself,
The unfabricated, the example that points to suchness,
Display, interweaving, and pacifying: ten kinds.
With the ten mirrors and the applying of aspects,
The lamp is applied to search out things in darkness.
By applying the certainties four by four by four,
The twelve all appear as four branches.
Application: the fourth, five, two, and four;
It appears as five branches, and applying these, five;
The sixty-one modes of entering conception, and skillful means,

Are perfected in six branches.

Lord of Laṅkā, the six branches here are these: the branch of the cause, the branch of the root, the branch of connection, the branch of guidance, the branch of certainty, and the branch of application.

Lord of Laṅkā, of these, the branch of the cause is that which has become the cause of arising, namely the six perfect conditions.

Lord of Laṅkā, furthermore, it is like this. At one time, when "Thus did I hear" definitively appeared as suchness itself, the Blessed One, the mind of all the tathāgatas, the one called the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, free of conventional terms and beyond all designations, the self-nature of great space that pervades all, directly present yet not abiding, impossible to point to, the king of total perfection, was dwelling in the realm called the Great All-Pervading Expanse. It is the place that pervades everything, called the universal mount of perfection; the state of great bliss in the expanse of space; where one laughs in the knowledge that all is awakened; the palace of the Dharma of the universal ground, primordially vast and wondrously renowned, unbroken in its extent; where, in the inexpressible space of the nature of reality, the sun of wisdom has risen beyond measure; without edge or center, everywhere equal in extent. There he dwelt as the great one who abides nowhere at all; attached to nothing, yet the very identity of attachment; doing nothing, yet with all deeds spontaneously accomplished; unborn and unceasing, liberated and pure; not a thing, of the nature of space; unfabricated and unmade, primordially just as it is; not abandoning saṃsāra, primordially spread out and all-pervading; not abandoning the three poisons, the great physician; focusing on nothing at all, yet the source of all focus; where the path of words is cut off, yet the source of all expression; unmixed with anything, totally perfect as one; in every respect the good state, the great crest that never declines; with wisdoms beyond count, and more beyond count, all enveloped without coming together or parting. So he dwelt in the essential nature of insubstantiality.

At one time, when these words of suchness, the secret essence, were heard thus as a means of harmonious engagement, the Blessed One of all the tathāgatas, the Lord of the Supreme Secret, the lord of blessing who has no accepting or rejecting, the array of an inexhaustible treasury from which all desires arise, with a splendor that delights in the sacred enjoyment of all that

is great, moving with the great conduct that cuts through the waves, wondrous, was in the realm called Sukhāvatī. It is the place where this very meaning is discussed, the basis where the great assembly is complete, the ground where great skill is perfected.

There, in the Akaniṣṭha palace of the dharmadhātu, was a celestial mansion of various jewels, without edge or center, its pinnacles everywhere equal in extent. It was ornamented with the king of jewels and made beautiful by strands of pearls, hanging clusters, and pendant garlands. On all its rafters, waxing and unwaxing suns and moons hovered, making it bright and forming inlays, and it was studded with stars and brilliant stars like nails. Eight jewel pillars were set up, adorned with suns and moons, and from the jewel capitals, jewel crests and rays of light radiated everywhere. Eight great beams were each draped with cloth. On a canopy of the nature of reality appeared vajra slats. Clouds of miracles gathered thick, the rain of awakening fell, the torment of the afflictions was cleared away, and the sprouts of wisdom grew. From the sound of the nature of reality that resounded came the opening of the discussion of the universal ground, primordially vast and wondrously renowned, free of verbal expression and appearing in the manner of a face and its mirror.

The celestial mansion was Vajra Abhirati. It was ornamented with vajras and made of various jewels, with a floor of gold spread out. Like a mirror, crystal, clear water, or well-refined gold, it was even and level, clear and gleaming, and reflections arose from it. It was soft, springy, smooth, pure, clear, supple, pliant, blazing, radiant, and free of conception. The light of various jewels arose from it naturally, and its rays radiated everywhere, completely dispelling outer and inner darkness. Its crowning pinnacle was a four-spoked wheel that blazed. It was ornamented all over with vajras. Its three doors were all clear, with an unbroken border of light. Sun and moon reliquary ornaments blazed in triple lines, rolled in pairs. It was adorned with steps and porticoes, adorned with four chamfered corners, and made beautiful by courtyards in between. It was adorned with necklaces and great necklaces, held up by archways, beautified with garlands, and adorned with nets and half-nets, and covered with fringes. Blazing vajras and jewels made it radiant all over. From its bells and tinkling bells resounded the Dharma sound of the Great Vehicle, and reflections of the dharmakāya arose. Its base was adorned with perfect ornaments, an unbroken vajra border, and vajra lattices and nets. Palm trees had grown there, hung with golden ornaments and embellished with jeweled

inlays, and streams of nectar flowed.

When there was neither outer nor inner, and all had become inner, there was great appearance obstructed nowhere; nothing at all was said, yet it was explained at length; nothing at all was intended; and the king perfect in the mastery of great samādhi was together with a retinue of perfect enjoyment beyond count, and more beyond count, namely: the tathāgata Akṣobhya, king of consciousness, and the rest, all the buddhas of the vajra lineage and class; the tathāgata Great Equanimity, king of feeling, and the rest, all the buddhas of the jewel lineage and class; the tathāgata Signless, king of perception, and the rest, all the buddhas of the lotus lineage and class; the tathāgata Great Being, king of formations, and the rest, all the buddhas of the youth lineage and class; and the tathāgata Imperceptible, king of form, and the rest, all the buddhas of the elephant lineage and class. All of them, purely connected like cloud banks of skillful means and like the space of wisdom, dwelt in perfect enjoyment as principal and retinue.

As a means of guiding, in words of extensive explanation that employ the hidden intention, it is said thus: "Heard at one time." The Blessed Ones, the kings of great miracle who appear as anything whatsoever, were in the buddha-field called Endowed with Inclination, where the abodes are just as they are, in the immeasurable world-system called Treasury of Merit, the place where all activity is completed. There the buddha who guides saṃsāra, the lamp that reveals appearance and existence, the being who clears away what is to be tamed, the noble one who acts for the good of beings, the emanation of compassion skilled in means, the Blessed One of the unbroken stream of arising, emanated as the great self of everlasting compassion, dwelt in a great exposition in the manner of teacher and listeners, together with a retinue beyond telling, beyond even what is beyond telling.

Wishing to show that all things appear in the manner of the two truths, in these words of their own condition, unobstructed, it is said, intending the nature of reality as self-appearance: "Heard at one time." The Blessed One, the secret body, the great bliss, was in the buddha-field renowned as Endowed with Lotuses, which is taught in accordance with this: the place of perfect miracle; the profound distinction of the Uṣṇīṣa Universal Monarch; the delight of the supreme secret, the womb of the Mother, the heart of the lotus, the palace in which all the victors are brought forth; the trace left by the one who has gone for the sake of the goal, the ground that ripens the sentient beings of the three realms of existence; the place where the dependent origination of

desire arises, which has become the path of beings. There the uncommon secret body dwelt with a secret retinue beyond telling, beyond even what is beyond telling, namely: the great secret beings Swift Vajra, Great Vajra Rapid, Great Vajra Sharp, Great Vajra Arising, Great Vajra Opening, Great Vajra Great, Great Vajra Vast, Great Vajra Profound, Great Vajra Steadfast, Great Vajra Various, and the rest, the most secret retinue, together with their emerging and entering. They dwelt in the manner of those who cut through doubts, those who have resolved them, and those who press forward to ask.

Thus, for each and every one of the tathāgatas, these distinctions of body appear in this way, and yet there is no appearing as distinct. Free as well from the nature of one and of many, they appear vividly, clearly, brilliantly and distinctly, everywhere and in every way.

At that time, on that occasion, this secret essence of the Great Vehicle of skillful means, the domain of great persons, the meaning of unerring hearing concerning the appearance of the four bodies, is discussed with the heirs of the victors in accordance with suchness, as follows. All the tathāgatas, knowing that all phenomena dawn within the intention of equality, dwelt in the state called unobservable equality of body. They dwelt in the state called unobservable equality of speech. They dwelt in the state called unobservable equality of mind, in which engaging, turning back and turning away are not observed.

Lord of Laṅkā, the two are simply two expressions of whatever occurred. Lord of Laṅkā, these are called the causal branch.

From the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas, the forty-seventh chapter, which teaches the perfect setting.

Lord of Laṅkā, what is the root branch? It refers to the root from which the expression arises, that by which the discourse is set in motion. It is as follows. Then, while those tathāgatas, without moving from the state of the expanse, were as though asleep, from the state of emptiness of the Mother of all buddhas, the Perfection of Wisdom, this sound of great exhortation arose:

Empty of existence and nonexistence, by the power of utmost yoga,
You who from the space-like state have drawn near to the sacred commitment,
Ocean of wisdom, expanse of complete liberation,
Nonabiding and unobservable, arise from the expanse of space!

From that sound, those Blessed Ones, knowing that all phenomena dawn in the heart of awakening, caused a sun vajra to arise from the state of emptiness, just as the heart of the sun rises in a clear sky. Then from that heart of the sun many tens of millions of light rays were sent forth, just as tens of millions of light rays are sent forth from a thousand suns. From those light rays the clouds of compassion, of the mind of awakening, gathered thick, and a rain of play poured down. Thereby they caused the thunder of various plays, the lightning of various plays, the offerings of various plays, the songs of various plays, the dances of various plays, the drums, conches, horns and flutes of various plays, the ornaments of various plays, the delights of various plays, the wisdom of various plays, the primordial wisdom of various plays, the meditative absorption of various plays, the bliss of various plays, the feeling of various plays, the great joy of various plays, and the queen of various plays, the great emptiness, all to enter into suchness.

Then from that state of emptiness of the Mother of all the tathāgatas arose this sound of the nature of reality, of suchness:

Deity of the expanse, heart commitment, who has perfected the two great accumulations,
Body of great play, who brings enjoyment to perfection,
Vajrasattva, fortunate and glorious, you are the lord:
Through the play of skillful means, arise from the expanse of great bliss!

Exhorted by that sound, he arose from that state of great bliss in the form of great miracle. With displays of magic, with swirling, with poise, with majesty, with the great mudrā of dance, with laughter of every kind, with the radiating and gathering of compassion, with the distinctions of qualities, with blazing and radiating light rays, and the rest, he filled all of space with emanations like garlands of lightning. Everywhere and in every way, signs, aspects, existence and nonexistence were completely pervaded by the state of suchness, the essence of secret mantra. Its very nature is secret.

Then again from that great emptiness, the suchness of the Mother of all the tathāgatas, this final sound of exhortation arose:

Body that sports in the illusion of primordial wisdom,
Who has gained mastery over great means and wisdom,
Noble lord, source from which many emanations arise,
Sugata, Sugata, please arise!

Thus exhorted, that Blessed One, the Lord of the Supreme Secret, entered into equipoise in the meditative absorption called Vajra Play Suchness, and remained without saying anything at all.

Then, from those sounds of great exhortation that had arisen from the state of the Mother of all the tathāgatas, the Perfection of Wisdom, the very great retinue was amazed and filled with wonder. All of them, with one voice, made supplication from within Vajra Play Suchness with this song:

How wonderful! From the wish-fulfilling supreme body, which is like space,
Performing the vajra dance of all-pervading blessing,
Body expanded in the play of cloud banks of splendor,
You display the miracle of unobstructed vajra play.

How wonderful! From the wish-fulfilling supreme speech, which is like an echo,
Uttering the vajra of melodious blessing,
Speech arrayed with an ocean of irresistible branches,
With a lion's roar you teach the ocean of secret mantra.

How wonderful! From the essence of primordial wisdom, which is like the sun,
Bringing the vajra bliss of blazing blessing,
Mind that is the sphere free of elaboration, nonconceptual,
You display the miracle that ascertains liberation itself.

Beings sunk in the mire of unknowing, folly and delusion,
Bound by the net of suffering, you set free through skillful means.
Those blinded by the darkness of ignorance, you open through the meaning.
Across the ocean of saṃsāra you ferry them with the boat of play.

Great mind of all the tathāgatas,
Endowed with the supreme essence, the meaning of primordial wisdom,
Scripture of the yoga of the Great Vehicle, gathering all vajras:
We pray you, explain it extensively to this assembled gathering!

"Aho!" they said, and bowing down with certainty they made supplication.

Then, when the Blessed One, the Lord of the Supreme Secret, had been supplicated with that song of Vajra Play Suchness, he gazed on the whole retinue and smiled. From the expanse of his utterly pure mind, suns of awareness, beyond telling, beyond even what is beyond telling, pervaded everywhere and in every way with boundless light rays. From each of those light rays arose various forms, such as vajra yakṣas and vajra rākṣasas. From each of these, in turn, immeasurable hundreds of thousands of buddhas, each

with their own retinues gathered around them, appeared, pervading infinite buddha-fields. From that, the light of the sun of awareness arose, pervading the realm of space, and every darkness, every deep and dense blackness, was completely dispelled. There arose the thunder of the Dharma of awareness, the rain of Dharma, various songs of Dharma, various dances of Dharma and various offerings of Dharma, and in boundless space they appeared vividly and unmistakably, pervading every direction, this way and that, above and below, interwoven, and so on. The inconceivable light rays of the wondrous body blazed, radiated and churned, vivid and distinct. The wondrous mind, too, was vast and clear. The wondrous, inconceivable speech also proclaimed, "Aho!" The immeasurable buddhas, too, with the single sound of inconceivable speech, proclaimed, "How wonderful! The meaning of the wondrous Dharma of play has come forth!" Wonder was born in the hundreds of thousands of the retinue and the various beings to be tamed, filling them with delight. Their skill in awareness was trained, the greatness of the meaning was brought out, and they were struck with awe and amazement. All of them remained close by. They remained at peace. They remained filled with joy.

Then that Lord of the Supreme Secret entered into equipoise in the meditative absorption called Vajra Stream, which purifies the retinue, and from the long hūṃ of his nostrils there came forth these beings possessed of manifest vajra might:

hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ Those of the lineage of the sacred Great Vehicle,
Gathered in the vajra gathering,
Are to be placed in vajra secret rows,
According to their order, higher and lower.
Those not of the lineage become lineage-less.
The sacred commitments of those of the lineage
Do not descend upon the lineage-less.
Whoever transgresses this will be destroyed.

hūṃ krodha jvala samaya rakṣaśka jvala samaya yakṣa jvala samaya citta jvala samaya

When this sound was sent forth, from the mass of light of his tongue faculty there came, in a whirling succession, blazing garlands of light of the wrathful ones, radiating garlands of light of the rākṣasas, churning garlands of light of the yakṣas, and garlands of light of the devourers. Thereby the rudras, the māras, the rākṣasas, the yakṣas, Entering Craving, Craving-Free, Īśvara, Balin,

monkeys, goats, lu-de creatures, bees, crows, fire-bearers, saṃsāra, water, earth, space, fire, sound, conceptual analysis and the rest no longer remained as signs, and were pacified into the nature of reality.

Then, as those light rays swirled in the sky, that great retinue was terrified and made this supplication: "How wonderful! Alas! Blessed One, we pray you, bless us so that we become fit vessels! We pray you, accept us into the lineage of the Great Vehicle!" When they had so supplicated, the Blessed One let the radiance of his face shine forth. Those light rays became the light of primordial wisdom, peaceful and swirling, beautiful and blissful, delighting everyone; and having purified the vessels, they dissolved back into the source of the light.

Lord of Laṅkā, then that Blessed One, the Lord of the Supreme Secret, arose decisively from the expanse of great nonabiding primordial wisdom, and with a sound like the roar of a victorious lion, there arose this sound of the great treatise: the array of meaning, the play of signs, the certainty of the secret, the commentary on the word, the mirror of Dharma, the source of reasoning, the Gathering of All Intentions, the vajra expanse. Having said, "oṃ hūṃ mūṃ," he said nothing at all. He did not speak at length. He did not deny what had been spoken. He did not negate. In the very state of not having spoken, he remained as the essence of extensive explanation.

Lord of Laṅkā, these are called the branch of the root application.

From the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas, the forty-eighth chapter, which teaches the branch of the root application.

Lord of Laṅkā, then what is the branch of connection? It is that to which each thing is connected. It is to be stated purposefully, as going purposefully, thus.

Lord of Laṅkā, at that time, on that occasion, I had become the great samaya, Vajrasattva. The Blessed One, the Lord of the Supreme Secret, intending that I myself should purposefully proclaim at length the secret meaning of the Great Vehicle, looked at me for a moment with his face inclined toward me, and urged me on with a smile. Then I, who appeared as the one called Vajrasattva of the Great Samaya, realizing that I had been truly urged, rose from my seat, touched my own marks at the five places, and, in order to proclaim at length the suchness of the Great Vehicle, placed my tongue upon a lotus. With great reverence I made a prostration in the yogic manner, bringing the four limbs of the body to the ground, gazed at the face of the Teacher with the gaze of a lion, and spoke these words:

Vajra King, Lord of the Assembly, please consider me!
King of Dharma, unmoving, you act in the way of the victors.
Supreme Victor, abiding firmly on the ground of great bliss,
With the blazing vajra tongue, supreme in the act of speech,
May the kings of sound and melody bless me!
This king of secret mantra, this mirror of Dharma,
By the power of the Supreme Victor, the King of Dharma himself,
It is fitting to proclaim at length to the assembled gathering.

"Aho!" So I made supplication. Then, in order to bless me, whom he had charged with the command of vajra activity, as a great vajra proclaimer, the Lord of the Supreme Secret entered into equipoise in the meditative absorption called Vajra Radiance, and from the light rays of his tongue came vajra karma satva cakra ha ha haṃ. A blazing wheel of crossed vajras, the being who is vajra alone, fell into my hand. I gained mastery over the vajra of activity, was blessed with the eloquence of a great expounder, utterly unconstrained, and became one of great conscientiousness, never careless.

Then I, Vajrasattva, took that emblem of activity in my hand and, with various vajra words, turned it five times, that is, in twelve ways, and changed it into two and five. Thereby the buddha-fields shook to their utterly pure limits: they shook, shook strongly, shook strongly everywhere; they moved, moved strongly, moved strongly everywhere; they rocked, rocked strongly, rocked strongly everywhere; they churned, churned strongly, churned strongly everywhere; they roared, roared strongly, roared strongly everywhere; they quaked, quaked strongly, quaked strongly everywhere. When the edges rose, the center sank; when the center rose, the edges sank; when the east rose, the west sank; when the west rose, the east sank; when the south rose, the north sank; when the north rose, the south sank. All the buddha-fields became as though they were nothing but me, Vajrasattva, and resounded with the sound that proclaims at length the essential nature of secret mantra in an unerring way. I, Vajrasattva himself, in a terrifying manner, remained in a majestic posture on a throne marked with lions and vajras, in front of the Teacher.

Then the great assembled gathering and retinue spoke thus to the Blessed One: "How wonderful! Blessed One, this Vajrasattva, so mighty, so greatly blessed, of such great cause, so learned, so clear and profound, is inseparable from the mind of the Blessed One and born from that mind; he is connected with suchness and born from suchness." So they said, praising me. Lord of

Laṅkā, the Blessed One then declared to them: "Great assembled gathering, this Vajrasattva is the very essence of the awakening mind, the lord of all compassion, the supreme of all skillful means, the mighty sovereign of all buddhas, the father of all bodhisattvas, the yoga of all yogas, the guide of all nirvāṇas, the great māra even of all māras, the tamer of those hard to tame even among all buddhas, the treasury of all Dharma, the lord of all secrets, the great source of all primordial wisdom. Why is this so? In the time of equality without beginning or end, in boundless time, immeasurable and inconceivable, beyond even the furthest limit of the furthest limit, he did what was to be done, performed the act, and became manifestly and perfectly awakened. Because he is joined to the intrinsic nature of all phenomena and connected with the intrinsic nature of all phenomena, he is born from the mind of all the victors and connected with that mind, and has become the father of all. Such is he." So he declared, speaking in praise of me.

At this the whole assembled gathering and retinue was amazed, and they said, "Blessed One, this is truly wondrous! Sugata, this is truly wondrous!" Then they bowed separately to the sacred Vajrasattva, made prostration in the yogic manner, bringing the four limbs of the body to the ground, offered wondrous flowers and various offerings of meditative absorption, and said:

You who are so marvelous and wondrous,
Born a victor from the mind of the buddhas,
How you appear here in this buddha-field!
Father of yogis, heir of the victors,
Turning the wheel of the word
That is one in connection with all intrinsic natures,
Make clear the sacred, utterly pure, supreme path,
Illustrating it through words!

"Aho!" So they made supplication.

Lord of Laṅkā, then I, the sacred Vajrasattva, turned and twirled the vajra, and spoke majestically in vajra words:

oṃ hūṃ muṃ a ho
The heir of the victors says nothing at all.
Because he does not speak, he explains at length.
This nature of reality, which cannot be explained,
The victors have not explained.
Thus even the Teacher, the Supreme Victor,

Does not wish to give an exposition;
His intention is to explain at length.
The nature of reality, which is unborn,
Because it is unborn, is explained as the essence.
That meaning which is the essence
Is not something that can be spoken in words.
In elaboration itself one goes astray:
So the victors have rightly explained.
Therefore the Vajra King himself
Intends what he has not spoken.
Whatever brings out the meanings of the intention,
Like a reflection in a mirror,
Appears to awareness as the meaning of the intention.
Though, by the meaning of the unborn essence,
It is not elaborated in words,
Yogis of signs and words,
Subtle in words but coarse in meaning,
Those weak in skill whose minds cling to words,
In order to satisfy their minds by guiding them,
Must have it illustrated by words of miracle,
Words that from the unobservable make it observable.
The mind of all the sugatas and victors,
That very secret, the meaning of the essence,
Equality, awakening, the Great Vehicle,
Clearly pervading and appearing in all,
Must be seen just as it is by all.
I am the essence of all the victors
Who abide in the three times;
In this meaning hidden in emptiness,
With the key illustrated by symbol and example,
I open the door to the awareness of equality.
The lineage that illustrates and brings forth the hidden meaning
Is said to be taught to those who have not seen.
Seeing it, it accords with suchness itself.

Thus the Lord of Secrets set out the rite in which all phenomena are gathered into the four branches of purpose and connection. Then the Lord of Laṅkā and

the others, beings of inferior bodies, also came to comprehend all phenomena completely by way of the four branches of purpose and connection.

From the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas, the forty-ninth chapter, which teaches the branch of connection and purpose.

Then again the Lord of Secrets called to the Lord of Laṅkā and said: "Lord of Laṅkā, what then is the branch of guiding? It is guiding fully from what to what. It should be discussed thus, discussed in full detail. Lord of Laṅkā, it is like this:

The branches of full guiding
Are guided by a set of ten,
And so the branches of the words of utterance and expression are complete:
The words of looking to what, of opening the door,
Of gathering, of leading to accomplishment,
Of condition, and of holding another object in focus,
The unfabricated, the mirror, and the interweavings.
By applying them in harmony with the ten mirrors,
Words and meaning are joined completely.

Lord of Laṅkā, it is like this:
As for looking to what, and looking:
One who travels here through the sky
Divides the arc of the sky into stretches by his skill;
Likewise one who goes here into that very thing
Divides the unmixed range of view into stretches.
The stages of ground to be traversed
Are divided to the measure of one's strength;
Likewise the junctures of meaning and of words
Are divided into sections and groups of meaning.

Just as under someone's dominion
Many lands are contained,
So all the many enumerations of expression
Are gathered into the single essence of something.

Those that go in this way or that
Appear directly connected, following one upon another.
The junctures of words of expression and expressed
Are here joined in connection without confusion.

One traveling to the place one is going
Goes by momentum, with no visible movement;
By uttering the letters and by one's own effort,
They are joined in accordance with the essence of something.

Whatever goes in whatever way,
What is unfitting appears fitting there:
Words that are coarse, harsh and faulty,
What is unfitting, are joined there fittingly.

Foods that are imagined in the mind
Draw out from within the nourishment one desires.
By holding something as the object of focus,
What is unclear is shown manifestly.

Just as when an echo arises in succession,
At the moment it arises one gains conviction,
Likewise when the object of valid cognition arises,
One is certain that it is the unfabricated itself.

Just as here a pure mirror
Shows the face and its reflection,
So by the mirror of close illustration
What is unseen is made clear.

As in interweaving, scattering and churning,
The junctures of twisting, of casting and gathering, and of scattering are joined,
Like the great power of the play of great skill,
So that very thing is joined as awareness itself.

Lord of Laṅkā, these
You should know to be only the branches
That guide into utterance and expression."

When the Lord of Secrets had spoken thus, the Lord of Laṅkā and the other beings of inferior bodies came to open fully the doors of speech concerning all phenomena.

From the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas, the fiftieth chapter, which discusses the branch of full guiding.

Then again the Lord of Secrets called decisively to the Great Being, the Lord of Laṅkā, and spoke in detail: "Lord of Laṅkā, it is like this:

The branch of certainty
Is what is expressed, by whom, to whom:
The four connections, explanation and application, the doors of expression,
Utterly pure and vividly clear.
To this, the Lord Avalokiteśvara
Sees all the beings without end
Here as only four vessels:
Those with clinging attachment, those with wrong craving,
Those with lineage, and those with intelligence.
All of them appear in four parts:
Desire, guidance, application and certainty appear.
These, at times, are four parts:
What is needed where, what is certain,
From the essence along with the object of focus,
In the four of scripture, meaning, logical reason and reasoning,
Joined as consistent with appearance, extensive and sound.
All the causes of nonexistence, imagined and clung to,
What is established and accomplished, appear according to how they are viewed.
Whoever, communicating to whomever through symbols,
Is certain in taking up the meaning of something."

When he had discussed this as the sacred certainty, the beings of inferior bodies found the certainty of all phenomena through mere symbols.

From the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas, the fifty-first chapter, which discusses the branch of sacred certainty.

Then again the Lord of Secrets, by the means of bringing the mind to full engagement, called to the Great Being of inferior karma, the Lord of Laṅkā, and said:

"Lord of Laṅkā, the very means
Of entering realization exhaustive of the branches is this:
Through the door from which intrinsic nature arises, the application of empowerment,
And the comprehension of certainty,
One should settle definitively upon the true meaning.
Knowing, entering and the result
Are the characteristics of the spontaneously present.

Its connection, its purpose, it must be illustrated,
And one must follow after it.
Hearing a little, familiarization, and becoming certain;
Opening, seeing, entering and attaining;
Seeking it, finding it, entering, making it manifest;
Approach, close approach, accomplishment and attainment;
Likewise becoming equal, so that for the yogi
It is spontaneously present and fit for activity.
This is the sequence of definite entry.
For the sake of others there are four stages of arising:
Moving, miracle, and causing to appear;
They are applied in sequence, just as they are.
Knowing that, knowing it as unborn,
At that time knowing absence of entity,
And knowing it primordially: such is the sequence.
All equality, suchness itself,
Accomplishment, not transgressing, and the substances in accord with conduct:
Intrinsic nature appears in five aspects.
Whatever is skilled, great, many, boundless and vast,
Transforming, of great waves, showing as anything at all,
Containing all, enjoying all, entering into bliss.
Destroying, pacifying, expanding the limits,
And gathering into completeness: these are the four activities.
By this branch of application,
All the branches are complete.

Lord of Laṅkā, these are the branches. You should know that by these branches every expression, in whatever way it is made, is fully distinguished."

When the Lord of Secrets had spoken thus, the beings of inferior bodies came to comprehend all phenomena completely.

From the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas, the fifty-second chapter, which explains the means within the branch of the means of entry.

Then again the Lord of Laṅkā asked the Lord of Secrets: "O Lord of Secrets, what is that which is called the full unraveling of the sūtra?" When he had

asked this, the Lord of Secrets said: "Lord of Laṅkā, as for this sūtra, all that is expressed here, wherever and in whatever way, comes down to just these four sūtras. Lord of Laṅkā, what are the four? They are: release through hearing something; release through seeing something; arising as direct perception through something; and the absence of any release from anything into anything."

"Lord of Laṅkā, of these, release through hearing something is this:

The intrinsic nature of all is suchness.
In that very thing which one hears,
All is pervasive and vast, without entity.
Knowing that, one comprehends it as suchness.

Lord of Laṅkā, release through seeing something is this:

When one sees that just as it is,
By that seeing, appearance and existence are utterly pure.
There is no fear of anything at all.
In that suchness, all are buddhas.

Lord of Laṅkā, release as direct perception through something is this:

When one knows that emptiness,
There, all things, directly perceived,
Are definitively exhausted in emptiness.
That itself, directly perceived, is buddhahood.

Lord of Laṅkā, the absence of any release from anything into anything is this:

All things, in the expanse of suchness,
Are buddhas from the very beginning, without conceptual thought.
How could they become buddhas only now?
It is simply suchness itself.

Lord of Laṅkā, these are the sūtras. The infinite expressions, by whomever, to whomever, in whatever way they are made, come down to these four sūtras alone. They untie the knots of everything, and you should know that they are the complete liberation and the extensive commentary of all phenomena."

When the Lord of Secrets had spoken thus, the beings of inferior bodies came to comprehend all directions completely and clearly.

From the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas, the fifty-third chapter, the extensive commentary on the sūtra.

Then again the Lord of Laṅkā, the bodhisattva, the Great Being, put the root questions in full to the Lord of Secrets: "O Lord of Secrets, what is the root of everything? What is it that brings release? Lord of Secrets, please make it understood. Lion of speech, please make it fully understood." When he had spoken thus, the Lord of Secrets said: "Lord of Laṅkā, this question about the root of everything is excellent. It is most excellent indeed. It is like this: the root is the mirror, the discordant, and certainty.

"Lord of Laṅkā, the mirror is this: taking up an example that shares the qualities of space. Just as space is, so one views certainty about anything in the same way. Lord of Laṅkā, what then is space? It is this: it is of one intrinsic nature, unstained, making room, unborn, undestroyed, without shape, without color, unconditioned, without anything grasped, without grasping, without limit, without center, without increase, without decrease, without going, without coming, without moving, without stirring, without formation, without abiding, without destruction, without being empty, without change, without anything it does not pervade, without anything that does not arise, without anything it does not encompass, without weariness, without setting, without characteristics, without cause, without condition, without result, without effort, and without conditioning activity.

"Lord of Laṅkā, space does not turn from existence into nonexistence, nor from nonexistence into existence. Likewise, there is in it no turning from clear to unclear, from unclear to clear, from distinct to one, from one to distinct, from what is to what is not, from what is not to what is, from near to far, from far to near; likewise no turning into large and small, good and bad, happy and suffering, pervading and not pervading, arising and not arising, pure and impure, established and unestablished, high and low, wide and narrow, shape and shapelessness, color and colorlessness, outer and inner, birth and cessation, transferring and not transferring, changing and unchanging, darkness and light, former and later, edge and center, self and other; and likewise there is no turning from having taken up to having cast away, nor from having cast away to having taken up. Therefore space is unfabricated everywhere and in every way. This very thing should be applied likewise: therefore it is unfabricated.

"Lord of Laṅkā, it is like this. Space, for example, was made by no one. It has no maker. It did not arise from a cause. It was not produced by conditions. It was not born at the beginning. It will not be destroyed at the end. No beginning or end is observed in it. There is no attaining it and no not attaining

it. There is no hope for it and no striving. Therefore space was made by no one, and because it is unmade, it has no remedy. Likewise this very thing too, because there is no maker, is unmade, and so it has no remedy.

"Lord of Laṅkā, it is like this:

Whoever seeks the limit of space
Will not find it by seeking.
Whoever knows that there is room,
That one has found space.
One who traces the mind to the very nature of mind
Does not find it, for it has no root.
Whoever knows it arises without ground or root,
That one has found the very nature of mind."

Mind seeks mind, yet mind does not find mind.
Who would search for the depth and root of mind?
Who would mark off the center and the edge of mind?
How could it be found by seeking?
How could mind point out mind?
Is mind said to have any substance?
By what could the substance of mind be made?
The awakening mind is no thing, yet emanates things.
What, who, is this great freedom from directions?
Being free of one direction, it is free of all directions.
It has passed beyond the domain of investigation.
If one realizes it as it is, that is suchness.

Mind seeking mind finds a certain warmth.
If one finds that warmth, it is the awakening mind.
It is anything at all, and whatever it is, it is fine.
That itself is the supreme meaning of the Dharma.
Therefore this nature of reality of saṃsāra
Does not exist as two;
The suchness of saṃsāra
Is taught in scripture to be the nature of reality.
The illusion of delusion in saṃsāra
And the illusion of utter purity and purification, these two,
Sentient beings and buddhas, though they are different,
Do not exist at all apart from suchness.

For example, from a single cloth as the material,
Transformed by the condition of dyes,
Though the colors are varied and different,
How could they exist apart from the cloth itself?
So these sentient beings and those with wisdom,
Ripened from false thought and from right thought,
From a single cause transformed by conditions,
Appear as two, awareness and ignorance.

The suffering of saṃsāra is like a dream;
As when, with a great breath, one wakes from a dream,
All is great bliss, the awakening mind,
Appearing as all-pervading and all-encompassing like space.
All that is imagined as coming from what is adventitious
Is conditioned; because it is unborn,
Suchness pervades and encompasses it all,
Great self-arisen wisdom, without effort.

The eighth section begins.

Lord of Laṅkā, of this very thing
There are seven roots that ascertain that it is so.
If one examines them and realizes it as it is,
That is the full ascertainment of it.
The continents and mountains, together with the encircling oceans,
Are seen clearly from the very summit of Meru.
Having found that, all the categories of vehicles,
The great suchness itself, are seen clearly.

The king of light in the world
Is the sun, majestic and bright.
Clearly illuminating all phenomena completely,
That itself is the great all-illuminating one.
Space, which gives great room,
As it makes room for the four great elements,
So by this very gathering of the secret
All the expressions of what is expressed are clearly explained.

Whoever obtains the secret of the word
Does not depend on any other person.
If one fully comprehends the secret essence,

One need not seek it in any speech or utterance.
The elements together with their continua
Arise and appear from the state of space.
Likewise all that arises as speech and utterance
Arises from that profound expanse itself.

All the categories of what is to be done for the aim
Are gathered into the gradual accomplishment of the result.
Though they are spoken of in great number and at length,
All of them are gathered into suchness.
Just as the clear heart of a mirror
Shows the reflection of a face,
So by that very mirror of the Dharma
The nature of everything is made clear.

Because the root of all is self-arisen,
Its nature is not contrived in any way.
Because the awareness that knows all never sets,
With the appearance of luminosity one sees in all directions.
Because everything is gathered into that itself,
It comes down to the essential nature of no thing.
Because all are one in suchness,
There is no convention of making them two.

Because the cause is primordially complete as the result,
It is free from both hope and fear: that is suchness.
Because there is no thing to be discarded,
How could there be anything to be taken up?
Already seen, already trained, already done,
Desire already fulfilled, conduct already practiced;
Likewise, since things are already accomplished,
It comes from the very finding of that.

The imagined appears when everything is void;
By being applied to everything, it is able to perform its function;
With doubt cut off, it appears in harmony.
In brief, it is just three;
In general, it comes down to just two;
Definitively, it is nothing but one.

Everything is gathered here, and arises from this.
If one knows this root of all,
Everything too is uncontrived, just as it is.
That suchness is the sūtra of all.

Everything appears as an illusion, without any basis.
Being without attachment, the mind is not disturbed.
In the state of space there is no intrinsic nature.
Because it cannot be examined, it is free from things.
There is nothing other than the essence itself,
Which shines forth as a stream of manifold things.
Appearing as a lamp, it dispels darkness.
It has arisen from the wish-fulfilling jewel itself.
Being without birth and cessation, it is free from fear.
Not fixed as anything at all, it is undaunted.
When one comprehends it, one is free from all effort and striving.
In the domain of understanding there is no journeying.

In each and every word of the great suchness
The intent of all the Victors is transmitted.
Though one cut the three roots elsewhere,
The secret meaning arises from itself alone.
Whoever seeks it somewhere else
Has entered a path that goes astray,
Obscured by the obscuration of the darkness of conceptual thought.
Whatever is not aware is what is obscured.
Conceptual thought itself is the obstructor;
Obstructors arise from that very thing.
For one in whom conceptual thought has not arisen,
How could there be what is called a māra?

If one asks from what the māras arise,
They arise from constant striving.
From non-striving itself, māras do not arise.
"Why not strive?" That itself is the māra.
Likewise faults, deviations and obscurations
Arise from seeing them as equal to good qualities.
If there is no seeing them as equal to good qualities,
How could there be faults, deviations and obscurations?

That itself is fault, deviation and obscuration.

If that itself has not become manifest,
Then whatever one keeps that has come from the secret meaning,
Like a sick man keeping medicine without knowing how to use it,
One wanders in bad states, with no sure means.

Objects, signs and things,
Memories, thoughts, and all that is heard and seen,
Just as they move in the mind,
So in that very instant they appear.
Not abiding permanently, momentary,
Never setting, unattached, is the mind of great bliss.
Since apart from the expanse of mind
There is nothing whatsoever called other,
How could there be any deviation or obscuration to bring about?
Who would pursue deviation and obscuration as a goal?
By whom, and how, could deviation and obscuration be found?
Deviation and obscuration too are that very expanse.
By seeking, that too comes to rest in that.
One seeks elsewhere, yet it arises from that.
By looking, what is seen is not realized;
It is just like a rainbow in a dark cave.

Through the distinction of seeing suchness,
Whichever of the four actual modes of conduct one engages in,
One is not bound; it becomes a means of liberation.
All of it, trained therein, is the supreme state of the path.
Those who pursue the meaning
And wish to cut off deviation and obscuration completely,
Yogin heroes who would eliminate the extremes,
Seize whatever side they are attached to,
And by holding to that view of center and extremes
They are firm in their certainty about ritual.
All of them are indeed yogins,
Yet they are not joined in union with the genuine meaning.
Their conduct may be joined in union,
But with the genuine meaning they are not joined at all.
They are attached to partial views,

But to the ultimate meaning they are not attached at all.
They taste the flavor of adventitious actions,
But they do not taste the flavor of the nature of reality.
They speak of a selflessness free of sides,
But they are not free of partial views.
Through ascetic discipline they may vanquish thoughts,
But the thoughts of apprehended and apprehender they do not vanquish.
Yogins who conceive of center and extremes
Seek the gold of the genuine Middle Way
By the lamp of verbal expression.
Seize this monkey of conceptual desire,
And tie up the thief, the cat.
Block every gold hole and skylight,
Tear down the piled clutter,
And if you open the king's treasury,
You become the owner of all that wealth complete.
One who seeks the path of the genuine Middle Way
Should abandon the five faults of conceptuality:
The mountain of coarse thought,
Signs, movement, sensation,
And the noticing of arising: these five kinds.
They are to be examined as follows.
Thought too is of two kinds,
Coarse and subtle.
Likewise signs are of two kinds, large and small;
Movement of two kinds, long and short;
Sensation, clear and unclear;
The noticing of arising, quick and slow.
These, obscuring the meaning,
Are great conceptions, great obstructors.
Why? Because the center itself is not seen.
By obscurations like darkness, overcast,
Thick gloom, banks of cloud,
And fog,
The center is not clear and is not seen.
These too are each of two kinds:
Darkness, and great pitch darkness,

As with utter gloom;
Complete overcast, and veiling;
Gloom, great and small, two kinds;
Thick great clouds, and wispy ones;
Fog, dense and patchy, two kinds.
The three lower states and the half-lit state,
The happy states of the four of desire,
The abodes of meditative concentration and the abodes of the four streams,
And falling into the state of śrāvaka, pratyekabuddha, or bodhisattva:
The pitch darkness that has become obscuration
Appears as the six distractions of signs:
Intrinsic nature, outer, inner, signs,
Attention, and negative tendencies.
These are held to be very clear.
Where the view of the Middle Way itself is vast,
The faults that obscure the path of the Middle Way
Arise in five kinds that obscure:
Through the force of the noticing of arising, of sinking and dullness, of grasping attachment,
Of rigid permanence and slack diffuseness,
There are the precipice, the gloom, cessation,
And nothing but perpetual nonexistence.
"These are faults of the Middle Way":
So the heroic yoga of the Middle Way holds.
Seeking the certain path of the Middle Way,
Keep to solitude continuously in a hermitage,
And with a mind that measures by the two kinds of valid cognition,
Cut off the trail of conceptual thought.
From what did earlier thoughts of existence and nonexistence arise?
On examination, thought arises from marks.
The mountain of thought is pacified,
And thereby one does not go to the three lower states.
If one asks from what thought arises,
It arises from signs themselves.
If signs are fully known as illusion,
The phenomena of signs are pacified,
And thereby one is not in the last of the desire realm.

And how is it with signs?
They too arise upon what occurs.
If mindfulness knows them as faults and as peace,
It dispels the faults of movement,
And one is not in the second of the desire realm.
Movement too, whatever it is, is likewise;
It too arises in that same way.
If it is known in that way,
It dispels the faulty sensation,
And one is not in the third of the desire realm either.
If it is scrutinized there in that way,
Whatever it is, it is only the outer and that itself.
If that is fully known as a fault,
Where could there be cessation and birth?
That is not in the fourth of the desire realm.
And as for where that arises from,
It comes about from the phenomena of mind.
If mind itself is fully known as illusion,
The phenomena of mind are pacified.
The aggregates are like reflections,
And mind is held to be like a mirage.
Freed from both extremes of existence and nonexistence,
One who knows this is not in the fifth of the desire realm.
Because one does not view mind itself as an existent thing
Or as something called nonexistent,
One does not fall into wonderment.
Because one has not become sunk in dullness,
It does not become a fault of meditative concentration.
Because one does not follow after perceptions,
One does not come to the abodes of sentient beings.
Because one sees the origin as the all-ground itself,
One is not in the state of peace either.
Because one does not view peace as peace,
How could one be in the state of a pratyekabuddha?
Because it is not mere cognition either,
One is not a bodhisattva there either.
In the Middle Way of emptiness and equality,

Because there is no division into separate, distinct things,
One does not train through the sequence of the grounds.
The Middle Way itself is beyond partial views and extremes.
On that very absence of intrinsic nature,
Within mind itself, instant by instant,
One should be mindful, unwavering and continuous.
When one rests in equipoise on it in this way,
The experiences of the signs of progress arise as follows:
Warmth, signs of progress, miracles,
Higher perceptions, and wisdom arise.
Warmth is stirring and attainment;
The signs of progress are arising and stability;
Miracles are arising and completion;
And where all awareness is clear,
There all aims are fulfilled.
It is like darkness clearing,
Light dawning, and the sky,
Seeing everywhere, and everything being clear.
Therefore, through its distinction,
The darkness of attachment to anything is dispelled.
Just as the wind sweeps away the clouds,
By a yoga of a single instant
That realm of darkness is swept away.
Just as when a lamp dispels the darkness
That very place becomes illuminated,
So if one knows it in an instant,
The darkness of long-held attachment is dispelled.
Those who know it
Have opened the door to suchness itself,
And likewise, since they possess that eye,
Seeing and hearing are composed into four chapters of words.
Since they stand on that ground, look to that.
If one does not possess that eye,
Then with words without limit or end,
Whatever conventions one may state about it,
One cannot distinguish the focus of the certain and the uncertain.
Wild fools whose minds follow after words

Are not the ground or path of training.
Whatever hundreds of thousands of words they may speak,
This is not to be spoken to others.
If anyone speaks it,
That is false speech, a thief of the vajra word.

He falls into the vajra hell from which there is no release.
If deceitful pretenders and hypocrites,
Without having opened the strength of a mind of certainty,
Led along by words and letters,
Teach a path that is uncertain,
Then, more than taking the lives of all living creatures,
Heavier still is teaching an uncertain Dharma.
Therefore, in the equality of extremes and center,
Whoever enters that bliss all at once,
Whether the time of abiding in yoga is long or short,
Whether there is radiating out or not,
Whenever nothing is left outside equality,
If one rests there in it just so,
Suchness itself appears immediately.
If one does not stir from it,
One does not go to the city of appearances.
If one is not attached to it in that way,
How could one go to non-appearance?
Because suchness itself has become manifest,
They are not in the state of peace.
When the extremes of existence and nonexistence are cut,
That is the very yoga beyond extremes.
"Here is the supreme certainty":
Those who make such a claim
In that which is without hope or fear
Surely appear as deviation and obscuration itself.
Why? Because they distinguish center and extremes.
If there is a center, extremes too arise by their nature;
If there is no center, extremes too are naturally absent.
Within that very distinguishing of center and extremes
Is suchness itself, free of extremes and center.

Not abiding, not taking up, not distinguishing,
It is nothing whatsoever, without seeing or hearing.
Distinguishing nothing, free of anything to be done,
It is free of the conventions of appearance and non-appearance.
The inconceivable nature of reality:
Rest in it as unthought suchness.
All inconceivable phenomena
Are nothing other than unthought suchness.
The grounds, the liberations, and so forth,
The dharmakāya, awakening, the side of the white,
All of these, with respect to the inconceivable,
Have become great deviations and obscurations.
The austerity of the great one hard to surpass
Is just unfabricated suchness alone.
It is hard to surpass for countless victors.
Whatever grasping there is regarding the formless is a deviation.
This ground of the Great All-Pervading Expanse
Is primordially untraversed, naturally arrayed.
There is nothing whatever not encompassed by this ground.
Whoever here arranges grounds and traverses them deviates.
Likewise, in the primordially arising awareness of that,
Whoever wishes distinctions to arise in stages
Is simply deluded here,
And has surely parted from the self-arisen.
In what has no object of thought and no reference,
The yogin of Great Equanimity,
Although it is simply just as it is,
Secludes the body, contrives the mind, and enters the place of deviation.
In that great total liberation,
Although it is certain there is no bondage or liberation,
Whoever here is bound by austerity and conceptions
Deviates from great liberation itself.
From the very beginning it is simply unfabricated;
Whatever abides is just suchness itself.
How could there be a place of deviation in it?
Deviation and obscuration too are just suchness.

When this had been discussed, the Lord of Laṅkā and the other beings of inferior bodies were completely freed from whatever bonds they had, and their doubts of hope and striving were cut off.

This concludes the fifty-fourth chapter, the teaching of the mirror of all phenomena, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then the Lord of Laṅkā, the bodhisattva, the Great Being, asked the Lord of Secrets fully about the question of the root: "O Lord of Secrets, what is that which is called the root of all phenomena? How should it be fully understood?"

When he had asked this, the Lord of Secrets said: "O Lord of Laṅkā, this excellent question is good; it is very, very good. That which is called the root of all phenomena: the root refers to bodhicitta. It should be fully understood as follows: it should be known as the nature of reality of the minds of all buddhas and the nature of reality of the minds of all sentient beings. It appears as the two, darkness and light.

"Lord of Laṅkā, it was like this. When the Blessed One, the Lord of the Supreme Secret, stayed for an instant in the secret abode called Endowed with Lotuses, the emanated womb of Uṣṇīṣa Universal Monarch, in the palace of the supreme secret, at that time, on that occasion, countless holy beings were cutting their doubts about the supreme secret of suchness, making their requests, hesitating to ask, and departing again with their doubts cut off. Having gathered in that assembly, I said this to the Blessed One: 'Blessed One, we have not seen and have not apprehended that root of all phenomena called the heart of awakening. We have not truly found it, and we have not known it with certainty. Since it is not reached by traversing, where is it? Where should it be sought? What is it? What is it called? Where is it lost? Blessed One, please teach it in this very instant of time. Sugata, please teach it.'

"When I had asked this, the Blessed One said: 'Great Being, that root of all phenomena called the heart of awakening is not seen because of obscuration, is not apprehended because it is nonexistent, is not found because it is profound, is not known because it is difficult, is not reached because it is swift, and is not encompassed because it is vast. It exists in the realm of darkness. It is to be sought in the three cities. It is the limbs, the sūtra, and the root. It refers to the essence, suchness. It is lost in the realm of darkness. Therefore, Great Being, in order to dispel this darkness, you should become skilled in its intrinsic nature. Likewise you should become skilled in its essence, its

characteristics, its limbs, its duration for as long as it lasts, its actions, the synonyms of darkness, its examples and so forth, and the means of dispelling it. You should apply yourself diligently to this. It should be known as being of one part with those who belong to the realm of darkness.'

"When he had said this, I said: 'Blessed One, from what did this darkness arise? What is the intrinsic nature of this darkness? What is the essence of this darkness? What is the characteristic of this darkness? How many limbs does this darkness have? What is the root of this darkness? How long does this darkness remain? What does this darkness obscure? How many varieties of this darkness are there? With what is this darkness concordant? Where does this darkness gather thickly? By what is this darkness dispelled? Why is it called darkness? Why does it thicken? Where is the net gathered? Please explain this. Sugata, please explain it.'

"When I had requested this, the Blessed One said: 'Great Being, the root of all phenomena comprised by darkness and light should be known as gathered without basis and without root.'

The sūtra that teaches this is as follows:

The heart from which the awakening of the buddhas
Arises and is brought forth is this very thing.
Like the heart of a lotus in bloom,
Its root lies in the mud of saṃsāra.
The rootless root
From which all roots arise
Is the root of all phenomena.
These three realms are gathered in it.
This Dharma is profound and hard to see,
And it cannot even be realized;
Even a being who dwells on the final ground
Does not see it.
This nature of reality, empty because it is nonexistent,
Is not apprehended as an existent thing either.
Apprehension and non-apprehension: the path of words is cut off.
It is nonconceptual and unborn.
Even if the clear-sighted, for endless time,
Searched everywhere, pervading all without remainder,
A thing to be called "this"

Would not be found and would never come to be found.
Even if the learned, for endless time,
Examined it with utmost intensity in every way,
Nothing whatever here is seen.
Even if the swift, for endless time,
Ran until they were utterly exhausted,
Still they have gone nowhere
From this very expanse; there is no going.
On the trunk of the unborn Dharma
Hang branches of four kinds,
And it ripens into the heart of unsurpassed awakening.
That is the tree of awakening, the origin of all.
Engaging with objects is the desire realm;
Grasping without manifestation is the form realm;
Without appearance yet uninterrupted is the formless itself.
That which comes from intention becomes action;
Whatever becomes the object is engagement itself;
Whatever is engaged, those are cognitions.
Though that object has become the realm of darkness,
In the realm of darkness that very thing appears.
Appearance, and the light of appearance arising,
Is the very heart of the root of birth and arising.
Knowing sides, one does not know it:
It is that very absence of essential nature.
Just as gold is lost in a dark cave,
So in the darkness, the pitch darkness of saṃsāra,
This bodhicitta, which is like precious gold,
Comes to be lost.
Those who have become of the realm of darkness
Arise as the very perception of darkness.
Whatever those of the realm of darkness know,
Even down to the merest subtle part,
Whatever the small-minded and childish
Deliberately discuss and speak of,
Speak of this to all the intelligent,
And know it to be for the sake of the foolish.
This too appears fully as follows:

The limbs, the sūtra, and the root
Are opening, releasing, and bringing forth.
What are renowned as the six limbs,
The six of seeing, hearing, feeling, experiencing, touching, and knowing,
Are the limbs that cut off arising and engaging.

Lord of Laṅkā, if you ask what the four sūtras are, they are these: the sūtra of the ground, the sūtra of reference, the sūtra of appearance, and the sūtra of engagement. That too is as follows:

The four sūtras, of ground, of reference,
Of appearance, and of engagement, are explained according to scripture.

Lord of Laṅkā, of these, the sūtra of the ground is as follows:

The childish hold the ground to be like this:
Formless, clung to as a name,
The very realm of nonexistence, simply that.
It arises as the essence of all cognition;
The knowable itself appears as the object.
The cause that brings all things forth
Is primordially and naturally unborn,
Unfabricated, luminous of itself,
Uncompounded because it has no cause or condition.
Uninterrupted, toward every object
It arises together with cognition, yet unclear.
All-pervading, equanimous, insubstantial,
Nonconceptual, free of analysis.
In the very suchness of that nonconceptuality,
However many earlier and later moments there are,
Like a river with its continuous flow,
Is a continuum arising, with birth and cessation.
Not cut off into a single thing,
It does not appear as separate classes;
So how could there be any distinguishing of particulars,
Saying "this" and "this"?
Phenomena comprised by the two conventions
Are each the whole of everything:
Going to all, entering all, joining with all,

Aware of things in their variety, yet not knowing them as divided.
It is movement itself and arrangement,
Full experiencing, cutting off, and grasping of that.
For one endowed with the five, present before it,
It is equal toward all.
Whatever clings grasps that and lets nothing go.
Like space that gives room,
It gives room for all phenomena to abide and arise;
It is not generating and the rest, and it is taking up.
Conditions are not endowed with two;
In that very uncertainty alone
It abides in everything.
Conditions are whatever meets with it.
While phenomena are one at the root,
By the force of their continuum there are two kinds,
Known as the ground and the support,
In which the distinction of delusion and knowing appears.
In the ground, going everywhere, deluded about all,
There is no dwelling place for clinging to aspects.
The support is appearance joined with the ground,
And the changeless, utterly pure abode with nothing to be sought.
Each of these has two, cause and effect.
Whatever is each earlier one
Is the cause of the ripening of each later one.
Thus it arises in saṃsāra everywhere.
By the force of the continuum of the five supports,
There appear five yogas, five antidotes,
Five examples of ripening, likewise the examples of application,
Five occasions, five paths, likewise the grounds,
Five sets of five dwelling places, five times,
Five abodes, and five kinds of culmination.
Divided here, they are fifty-six;
Because they appear as complete, they are explained as five.
Because it has become the ground of all phenomena,
Through mistaken conditions it appears as saṃsāra.
If the meaning of the intrinsic nature just as it is
Is seen with certainty, that is nirvāṇa.

From the all-ground and whoever knows it
The heap of phenomena, the three existences, arise.
From its arising the root takes on variety.
It is known as the expanse, the source, and the cause,
Emptiness, and without characteristics,
Suchness, the unmistaken,
The unfabricated, that which is not other;
It is known as samādhi, as thought, as emptiness,
Insight, calm abiding, liberation,
The Middle Way free of extremes, without anything apprehended,
Without apprehender, without annihilation, without permanence,
Unborn, unceasing, without thought,
Without conceptuality, without signs,
Likewise without self and without other,
Without going and without coming,
Stainless, without coming together or parting,
Without aggregates, without elements, without sense sources,
Without objects, without karma, without cause and effect,
The unborn heart, without awakening.
Buddha, Dharma, and bodhicitta:
That is unborn and unceasing;
That is like space.

The expanse of phenomena itself is the dharmakāya;
It is known as nonconceptual wisdom.
Unarisen, from the very beginning it appears as intrinsic nature.
However long there is existence that takes up rebirth,
Whatever is cleared away, whatever arises and ceases,
Because the continuum of suffering is exhausted and burned away,
It definitely emerges through five occasions of change.
Formless and unseen, it is not existent.
If it existed, it would have become an object of seeing.
How could what has not become an object of seeing
Rightly be called existent?
The cause that arises without limit or end
Is insubstantial, the ground and support, essential nature itself;
Therefore distinct variety appears.

If this expanse did not exist, it would contradict everything.
If there were a single nonexistent thing,
Then grasping at sides too would be like that,
And one would never be liberated:
The knot of bondage would be there.
Whoever grasps at limits and views extremes
Does not see the limitless meaning.
Grasping at limits is like measuring height in the sky.
Liberation is taught to lie in limitlessness itself.
One who grasps at limits and wishes for liberation is not liberated.
Though sand is cultivated, it does not ripen into grain.
Though a crystal ball is transformed, it does not acquire depth.
Though a glass bead is transformed, it is not a jewel.
Though earth and stone are mixed, they cannot be made one.
In the ground of the lightning flash there is no darkness.
Vermilion dust and refined gold can never be one.
That a person should make offerings to himself is impossible.
The earlier and later currents of a river do not meet.
Where phenomena accord, their kinds are infinite;
Therefore it is praised as suchness.
If that itself did not exist, then in all things
How could there be any taking up of it?
If that itself did not exist, then once the continuum was blocked,
When, at some point, it rises again,
That from which it arose is from nothing.
If what is absent and that which is absent are not two,
From what would it rise, and what would it not become?
Likewise, when it comes to cease through something,
However many moments, it rises from there.
Therefore that itself is the ground of all,
Just like the body, and poison and medicine.
The five engagements are like dreams.
That being so, is this one,
Or is it something distinct?
Free of the essence of one and distinct,
Whether as shape or as color,
It is like turbid water and the water in milk.

So then, is that itself the stronger,
Or is this ground of it the stronger?
Unmoving and unchanging, yet moving and changing;
Unarisen, and likewise arising,
Just like the arising of space.
Beginning and end: no time is apprehended.
Unmistaken, unfabricated suchness,
The expanse where intrinsic nature appears everywhere,
Unarisen intrinsic nature, clear from the very beginning.
What is called the ground, or its continuum,
Is the potent root of the birth and arising
Of all streams of cognition, set as the ground,
That very cause from which variety arises.
Clouds that move in a clear sky,
From the time that even a tiny measure has arisen,
Are called mist, vapor, banks of cloud, and overcast;
Before the moment of their arising,
It is called the clear sky itself appearing.
Likewise, that itself is set as the ground;
Because they are alike, it appears there,
And the particular distinction of each is only that.
From that very movement of it
The hosts of engagements appear as its display.
Because the potent root increases,
In whatever and wherever, whatever is afflicted
Appears as signs, grasping, moving, stirring, agitating;
In whatever appears of itself, that is clearly aware.
Wherever it looks and whatever it grasps,
From that continuum this arises there.
Whatever feels, whatever knows, whatever knows that,
Is the very thing that is frightened, terrified, afraid.
A mirror, a burning glass, and the arising of fire, these three:
Whatever they meet, that arises accordingly.
A mirror, waves on a lake, and waves of earth, these three:
However long that continuum lasts, there are the noticings of arising.
Through that very cause there are five natures,
Like tongs that hold fire, that hold that, that hold a leaf.

Through that itself, in that continuum,
Whatever is clung to, it does the grasping of that.
White cloth and the like:
They gather under the power of whichever door.
That continuum depends on that itself;
It is just whatever has been imprinted.
Snow, grime, and the like:
Through "the like," they appear as those very things.
Whatever arises in that continuum,
Those too are just those very things.
From milk, water, and seed,
Because they are unlike, that is the sign.
From that continuum of that itself,
That too appears in that way.
Whatever those things are that abide,
What arises there is just that.
Quick ripening and timely ripening are not two times;
It is the increase and decrease of large and small seeds.
Just as clouds, haze, and darkness
Obscure a substance so that it is not seen,
So by the overcast darkness of its continuum
The very thing to be seen is not seen.
In the first, the second, and the later,
Clarity, cessation, and distinctness appear.
Because that itself goes to all,
The one takes on distinct variety.
From the display of that itself come the six engagements,
And re-engagement too is from that itself,
Just like a stream of rain or a mirage.
Through the power of an eye disease, with respect to objects,
They are not distinct; they are mere essence.
From its mingling as one with whatever,
The magical display distinguishes it and takes them up.
Arisen from that itself, it distinguishes them.
Though whatever joins here does not appear,
Through the power of something, distinctness appears.
From that, that arises; from that itself,

Likewise those arise.
A foul smell arises: whose smell is it?
Clinging to what is absent in something,
From that itself, unlike and not one,
That itself is other, and that continuum other.
That whose essence is one
Also changes according to place and occasion.
For one whose habitual tendencies are utterly pure,
Just as everything is clear through clarity,
Whose continuum is cleared, all-pervading and vast,
"That itself is the utterly pure Middle Way":
So those whose domain is darkness hold.
Darkness too arises in that itself.
The intrinsic nature and essence of darkness,
Its characteristics, limbs, and root,
Its abode, obscuration, and particular phenomena,
Where, by what, for what, and what:
These should be definitely distinguished.

Lord of Laṅkā, these are called the sūtra of the ground. The phenomena of darkness were taught with a view to those whose domain is darkness, who are swollen with karma.

Lord of Laṅkā, if you ask what the sūtra of reference is, it is this:

The form realm, grasping that, is a single abode.
Grasping that, that itself looks at that.
Grasping that, making it that, it has darkness.
Grasping sides, sideless, aspect and one;
Uncertain, going in general, not apprehending two;
Without variety, it grasps that as self.
Stainless, without grasping, with nothing else like it,
Its engagement without support, without distinction,
In the three times there is no grasping of it.
Through grasping that as that in that,
There is the realm of attachment to the two, form and name.

Lord of Laṅkā, if you ask what the sūtra of appearance is, it is this:

The desire realm, engaging that, following that, abiding:
It is the third. Those are
That itself arising, its support, and immediately after it:
The five objects of desire and the two phenomena.
All activities, and always one;
The three classes, and the meeting, holding the classes;
Engaging that is seeking, cutting, and bringing down.
Unceasing, wherever, the continuum pervades and engages.
In the three times and three occasions there is no engagement.

Variety itself is planted in that.
Its engagement, too, is of two kinds:
The five, and the common and the particular.

These are knowing objects, knowing characteristics, knowing time, knowing the continuum of moments, engaging in actions, and fully experiencing their results.

Six, two, five, three, twelve, and one:
All of these bring about engagement in that.

Lord of Laṅkā, it is like this:

The Lord of the Supreme Secret,
In the delight of the supreme secret,
With his intention explained this domain at length.
First, conceiving the seven conceptions:
Having signs, and being signs,
Seeking engagement by its own nature,
Discriminating, and afflicted,
And conceptuality other than these.
Second, the three proximate minds:
Of the right kind, not of the kind, and neither.
Third, the conditions that delude and that embolden:
Whatever arises here becomes the support of the faculties.
Of the consciousness that arises from a faculty,
Concordant with it, and concordant with its arising:
Weak, and unaccustomed,
Sharp, and beyond measure.
Fourth, wandering of the life force, agitation of the heart,
Imbalance, fear and fright,

Being struck in the vital points, and possession by another.
Fifth, the onset of illness, weakness,
Fatigue, excess, and gloom,
Fixation, habit, and change through other conditions.
Of five and two, the first is what arises outward:
Signs, and whatever here is cleared away,
Whatever, when released, has all its entanglements exhausted,
Destroyed through the condition of planetary influence,
And changing through the conditions of others.
Ceasing in a single moment and its clearing:
That too, engaging there, is just that.
The second, engaging in making two:
The preliminaries, thinking "This is it,"
The seventh, generating and applying effort,
Sets all arisings in motion.
The third, bringing about freedom from attachment:
Weary of the object and place of attachment,
Separated by others, and interrupted,
It is brought about by correct attention.
The fourth, degenerated through attachment,
Abiding firmly through deluded views:
Here, slight habituation,
Aspects, indications, and signs,
Because the mind that does that degenerates and so forth, there is change;
Taking it up correctly and engaging therein,
Being obscured, and being seized by others.
The fifth, cutting off the continuum of meaning:
Having the strength of clarity and of wrongness,
Finding companions concordant in enjoyments,
Those who go on without breaking their continuum,
Not cutting off or turning back continually:
The wrong continuum persists and the continuum of meaning is cut off.
Of five and three, the first is linking,
Endowed with the continuum of meaning that turns back from that.
The second is of linking to rebirth:
In the phenomena of death there are two,
Timely and untimely. Of these,

For some there is untimely death,
Where those conditions are exhausted, or through other conditions.
Then, though there is a cause for long life,
The conditions for remaining long are incomplete.
The karmic conditions of not avoiding danger,
Excess, and what is unsuitable,
Pressing on what has not been cleared,
Not expelling what has long accumulated,
Blocking the flow so that it ceases,
Not relying on the respective antidotes,
Not knowing what suits through lack of habit,
Going at the wrong time, and faults of conduct.
Then one is endowed with three perceptions:
Endowed with meaning, with wrongness, or with equanimity.
Whatever meaning one is endowed with, there one goes.
Having relied on it before and remembering it,
Even if it is made clear by others,
It arises coarsely until then.
When perception moves subtly,
Turning back from that and endowed with equanimity,
What was relied on before arises;
Others cannot dispel it,
And even when urged one cannot remember.
Whoever is endowed with that goes to a happy destiny,
And does not experience
Even unbearable, fierce feelings.
At that time, whatever is seen,
What was never seen anywhere is seen.
Just as, through the condition of sunlight,
Light gradually arises,
So from the realm of darkness it becomes light.
Forms appear like a dream,
And various delightful things are seen.
Knowing all of that,
Here one leaves from the lower part;
The warmth fades upward,
And whatever emerges at the crown is happy.

Where one goes wrongly,
It is just the reverse of the above.
Through unbearable, fierce feelings,
Extremely sharp, unbearable pains,
Moving, stirring, unpleasant sounds, and grahas,
When one sees the appearances of delusion,
Those who were loving and the like
Appear as executioners and other unwanted figures.
Seeing terrifying forms of every kind,
Dust arises, the hair stands on end,
The limbs flail and clutch at the sky,
Excrement and urine are released, and the eyes roll back.
From the realm of light one has come into darkness.
Knowing all of that, one arises and falls;
Whatever arises at the end is unhappy.
Equanimity: either it is not clear through that,
Or it has not been made clear by others;
Unclear in both ways, it is equanimity.
Whatever one is endowed with, wherever one goes,
It is certainly just as one has become habituated.
Inclined toward habit, that is powerful.
Whatever one is unaccustomed to, even if made clear,
Ceases through the force of non-attachment.
If one is equally habituated to both,
Then whatever is clear first,
Or what has been made clear by others,
Does not turn back, and the other does not engage.
Some equanimity changes;
Some does not change, and completion does not arise.
At the time when all transfer,
In the intervals before the occasion has come,
When the movement here is unclear,
Over a long time, through habituation,
Whatever one is attached to arises.
From that, through the power of that,
Knowing that it will cease to be here,
Aversion arises toward this very thing,

And one comes to engage with what is to come.
Overwhelmed by the fire of aversion,
The continuum of this abiding ceases,
And that attachment to what has not yet arisen,
The sevenfold intermediate state of the three existences,
Is the support for bringing about rebirth.
At that time the yogin
Likewise has great purpose in habituation to that.
At that time attachment does arise, but
Through the power of the meaning to which one has become habituated,
That attachment is overwhelmed,
Just as a person with skill
Overpowers those who have no strength.
In the yoga of the knowledge holders of awakening,
Whatever one is attached to does not arise.
The unbearable suffering of the vital points,
Except for the high and the low,
Occurs for all others,
Because there is no extreme danger or joy.

Only the two, great suffering and small:
Whatever ceases, ceases either all at once or by stages.
Having become habituated to that very thing, whatever has not ceased,
Being foremost, is clung to there and held dear.
The third of the three existences is the being of the intermediate seven:
Born miraculously, possessed of faculties, moving by the power of karma.
It is seen by those of like kind, and is not seen by others.
Great bliss, bliss, and suffering,
And so forth: wherever it is going to be born,
It takes on the shape of that, and it is unobstructed.
As for its body or its sphere of activity,
Those who have become stained
Are like black things in the black darkness of night;
All of them see all the others.
Those who are stainless
Are like white moonlight and white things;
These two are seen with the pure eye of their kind.

Its size is of the smallest measure:
An emanated form, the size of a five-year-old.
Until it has taken up a place of birth,
Its eye is like the eye of that state:
Unobstructed by anything, it sees those of equal fortune.
It is not like that for all.
The places of birth of those of equal fortune,
And their very abodes, it comes to see.
For those who are stained, the eye is clear downward;
Going head downward, they do not see others.
For the stainless it is clear upward; the others likewise:
In whatever direction each faces, that alone appears.
The rest are just as above.
The one with the core of the being of the intermediate seven,
Until it finds its birth,
If it is delayed at the longest, remains for seven days.
If it is endowed with the conditions, there is no fixed time:
It transfers after one, two, or three days.
If it is not endowed with them, then after that
It remains there again for up to seven days.
If it exists but is not endowed with them,
Up to the end of seven weeks,
At each seventh day it changes,
And it remains there until that is complete.
When its stay there is exhausted,
It takes up a stay elsewhere;
However long that holds sway,
Once the seven sevens are complete, from then on
How could it possibly fail to take birth?
In the interval between what sets and what appears,
Because it abides for a moment, it is the intermediate state.
Being of seven days and of the nature of setting,
It is also called the setting existence.
Because it abides for up to seven days,
It is called the being of the intermediate seven.
Because it follows after scents and feeds on scents,
It is also called the gandharva, the one who approaches.

Because it arises in dependence on that,
It is also called the one arisen from that.
Because it holds the shape and form of its birth,
Having the manner of the former and the later,
And because it goes before birth,
It is also called the one manifestly produced.
Because it always hovers close around food,
It is also called the one who hovers near.
Because it is the interval between the two,
It is called the existence that links.
Because it possesses form,
It has no place in the formless realm.
The existence abiding there,
Toward the existence that ceased before,
Through habituation to attachment, aversion, and clinging
Toward the three, that, what is not that, and what is regarded with equanimity,
Just as it formerly clung to whatever it clung to,
At that time it delights in that.
The places where good and bad deeds were done in the former life,
Whatever lies in their valleys, that itself appears.
Seeing these like a dream,
What it sees becomes manifest as objects.
At that time, as when seeing illusory forms,
Omens arise through which its future is shown.
For one who is not endowed with the conditions for happiness,
If it dwells there and sets there,
The omens of arising in a lower state are these:
Of insects, worms and the like,
It sees the kind in which it will arise.
Sounds of clamor and thickets of reeds,
Dense forests and the like,
Groves of shrubs and various smells,
Mansions, pools, and massing clouds:
Signs of entering within arise.
For one who is pure here,
The omens of seeing its kind are these:
Peaceful places and pleasing sounds,

Delightful satisfaction of the senses,
Mansions and celestial palaces,
And pleasure groves in its field of vision:
Signs of arising appear.
Universal monarchs and the like,
Pure through purity, it sees that kind.
The core abiding there,
Because it clings with attachment to desire,
Follows wherever a scent arises,
To the place where scents of its own and not its own arise.
Clinging to that, it becomes satisfied,
And at the union, aversion arises toward it.
Through this, the continuum of the intermediate seven is cut off.
While it clings, it is exhausted there,
And through that very thing it is nourished;
From the core where it was nourished,
Various kinds of embodied beings appear.
Those born from the condition of warmth and from moisture take on that kind;
In a realm without that, it does not arise.
It is not absent, but is like motes in space.
The objects with which it is connected,
However far they may be by measure,
Its unobstructed eye reaches what it sees and feels.
Because it goes by the power of that,
It arrives at the very moment of knowing.
For it there is no convention of far.
Why? Because it is all-pervading and immaterial,
Not the sphere of embodied beings.
Some, through the power of what they cling to,
See those of a kind that appears concordant
Wherever they find what is compatible.
Right there, roaming about in that place,
Thought and analysis take hold around it,
And through clinging, the nature of clinging rises up.
Through its power, deluded there,
It sees things in an inverted way,
And they appear mistakenly, like an illusion.

Wherever that person finds a compatible meeting,
There that appears clearly to it.
If it takes the side of staying,
Desire attached to arising comes about.
The reverse of that is likewise:
It wishes to change its abode and be parted from its place.
Arising is likewise:
Where it is not compatible, it sees that.
For it, likewise, by the power of that,
Apart from the mere signs of abiding and arising,
Nothing else appears.

It sees that, and having become caught up in it,
Displeasure toward it arises.
Through that its continuum ceases,
And, just as whatever seizes whatever,
Through clinging it takes hold of that existence.
It is guarded by its own materiality.
The being of the intermediate seven bound for a lower destiny,
Because habituation to clinging to killing has piled up,
When it dwells in whatever place it is,
Killing and the like appear to it.
As soon as it sees that,
Recognizing it through its former habituation,
It runs there thinking, "I must kill."
Seeing the birthplace in the place of killing,
Because it undertakes the deeds of killing and the like,
It is caught up in them and aversion arises.
Through that the continuum of the intermediate seven ceases,
And taking on a lower body, it experiences the afflictions.
Thus the being of the intermediate seven
Of the various realms in which it will arise,
In the place where it is to arise,
Goes toward the objects it was habituated to as they appear.
Because it is caught up in conduct of aversion toward them,
By the power of aversion its continuum ceases.
When that appearance has arisen, it takes up what had not arisen.

For the four birthplaces there are four ways of entry:
Entering, dwelling, and emerging with full awareness;
Likewise entering and dwelling aware, but emerging unaware;
Entering aware, but dwelling and emerging unaware;
And entering, dwelling, and emerging all unaware.
The one standing near, mingled with grasping,
Takes birth when the three places are in accord.
If, through the birthplace, the seed, and karma,
There are not the three obstacles of faults,
Everything ripens in the womb.
Moreover, at the time when intense attachment
Of the one source for the other arises,
At the climax the essence that is held comes forth.
Then likewise, from both of them,
A single drop of essence each
Comes forth without fail.
That very thing mingles there,
And it gathers as warmth settles;
The all-encompassing one enters there.
That which has no essence,
Why does it grasp at an entity?
It is just as ḍākinīs, by the power of desire,
Hold to an image drawn with the juice of the earth:
It holds to an image of attachment to what does not exist.
By the power of that all-encompassing one,
Without wavering, the substance ripens and is nourished.
In whichever direction those stages of the embryo lie,
Its very entry there is the support of the heart.
Right after it abides, it is endowed with equanimity,
And at that juncture it becomes two.
In the phases when the six sense bases are desired,
At the time when it is clear and easy,
It has become well nourished.
Likewise, at the time it is curled up, it is shaped,
And it enters from the cord, and is nourished by that.
Whatever five there are, it is produced by these elements;
What it relies on as one is the elements themselves;

That itself, having entered the support, is the core.
In the last two the faculties and elements arise.
Like the elements, it grows, becomes solid, gathers, ripens, and holds together,
And the limbs separate and come forth.
Through whatever causes, its complexion changes.
If it is the abiding kind, like the side that accords, it is on the left;
If the arising kind, wrinkled and still, facing the other way, on the right.
While it abides, the time of abiding is eight,
And as with the early embryonic stages, the limbs become firm.
For that reason, then, the elements,
The faculties, and the sexual organs mature.
At that time of complete perfection,
The wind of the weeks arises,
Which brings about its affliction.
Because the wind belonging to the elements arises,
It becomes restless and moving,
And it is turned around, according to the way existence arises.
The time they remain there
Is thirty-eight weeks;
By that, all is completed.
When its six roots and four are complete,
It emerges without fail.
The fifth: the four principles of arising,
From which comes the very source of yoga;
These are four sets of four,
Renowned as the sixteen principles,
In which all of birth and self are gathered.
These are births brought about by karma.
That all of them do all of this
Is karma, slow and swift:
So it is seen by those whose sphere is darkness.
For those obscured, entangled by karma,
With that intent it was thus taught in the sūtra.
Lord of Laṅkā, these are to be known as the Sūtra of Appearance.
Lord of Laṅkā, furthermore, what is the Sūtra of Entry? It is as follows:
That which desires abides in three ways;

It opens space, and one stream produces another stream;
It divides into separate classes and exercises power;
Endowed with that itself, it is just that;
It is mere arising in the nature of whatever;
It is not anything at all: that is the middle.
Totally uncontrived, its nature simple,
Three, three, two, and the three conditions, with time:
That is the complete desire realm.
Lord of Laṅkā, these are called the four sūtras; one should know that through them that is completely unravelled.
Lord of Laṅkā, what then are the three roots? They are these: the root of entities, the root of expression, and the all-encompassing root. Lord of Laṅkā, of these, the root of entities is that from nothing whatsoever anything at all appears. The root of expression is that from nothing whatsoever it becomes anything at all. The all-encompassing root is that from nothing whatsoever there is awareness itself of anything at all. Lord of Laṅkā, these are the roots; through them everything is brought forth.
Lord of Laṅkā, these are as follows:
What the King of Dharma taught,
Through mind, through mouth, and through answers to questions, the three,
Called meaning, scripture, and tantra,
Is renowned here as three.
Those who have thoughts about this,
Thinking, "How does the single speech of the King of Dharma
Appear as three, called tantra, scripture, and the ultimate?"
Whoever has such thoughts and asks this,
He himself knows, and to make it clear,
With that intent he taught the three distinctly.
That is the context and what follows from the context.
What abides in the mind of the Person,
Not having come forth from the mouth, is the ultimate itself.
When that is indicated through the transformation of speech,
It is the scriptural word of the Person, the king.
When answers to questions unfold in subtle detail,
It is the tantra word of the Person, the king.
Great in means, small in hardship, immeasurable in meaning,
Easy to practice, hard to fathom, the profound instruction;

That very certainty, just that,
Uncorrupted and determined just as it is, is scripture.
The tantras of action, with their bases of rules and narratives,
And the tantras with the great conceptions, their branches and connections:
They appear as three, yet come down to one.
In the nature of the single indivisible mode,
The expressive power and the manifold appearances
Are one, entirely without aspects.
Thus that supreme secret explained.
For those who are entangled by karma,
Whatever side of darkness is explained here,
Don the armor and make it known.
From the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas, this is the fifty-fifth chapter, teaching the sphere of darkness of the root of all phenomena.
Then the Lord of Laṅkā, the bodhisattva, the Great Being, again put a thorough question to the Lord of Secrets: "O Lord of Secrets, with regard to the root, what is the sphere of the totally pure appearance of what?" When he had asked this, the Lord of Secrets said, "Lord of Laṅkā, that question of yours about total purity is excellent! It is most excellent!"

Lord of Laṅkā, moreover it is like this. When the Blessed One, the purity of essential nature, was naturally dwelling in the buddhafield called Totally Pure, then, at that time, he regarded whatever appeared to the immeasurable victors, whose intentions were completely gathered together, as the sphere of total purity. That appearance of suchness I shall discuss thoroughly and without error.
Lord of Laṅkā, it is like this:
As gold lost in a dark pit appears of itself by the light of a lamp,
So mind, lost in the darkness of ignorance, appears of itself.
This root of the complete gathering of intentions
Was taught by gathering the intentions of those who passed in former ages.
The root of all phenomena is gathered in this very mind.
Mind itself, transformed, appears as the five wisdoms.
Since it is definitively placed in that very meaning,
The transformation of mind itself is also just that.
Since the five wisdoms are complete in it,

The five wisdoms too are gathered into one.
When the nature of mind is realized just as it is,
Primordially buddha, unmistaken and uncontrived,
It is called the gathering, since one has attained the ground that evenly pervades.
At that stage the views of existence and nonexistence come to an end.
How the suchness of mind is,
And whether its present continuity exists or not, should be known.
How, here, should one look at suchness?
Is it appearing or not appearing?
Then is it buddha or not buddha?
Apart from it, is there a buddha or not?
Decide through deliberation how it is to be posited.
Even when, having ascertained it thus, it has become so,
Do not suppress the adventitious path of action, but practice it likewise.
Therefore the nature of all is gathered in that very thing.
If one rests there without thought and without reference point,
Whatever appears and whatever exists is signless and one;
That very thing, without arising and ceasing, is primordially buddha.
Since that very thing is undistracted, even without clearing anything away,
One rides upon completion as a whole and has attained the very ground from the beginning.
Even when that very thing becomes clear in experience, as experience and warmth,
In order to show that it does not conflict with the doors of all phenomena,
One blocks the doors to deviation through possessing the three samādhis,
And through the three great warmths one experiences the sacred intention.
Therefore, by finding the experience of the three samādhis,
The fruit, the nature of the six perfections, is complete.
Rest mind itself, uncontrived, in the state of space.
Then, whatever memories and thoughts arise,
Since they are resolved by uncontrived suchness itself,
It is naturally uncontrived and lightly luminous:
So it is praised in the Guhyasamāja.
Undistracted, without arising and ceasing, that itself is samādhi;
The meaning of the three yogas is complete at that point.
Therefore, through the lineage of intention of the spiritual friend of all,

One should know mind itself as the ultimate meaning.
Since that itself is Vajrasattva,
Whoever sees this sees his face.
Since from seeing that onward one is sacred,
One is therefore renowned as the spiritual friend of all.
Whoever has seen such a meaning
Should look at nothing else, and be devoted to that.
Then, ascertaining that what is to be done is done and there is nothing to seek,
That is called totally pure self-arisen wisdom.
Thereby, whatever pleasure and pain of grasping and attachment arise,
One affirms that the two accumulations are complete without being accumulated.
Nonconceptual samādhi, with signs completely purified,
Dharmatā made manifest, great qualities unceasing:
Since the two obscurations are purified and the great accumulations complete,
One attains the grounds with all their factors in accord.
This is the profound intention and conduct of the all-gathering;
It is not the sphere of everyone.
Just as one who sees sees its meaning,
So, because the deluded do not see it,
The darkness of clinging from the beginning is hard to clear away.
Though it is said that there are distinctions between ground and ground,
When the nonduality of seeing and not seeing is clear,
The sacred intention is certainly spontaneously present.
What difference is there in nature between empty and unborn?
Existence and nonexistence, permanence and annihilation, action and seeking, and the rest,
All primordially abide as spontaneously present.
Whatever cause and fruit appear, whatever exists,
They appear as the ornament of dharmatā, of suchness.
That itself, unobstructed, is the mode of total completion.
Even those who say that higher and lower and the rest, the two, faults and qualities,
And cause and effect are clear as separate,
Through mere conditions of seeing and not seeing, of hope and effort,
All come down to one in suchness.

Just as in it there is primordially no meeting and parting,
Whatever unequal and equal spheres appear,
There is nothing at all that is not this very suchness.
That itself, in that, unites the completion of the accumulations, means, and wisdom.
When this is ascertained, the gathered intentions of the sacred ones
Are gathered in that ultimate, uncontrived mind itself.
Since the nature of mind is unmade and self-arisen,
It is called samādhi, free of all reference points.
For that mind of awakening ascertained in this way,
Since there is no place to travel to and no form of view,
Signs, omniscience, faults and qualities are primordially absent too.
Both Great Vehicles are complete, all doubts are cut,
And it is resolved in the unexcelled Great Perfection.
Therefore the subtle aspect that distinguishes extremes and middle,
In that very distinguishing of extremes and middle, all is one;
For the sake of a distinctly exalted meaning it is called the all-gathering.
As for objects outer and inner, such as desire and action, held as causes,
Abiding as mere signs of joy,
And those through whose conduct phenomena are gathered into mind,
Even those who say that the two extremes are naturally clear,
Because they are seen as resolved, do not exist or not exist apart.
If one holds that they exist, that is a great fault.
Therefore, whatever separate meditative concentrations appear,
They are mere delusive appearances, the sphere of childish beings.
The sacred and the inferior are like an illusion and a mirage;
Since by nature they are without arising and ceasing, they are like space.
There, in the all-gathering, there is no seeing for anyone.
Some hold that not appearing at all is faultless;
That is a delusion, and so it is not acceptable.
Seen and unseen appearances have no intrinsic nature.
The profound intention and conduct of the secret all-gathering,
When self-arisen self-awareness appears directly,
Is called the seeing of self-arisen wisdom itself.
When the sacred intention is seen in this way,
All thought and attachment are cleared, beyond the objects of seeing:
It is resting without action, without appearance, without seeking.

With no object of reference, unattached to phenomena, it is abandoned.
The expanse where what is seen and felt, the path of bliss, lies open without limit:
Whatever changes and whatever appears has never moved from that anywhere.
Its reasoning is made clear by suchness itself.
The all-gathering does not examine its meaning.
All phenomena appear as self-arisen, self-aware wisdom.
Their meaning is unborn, unarisen, unborn,
And even what is designated as cause and fruit is primordially absent.
Whoever knows it thus has completed the two accumulations in that very knowing.
To rest evenly in the meaning with a contrived mind is itself a fault:
It conflicts with that, and does not meet with it.
But letting the certainty that comes from that pervade
Does not conflict with it; that itself is certainty.
At the time of self-awareness, there is no duality in it.
That very essence is spontaneously present as cause and fruit.
At that time ultimate experience and warmth are complete.
Appearing and not appearing, permanence and annihilation, and the rest:
Through certainty in experience and warmth one reaches the depth of the meaning,
And this doubt about separate positions is cut.
If, firmly devoted to that very thing, with certainty and a stable mind,
One settles the view through connection with it,
One who has a sacred rank in an inferior body
Is a mighty lord, so bow to him with respect.
With the five great provisions free of deceit,
Regard him like the jewel on the crown of Indra.
The three words of the complete gathering of intentions
Should be made the confidence of the mind through faith and certainty.
Certainty in the meaning of the three words is found and becomes manifest.
The definitive meaning comes down to self-awareness alone.
When the Lord of Secrets had spoken thus, the Lord of Laṅkā and the other beings with inferior bodies came to a definitive settlement on the root of all phenomena.
From the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas, this is

the fifty-sixth chapter, teaching the sphere of pure appearance of the root of all phenomena.

Beginning the ninth section.

Then again the Lord of Laṅkā and the other bodhisattvas, great beings with inferior bodies, put a thorough question to the Lord of Secrets: "O Lord of Secrets, when we hear that you here, in what was set out as the ten categories of Dharma, said that one should leave the nature uncontrived, how should that be fully understood? What is the nature? In what way is it uncontrived? Of what is that the nature?" When they had asked this, the Lord of Secrets said:

"O friends with inferior bodies, the nature is that which does not change. Uncontrived means genuine. These are the nature of secret mantra, the nature of the view of it, the nature of not transgressing it, and the nature of conducting oneself accordingly.

"Friends, here the nature of secret mantra is as follows:

Because its nature is like space,
Free of conceptual thought, it does not conceive anything.
Likewise, because its nature is that of earth,
Its nature is that from which all arises.
Because it is like the nature of fire,
It makes all entities nonexistent.
Because it is like the nature of wind,
It clears away all moving dust and unmoving dust.
Because it is just the nature of water,
With nothing else, it is gathered into suchness.
Because it is the nature of medicine,
It draws out the chronic disease of saṃsāra.
Because it is thus the nature of nourishment,
It is the sustenance of all pure livelihood.
Because it is like the nature of cutting,
It cuts through the ocean of suffering.
Because its nature is like the sun,
It illuminates the dark house, showing what is there.
Because its nature is like Mount Meru,
It cannot be shaken or moved by anything.
Because its nature is like the ocean,
Blessing arises from the unmoving.
Likewise, because its nature is that of elixir,
It is just as when poison turns into medicine.

These and other infinite supreme qualities,
Free of conceptual thought, all arise from it;
Uncontrived and uncorrupted, it is just so.
Friends, these should be known as the nature of secret mantra." This is how what they had heard was discussed.
"Friends, what then is the nature of the view of it? It is as follows:
Unmistaken, unchanging, decisively determined,
Unattached, nonconceptual, unshaken.
For example, from the nature of space,
Clouds, mist, haze, and vapor,
The moon, the sun, and the hosts of stars
Appear, yet it remains just like space.
Likewise, from the space of suchness,
Whatever conceptual thoughts of signs arise,
The yogin should see
That dharmatā remains just like space.
In that suchness, uncontrived just as it is,
Through the difference between seeing and not seeing,
Look at the differences of view one by one.
For the conceptual it is conceptual thought itself;
For those with wrong craving it is wrong thought itself;
For those who merely hold to a position it is a substance of convention;
For those who know positions it appears as an illusion.
Certain of that itself there, one sees space;
Abiding like space, in space,
It merely appears as space itself.
Friends, these should be known as the nature of the view." This is how what they had heard was definitively discussed.
"Friends, what is the nature of not transgressing it? It is as follows:
Here, in dharmatā, which is like space,
Where all is entirely one,
Free of the alternatives of guarding and not guarding,
How could there be a measure to hold for guarding?
The yogin who is like space
Guards the samaya that is like space.
If here there is no boundary to guard, there is ease;
By that, everything is guarded.

Why? Because each and every thing
Is ascertained as sacred,
Holding to measures and having limits is itself the breach.
Better that those conceptions
Of guarding and not guarding be absent;
To hold to such boundaries of guarding
Is an illusion, and therefore sacred.
Who would call that guarding?
There are no words for guarding and not guarding.
To accept and reject within dharmatā,
How could that be sacred?
Phenomena of guarding and not guarding,
Since there is nothing to guard, are left just as they are.
In the ultimate of suchness,
One places the mind just as it is,
And by the samaya that is beyond expression,
Binds oneself willingly where there is no boundary to guard.
This samaya of space, with nothing to guard,
In a nature according to how it is known,
Appears separately as vow and as moral discipline.
For worldly people it is binding law;
For children it is knowing proper manners;
For those come of age it is known as a vow;
For the unexcelled supreme it appears as samaya.
Though it has not moved from a single meaning,
It is known separately according to those to be trained.
Being endowed with suchness, it is sacred;
If one transgresses it, it becomes a fault.
This great samaya of the sacred,
In which guarding one is guarding all,
Should not be made to conflict with anything,
And should be made to serve the purpose of whatever it is for.
Friends, these should be known as the nature of not transgressing." This is how what they had heard was thoroughly discussed.

"O friends, what then is the nature of conducting oneself accordingly? It is as follows:

When the three extremes of body, speech, and mind
Are completely purified and perfected,
Since that is sacred conduct,
It is explained as knowing the sacred family, not the inferior.
As for the conduct of vajra body,
Since there is nowhere to go, one does not contrive the body.
Since one is alone, one abides as one.
Like the gaze of an elephant,
One should likewise abide in a natural way.
Wherever one abides, one abides always,
Yet one should not be attached to that abiding.
In whichever of the four modes of conduct one is engaged,
One should abide uncontrived and natural.
Apart from merely protecting against harm,
So that one does not fall into distress,
One should not contrive for beauty or adornment;
Wherever one is, apply oneself to whatever brings ease.
As for the sphere of vajra mantra,
The yogin who is without activity
Does not perform the work of stūpas,
Does not read volumes of scripture,
Does not engage in the work of making images,
Does not bind mudrās with the hands;
Verbal recitation obscures that.
The yogin does not prostrate with the body,
Does not look to gain and honor,
Not for profit, not for fame.
Why? Because these are outer distraction,
Because they are extreme distraction,
And are not close to that.
So one should keep this body in its natural state.
For the yogin of definitive meditative concentration,
The food of vajra mantra
Is merely a support that sustains the body's vitality.
Apart from what comes along and what is available,
One should not strive after food for its own sake.
How could it be for the sake of fine taste and flavor?

Eat just as it is, uncontrived and natural;
Do not contrive for the sake of livelihood.
There is no rejecting or adopting of attachment or nonattachment.
One should not take what is given,
And should not resort to living by begging.
Why? Because that does not transform it;
It is a livelihood not completely pure.
To draw a boundary out of the boundless:
This is the work of the yogin.
When, for the sake of yoga, one enters
The inner dharmatā, what is to be known,
In order to remove the interruptions
Caused by the distractions of outer busyness,
At the boundary between outer and inner
One should cut off all coming and going and moving about.
Since for this there is no ground of abiding and no support,
To contrive the body for comfortable abiding is beyond compare in fault.
To contrive one's mode of conduct out of clinging:
That is to corrupt the body by contrivance.
Do not contrive bodily solitude for meditative concentration.
That which is solitary there, uncontrived,
Is itself the place of primordial solitude.
This is the domain of the supreme yogin.
Do not contrive mountain caves and celestial palaces.
That itself, immeasurable and uncontrived,
Is the primordially wondrous palace,
Self-arisen without being made.
As for the sphere of vajra speech,
Apart from speaking pleasantly for the sake of the sacred,
There is no chatter or joking.
Everything said is definitive;
One speaks straightforwardly and does not alter one's words.
As one has spoken, so one should act.
One does not talk about everything at all;
Whatever one says should be connected with the meaning.
Except for the occasion and the purpose,
One should not ramble.

Illustrate everything with examples and bring it home;
Make everything measured, a valid cognition.
The yogin in the uncontrived state:
This is explained as the conduct of vajra speech.
As for the sphere of vajra mind:
Uncontrived, unmoving, free of thought,
Undistracted, not dull, it remains clear;
Unattached to desire, free of superimposition and denial,
With nothing to adopt or reject, without attachment or aversion,
Without concealment or destruction, it is not gain or wealth;
Free of sides, limitless, completely pure,
Having donned the armor, it goes straight upon the path itself.
Poison is transformed and kept as medicine; it is equipped with weapons;
It is devoted to the vajra fortress;
It has the intelligence of a wish-fulfilling jewel.
Where it does not change, what does not change,
Being one with all in this expanse,
Because it is manifest to the mind,
It is completely beautiful and conscientious,
And through the power of that itself it has a sense of shame.
Since in it there is no I or no I,
It is completely endowed with everything,
And certain through the bliss of everything.
Because this is empty, it conceives nothing.
Because that itself is peace, it is without turmoil,
And because nothing at all arises from anywhere,
It does not search elsewhere,
And without material concerns, it does not contrive its manner.
Because there is no torment, there is no desire;
Because it arises unattached, it holds to contentment.
Because it does not grasp anything as a sign,
There is no clean or unclean, and there are no three times.
Likewise there is no sacred one either.
Mind itself, that essence of space,
Is massed over and covered by adventitious clouds.
Without scattering them with the wind of wisdom,
To wish to clear the obscurations and make dharmatā clear

Through conduct like that of a clown
Is like this: when the sun is completely obscured
By a shadow like clouds made of moisture,
Childish ones, who do not know its nature,
Blow with the breath of their mouths
At the heap of the great gathered clouds,
Wishing to clear the clouds and make the sunlight clear.
Friends, these should be known as the nature of conducting oneself accordingly." This is what was heard without error.
From the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas, this is the fifty-seventh chapter, called the chapter on the nature of yoga.
Then again the Lord of Laṅkā and the other bodhisattvas, great beings, put a thorough question to the Lord of Secrets: "O Lord of Secrets, how should we fully understand what you taught as a pledge, that one should grow a tree? Of what is that the tree?" When they had asked this, the Lord of Secrets said:
"O friends, the tree is the tree of awakening. Because it ripens into the unexcelled fruit and becomes the nourishment of all without exception, one should grow that tree.
"Friends, it is as follows:
From that very vajra essence,
In that where all thorns are cleansed,
In what is entirely and completely perfected,
What was explained on the occasion of application,
Which definitively comments on its intention,
That itself should be set forth.
There, in commenting on the intention, there are ten occasions of application:
Generating aspiration and applying effort,
Entering the training and the transformation of perception,
After applying, entering the object of experienced taste,
The great realization, gaining confidence, and becoming workable:
These are the ten occasions of mind together with continuity.
Because those essences possess continuity,
Through the ten occasions of the great yoga,
In the distinctions of the five kinds of yoga,
Sixteen are definitely completed through continuity.
Likewise, in all wisdoms,
Through the distinctions of ten kinds,

From the very first until completion,
Whatever is applied causes the obscurations to set.
Wherever a person sees,
There a single awareness, the mind of awakening, arises.
If one asks what it is that sets,
It is moving, aspiring, arising,
Applying, entering, and not changing;
Awareness, abiding, and completion.

Whatever image of whatever thing appears,
These are examples that accord with insubstantial self-appearance:
It appears like subtle, ordinary, and great stars,
And like the moon of the second day,
Of the third, the fourth, and the fifth,
Of the eighth, and of the sixteenth.
On the occasions when intention arises,
The mind in which moving predominates comes forth;
Like a gloomy mass of dark clouds,
Darting flickers and stars appear dimly.
On the occasions when effort is applied,
The mind in which aspiring predominates comes forth;
It is like very ordinary stars,
Dim wherever they are.
On the occasions when one enters the training,
The arising mind of awakening comes forth;
Like great flares of fire
And great stars, it appears dimly.
On the occasions when perception is transformed,
The mind in which applying predominates is born;
It appears like a whirling firebrand's wheel
And like the moon of the first day.
On the occasions when one enters the great yoga,
The mind in which entering predominates is born;
It appears like a lamp
And like the moon of the second day.
On the occasions when the taste is experienced,
The mind in which joy predominates comes forth;

It appears like a lamp within a vessel,
Or like the third day's moon.
On the occasions when one engages with objects,
The mind in which not changing predominates comes forth;
It is close to attainment and to being shown,
And its nature appears like the fourth day's moon.
On the occasions of great examination,
The mind in which awareness predominates comes forth;
The first great sign is closely approached,
And its nature appears like the fifth day's moon.
On the occasions when confidence is gained,
The mind in which abiding predominates comes forth;
It appears like a perfectly steady lamp,
Its nature like the eighth day's moon.
When the signs are obtained, it is called accomplished.
On the occasions when it becomes workable,
The mind in which completion predominates comes forth;
It appears like a lamp that needs no remedy,
And like the moon complete in all its digits.
Through certain stability it is accomplishment.
Mind itself is buddha from the very beginning,
But, obscured by conceptuality, one does not know it.
From the tree of the mind of awakening
The unsurpassed fruit ripens.
Therefore, excellent friends,
The mind of awakening of the excellent ones
Is at all times possessed of continuity;
To be without continuity, cut off, is not excellent.
Through continuity itself it surely ripens:
The growing tree where it ripens
Is the excellent tree of awakening,
And the excellent fruit will surely ripen.

Friends, this has been the definitive discussion of the intention of growing the excellent tree.

This concludes the fifty-eighth chapter, on growing the excellent tree, the secret of reality, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All

Buddhas.

Then again the bodhisattva great beings, the Lord of Laṅkā and the others, asked a question: "O Lord of Secrets, concerning the intention behind the vow, 'One should follow the excellent ones,' how is one to follow the excellent ones? How is that to be fully understood?"

When they had asked this, the Lord of Secrets said: "O friends, it is like this: following the excellent ones means the excellent path that is known with certainty. Friends, what is the excellent path? It is this. On one occasion that I saw and heard, the excellent spiritual friend himself declared definitively: 'Because the body of essential nature has no remedy, it is endowed with all conceptualizations: permanence, annihilation, arising, cessation, objectification, attachment, aversion, delusion, pride, and jealousy; the five objects of desire; killing, taking what is not given, sexual misconduct, lying, slander, harsh speech, idle talk, covetousness, malice, and wrong view. To engage with certainty in the five deeds of immediate retribution, the five that are close to them, the four grave ones, the eight perversions, defiled meat, excrement, urine, blood, semen, and so forth, is to be known as the excellent path of the excellent ones.'

"When he had declared this with excellent certainty, I said to him:
'Emaho! A wondrous, marvelous Dharma!
From the true and authoritative speech
Of the perfect buddhas who proclaim it,
How does this origin of perversity come about?'
When I had made this request with earnest longing,
The excellent spiritual friend declared:
'Because the supreme means are beyond measure,
For those attached to what is perverse,
In order to bring them to the definitive meaning,
This is taught as a method of guiding them.
However firmly they hold to perverse attachments,
Those who would not enter but would turn away,
If they are drawn in by the method of perverse conduct,
Will without doubt come forth.
In order to catch them by the method of enticement,
According to their various individual inclinations,
It is taught as a method of drawing them in to rely on it,
Matched so as to accord with their views and conduct.

For example, just as parents, by the means
Of threats and frightening, urge
Naughty children to the work they ought to do,
So out of love one leads them to the aim.
Moreover, just as someone
Who wishes to go to the far shore of a river
Travels relying on a boat,
And, having reached the far side, abandons it,
So the different methods or vehicles,
Though they are means of guidance to be relied on,
The moment the certainty of the meaning is found,
Are discarded like the boat once the river is crossed.
Therefore, if suchness is known,
Everything whatsoever, without exception,
Being certain as the excellent path,
Is the shortcut among paths.'
Having said this, he remained in silence.

"O friends, therefore, if you enter this excellent path that follows the excellent ones, then everything, in every respect, in all its aspects, will become known, clear, unconfused, and fully complete. Those who wish to fully understand saṃsāra should also know this path. Those who wish to fully understand nirvāṇa should also know this path. Furthermore, those who wish to attain the twenty great miracles should also fully know this excellent path. Those who wish to level the eighty mountains of conceptuality should also fully know this excellent path. Those who wish to cut off the nine doors of downfall should also fully know this excellent path.

Whoever wish to know all these and the rest,
Limitless, each and every one, complete,
Should come to know this excellent path.
Mind itself is the excellent path:
Like the path of a bird in the sky, it leaves no trace,
The excellent path without fear or deviation.
This definitive path, too,
So that all may come to know it,
Is indicated by the path of words;
Yet it is inexpressible, beyond the reach of words.

In its own nature, that itself,
The uncontrived nature, is suchness.
It has no name, but because names are imputed,
Seeing and not seeing become distinct.
From that it becomes the basis for conduct:
So that through expression that very thing may be seen,
From the enumerations of the path of words
The doors of the path of words become measureless.
From that comes the trail cut by the excellent ones,
The scripture that arose from their minds,
The search for the treasure close at hand by lamplight,
The shortcut, excellent awakening, which is this:
If one follows after whatever arises,
One will circle on the wheel of saṃsāra.
If one blocks whatever movement arises,
It becomes a mere cessation of the continuum.
The fool for whom nothing arises
Enters the dark path of the extremists.
Whatever one grasps singly as "this"
Is a mountain of conceptualizing signs.
If one sets a limit, saying, "There is no before and after,"
That is the extremist of nonexistence and annihilation.
Whatever stirs for a single moment within the uncontrived,
Where arising and ceasing take place,
Whatever arises and grows from that
Makes the path of enumerations grow,
But the excellent path itself is not found.
For example, childish beings
Abandon their shadow and seek something pure;
By the very thing from which it came,
Though they search, they find no waning or waxing.
That itself is thus from the very beginning.
Whoever here seeks the path
Through various sufferings, to the point of exhaustion,
Does pointless work, the work of māras.
Whatever is said of it in words
Is like arguing with the sky.

Though medicine and treatment are explained in words,
They do not heal the crowd of the sick.
If one has not become that very suchness,
The path of words that one speaks is not it.
Here, to abandon one thing and seek another
Is like abandoning a form to seek its shadow.
Since mind itself is the excellent path,
Ignorance and wisdom are not distinct.
Nonconceptuality is one in this path.
Since mind itself appears as variety,
Variety is one in this path.
For example, from a single material, gold,
Shapes and forms are made distinct,
And so each of them bears its own name;
Whatever they are called, they are one in the essence of gold.
Likewise, in the nature of mind,
Through the difference of seeing and not seeing,
However one looks, so it appears;
And though it appears, nothing other than it is observed.
Just as a jewel that blazes like a lamp,
Though it lies hidden in a foul pit,
Because its nature is self-appearing,
Shines its light clearly into the sky,
So the jewel lamp of mind itself,
Though sunk in the mire of a wretched body,
Being self-arisen, self-pacified, self-appearing,
Is fully luminous in its uncontrived nature.
This mind is just like space:
All-pervading, empty and clear, it gives rise to variety.
Arising, being felt, moving, and ceasing, all of these
Arise by nature and subside by themselves.
In short, just as one examines and thinks,
So it changes, and thus all appears as its essence.
From the uncontrived, motionless itself
The causes of variety arise without fault,
And the miraculous display is unceasing and without fear.
It comes down simply to resting the mind, undistracted,

In a nature like that of space.
That is the great purpose, accomplished without toil.
That itself is the essence
From which the buddhas of all three times arise.
However many abide in its meaning,
If, through seeing, they grow accustomed to that very thing there,
Finding the path, seeing the path, experience and warmth
Will certainly arise through the meaning itself;
And even for one who is not such, once it is grasped,
Excellent awakening will arise.
Toward phenomena that are conceptualized signs,
Certain understanding arises.
That all phenomena are like this,
And yet not to see it so, is a great wonder;
To see it so is also a great wonder.
Emaho! One is moved to wonder, "What is this?"
Those who do not see that itself,
Through the great toil of difficult, effortful achievement,
Seek the excellent path, each path a long one;
Though its meaning arises and is present,
They do not find that path.
To find the path of the excellent ones
Is more excellent than excellence itself.
It is not the equal of supports and images;
Peace with a body remaining and final cessation, these two are not its equal;
The grounds of training are not its equal;
Yogic mentation, the extremes of conceptuality,
And whatever is equal to such things are not its equal.
Therefore, since the great pure path
Is this secret of mind,
By knowing this secret path
Gathered from all intentions,
There is no reason for the work of searching:
By seeing this very path,
Without any hardship or effort,
Each and every thing is accomplished.
Wherever the secret of mind abides,

That is the excellent solitude;
As the supreme great hermitage itself
The Gathering of the Intentions of All has declared it.
That itself is the immeasurable supreme celestial palace,
The marvelous mansion of the wish-fulfilling jewel,
Unmade, self-arisen, without outside or inside,
Become inward through and through.
Whatever gathers here is no assembly;
In it, that itself is the supreme gathering of the assembly.
Gathering all phenomena, it has no arising,
The supreme delight of immeasurable Victors.
Whatever here is enjoyment of the senses is a requisite;
That itself is the great requisite.
If this superior requisite is known,
It is the root of all requisites.
To make meditation is not meditation;
What is to be contemplated has no reference point.
If this excellent secret path is known,
This itself is the excellent path of meditation.
Though one says "guard," nothing to be guarded is observed;
This secret path is emptiness, arising without existence.
If one knows the words through the greatness of center and extremes,
This is the excellent secret of guarding.
The path of words speaks of equality, yet equality is not observed;
In this secret where all is one,
How could there be anything more to call "equal"?
It is equal to the Gathering of the Intentions of All.
Whatever else is the conduct of discipline,
Bending toward that and engaging in its play,
Since here all is tamed and here all has entered,
The Gathering of All is declared the supreme discipline.
This path, the very reality, the secret of mind,
Being accomplished from the beginning, has no supplication or obtaining;
"Accomplishment that is never interrupted,"
So the excellent Gathering of the Intentions of All declares.
Thus, if one sees the secret of mind,
By seeing the path not seen before,

Seeing is nothing whatsoever;
That to which it appears is the path of seeing.

Friends, this has been the full discussion of what was heard in this way, called "the excellent path that follows the excellent ones."

This concludes the fifty-ninth chapter, on following yoga, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then again the heroic friends, the Lord of Laṅkā and the others, put a question to the Lord of Secrets: "O Lord of Secrets, how are we to fully understand the intention behind the vow, 'Here one should keep the blazing jewel lamp'?"

When they had put this question, the Lord of Secrets said: "O friends, the blazing jewel is a source of light. Since it is not extinguished even by gusts of scattering wind, and does nothing but dispel darkness, it is called a lamp. It is this: the knowing that dispels unknowing. Just as in the heart of the sun or in a jewel lamp there is no ground for darkness, so in the nature of knowing there is no ground for unknowing.

"Moreover, when the excellent lamp has set, distinct forms appear within the single reality of all, namely: the knowing of darkness, the knowing of the astonished, the knowing of the childish, the knowing of partial understanding, the knowing that distinguishes extremes and center, and the knowing of excellence itself.

"O friends, the knowing of darkness is knowing this wrongly. The knowing of those with perverse craving speaks of difference and holds to duality. The childish are those who speak of nonexistence yet hold that everything exists. It is like this:
From particles to leagues, from instants
To eons, stars, sun and moon,
Mountains, the encircling ring, and the bodies of the embodied,
Mind and life span, the measures of enjoyments,
And the characteristics of time, abiding, destruction and setting,
They break all of these down
Into separate particulars,
And speak of nonexistence while holding that things exist.
Because their inclination is small, they go no further.
The yogin here who understands in part
Holds that, since all this is only here,

It appears as insubstantial consciousness itself;
That itself, uncontrived, is suchness,
And because it exists, he holds the dharmakāya to be permanent.
The yogins who distinguish definitively
Act on the conventional level,
Since things appear with the character of illusion,
And make no definitive division.
Some are certain of it in this way:
Apart from that, it does not come about;
Since that itself, by that, is insubstantial,
It does not exist as the ultimate.
Some, since nothing is grasped,
Allow that its appearing may be anywhere at all:
The subtlest ground, knowing all aspects,
Does not exist in the way of a deceiver.
What is the excellence of excellence itself?
In the nature of reality, buddha from the beginning,
In order to reverse views other than this,
One says, "buddha from the beginning";
But this is said merely as a convention.
"From the beginning" is a path of words, spoken;
For what is free of the two conventions
One does not apply the terms of words that superimpose or deny.
The conventions of speech pass beyond the path of words.
"Does this space exist or not?"
Fools will argue so;
The wise are not like that;
To argue over it is a great wonder.
"Does this suchness exist or not?"
The childish will argue so;
Those persons who are not like that know
That argument is nothing but corrupted wisdom.
All phenomena that appear in this way
Are buddha from the beginning, by their very nature;
They do not turn from what they are not into what they are.
In the reality of essential nature,
What is there to make of "it is" and "it is not"?

"This space does not exist":
Whoever does not know conceives it so;
Whoever knows does not conceive it from the beginning;
He does not conceive it as not being, and speaks no words.
In cause, action, and enumeration,
In characteristic, certainty, and essence,
In result and purpose, each one arises.
Thus, here, whatever is the cause
Is self-arising itself, with examination and analysis;
Whatever spreads forth as sense sources in whatever,
These two themselves are the cause.
Whatever is and is not from whatever, however many,
The distinctions, particulars and differences,
With definitive distinguishing, engagement, relation and application,
Holding to them without error,
Manifesting, intended meaning, and connection.
The enumerations of two kinds are according to the meaning.
It makes certain of all.
That itself is unmixed and fully complete:
Insubstantial, nonconceptual, fully complete,
Each one distinct, inconceivable,
Unmixed, it acts in accord with how things are.
Whatever here is without error,
Fully perfected, is the supreme itself.
Wholly unconfused, it illuminates everything;
Wherever it is, it is unobstructed and unimpeded;
Entering all, it cuts through ignorance;
It is what has become all the sense sources.
Whatever spreads forth, into which the wind of whatever enters,
Is the immeasurable wisdom of the wise.
Wherever there is reversal, that itself is pure.
Because that itself has reached perfection,
With the lamp that illuminates the target
One should look upon that itself in it.
One who does not know the light of the lamp
Is veiled by darkness from everything to be seen;
Nothing will ever appear,

And he goes to the great city of the blind.
Whoever keeps the blazing lamp,
Through which darkness is cleared from all and all is illuminated,
Will see the unmistaken, uncontrived suchness
Through the lamp's aim upon the target.
Thus, excellent friends,
Without keeping the fire of the blazing jewel lamp
To illuminate darkness, aimed upon the target,
How could one fittingly see that golden reality?

"Friends, these should be understood as a good discussion of the excellent intention, 'One should keep the excellent lamp.'"

This concludes the sixtieth chapter, teaching the lamp of the eye of yoga, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then again the great beings, lowly and excellent, the Lord of Laṅkā and the others, put a question: "O Lord of Secrets, how are we to fully understand the intention behind the vow, 'One should go especially to what is higher'?"

When they had requested this, the Lord of Secrets said: "O friends, that one should go especially, that is excellent. It is most excellent indeed.

"That ground is as follows. The lamp called Full Illumination, well arranged through the yoga of those excellent ones who are masters of the grounds, is this:
The difference between ground and ground
Here, where there is none at all,
Comes down to higher and lower stages of self-awareness
Through differences in cutting through what is to be known.
For example, from a king's treasury
Those who want great or small means,
Through differences of outer and inner austerity,
And by the methods of work through which they enter the gates of service,
Take whatever they take according to high or low skill;
Though they all serve a single king,
There are distinctions among the several kinds of jewels,
And the great means of the nine gates are employed separately;
But one who becomes king is lord
Of all that wealth, the one who confers authority.

In unabiding, uncontrived suchness,
Where there is nothing to be known apart from it,
Through differences of skill
All the separate gates of entry are traversed.
In that single reality of it,
Through differences of high and low in the reach of skill,
Awareness appears in such a way
As distinct stations of the grounds.
Here, where everything is one,
Seeing it is discordant, through the power of that.
For example, like a source with many gates,
The grounds and liberations, each a separate gate,
Appear thus as variety within the one.
Though one trains in the grounds, entering and so on,
In whatever grounds and liberations there are,
Since the root of all is cut here,
They are one, and there is no difference at all.
It is like mountain and Meru,
Wandering ascetic and youth:
The differences in what is seen, heard and taught
Exist in that way only in terms of meaning.
Therefore, since the very ground
On which all phenomena abide is mind,
Exemplified by the simile of space,
It should be known as the ground of all.
Thus the yogin who knows this,
Skilled in the methods of the path,
Loses the path, seeks the path, and finds the path,
And so finds the shortcut with ease and is accomplished.
To find what is found and abide in it
Is the ground of yogic practice.
For all the grounds, which are perfect in oneness,
Because awareness is superior, middling or inferior,
The one appears with ten distinctions,
And for this purpose they are to be enumerated.
These grounds of abiding, holding and conduct
Are completed in a single set of ten.

On this ground of uncertainty, subject to change,
Are five yogas: contrived and coarse conduct,
Holding to modes and signs, inclination,
And well-directed aspiration;
With entering, turning back and falling,
One circles everywhere and is uncertain.
The yogin of aspiration and intention:
This is called the ground of abiding and training.
On this ground of the foundation through reliance,
The beginner yogin
Practices the training and certainty
In both pure and impure ways.
The yogin who works awaiting command:
This is called the ground of abiding and training.
On this ground of conduct of great importance,
The yoga that discerns the great families
Is the ground of abiding and training;
Moreover, on all the grounds where there is no "I,"
By the very method of cutting, training and applying,
One wages the great contest of strength between good and bad.
On this ground of continuous training,
The warmth of moving, obtaining and stability,
And likewise the great signs of moving,
Of obtaining itself, and of stability,
Are six kinds of yoga.
The ten limits of training are brought to completion,
And, like the moon waxing bright,
The wisdom of training increases.
One is not afraid of the meaning, and wonder is born.
That being who enters with a mind in training
Does not turn back to the lower realms and enters solitude;
Obstacles too arise for him.
The yoga of the secret gate of scripture,
The yoga of continuous conduct,
And the yoga of marks and signs, these three:
This is called the ground of abiding and training.
On this ground, the Treasury of Merit,

Is the yoga of continuous conduct itself,
The place of pure inclination and aspiration,
The ground that is the abode of the mind of great skill,
Mounted upon the ten limits of training as a whole.
On this ground of going distinctively through reliance,
The yogin who draws a great breath of relief,
Holding the great family, great equal perfection,
Definitive conduct, applying great skill,
Entering objects, and applying awareness,
Goes to the completion of these seven.
In the ten limits of the cause and result of training
He applies himself in the manner of habituation.
From resting, all is seen;
On the irreversible ground there is nothing to habituate.
Though these share one basis of application,
They are reckoned as arising from separate, uncommon
Obscurations, and each wisdom dawns in turn.
Therefore, within a single limit of training,
The great perfections, irreversibility and the rest,
In each truth there,
Each arising of skill dawns,
And the last is completed by self-arising itself.
For those who reach the end, who attain, and who are irreversible,
In order, through dreams, echoes,
And direct certainty, as is fitting,
The vajra prophecy of yoga is given:
"Vajra, vajra yogin,"
So he is named, and it is proclaimed
In the earthly realms and in all the buddha fields,
And he comes forth as an excellent yogin.
On this ground of the arising of the focused result
Are three yogas: the yoga of accomplishment, the great yoga,
And the yoga of arising in completion.
Born from the Victor on the path of the Victor's mind,
The Victor's son, the heir of the lineage,
All the distinctive reaches of skill complete,
He is one who engages in samādhi.

On this ground, unchanging through abiding,
The yoga of marvelous play,
The great gathering assembled, and great skill completed,
Should be known as complete in three.
The great seal is illusion;
The great king, a wheel-turning monarch,
From the station of seeing to the sixteenth ground,
Enjoys himself in the station of completion.
On this ground of the all-pervading nature of reality,
The yoga of the ornament of play,
Great bliss, and completion in the bindu
Appear as three.
If one joins object, meaning and wisdom by these,
Then through knowing, all is complete:
This is conduct that is the illusion of illusion.
On this ground mounted upon completion as a whole,
From the tenth, the last, down to the first,
The final completion is the realization of all.
In the vast expanse, the heart of space,
A hundred thousand cloudless suns spread everywhere.
Whatever appears is nothing at all;
In the essence that neither arises nor ceases,
However one looks, so it appears there;
All-pervading, boundless, cut by waves.
Moreover, through the distinction of excellence,
The yoga of the great self,
Spontaneous presence, and perfection in the vast expanse,
These three complete, are self-arising pervasion.
These grounds of yogic practice:
Where there is distinction, distinction appears;
Where there is no distinction, there is no distinction.
Yogins of high and low reach of skill
Must traverse grounds of high and low station.
O you who appear here as the supreme questioner,
Lord of Laṅkā, who have become excellent!
Here, where all yoga is applied,
In this root of the ten definite grounds,

From its root and its branches,
Twelve, seven and two are complete.
Therefore, though from the distinctions of the grounds
They are vast and many in number,
One should apply these grounds of yoga.

The source of ground upon ground,
The ground of all, is great through all;
Whoever reaches this great ground
Traverses the grounds in a mere instant.

"Friends, these should be understood as the full discussion of the intention behind the vow, 'One should go especially to what is higher.'"

This concludes the sixty-first chapter, teaching the lamp of the grounds of yoga, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then again the lowly and excellent ones, the Lord of Laṅkā and the others, asked the Lord of Secrets: "O Lord of Secrets, how are we to fully understand the intention behind the vow, 'One should engage with objects'?"

When they had asked this, the Lord of Secrets fully replied: "O friends, objects are as follows. Those who wish to purify fields should engage with the object of their intention, reality itself, and with the limitless saṃsāras, the objects in which arising takes place. It is like this:
Just as launderers
Stretch out the cloth wherever it is to be cleaned,
So here, from the very first of actions,
Whatever is applied is most precious."

When he had said this, the bodhisattva great being, the Lord of Laṅkā, spoke as follows: "Lord of Secrets, since everything in every way is buddha from the beginning, there is no need for anything to become buddha now. Since that is so, there is no applying oneself to an object of intention, and nothing at all has become an object of compassion. That being so, what here has become an object of compassion? Who has become an object of compassion?"

When he had said this, the Lord of Secrets said: "O Lord of Laṅkā, it is just so. Since all are buddha from the beginning and are reality itself, there is no object of compassion and no object of intention at all; and yet, in whatever way it may be, in a manner that does not depart from the nature of reality, one

should not oppose anything or be opposed to it. To act for the inner meaning itself is the great commitment, and that, since all is buddha from the beginning, there is no aim to be accomplished is great compassion. To know that there is no need to enter the excellent intention should be understood as having entered the object of the excellent intention, reality itself. Lord of Laṅkā, it is like this:

Whoever abides in the excellent intention,
Since it is deeper even than the deep,
In order to resolve it from its very depths,
Does not settle down in anything at all
Together with ordinary people in the four secret domains.
Moreover, in what is fully complete,
Though there is no deed to be done by deeds,
Since its nature is to benefit others,
Here one should bring benefit.
Whatever comes to contradict that aim,
And the requisites that derive from it,
As a turtle does when something comes at its head,
Should be shed without limit or end.
Why? Because yogins everywhere
Are not other than excellent yoga itself.
If, through the power of something,
One comes to contradict the excellent aim,
Great danger discordant with it arises.
If that arises for him,
There is no protector or noble one for him apart from that;
Whatever is not held, the rope is cut.
If anything comes about for the sake of others,
From the subtlest of the subtle upward,
Each and every thing, just as it is,
Should be done diligently and with delight.
Mendicants, those who delight in begging,
And those who live their lives by begging
Should be organized into groups, sections and colleges,
And made into a field for compassion to bear its fruit.
Medicines, grains and herbal essences,
And those that are the supreme of nourishing substances,
Having been ground or made into powder,

Should be cast into rivers, waters or great lakes,
And given without attachment.
Having vowed oneself as their support,
One should found places for healing the sick, for study, practice and meditation,
Making them supreme places of resort,
And make offerings and gifts according to the wheel of time.
Wherever the scripture of the excellent ones has appeared,
Relying on all the stūpas of speech,
Through recitation, service and veneration,
One should make the paths vast and broad.
Whatever makes excellence increase:
These definitive excellent ones,
Whether they speak, give, teach or guide,
Their wisdom becomes immeasurable.
By familiarizing and familiarizing again,
In order to purify that,
Amid the many objects of thought and activity,
One should train the skills of the object itself.
Turning well the excellent wheel,
Purifying the continuum, one should look to superior wisdom.
At toll scales and on toll roads
Clearing away all the harms of hardship,
One should turn the wheel of immeasurable compassion,
And not cut off the flow of the wheel of giving.
In water, in earth, or in the sky,
In fire, or likewise in the winds,
Spreading and offering the bodily remains and the relics,
One should make a wheel of the great work begun.
For averting the deeds of immediate retribution,
Dust is shaken from the continuum of body and mind:
In the palaces of the cloud hosts of noble ones,
With bodies as many as atoms, one offers and confesses with the mind.
Burning the wood of karma, so that the Victors are pleased,
From the great path of applying great means,
One should perform the supreme fourfold fire rite;
By this the deeds of immediate retribution are averted.

The maṇḍalas from which compassion arises
Should be practiced diligently, in whatever way one is accustomed.
Of roots such as these,
Abandoning all that do not serve the aim,
One should raise a great army through the accumulation of diligence.
Thus the arising of action and the rest
Are not practiced for any other end,
Because the one-pointed, purposeful yogin
Must make the purifying of his continuum purposeful.
And if one is weak in skill and lacks it,
Gathering together all the great expenditures of accumulated virtue,
Counting here the aims of what has been accumulated,
If one brings forth the force of longing and shakes out one's skill,
Like the moon's reflection in a river when the sun has risen,
It is precious that it arises by the force of its nature.
Therefore even the smallest thing, and upward,
Should be made to serve the excellent aim.
Here, all things, held and unheld,
Stable and moving, and the rest:
If one rests the mind in suchness,
That itself is great compassion.
Lord of Laṅkā, in this way,
By the manner in which there is no object,
Whatever entering there is, from non-entering,
Is the excellent engagement with objects."

When he had said this, the beings of lowly body, the Lord of Laṅkā and the others, found the excellent certainty of continuously engaging with objects.

This concludes the sixty-second chapter, on engaging with excellent objects, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then again those lowly beings, the Lord of Laṅkā and the others, put a question of illustration to the Lord of Secrets: "O Lord of Secrets, how should we fully examine the intention whose pledge is, 'The mirror is to be examined'?"

When they had asked this, the Lord of Secrets said: "O friends, the mirror by which one comes to know what is illustrated, and by what, is this:

Appearing, imputed and arising,
Unattached, arising, appearing, pure,
Abiding and arising: the ten kinds of correspondence.
Illusion, mirage, the moon in water,
Dream, echo, optical illusion,
Firebrand and city of the gandharvas,
Emanation and reflection: the ten mirrors.
The ten corresponding objects are set forth as illustrations.
Though without entity, they appear as entities:
They are examples of what can appear as entities.

As for the nature of an illusion:
Through the exertion of some person
And the application of medicines and mantras,
It appears as anything at all, captivating the senses;
Yet in it there is no entity that comes or goes.
Just so, the nature of the secret:
From a conjunction in which causes that do not exist arise,
However it appears and arises, it has no intrinsic nature.

As for the nature of a mirage here:
At times of destruction, arising and movement,
From the nature of this and that,
Children, through the perception of being parched,
May fix upon the perception of water,
Yet how could it become a cause of quenching thirst?
Likewise, its particulars as well:
Upon what is wholly empty of intrinsic nature
Conventions, signs and names are imputed;
Since that itself is empty, it is not apprehended.

As for the moon in water here:
When the moon rises in an unobscured sky,
Its reflection appears in clear water;
In it there is no imputed entity.
Likewise, without anything being arranged,
Whatever shines clear from that very sky,
Whatever appears here is that very thing;
That itself is without entity, free of grasping and conceiving.

As for the nature of a dream:
When someone is overcome by sleep,
For a moment, an instant, a short while,
Or for years and so on, however long,
He seems to experience various pleasures and pains;
Yet just as on waking nothing at all is found,
So in emptiness, where nothing at all exists,
Whatever particular conduct one engages in,
Through nonattachment to the conduct, just as it is,
When examined, it is free of all objects of reference.

As for the nature of the arising of an echo:
In its own place, conditioned by a sound,
Just so an echo arises;
That itself is an arising from nothing at all.
The blessings of the secret of secret mantra,
For whose sake the nonexistent arises:
From nothing at all, anything at all arises;
Causes that do not exist appear when looked upon with imputation and attachment.

As for the nature of an optical illusion here:
To one with a disease of the eye, things appear;
They merely appear before confusion;
Of what so appears, nothing whatever exists.
From emptiness, the intrinsic nature free of elaboration,
Whatever kinds of miraculous display appear
Merely appear as miraculous display;
Of those appearances, none whatever exists.

From water and the clear sky
Bubbles and banks of cloud arise as distinct;
Being by nature self-arising and self-subsiding,
They are pure as water itself and sky itself.
All that appears and does not appear,
Each and every one, from that very reality
Arising of itself, just as it is,
Is certain to be purity itself.

The abode of the gandharvas is not fixed;
Wherever their forms arise,
There their city likewise arises;
In its very arising, it is not to be imputed there.
The suchness of what is just as it is:
Wherever abiding abides,
There it appears as a great immeasurable palace;
Yet it does not abide as it appears.

As for the nature of an emanation:
Arising from nothing, from one it arises as many;
What arises appears like the stream of a turning wheel;
The stream of arising appearance is never cut.
From the nature of the equality of the unequal,
It arises just as it is;
What arises here is never interrupted;
In it there is no depletion and no increase.

As for whatever reflection appears here:
In dependence on a face and a clear surface where a face arises,
Just so a reflection arises;
That itself: the two are not different.
Here, though cause and effect are separate,
The cause itself is the effect, and that very effect the cause;
Therefore in it the two do not exist;
It is suchness, just that itself.

Therefore, since all phenomena whatsoever
Are one in being just as they are,
However things appear and whatever arises,
There is no arising or appearing apart from the unmoving.

This profound and supreme secret
Is like examining the sky: its depth is hard to fathom.
Whatever one who lacks yoga conceives,
By conceiving it he will not come to realize it.
For example, if one closely examines
The core of the sun with the faculty of the eye,
One does not perceive that core;
The blazing light overwhelms and dazzles the eye.

Likewise, the childish of weak intellect,
However they examine the meaning of the essence,
Do not see the secret essence;
The weak-minded children only grow weary.

Therefore, this supreme secret,
Though it cannot be known through illustration,
Is given to the yogin as a mere partial indication,
In order to illustrate it for the deluded host.
This inconceivable nature of reality
Is left just so, free from thought.
This dharma that is left unexamined
I have not taught to the childish.
Since it transcends illustration by expression,
How could it ever be shown as 'this'?
Since it does not exist, no object to be shown is found;
For the unobservable dharma there is no path of words.
All phenomena are like space,
And space too has no characteristic.
Just as the center and edges of space are not found,
All phenomena are free of edge, center and boundary.
Whatever name gives expression to 'space',
That very expression is an entity;
Yet though the conventional name for it is spoken,
Space itself is not thereby obstructed.
Whatever is said of this as 'nonconceptual',
That very statement is conceptualization;
Yet whatever conceptualization may say,
Nonduality in it is not obstructed.
Here, all wishing for duality
And all distinguishing of center and extremes are errors.
Even the convention called 'equality'
Comes from distinguishing two, center and extremes.
Ah, brothers in Dharma, this is one:
While nothing at all exists apart from it,
Whatever is two or more is conceptualization.
Let everyone settle in this certainty.

Friends, you should understand that the supreme intention, 'The mirror is to be examined,' has thus been ascertained and discussed."

When he had said this, the beings of lowly body, the Lord of Laṅkā and the others, came to settle in genuine certainty.

This concludes the sixty-third chapter, called Illustration, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then again the excellent lowly ones, the Lord of Laṅkā and the others, asked the Lord of Secrets the question on the ninth of the ten sūtras set out here: "O Lord of Secrets, how should we fully understand the intention whose pledge is, 'One should apply what is concordant'?"

When they had asked this, the Lord of Secrets said: "Lord of Laṅkā, these should be fully understood as follows:

In the city of the realm of children,
Thick with the gloom of great darkness,
Here in the ever-continuing round,
The activities that bring certain entry,
Through the gathering of all the supreme intentions,
Whatever has become the domain of whomever,
However and as much as has been taught,
Should be known here as threefold:
Concordant engagement, introducing means,
And the mixing of application and conduct.
By these each and every thing, as is fitting,
Is definitely applied to the supreme aim.

Lord of Laṅkā, it is like this:
Whatever concordant application one engages in,
Being certain of who is where,
One acts in harmony with those very beings.
If one shows oneself wholly in harmony with them,
That itself should come about for them.
In order to make them supreme,
Through whatever is applied in harmony with them,
One draws all their minds and leads them in.
Whatever captivates, draws and introduces the mind,
Whatever is pleasing, just that,
Applied with earnestness, is the very thing.

For example, in the realms of darkness,
Whoever has become whatever, through whatever,
That enters his mind,
And since he and it are one, not other,
Then, knowing that in him,
One gains the means to bring him under control,
And the path of words that transforms it arises.
Having passed beyond that, by entering
The mind of the supreme alone, one says, 'Ah, confusion!
Here is a fault, here a reversal,' and dedicates the rising and the rest.
Within that, this was done by him alone.
Whoever here enters into the supreme
Is fit to enter into the supreme alone.
Therefore that is its very reality;
And so, whatever its reality may be,
It nonetheless enters the supreme domain.

Lord of Laṅkā, how is this so?
If you ask what it is like:
In an instant that I saw and heard,
When my supreme spiritual friend
Was teaching this path at length
To great gatherings,
Among those who had assembled in that retinue,
Goddesses, nāginīs and low-caste women,
A circle of six maidens gathered,
Showing their joy with song and dance,
And danced their steps in pairs with great delight.
At that time, though it was not a supreme domain,
The supreme, the most excellent secret itself,
By releasing it as conduct in harmony with it,
Regarded it as the very supreme of domains.
To the host of his heirs assembled there he said:
'Ah, host of the great assembly,
All you who have arisen in my lineage and family:
Divine music, song and dance,
Melodious, graceful, charming and beautiful steps,
The means that captivate, introduce and draw the mind,

The three hundred limbs of song,
And inexhaustible steps and ways of dancing:
Gather all, delight all, apply concordance!'
Thus that supreme one spoke.

Then that very one among his heirs,
Through intelligence endowed with means,
Knowing who was to be tamed by what,
In order to apply concordance with the six worlds,
Moved in harmony from his place,
Transforming into supreme dance like lightning.
With ten million glorious hands
He filled the whole realm of space,
Dancing through the power of his steps,
And the sound of the three hundred limbs of song,
As though the three existences were filled with thunder,
Filled the six worlds without end or limit,
And so captivated and drew their minds.
The marvelous secret words of the Great Vehicle:
By transforming a single word, words without limit;
The meaning utterly beyond the path of words;
He revealed the profound domain of the buddhas.
How wonderful! Amazing, marvelous Dharma!
The meaning of marvelous play arises.
From the distinctions of concordant application
Play arises in the six worlds.
In order to cut the stream of the path of saṃsāra,
In the heart of the six worlds
The light of compassion and means radiated
And burned up all the entities of the six streams.
With wisdom unattached to modes of conduct,
In order to apply it as concordant means,
Like the conduct of the world's children
He played with the six maidens of the world.
Moving six steps, he liberated the six classes of beings;
Singing six songs, he drew in the six objects;
Proclaiming six words, he perfected the six aims.

On the ground of laziness and distraction:
The swift step of diligence, the thoroughbred's step;
The melodious song of Brahmā's voice;
The secret word of the vajra that accomplishes the aim.
On the ground of the mountain of pride:
The step of hero and of strongman;
The song melodious with a hundred thousand cymbals;
The word of calm abiding, nonconceptual space.
On the ground where all things gather:
The step of five supreme bulls at play;
Song and dance, captivating and melodious song;
The word that pulls out the stake of grasping.
On the ground where delusion gathers:
The step of a lion fiercely at play;
Song melodious as the kalaviṅka's voice;
The word clear with meaning from the very beginning.
On the ground where passion gathers:
The step of the great vajra garuḍa soaring;
Song melodious as the rumbling of great thunder;
The word of the blazing wish-fulfilling jewel.
On the ground where aversion gathers:
The step of the savage wrathful one in fury;
The song of savage rākṣasīs in fury;
The word of vajra storm and meteor.

From the marvelous secret maṇḍala
The fire of blazing wisdom arises,
Burns the firewood of the saṃsāra of the three realms,
Dries up the blood-lake of the saṃsāra of the three existences,
Destroys the mountain of pride from its foundation,
Quenches the blazing flames of aversion,
Utterly conquers the darkness of delusion,
And dries up the swamp where saṃsāra gathers.
Lord of Laṅkā, these
Are the play that entices children:
By applying what is in harmony with their share,
They are applied to the supreme aim.

Lord of Laṅkā, there is more besides:
The yogic discipline of blending by introducing skillful means
Is that, just as the world has its perverse cravings,
One carries out the distinctive conduct of the discipline.
Like the fox, the thoroughbred and the fine steed,
Like an elephant gone utterly mad,
Heroic, devouring, fierce, ferocious and wild,
Like the great sky-soaring garuḍa that heeds nothing,
Fierce and squat, a great trunk, terrifying and coiled,
Capable of anything, never turning back, the gold of the ocean,
Having a mind like a mute's, like darkness,
Unchanging like Meru, of great stability,
Like space, free of all wide and narrow,
The Fierce One with a tongue of meteoric iron,
The great Fierce One, master of the discipline,
A mind that devours, like jealous rivalry,
Steadfast in the certain pride of the elephant,
The matchless lion that roars a single sound,
Soft to the touch, keeping company with passion like a bird,
An illusion enticing in the manner of illusion,
Conceptualizing nothing, yet practicing everything,
Unobstructed devourer, swift in action, a devouring mouth,
Swift as an instant, changing like lightning,
A garuḍa guarding whatever is to be guarded,
Mastering the land, taking a bride, moving in the royal court.
The great yogic discipline
Keeps in mind the twelve and the three.
What is practiced here
Is the supreme secret means of yoga:
By introducing it into anything at all, one blends;
It is practicing all moral discipline as one.

Lord of Laṅkā, there is more besides:
The conduct of engaging through accord
Is that very thing, thus, just so:
Whatever manner resembles whatever it may be.
For those whose desire has become male and female,
Whatever appears as male and female from desiring male and female,

To appear as male and female out of the absence of male and female is the conduct of engaging in accord.
For those whom attachment to desire turns to anger,
Whatever appears as anger from desiring anger,
To appear as anger out of the absence of anger is the conduct of engaging in accord.
For those to whom attachment to desire appears as darkness,
Whatever has become darkness from desiring darkness,
To appear as darkness out of the absence of darkness is the conduct of engaging in accord.
Just so, in whatever way, likewise,
With these and the rest, without limit,
All things whatsoever appear there:
Through the conduct of engaging in accord, the aim is accomplished.

"Lord of Laṅkā, one should engage with them in accord with them." When he had said this, the Lord of Laṅkā and the others, both lesser and excellent, became free of conceptualizing the view and conduct that have no final limit.

This is the sixty-fourth chapter, called "Liberation through Displays in the Play of Illusion," from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then the Lord of Laṅkā again put a question to the Lord of Secrets: "O Lord of Secrets, how should the intention of the pledge, 'I shall heal the sick,' be understood?" When he had asked this, the Lord of Secrets said: "Lord of Laṅkā, it is like this. One should heal the sick of the three cities. One should be skilled in the root of disease. One should strive in the means of purging disease. One should rely on excellent physicians. One should keep and increase the medicine of the excellent remedy. One should be skilled in compounding medicines. One should guard the regimen of medicine. One should not part from the gathering of the sick. One should cut the continuity of disease. One should become the remedy for disease.

"Lord of Laṅkā, the three cities are the city of non-appearance, the city of total appearance, and the city of half appearance. The root of disease is the thorn that arises from great darkness. The means of purging disease is bringing together medicine and physician. The excellent physician is the excellent spiritual friend. The medicine of the excellent remedy is calm abiding and

insight. Compounding medicine is applying these to suchness itself. Guarding the regimen of medicine is not departing from suchness. Not parting from the gathering of the sick is not wearying of saṃsāra. Cutting the continuity of disease is the certainty that all things are that very nature. Becoming the remedy for disease is fully delivering beings from saṃsāra.

"Lord of Laṅkā, there is this as well.
On an occasion that I saw and heard,
When that excellent friend of all
Tamed the Lord of the Charnel Ground,
All the chiefs of the world assembled
And were placed in the gathering of the heirs.
From among those vast assemblies
Gathered in that retinue,
A follower of a wrong school, present there incidentally,
One who greatly practiced the discipline of medicine,
The sage Black Kāla,
Approached and made this request:
'You, great and supreme King of Medicine,
Hold the maṇḍala of medicine that conquers poison.
Since you are the enemy of every disease,
Please pacify the diseases of the thorn.'
At this earnest request,
That great and supreme King of Medicine,
With kindly regard for the sage,
Spoke what he had spoken in the gathering before:
'In the casket of the three realms,
The beings of the three existences, the great poisons,
Compounded with the elixir of the buddhas of the three times,
Complete the maṇḍala of self-arisen amṛta.'
When he had spoken this with certainty,
Black Kāla made a request:
'From this body that appears as intrinsic nature
Come the five great requisites,
The amṛta that dispels the five poisons,
The supreme medicine of the sages.'
At this earnest request,
The excellent physician spoke thus:

'Self-arisen and pure from the very beginning,
The medicine compounded from eight roots and a thousand,
The substance of the five families and the five samayas,
The ingredient accomplished in the fullness of the five wisdoms,
In order to liberate all beings of the five lineages,
Is the supreme amṛta that dispels the five poisons.'
Having spoken thus, he remained silent."

Then Black Kāla again made a request:
"Since it arises from oneself, it does not arise from another.
It is pure, being exhausted into nothing but essence and dregs.
The eight roots and the thousand branches
And the five pairs become complete."
At this earnest request,
The heir who had gathered in that retinue,
You yourself, endowed with intelligence and means,
Spoke this means of loosening attachment:
"The five substances, the later outflows,
Since they arise from the cause
That is the continuum of the elements and of food,
Do not arise from oneself; they arise from another."
When the excellent friend had said this,
Black Kāla spoke again:
"If that is how it is,
Then since it is a plain contradiction,
Where could the dharma
Called 'self-arisen, self-arisen' be found?"
When he had asked this question,
The excellent one himself answered him:
"If there is any dharma that arises
Without depending on causes and conditions,
Then since it does not arise from another and has no maker,
That dharma is held to be self-arisen."
When he had said this, in reply
Black Kāla spoke thus:
"It is not abandoned by abandoning it:
A dharma that arises continually from oneself,

Not arising from another, without cause and effect,
Whatever that dharma is, it is self-arisen."
To that the other spoke thus:
"A dharma not to be abandoned but to be adopted
Ought to abide at all times and in every way
Without meeting or parting;
If the continuum of its arising ceases, its continuum ceases."
To that, in this way,
Black Kāla answered again:
"Because it is amṛta, it is able
To perform each of its own proper functions.
In the world, whatever is able
To bring benefit is known as an elixir."
To that, here,
The supreme excellent friend answered:
"Since it is called amṛta,
Amṛta has two functions:
It heals disease and raises the dead;
But these do not have those two powers."
In reply to what he said,
Black Kāla answered him:
"Since countless victors of the past
Practiced these five disciplines as foremost,
And since they held them as the supreme samaya,
They are known to be the samaya of old."
To that the excellent one said:
"If they are certainly the samaya of the buddhas,
Then from the very beginning until completion
One must possess them without parting from them;
If the stream of outflows were cut, one would be parted from them: a contradiction."
To that Kāla said:
"Since the self is permanent,
That outflow too is permanent;
It is utterly and entirely inseparable,
So how could there be parting through its exhaustion?"
To that the excellent one said:

"Since all the outer and inner outflows,
Each and every one, are entirely exhausted,
Consider the grounds, the liberations and the activities:
Needless to say, the path of outflows, all appearance, is exhausted."
To that Kāla said:
"If that is how it is,
Then since it is a plain contradiction,
Do not those who profess that all is equal
Contradict equality itself?"
To that the excellent one said:
"Those who, not knowing what is utterly unmixed,
Fix their minds on the word 'good'
And profess Samantabhadra, the All-Good,
Become the very sense sources of darkness.
Although in total perfection all is equal,
All also appears unmixed.
Whoever does not see the meaning of total perfection
Is a traveler on the wrong path of the conduct of perfection.
The words and sounds of the vehicle of the great secret
Appear in the one as not one, each distinct.
Distinguished by their essential nature,
Whatever they are appears as definitively liberated.
If one definitely holds that the arising of outflows is the root,
Then these, just as they are, uncontrived,
Are from the beginning emptiness, free of conceptual thought:
It is simply the certainty that this is so.
If one asks why they are an elixir:
The disease of yoga is conceptual thought,
Through which one dies again and again in the depths and reaches of saṃsāra.
The root of conceptual thought
Is the five kinds of outer and inner outflows.
Since all of them, in suchness, in emptiness,
Arise free of concepts, without limit or end,
They heal disease and raise the dead."
When that supreme excellent one had answered thus,
Kāla was freed from clinging to signs;

He found that very thing there with certainty, and nowhere else,
And he himself became a great and supreme physician.

"Lord of Laṅkā, these are the deliberations on what was definitively heard: 'One should heal the sick.' This is how it should be definitively understood." When the Lord of Secrets had said this, the Lord of Laṅkā and the others, both lesser and excellent, were completely liberated from the conceptualization of signs.

This is the sixty-fifth chapter, "Self-Arisen Amṛta," from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

The tenth section, placed at the end.

Then again the bodhisattvas of lesser body, the Lord of Laṅkā and the others, said to the Lord of Secrets: "O Lord of Secrets, by what name should we call this supreme secret that you yourself have so extensively deliberated? Into what is the sūtra gathered?" When they had asked this, the Lord of Secrets said: "O Lord of Laṅkā, this supreme secret, which I have deliberated just as it is, should be called by eight alternative names, and the sūtra should be known to be gathered into ten.

"Lord of Laṅkā, if you ask what the eight alternative names are: it is called the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas. It is also called the Essence. It is also called the Tantra of the Vajra Array. It is also called the Scripture of Perfect Yoga. It is also called the Sūtra of All-Gathered Knowledge. It is also called the Realization of the Great Vehicle. It is also called the Arrayed Enumeration of the Dharma. It is also called the Sūtra Teaching How the Great Vehicle Arose.

"If you ask why: Lord of Laṅkā, it is because it does not depart from that which it intends; because it is no one's domain, and everything arises from nonexistence; because its wisdom is fully arrayed; because it explains whatever is certain in this way as yoga; because here everything is drawn in; because the excellent ones have fully comprehended it; because it is arrayed without mixing anything; and because it definitively arose and arises in twelve circumstances.

"Lord of Laṅkā, if you ask what it means that the sūtra is gathered into ten: it is gathered into just ten points, as follows. One should grasp the basis. One should unravel the tantra. One should open the door. One should bring it to

completion. One should gather everything together. One should cross over the pass. One should decide the ground. One should find the experience. One should keep the hardship small. One should make it a single sūtra.

"Lord of Laṅkā, know that the basis of all dharmas is samaya. The abiding of samaya is like this:
That there is nothing to guard and no guarding
Is the supreme samaya of dharmatā.
Since everything is itself supreme,
One should not go against anything at all.
Whoever abides in this supreme samaya
Is on the ground of a supreme vidyādhara.
Toward the objects that are to be guarded,
To be without deceit, pretense or guile is itself supreme.
In this profound, clear, vast and supreme teaching,
The moral disciplines proclaimed in this way
And all the many activities of the ritual manuals
Are all here guarded as samaya and completely pure.
This samaya is greatly marvelous;
Because it is not shared by all,
For all those of small aspiration
One should set the boundaries of what is to be guarded.

The utterly secret teachings of the Great Vehicle
Should be guarded, from those who are not fit vessels,
By the means of concealment
Outer, inner and secret.
Those vessels that are not a proper place for the teaching,
The varieties gathered into four kinds,
Are explained so that the excellent Subhūti of the future
May examine them and keep this secret.
This wish-fulfilling jewel of the great secret
Is not flawed or at fault;
It is for the benefit of those of small intellect
That it is kept utterly secret through compassionate means.
Worldly people, followers of the lesser vehicle,
Those of perverse craving, attached to wrong positions,
Faithless, dull-witted, distracted and torpid,
Who strive at nothing, are like darkness.

These are perverse, their samaya broken, turned away from this;
The rope of their awakening is cut at its depth;
The sprout of their mind is burnt at the root;
They lie face down in the swamp of the lower realms.
Though they speak of the secret meanings in words,
They do not know this hidden secret.
To crooked companions who fancy they know,
They speak above all of what ought to be kept secret.
On the four branches themselves
They hear the sounds, without the meaning, and do not practice.
Those who cannot keep what is entrusted to them
Leak away into saṃsāra without essence.
Though they speak in words of the three supreme treasuries
Of view, samaya and conduct,
They have not come to abide where clinging has no limit.
Tormented by guile, deceit, jealousy and avarice,
Fixed in their grasp of the dharma of non-action,
Yet without that very thing in themselves,
They call yogins inferior;
Their sacred bond is defeated and they sink into saṃsāra.
Feigning good conduct, making guesses, bringing out contemptuous words,
Smooth-tongued, double-tongued, twisting things around,
Deludedly cursing anyone, these oath-bound ones
Are fit only for the sake of arrogance in this one life.
Thieving, guileful, deceitful, cheating and enticing,
Clinging for material gain, delighting in words,
Conceited, eager to talk, hypocritical,
Speakers of falsehood, venomous, they fall in the end.
To such defeated and bad vessels,
The great secret, that very secret,
Being profound and its depth hard to fathom,
Even if taught, becomes a cause of defeat and downfall.
Therefore it is not to be taught.
If it were taught,
Whoever teaches, speaks, or listens,
Would be ruined in this life and the long term: both would burn.
Toward a yogin learned, lucid and meaningful,

Whoever, not knowing yoga,
Under the sway of arrogance or out of jealousy,
Gives rise to whatever kinds of thoughts,
For as many eons as their number
Will experience unbearable results.
If he would afterward attain happiness,
He must first pass through that many eons.
Even one learned, lucid and meaningful,
If he definitely thinks as above,
He too takes on a bad state,
And the learned cannot protect him from it.
If toward an excellent one who has come forth in the way of yoga
One stirs him up with words like weapons,
And speaks ill of him with exaggeration and denigration in song and talk,
One will fall into the vajra hell.
Even the incidental ripening
Will come about exactly as it is.
Yogins of inferior fortune,
Whose root is broken and whose nature is flawed,
Possessed of bad causes, anger and ferocity,
Carry out unbearable and malicious deeds.
Those of ignorant disposition,
Childish in nature and weak of mind,
With an extremely inferior view,
Look to pretenders.
Toward those endowed with the most excellent of the excellent,
Of loving manner, always abiding in patience,
Who likewise seek auspicious aims,
Such people have no aspiration.
While behaving with samaya like a monkey,
A buddha who attains the essence of awakening
Will never come forth;
I have never truly seen one come forth.
Toward a yogin who has become an heir of the victors,
Skilled in showing the path and removing faults,
Some, under the sway of arrogance,
Reject him and by such means bring him to ruin.

That is the bottom stone of saṃsāra;
Never will it rise to the surface of liberation.
Ignorant and deluded yogins
Do not follow
Those who go definitively to the truly excellent,
But follow whoever looks to the desire for material things,
And long for that;
They are travelers on a wrong path.
For the view of yoga and the gain of awakening
They give no thought even if the rope is cut;
For the desire for material things and the gain of guile and trickery,
However small, whatever they pursue, they stake their lives.
One with the nature of a supreme yogin
Is like a lamp inside a vase:
Though he possesses the meaning of the treasury of awareness,
Like the claws of a thieving beast,
He reveals the meaning of what is hidden within,
Yet here the fool sees nothing at all.
For example, it is just like this:
A man who carries treasure on his body
And a man who has become a fool,
Staying in one place, look alike, with no difference between the two.
They speak in praise of this secret,
But do not pursue the secret's meaning.
They speak in praise of samādhi,
But do not pursue the meaning of samādhi.
They speak in praise of the true,
But do not pursue the meaning of the true.
They speak in praise of samaya,
But do not pursue the meaning of samaya.
Just as some beings
Say, "A precious jewel is like this:
All desired qualities come from it,"
And extol its qualities at length;
And when other beings ask them,
"Do you have even a little
Of that which brings forth what is desired?"

They have none, and so reply,
"I have merely mentioned a few
Of the qualities that fulfill needs;
That thing itself I do not have";
Likewise, those who do not strive in yoga,
Being devoid of the dharmas in which one should train,
Though they speak in praise of the excellent,
Have nothing excellent in them.
Such enjoyments as these
Rarely meet with excellence itself.
Whoever, holding the dharma of yoga,
Regards those whose yoga has degenerated, who have perverse craving,
As voices that destroy the secret,
And, as if seeing their evil,
Censures them and binds the ground,
That person is an heir of the excellent.
For example, when someone
Transgresses the king's law,
One who does not let him go as he pleases but applies the rule,
Correcting by command what is hard to straighten,
Becomes renowned and known to all
As "excellent, pleasing to the king's mind."
If a poisonous tree grows in a garden,
As soon as the gardener recognizes the poison,
He tears it out by the root and destroys it.
Why? Because if the poison spread
Among the garden's food plants, people would die.

Those who have degenerated, those poisonous ones,
Should be firmly shunned by the yogin who keeps the discipline,
Whether in dwelling place or for a span of years.
Those who do not shun them but act as their protectors
Are samaya-demons of the secret.
In truth, any yogin who,
Toward the profound oaths and precepts,
Keeps an unwavering intention to guard them,
Even if, in the root and branch commitments,

He should break one without noticing,
Though there will be a ripening, his root is not broken.
Just as the elephant Enaya,
Though it dies and becomes a corpse,
Still serves a purpose through its bezoar,
So even if a yogin degenerates and becomes a corpse,
He becomes something supreme for others
And is able to accomplish their aims.
Even so, all such as these
Should not be seen even in dreams.
Why? Just as a little milk
Going bad spoils all the milk,
A single degenerate yogin
Makes all yogins unruly.
All those of perverse yoga
Who let saṃsāra win the battle
The yogin certain of the ultimate
Should all resolutely cast out.
If they are not cast out and behave perversely,
Saṃsāra will win the battle,
And the power of the blessing of truth will grow small.
Everyone will say, "Practicing virtue does little good,"
Will grow weary of the true aim,
And will incline toward perverse dharmas.
Because everyone engages in perverse actions,
All kinds of unpleasant things arise.
Therefore, whatever the punishment of the command
For both exaggerating and denigrating,
Those possessed of wisdom, by the nature of their view,
Never do any harm at all;
But the wicked and mighty ones
Who dwell in their retinue,
The moment they see the faults
Of yogins who practice perversely, cut them down with punishment,
And all fall headlong into the lower realms.
There is one who is supreme against harm to practice:
Unlike these, complete in all things,

Possessed of lineage and of meaning, of good conduct,
His mind attached to nothing, endowed with emptiness,
Having unlocked the bolt of the mind of delusion
With the key of wisdom and liberation,
Possessing the eye of the King of Dharma,
The excellent domain free of extremes and partisanship,
Knowing how to enter the unerring path,
Thoroughly tamed, like a great tree in its trunk,
Just as is taught in the scriptures of the oaths and precepts:
That excellent sage of austerity
Is the most excellent of the excellent,
And for him one should open the door of the secret.
Just as austerity is mastered by the sage,
So it is a wish-fulfilling jewel:
From it come delightful wishes and happiness;
It is the mother of all vidyādharas and victors.
Likewise, this excellent austerity,
By abiding in it, is the ground of support;
It is also the life force of all austerities;
It is the supreme wealth of all the excellent.
This excellent one is a refuge from fears,
The supreme guide on the path traveled by the excellent,
The boat that ferries across the river of the excellent;
Likewise it is the supreme siddhi.
It is the best of samaya companions;
It is the guide of those blind to samaya;
It is the army that conquers opposing factions;
It brings victory in the battle of saṃsāra.
Therefore it is the excellent proof.
In such a way that one's three doors,
Holding to the limit of the three purities,
Do not here spoil the four empowerments,
One holds the three doors together with non-harm:
These are the four key points of being wholly unimpaired.
Brought to completion, with the four kinds of seals and signs,
The key points are counted in mindfulness and dedicated.
The children of small aspiration,

Possessed of the continuity of discipline and bound by the precepts,
Should diligently guard
Everything down to the subtlest of the subtle.
Of the vajra body, speech and mind,
There is speech, conduct, the delightful,
Not abandoning, the knowable, accomplishment,
Nonexistence, openness, oneness,
And spontaneous presence: ten kinds.
From this view a hundred thousand arise.
It is the supreme wealth to be practiced
By every yoga of yoga.
To the child who practices after definitive examination
From the family lineage of excellent yoga,
This scripture is taught, definitive for the mind
Of the profound and supremely perfect bliss.
Its preliminary is samaya:
Before the profound and all the rest,
In order to guard the narrow and dangerous paths
Of the fierce vajra oaths,
If the general and particular samayas
Are made firm through the definitive meaning,
That is a great vessel of treasure.
Thus, having taken one's stand in the excellent vow,
On every occasion and at every time,
To be able to guard what must be guarded,
The samayas of disciplined conduct,
Comes first among all samayas.
Having abandoned all that does not serve the aim,
One should practice thus, in order to accord with all.
The one that cannot be crushed is the lion,
For it is the king of beasts of prey.
A casket is the king's treasury;
It is not fitting to throw poison into it.
The tender shoots of precious sprouts
Should not be cut, severing the stream of their growth.
Even ordinary melted snow water
The wise should not drink.

The anthers of the lotus should not be opened;
Unless by moonlight, it should not be opened.
Into an unexamined vessel full of holes
Medicine of amṛta poured will leak away.
Those with meaningless and artificial signs of conduct
Should not be kept or kept company with.
Precious eggs of white crystal
Should not be sunk into the mud of a swamp.
The milk of the white lioness
Should not be poured into a vessel not made of gold.
The precious wish-fulfilling jewel
Is not to be burned.
The great garuḍa's wings, spread in the sky,
Are not to be broken.
The fiery bolts of meteoric iron
Are not to be hammered.
The deeds performed in the play of tigers and lions
Should not be mimicked.
The foundation packed with great vajra rock,
How could it be torn down?
The fence of the vajra enclosure,
Which is to bind, is not to be torn apart.
The lamp that burns the firewood
Should not be shaken by fierce scattering winds.
The flowing streams of vajra words
Are not to be cut off at random.
The king's edicts and seals
Should not be erased carelessly.
The fortress packed with vajra diamond
Should not be overturned from its foundation.

The wish-fulfilling jewel on the crown
Should not be taken down from the top of the victory banner.
Distinguished by the means of yoga,
It is the samaya of those of skill,
The supreme wealth of the fortunate.
The supreme wealth of constant training

Is the meditative concentrations of vajra activity.
With the vajra armor and stake of great wrath,
The enemy that obstructs life,
The dense afflictions, should be destroyed.
What has become the basis of idleness and laziness,
The mountain of pride that boasts of mastery,
The essence that inflames the senses and weakens them,
And the conditions that make one swagger should also be restrained.
Apart from the secret mantra of the Great Vehicle,
Whatever signs there are, the words of the childish,
Should not be uttered even in part;
Everything should be done as that very nature alone.
Just as people who are to be put to death,
When the executioner is about to kill them,
Strive at the means of escape,
So one should strive diligently, slaying the enemy of laziness.
To remove the obstacles that obscure yoga,
Those bound by the knot of austerity and vows
Should abandon attachment to sensual pleasures and discord,
Being not one here with what is one,
Being two-faced, outer and inner, and given to harmful deeds,
Intoxication with desire, dullness, torpor and greed,
Faithlessness, broken roots, haughtiness and distraction:
All the wise should abandon these.
These are obstructors of yoga;
They interrupt yoga.
For one who has definitively entered yoga,
The māras that interrupt its continuity
Are great conceptual jealousy;
Indifference and laziness toward everything;
Possessions, busyness and distraction;
Harsh words, those sharp weapons;
And anger, ferocity, short temper and great turbulence:
These are the five māras of the practice of yoga.
They obscure the true aim;
With the antidote, the supreme mind of awakening,
Turn them back into the state of great peace.

The enemies who steal the wealth of yoga
Should be tamed by one skilled in means.
Whoever contrives the nature of yoga
Falls away from being a sage;
Through the notoriety of his misdeeds,
That is the enemy that makes them a laughingstock.
Through an inferior view and coarse, careless conduct,
They habitually behave against this;
By going against the command and engaging in malicious deeds,
That is the enemy of corruption, which does not serve the aim.
Transgressing the vajra austerity and samaya,
Not having become the expanse, they are corrupt through laxity;
Like a tree whose roots have rotted,
That is the enemy that, breaking, falls into the six.
As for applying oneself to the genuine itself,
If one has no definitive words about it,
The aims are not accomplished,
And it does not become a result: that is the enemy of deviation.
These enemies that steal the supreme, excellent wealth
From yogins who practice yoga,
The four enemies of fault, one should turn back
With intelligence skilled in means.
These fields that appear as the three existences
Are definitively pure fields;
Since the grounds are purified all at once,
The fields are the most excellent of all.
These gatherings of sensual pleasures as offerings
Are the supreme of great requisites;
They are the marvelous offerings
That please all the excellent wisdom minds.
These places of saṃsāra, these charnel grounds,
Are the places of great bliss:
The unerring, uncontrived dharmadhātu,
The ground of effortless spontaneous presence.
The five great poisons, the root of all,
Are the five great wisdoms themselves;
Since the all-knowing self-awareness is self-arisen,

The yogin possesses the eye of self-awareness.
Lord of Laṅkā, these
Are the supreme secret samayas.
In these words of instruction from the excellent,
Whoever is a definitive yogin,
Just as from seeds planted
In reliance on moist ground,
Only the excellent is fit to enter.
Through yearning, whatever its very nature,
Yearning, one enters the domain of the excellent.
Lord of Laṅkā, how is it?
If you ask what it is like:
On one occasion that I saw and heard,
When my excellent spiritual friend
Was teaching this path at length
To great assemblies,
Gathered in this retinue
Were goddesses, nāginīs, and women of low caste;
Since a retinue of six maidens had gathered,
The six fruits came to ripen.
Just as that which holds the life of the living,
Since it has become the basis of all dharmas,
Abiding in this samaya,
Through its ripening into unsurpassed awakening,
Is the excellent holder of the life of virtue.
If it should degenerate,
The places of rebirth for punishment, the eight great hells,
With unbearable and fierce suffering,
Turn like a wheel of weapons.
Lord of Laṅkā, if you ask
What degeneration from this is:
Great total degeneration,
Degeneration of the root, degeneration of the branches,
Likewise degeneration of recitation, and incidental degeneration: these five
Arise constantly in a continuous cycle.
The means by which they are to be restored
I shall explain as five kinds:

Action, substance, aspiration,
Samādhi, and suchness itself.
Action restores in five ways:
For the first, one hundred thirty thousand;
For degeneration of the root, fifty-three thousand;
For degeneration of the branches,
One should complete five thousand three hundred;
For degeneration of recitation, one hundred fifty-three;
For incidental degeneration,
Restore it with fifteen, one and three.
Substance is with the five kinds of precious things:
Whatever samaya of the families has been broken,
Toward whichever gurus of the five families
Whatever oath was destroyed, one makes amends with that wealth.
Aspiration is with faith and clear trust,
With a cry of intense longing,
Lamenting constantly without ceasing;
Even while one undergoes life in a great hell,
It becomes the supreme antidote:
That is excellent restoration.
The great means of samādhi is this:
Though fire is needed to burn the world,
No fire is needed to burn habitual tendencies:
Since the fire of the wisdom of awareness arises,
All the firewood of obscurations is burned.
Though wind is needed to scatter the world,
No wind is needed to blow away signs:
Since the wind of the wisdom of awareness arises,
All the dust of signs is swept away.
Though water is needed to wash the body,
No water is needed to wash the mind:
Since the water of the wisdom of awareness arises,
All the grime of habitual tendencies is cleansed.
The river of emptiness is the bathing pool;
From the sky of suchness
It is burned in the eon of blazing, radiating fire:
That is the most excellent drying.

As for suchness itself, its supreme means:
For any excellent yogin,
When the punishment for degeneration arises,
Likewise, though suchness itself is unmoved,
There is no protector or refuge other than it;
There is no convention of degenerated and not degenerated;
Restored or not restored is beyond the path of words.

"Lord of Laṅkā, these should be known as the deliberation on fully grasping the basis." When he had said this, the lesser ones, the Lord of Laṅkā and the others, came to enjoy fully the wealth of the excellent.

This is the sixty-sixth chapter, called "The Supreme Secret of Samaya," from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then again the Lord of Secrets said: "O excellent friends, the full liberation of the mind-stream depends upon the excellent one. And what is that? It is as follows:

The condition that ripens the unsurpassed Essence,
The one of great intelligence to whom questions are put,
The guide for those who have lost the way, the spiritual friend and protector,
The precious lamp that dispels darkness,
The eye faculty that sees, the mental consciousness,
The boat that ferries across the fordless river,
The great fortress against fear, the castle to rely on,
The supreme physician who draws out the chronic sickness of saṃsāra,
The captain who brings back jewels from the islands of the ocean:
That excellent guru
Should first be known with certainty.

The treasury of the collections, the great house of treasures,
The twelve keys of commentary,
The excellent definitive sūtras and the ten principles,
The ten limits, the branch sūtras and the root:
Whether one here possesses the ten topics in full,
Whether the extremes of faults have been exhausted
And one has crossed to the far shore of the ocean of qualities,
Whether or not one has reached the measure of an excellent one,
When looking to such a one as spiritual friend and protector,

Whether he is consummate and perfectly complete:
Since what one knows oneself is not the measure of this,
With methods and their branches
One should examine him through others.
If, on examination, he is endowed with all that merits dedication,
One should not go over to another.
If the five requisites of the excellent one are complete,
It is not a matter of lacking the lesser requisites.
If he is surely Samantabhadra himself,
The object of his gaze is not the base.
A lamp does not hold steady in a raging gale;
It is not found in the lowly, loose in desire and loose in speech;
How could it be in the foolish, the dull and the deluded?
Just so with the faults of worldly people:
However those excellent ones may be,
If they are surely guides skilled in the path,
However hard it may be to bear,
All of it, all of it, should be borne.
This excellent one is the guide;
Since he is my protector,
All worldly conventions
Are surely, every one of them, illusion.
These mere trivialities here,
For whom are they a hindrance to the excellent one?
Toward this that is seen for a mere instant,
"If it is like that, then it is like this";
One simply bears it for so long as it lasts.
Come what may, overcome it and practice.
Will not this perverse grumbling
Be turned to the excellent aim?
Reflecting thus, one should hold him as excellent.
Focusing on the great long-term aim,
Generate one's understanding afresh.
Toward the excellent one of supreme bliss,
Because of these momentary conventions,
How could one possibly be indifferent?
When here I wander without a protector,

In all these directions,
Where is anyone of the kind from whom help comes?
Apart from the excellent one there is not a single one.
Though here there are many helpers and protectors,
And whatever ties one may have with the lowly,
They are experts in a mind bent on wrong practice,
Advisers in leaping over a precipice;
They have no thought of holding one back for one's own good.
Why, without a spiritual friend as refuge,
Do all go off to the city of the low-born?
How could they be fit objects of a trusting, loving mind?
For one wandering here in darkness,
The one who shows the path of the light of supreme bliss
Is that great refuge, the excellent one;
No other is able to protect.
Therefore, to the excellent ones
One should attend with utmost devotion, drawing near.
When here the way of light dawns,
Pray with longing to the excellent one himself.
Once one has obtained light from the excellent one,
Of acts that would go against that excellent one
Do not do even the measure of a particle.
Do not break the seal, do not cast aside the transmission;
From the first longing until one is fit for the work,
One must rely on him.
Whoever here has not recognized him
And passes the time in mere indifference,
For him there is no excellent aim,
Because he lacks that condition.
Turning from the objects of training, consumed by doubt,
Through laziness not striving toward the object,
Through slackness showing him no respect,
The knowable is veiled by masses of darkness.
As the seeing of the sky is blocked by thick clouds,
As a knot is one that a child has not the strength to open,
So the binding of knots arises from this:
How could the mind-stream possibly be liberated?

One who is poor in the five excellent requisites,
If that destitute one would free others,
They too become poor.
Being bereft of excellent sustenance,
Destitute of great enjoyments,
They fall into a very wilderness of famine.
Once such a lowly person
Has been taken as one's excellent one,
Whether he is surely excellent or not,
How could breaking his word be proper?
If one's seal with him is breached,
One goes to the Vajra Hell
And experiences unbearable suffering.
The dog that guards the hell, known as Lude,
Like a lion in form,
With fangs like long awls and sharp points,
Sets upon one and chases one along a path of weapons.
Into the forest of swords with razor-sharp edges
One runs here and there, without refuge.
In the fordless river
Of boiling molten bronze and scalding ash one sinks.
Into a dark pit of blazing fire,
Filled with tridents and great arrows,
Needle-like sharp points and long awls,
And sharp knives and swords, one falls.
From those successions of suffering
There is no chance of release.
Having become a disciple, what person with a mind
Would do wrong to that excellent one?
Having wronged all the buddhas,
They always go headlong downward.
Whoever transgresses the excellent one himself,
Who is joined in equality with all the excellent ones,
The excellent yogins who have gained power,
All in turmoil, drink his great blood.
The arranged syllables of the excellent letters
Dawn within the great breath,

And a nine-headed iron scorpion
That has become rākṣasas and yakṣas
Kills him and sends him on into the great hell.
Harmers and robbers of wealth,
Obstructors, and the poisoned points of evil
Do harm to that degenerate one.
Being a sinner, he dies.
Royal punishment and the like,
The eight fears, befall him.
Toll collectors, great beasts of prey and the like,
He is killed by yakṣas and goes to misery.
Why? Because of the eight classes of gods and demons,
All the fierce males, fierce females and oath-bound ones
Are protectors of the Dharma, servants of the command,
And never let the moment pass in carrying out the command.
Therefore the children who practice the Dharma
And enter upon the excellent
Should never disparage his feet,
Nor break even a corner of his word.

Whoever single-mindedly guards the Dharma,
The guardians who protect the Dharma,
The fierce ones of great power as well,
Will always protect him like a son.
And what is it to guard the Dharma?
Whoever is not deluded about any phenomena
And has certain knowledge
Becomes skilled in guarding the Dharma.
Whoever is unskilled in everything
And holds firmly to a deluded view
Cannot be changed by any attempt to change him,
And will never guard the Dharma.
If at all times
That excellent one and he are one,
Yet through a weak character, weariness and sloth
He goes against him, it is a cause of downfall and obscuration.
Therefore do not cut off the scripture of the excellent one.

The scripture of the excellent one, established as valid,
Is all of it spoken with hidden intent,
Applied in keeping with its audience.
And what is that like?
It is as when those with perverse craving ask,
"Who is it that guides the world?"
"O you who bring delight to the world,
If you know how to teach all things as delight,
And, having shown the meaning of delight as I do,
Know the fruit beyond doubt,
Then you are called omniscient."
What was taught to those of such inclination was this:
"If you kill, destroy and utterly vanquish
Father, mother, brahmins and kings,
They are forever the supreme of bliss."
One who was taught this and practiced it
Came to possess the bliss of supreme bliss.
Likewise, in the hidden intent of the Word
There are sūtras and matters of great importance;
So if you trust the one you have taken
As great refuge and excellent one to be valid and excellent,
Hold his way too as excellent.

Lord of Laṅkā, at the time when
The Lord of the Supreme Secret
Commanded me in these words,
"Vajrasattva, Vajradhara, listen!
Those who attain buddhahood over a hundred thousand eons
Should know the master as one held in awe.
Why? Because the buddhas of the eons
Arose in reliance upon masters.
Without relying on masters
Buddhas do not arise;
I have never truly seen them arise so.
Were they to arise, it would contradict the way of the excellent.
Before the excellent one who is endowed with the meaning,
At all times of the three times,

When all the sugatas and victors
Dwelling in the realms of the ten directions arrive,
They pay homage with mantra and with longing.
Beings, gods and humans,
Likewise nāgas and yakṣas,
Rākṣasas holding wrong views,
And all the vidyādharas gather together,
Scatter emanated flowers everywhere, and say:
'Guru, excellent spiritual friend,
You are our father.
Guru, excellent spiritual friend,
You are our mother.
Guru, excellent spiritual friend,
You are our protector.
You are the counselor of those whose minds are ignorant and deluded,
The guide of those who have lost the way,
The lamp of those who wander in dark caverns,
The jewel that dispels torment.
To your sun face we bow and pay homage;
To your sky mind we bow and pay homage;
To your moon body we bow and pay homage;
To your lotus feet we bow and pay homage.'
Thus with joy and reverence
They pay homage with mantra and with longing.
Therefore, since all the victors
And the sattvas and vidyādharas
Arise from the excellent of the excellent,
Just as a mother gives birth to a child,
So should you know the excellent one.
The nature of that excellent one, moreover, is this:
A trustworthy and tamed mind,
An intelligence measureless and vast,
Withstanding conditions, patient, upright in all things,
Honest in conduct and without deceit;
To all beings who are in danger
He gives by skillful means fearlessness of every kind;
Heroic, powerful, of great diligence;

In every object of knowledge
He proceeds just as he wishes;
Though questioned to the end of existence, he knows no exhaustion;
When examined, his qualities appear more and more;
He speaks the truth and his word does not change;
He does just as he has said;
Toward good and bad deeds
He has no conceptual grasping at liking and disliking;
Like the lion, king of beasts,
Splendid and majestic, he is not drawn in by objects;
He has given up busyness and base activities;
Free of wandering and distraction wherever he is, always;
Like a lion he dwells alone,
Keeping to the wilderness and solitary paths.
One endowed with these is worthy to be the excellent one,
An object of veneration in every way excellent."

Even if he lacks that nature,
If he holds the treasury of the excellent and its stewardship,
Take him as excellent and treat him as excellent.
Even if he does not know or realize all phenomena,
By greatly honoring and serving
The guru who has become one's excellent one,
One will cross the ocean of saṃsāra.
Why? Just as seed sown in a fine, moist field
Grows and multiplies,
So in the supreme field of excellent merit
Not a single sesame seed is lost or fails to increase.
There are four excellent spiritual friends
Who protect from the extremes of saṃsāra:
Source, scripture, empowerment,
And the measure of certain understanding: these four.
From them arise four antidotes:
The power of generating the mind, the power of regret,
The power of action and the power of focus;
They overcome the powers of wrongness.
One crosses the four rivers,

All mind-streams are fully liberated,
And one becomes the excellent of the excellent."
Having spoken thus, he said nothing more.

Therefore, Lord of Laṅkā, here,
The intelligent, with joy and reverence,
Before those known to have become excellent ones,
Should show respect three times in their presence
And touch their feet with the crown of the head.
Toward those who are excellent, or not yet certain,
Gathering the excellent Dharma and the rest,
In order to overcome faults,
One should show worldly courtesy and respect.
When his word comes, whether in reproach or in encouragement,
Respond again and again with attentive deference.
Marking the pauses with words of courtesy,
Recall all of this as is fitting.
On occasions of asking after his ease, receiving, rising,
Carrying out tasks, making requests and the like,
With a pliant mind, courteous and respectful,
Without obstinacy, act boldly and diligently.
In every way keep a modest bearing and remain conscientious;
Speak honestly and without deceit.
Why? Because one who acts toward one who has become excellent
Unreliably and deceitfully
Deceives all who have become excellent,
And falls into the Vajra Hell.
Those diligent and persevering, of good disposition,
Able to bear blows and to keep secrets,
Elegant, of pleasing countenance, with graceful manners,
Of good conduct in the three doors, restraining the three extremes,
Should act in harmony with the excellent one himself,
And with clarity and purity discern what they understand.
When sitting at ease among the excellent,
Do not become the subject of everyone's talk.
Regarding anyone's good or bad conduct,
Do not disparage them behind their backs.

Speaking of good and bad about oneself,
Telling all one has seen, saying all, exaggerating and denigrating,
If one wishes to draw others into talk:
Cut off talk and one will find ease.
In the places where the excellent dwell,
Do not speak in anger, harshly, or idly.
Do not act in a careless manner.
Do not speak without decorum, improperly,
Or without awe.
Do not boast of daring, ability, or all one has seen,
Nor make empty brags and the like.
Words that cut others down with contempt,
And taking sides, should not be engaged in.
To one who has become the abode of the excellent,
Offerings that are suitable and appropriate,
Wealth and riches, the finest garments,
The finest elixirs, food and the like,
Should be offered and presented to please him.
Thereby illness, poverty and the like,
And the sufferings of hunger and fever,
Will never strike.
Making requests, making offerings, being ill,
Waiting in his presence for his word,
Not understanding the conduct of the excellent:
Staying in one place with the excellent ones,
It is never right to be ignorant of attendance;
Not to act in this way is a fault.
Do not step on the shadow of his body,
And do not tread upon his footprints.
His clothes, cushion, supports and the like
Should never be stepped over.
When the excellent one's word comes, carry it out as it names.
If one is not able and cannot do it,
Without pretense or the like, give up the post.
Guard the excellent one's property like your life.
His close attendants, regard as the excellent one;
His retinue and servants, regard as relatives;

Always look on them with an even mind.
A throne, a bed, a comfortable seat, the manner of a guru,
Disrespect and other improper ways
Are unseemly in the presence of the excellent one;
If one does these, courtesy and samaya decline.
Covering the head, carrying a parasol,
Leaning on the hand, leaning the body, likewise baring the upper body,
And here, coarse and disorderly ways,
Should not be done within his sight.
The ways of commoners, caṇḍālas and low-caste women
Are never fit to come before the excellent one's gaze.
The conduct of the wanton and the mad who roam everywhere
Is not for the presence of the excellent.
Act on whatever arises in his visible instruction;
As the act arises, so the action arises.
Act gently and slowly, as though wary of being heard.
Within sight of the excellent one's conduct
Do not behave with great carelessness.
Having trained, adopt a graceful manner,
And remain conscientious.
Whatever the body must discharge
Should not be within his sight or hearing.
Visible bodily functions
The intelligent do not perform there.
Crowding together in idle gatherings
Is not fitting in the excellent one's presence.
Restless, distracted, greedy and unpeaceful ways
Should not be shown within his range.
The bodily functions that arise from the elements,
Hiding, concealing, screening or covering them,
Do all things softly, quietly and gently,
In whatever way is seemly before that excellent one.
From whatever side the excellent one moves his seat,
Be attentive on one's own part and show courtesy.
Moving, folding, pressing and airing, prepare his seat;
From whatever is lacking, arrange it for his comfort.
Make effort beforehand, and when his word comes, gather courtesy;

And when it is completed, do likewise.
When the intelligent engage in the four modes of conduct,
Apply courtesy and respect in the same way.
Disrespect and indifference
Should never be shown at all.
Courtesy, honor and service:
Before a task and at its very time,
Include courtesy and go about at ease.
Ask after his ease and the like with courtesy.
In the very presence of true austerity,
Wherever one is and whatever the occasion, offer courtesy.
Never call him by his name;
Saying "excellent one," "guru," "spiritual friend,"
Add a word of respect at the end.
Make distinctions of respect in everything.
When his word comes, say, "As you command."
Receive his speech with palms joined.
Follow the excellent one's word as it comes.
All of this is what courtesy signifies.
Adopting a graceful manner, with reverent longing,
Request permission three times.
With humble pliancy free of obstinacy and pride,
Do all attendance mindful of his intent.
With the conduct of a newly ordained monk,
Give up flirtatious and similar behavior,
And the wearing of ornaments and bearing of weapons.
That intelligent reverence itself
Let one examine in oneself,
And give up grounds for others' censure.
Whatever person all agree is good,
Act as he does.
Whatever base one all agree is not praiseworthy,
Give up his conduct.
Maṇḍalas and the like, fire offerings,
Accepting disciples, and teaching the Dharma
Should not be undertaken without his word;
In the excellent one's domain this is not fitting.

If one works for the benefit of others,
Do not use the requisites received for it;
Offer them all to the excellent one,
And take what remains after the excellent one has taken.
Even making disciples of the excellent one's disciples
Is not fitting in the excellent one's presence.

It is not only honor, courtesy and the like:
Whatever there is, the excellent one himself possesses.
Whatever the excellent one bestows out of compassion,
The intelligent should receive with both hands,
Going forward with courtesy to meet it.
Free of dullness, with clear mindfulness, well composed,
Do not transgress your own deportment.
That sun among the intelligent,
In order to worship the excellent one like a deity,
Should offer in full to that excellent one
The eight requisites that please him:
Faith without weariness,
Humble pliancy without obstinacy or pride,
Material goods without miserliness,
Courtesy without hesitation,
Uprightness without guile or deceit,
One's own being without flattery,
Wisdom without delusion,
And stainless superior intention: these eight
Offer in full to that excellent one.
When the bounds of the training enjoined by the excellent one
Are completed in full, the mind-stream is freed,
And one moves unobstructed through all that can be known.
The wisdom that unties the knots of one's own mind-stream
Moves like a bird in the sky.
At the end, the stream untied and objects abandoned,
One's kingdom and one's own body,
Sons and wife, wealth and riches,
The supreme wealth one most cherishes and delights in,
Offer to that excellent one.

Even one's own body, as is fitting,
Redeem with wealth for whatever it is worth.
Then, just as it is, wherever one is at ease,
Enter into resting in genuine yoga.
The excellent ones of old, the excellent,
Follow in the footsteps of the sugatas.
The sugatas, the excellent ones of old,
Having pleased the excellent captain,
Abandoned everything and went to the edges of the wilderness;
By this the excellent one himself is pleased.
Therefore, from the excellent captain
Never be separated at any time,
Just like a body and its shadow.
When the intelligent ask, they become excellent.
Just as a thoroughbred steed
Bound by a restraining fetter,
Once released, comes out with ease
And goes unhindered anywhere,
So this thoroughbred faculty of mind,
Bound by the bonds of ignorance,
When the excellent one opens the door of liberation,
Frees all its mind-streams and goes unhindered.
This is the untying of the knotted bonds
Of beings in the stream of ignorance;
To become accustomed to the training
That frees the mind-streams is most precious.

"Lord of Laṅkā, these should be known as the thorough deliberation on the bounds of the training that fully frees the mind-stream." When he had said this, the sattvas of lesser body came to know that the countless buddhas had been trained by excellent masters.

This is the sixty-seventh chapter, called "The Supreme Excellent Honoring," from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then again the Lord of Secrets said to the bodhisattvas of excellent body: "O friends, the opening of the doors is as follows:

Upon the essence ascertained
As suchness just as it is,
By way of awareness and unawareness,
In what appears in two ways,
As all-knowing conduct and as all-pervading delusion,
It becomes many and diverse.
Delusion appears in two ways:
Ignorance and wrong knowing.
Ignorance is twofold: the slack and the Lokāyatas.
Wrong conception is the Extremists and the tīrthikas.
These, moreover, attached and with perverse craving,
Are called 'the world' and 'the worldly.'
The wrongness of the tīrthikas and the wrongness from other conditions
Are also described as 'arising incidentally.'
These two kinds of ignorance, appearing as the basis,
Those of inferior lineage and of uncertain lineage,
And those of severed lineage who hold perceptions:
These are darkness thickly gathered on every side.
The four with perceptions: the attached,
The distracted, and the timid,
And those known as Endowed with Inclination,
Appear as fields that hold the seed.
This wrong conception is a wondrous thing:
Three hundred and sixty-two,
Twenty or ten, five and two,
It appears in many diverse forms.
From partisan holding that lacks the requisites come
The view of the perishing collection, extreme views,
Wrong views, holding views as supreme,
And holding one's own discipline as supreme:
These are known as the five classes of discordant kinds.
Wrong by nature is wrongness itself.
Wrong from other conditions: practicing without subtlety,
Relying on scripture yet holding only to its signs,
Practicing artificially and speaking nonsense.
Relying on a mere fragment of scripture,
Going astray on the wrong side, corrupted by adulteration,
And deciding from a partial standpoint: these are known as the four kinds.

The artificial are only two:
Those changed by another and those changed by this.
Endowed with five, place, retinue, requisites, wealth
And enjoyments, they are changed by another.
Eternalism from recollection, holding to dependence as the cause,
The extreme of nonexistence, knowing the infinite,
The view of total non-distraction,
The view asserting that consciousness exists after death,
Likewise the view of nonexistence,
The view that this arises from that,
The view that it is neither existent nor nonexistent,
And 'when I die, this life is nirvāṇa.'
Here, relying on a mere fragment
Is simply not being what it is not.
What has become going astray on the wrong side
Is sixfold: each separate and distinct;
The general view that whatever is known is faultless;
The view of the cause, the view of purity through loving-kindness;
The view of purity through contrived livelihood;
Contrived ornaments, shoes and clothing,
Matted locks and adornments;
And sixth, relying on austerities.
What is corrupted by adulteration:
Relying on it, the view of self, conceiving supports,
Attachment to supports, attachment to blessings, auspicious signs,
And wrong refuge: these are utterly corrupt.
What is deciding from a partial standpoint?
Outsiders and the genuine,
Secret mantra practitioners and those of the great secret.
Here the outsiders are of three kinds:
The Vaiśeṣikas, the conventionalists,
And those who decide one-sidedly from their own appearances.
The genuine are subtle and profound,
Vast and spacious, suchness itself.
Secret mantra: the Vedas, conduct of awareness,
And union of families, deciding from a partial standpoint as excellent.
The great secret: great practice of discipline,

Those who overthrow kings and those of royal methods.
These that arise incidentally
Are complete in ten limitless classes;
Whoever has reached the limit holds the signs
And is an attendant of all the buddhas.
Lord of Laṅkā, moreover,
Just as it came from his mouth,
After the lamp of the world has set,
Those of diverse inclinations
Arise incidentally in the same way.
All-knowing conduct is also of two kinds:
The gradual and the simultaneous.
Gradual entry is of three kinds:
The unmistaken itself,
And the three of accomplishment, conduct and realization.

This too, by way of two kinds of distinction,
Was taught by the excellent one in threes, threes and twos:
Do you not know it?
Therefore great and small, two, three and six.
Accomplishment is twofold, profound and subtle:
The greatly intelligent, the profound, and the lesser.
Conduct is of vast waves and partial,
Vast, and practicing with signs;
That is explained as the secret of the great secret.
Realization is of two kinds, entering outer and inner.
Seizing on the crux of the discordant side,
The wish for the two parts separately arises.
The outer are two, the Vaiśeṣikas and the conventionalists;
From one of the two parts dispute arises.
Entering inward: the mind's appearance without center or edge;
Holding to the side that joins outer and inner as one,
Here definitive decision arises;
Distinguishing extremes and center, definite entry,
And establishing arise in the same way.
Holding to the side of one's own view,
Through debate doubt arises,

And distinguishing center and extremes, definite entry,
And establishing arise in the same way.
For the yogin of simultaneous entry,
Action, the means of action, and non-action,
The born, the unborn, and no birth or cessation:
All this is unmixed and perfectly complete.
Unmixed: planets and stars spread across the sky;
Perfectly complete: all-pervading, spread out like the sky;
Like a rainbow in the sky, unmixed and one.
The deluded, the gradual, and the conduct of simultaneous entry:
Abandoning attachment to objects of desire,
Transforming conduct, realizing through knowledge, mastering conduct.
Knowledge: worldly, conceptual and noble;
Conduct: that of the intelligent, the means of mastery.
The vessels for this, too, he saw as four:
Those of the lineage of attachment, clinging and perverse craving,
And to the vessels possessed of intelligence
What is to be taught was spoken in four ways:
Words that lead, conditioned by their wishes, provisional and indirect;
Hidden intent; and the ultimate, definitive: these four
Are matched to the conditions of the vessels.
All this, on the one ground of the knowable,
Is seen differently according to one's wishes.
Thus, just as the doors of seeing differ,
In the array of manifold appearances,
One who enters and looks into them all
And brings them down to one is the excellent one.
Just as a bee in search of a hole
Goes into every one and comes out again,
And then, whichever is its own crevice,
Enters it surely and stays there,
So the yogin who seeks the meaning
Gathers, following, whatever doors of conduct there are,
Enters the doors of view, examines and compares them,
And arrives at the very secret of the definitive ultimate.
In order to track down that meaning itself,
Comparing all the doors throughout

Is the method in which to train;
To become accustomed to it is most precious.

"Lord of Laṅkā, these are the full opening of the doors that appear as arising later; they should be known as the thorough deliberation on the bounds of training in comparing all." When he had said this, the sattvas of lesser body came to know the doors of all phenomena as self-appearing.

This is the sixty-eighth chapter, called "Fully Opening the Doors of All Phenomena," from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then again the Lord of Secrets said to the sattvas of lesser body: "O friends, what is it that is to be brought to completion? It is this: the aspect of the inconceivable is to be brought to completion as the unthinkable. The unthinkable is to be brought to completion as the suchness of mind. The suchness of mind is to be brought to completion as the suchness of the gathering of the excellent intentions. Why is that? If one is skilled in the suchness of the gathering of the excellent intentions, one becomes skilled in the suchness of mind. If one is skilled in the suchness of mind, one becomes skilled in the unthinkable. If one is skilled in the unthinkable, one becomes skilled in the aspect of the inconceivable. If one is skilled in the inconceivable, that is omniscience, and it should be known as the very gathering of all the intentions.

"Friends, therefore, the aspect of all inconceivable phenomena is fully explained by three kinds of yogin. What are the three? The yoga of action, the yoga of performing action, and the yoga of non-action.

"Friends, the yoga of action, moreover, should be known as threefold. What are the three? Outer yoga, inner yoga, and outer and inner yoga. Friends, among these, what is outer yoga? It is this: the great yoga called earth vajra, and likewise water vajra, fire vajra, wind vajra, space vajra, form vajra, sound, smell, taste, touch, and the great yogas called dharma vajra, brought to completion and made supreme in the suchness of the excellent intention.

"Friends, inner yoga is this: the great yoga called mind vajra, and likewise the yogas called the vajra of whatever is grasped, conception, analysis and the like, brought to completion and made supreme in the suchness of the excellent intention.

"Friends, what is outer and inner yoga? It is this: the aspects of all, of white, of black, of the certain, of the uncertain, of the lesser, of the excellent, of what arises, of what does not arise, of the made, of the unmade, of the prescribed, of the unprescribed, of the common and of the particular, brought to completion and made supreme in the suchness of the excellent intention. Friends, these should be known as the yoga of action.

"What is the yoga of performing action? It is this: support, conduct, the eye, distinction, the unchanging, suppression by prowess, and total awareness. Friends, these too are brought to completion and made supreme in the suchness of the excellent intention. Friends, moreover, there are these: union, non-abiding, moving, transforming, prowess, arising, entering, door, knowing, abode, awareness, path, entering, primordial wisdom, and pervading; these aspects too are brought to completion and made supreme in the suchness of the excellent intention. Moreover, the doors of seeing, non-distraction, meaning, word, mantra and letter: these aspects too are brought to completion and made supreme in the suchness of the excellent intention. Friends, these should be known as the yoga of performing action.

O friends, what is the yoga of non-action? It is this: ground, training, application, examination, transgression, the unerring, certainty, intention, primordial wisdom, accumulation, practice, accomplishment, meditative absorption, the great, primordial wisdom, the mode of arising, greatness, play, boldness, splendor, power, miraculous display, and complete perfection; these aspects are to be brought to completion and made supreme in the suchness of the excellent intention. How is that? Friends, it is like this:

Just as one who climbs to a lofty mountain's peak
With diligence, never growing weary,
Sees everything clearly from that high place,
And so knows well the paths, all laid out in view,
So too, if on the lofty mountain of wisdom
One surveys everything with excellent diligence,
Wisdom reaches what is supreme over all,
And the primordial wisdom of the skilled is beyond measure.
One should become skilled in the meaning;
This is the supreme training.
To become skilled in that very excellent intention
Is most precious.

Friends, these should be fully known as what is to be brought to completion.

When he had said this, the heroic beings of lesser bodies became supreme over all and attained forbearance toward the suchness of the excellent intention.

This is the sixty-ninth chapter of the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas, called Teaching the Inconceivable.

Then again the Lord of Secrets spoke to the excellent ones: "Friends, the bringing of everything together is accomplished through these: through activity, through intrinsic nature, and through transformation. Friends, among these, activity is through the activity of gathering. Intrinsic nature is through the nature of reality. What is to be tamed through transformation is this: cause, time, measure, renown, hindrance, sign, and attainment.

"Friends, among these, the cause is simply the five great requisites. The time is the completion of the ten limits, close inquiry, the gathering of those of the right family, the attainment of clarity, becoming fit for action, the appearance of signs, many mantra practitioners, the finding of meditative experience, and the completion of the activity.

"Friends, the measure is this: the guide, the omens, and ripening. Friends, what is the guide? It is this: familiarization, awareness, gathering, attainment, and completion. Friends, the omens are these: seeing, prosperity, capacity, and hearing. Friends, ripening is this: the fierce rite and the unshakable.

"Friends, what is renown? It is this: the lineage of the four rivers in which one has arisen, those above whom one is exalted, what one possesses, what one is skilled in, and what one has attained.

"Friends, what is hindrance? It is this: attainment, non-attachment, being unstained, and burning. What are the signs? They are these: renown, transformation, firmness, and arising.

"Friends, what is attainment? It is this: attainment through conferral and attainment through prowess. Friends, it should be understood that this is attained as follows:

Here, to the objects of compassion,
Whatever blessing may arise,
To yogins of aspiration
Twelve volumes should be given.
To whoever is a yogin of application

The sun and moon both should be given.
The yogin who gains great reassurance
Will surely obtain the seven precious things.
The yogin who has attained the great prophecy
Obtains the eight svastikas.
The yogin of perfected great prowess
Obtains that very distinction of the ten prowesses.
The excellent master of all
Obtains the unsurpassed blazing emptiness of thought.
This great secret, the Gathering of All Intentions,
If, without having heard it, one explains it presumptuously on one's own,
Then even striving in all the boundless teachings,
One will never come to see the excellent.
Just as one born in a royal lineage,
Installed by the many as sovereign lord,
Gains dominion over all
Through the precious wheel and the other treasures,
So one born in the lineage of yoga,
Empowered as King of Dharma,
Through the blazing emptiness of thought and the rest,
Goes on to become the distinguished, excellent master.
This is the distinction of the master:
To become familiar with the means of training,
Traversed with prowess, by which one surely comes to the throne,
Is most precious.

"O friends, these should be known as the full deliberation on bringing everything together."

When he had said this, the lesser excellent ones attained the warmth of the teaching of the excellent scripture.

This is the seventieth chapter of the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas, called Explaining the Excellent Yoga.

Then again that Lord of Secrets spoke to the heroic beings of lesser bodies: "O friends, what is to be decisively settled is this: going onward without turning back, following the armor one has donned. Thus, just as the multiplicity of things follows things as they are, and just as the elements follow space, so

mental events follow mind itself, and all phenomena follow the nature of reality. Likewise, since all that is spoken and all that is done follows the excellent intention, wherever one practices, it is just as the Gathering of All Intentions has explained. O friends, that is like this:

Equal and unequal, unequal and equal,
Wholly unequal and perfectly equal:
The distinctions of Secret Mantra conduct, too,
Are to be practiced as equal in meaning with whatever it may be.
Conduct through blessing,
Or conduct through the means of mastery,
Is like space or a king,
Or like a mass of fire or a river.
These, too, through the greater or lesser reach of their domain,
Exert their blessing according to their distinctions.
Just as that king, too, by his distinction,
Has degrees of greater and lesser
In the realms over which he holds sway,
So the yogic way of mantra appears.
Entering the conduct of great means, too,
Is entering directly, as befits one's measure.
It is like an elephant entering water:
The great elephant heeds neither ford nor slope.
Yet by greater or lesser prowess and vigor,
Some cut straight across,
While some go the way the water flows.

Thus, though those who enter yogic conduct
Cut straight through to the fruit, the actual meaning,
Because, through the differences in the high or low reach of their prowess,
They practice according to the measure of their ability,
Grounds, phases and primordial wisdom,
Obscurations, deviations and conceptions,
Conduct, samaya and meditative absorption,
Time, accomplishment and culmination,
And the distinctions of view are transformed;
And although all of them are nothing but one,
The many renowned enumerations and divisions,
Matched to the capacity of the vessel,

Are taught with every kind of distinction.

Moreover, through the distinctions of prowess,
If lesser yogins, from the level of the beginner
And upward, abandon their own respective roots,
And practice the way of the great yogins,
Of the yoga of perfected great prowess and the rest,
Desiring its aim,
Then, though a frog may act out the deeds of a garuḍa,
The object it seeks is beyond its reach.
One whose rank in the trade of jewels is low,
Abandoning the measure of livelihood that is his lot,
Though he sets his aim on the great wealth
Of a king, high in rank through his means,
Does not obtain it and is left without a living.
These aims of the fortunate
Are hard for those of weak fortune to accomplish.
Therefore, in the Gathering of All Intentions,
Here, for the sake of lesser yogins,
The practices of healing and of purifying
Are taught as suited to the lesser ones.
This rite of healing and of raising
Is practiced in keeping with those who conceptualize.
Healing cures the illness of being seized by conceptual thought
With medicine for lapses in view and conduct.
In this rite of raising the dead,
The sick of the three realms of saṃsāra,
Dead in the extremes of permanence and annihilation, are taken from the charnel ground;
Taking up the corpse, the great carcass of delusion,
In order to raise it into non-arising and non-ceasing,
One should strike the corpse with the mantra
Of the wish-fulfilling jewel and press it down.
Having oneself become the antidote of the corpse,
Recite the corpse mantra without interruption.
When the splendor of the corpse arises,
Make diligent effort without a break.

When that corpse begins to stir,
Anoint it with the appropriate elixir of transformation.
Having bound all the corpse's limbs,
Do not interrupt the fierce recitation.
When it rises up there,
It displays a host of terrifying miracles.
The person who keeps the yogic discipline
Then cuts off the corpse's tongue;
If he strikes the corpse with it, it turns into gold.
Likewise, if it is transformed by the condition
Of whatever is wished for, it becomes just that.
The tongue is said to be a sword, a weapon,
And with it one cuts off the corpse's head;
Whatever substances one wishes are accomplished.
Taking the skull as armor
And wielding the tongue as a sword,
One turns back even the battle ranks of the asuras.
The fleetness of foot that comes from accomplishing the vetāla
Is beyond all measure:
If a man endowed with prowess,
Looking to the four directions, all at once
Shoots arrows, then before they fall to the ground
One retrieves them at the limits, circling the world in an instant.
Before the man's hand has even dropped,
One has at once arrived back at the place,
Gaining speed as swift as a moment.
These and endless other things,
All that one wishes, come from the corpse.
When, practicing on the corpse as a corpse, the corpse is accomplished,
The substance of the corpse no longer appears,
And since it appears as whatever it was practiced to be,
How could there be conceptual thought about the corpse?
Just as one is resolved by knowing
That the corpse has no intrinsic nature of a corpse,
If one likewise practices conduct in equality,
The excellent ones call it "view and conduct are equal."
"This is the conduct of the excellent nectar

Of raising the dead,"
So the Gathering of the Excellent Intentions has proclaimed.

Friends, these should be known as the complete practice of the rite of raising the dead.

Friends, what then is the practice of purification? It is this: purifying the thorn of conceptual thought, and thoroughly purifying the mind-stream. Of these, purifying the thorn of conceptual thought is purifying the things of conceptual thought. Friends, thoroughly purifying the mind-stream is purifying through the activity of arrangement and purifying through the activity of fire. Of these, what is purifying through the activity of arrangement?

At the start of the undertaking, the beginner,
When entering the ultimate meaning,
Should be purified by the five supreme means.
In the vajra approach at its appointed times,
In close accomplishment here,
And in the application of great accomplishment,
Numbers, times and signs are to be set.
At this door of the command that delimits the yoga,
The secret door is not opened, for they would be terrified.
Why? Because they are beginners:
Childish ones whose minds have not yet unfolded,
Uncertain, turning back and entering,
Would stray from the meaning of the Great Vehicle.
The childish ones who enter this place,
Even when drawn out of the six worlds,
Are placed on the ground where, subject to change, they are not yet certain,
And gentle means are applied as is fitting.
The five clusters of the great vajra means,
Endowed with the sixteen hosts of Vajradharas,
The vajra maṇḍala of the expanse,
Is to be drawn, or else visualized,
Or else used as speech, actual objects or symbols.
Through the religious customs of the lords of the world,
Having generated devotion and mindfulness,
And drawing benefit from the natural objects,
When one pays homage, makes prostrations and so forth,

With the lesser vajra substances blended into elixir,
With the great requisites and the rest,
Make offerings to the assembly of vajra means.
Singing the songs of vajra yoga,
Pleasing them, the activity accomplished and the count completed,
Once they are pleased, one should aspire to purify the mind-stream.
To disciples who are fit vessels,
Through such acts as knowing their faculties,
Grant the mode of entry, empowerment and accomplishment.
With the five kinds of vajra oaths,
Having given them, as appropriate, the responsibilities of training
In the form of prowess,
They swear the vajra oath of great importance.
Then the greater and lesser practices,
As they wish, with earnestness,
The austerities of vajra yoga, are to be done.
With vajra words in which such things as "unable" have no place,
One should urge them on firmly.
For the sake of the bewildered, one rouses their minds
And transforms their perception with wondrous words.
To those with the eye of wisdom, the objects of knowledge,
All of them, should be taught in sequence.
For those who have warmth and great breadth of mind,
Open the secret door into inner yoga.
To the coarse in manner, the wild and unruly,
Show the perilous defiles and the distractions of saṃsāra.
To those who have the words of vajra prophecy,
Confer empowerment according to their capacity.
For those without prowess, who are unable,
Only the benefits are praised.
Here, toward the clear and the unclear,
Neither cast down light nor cast down weight.
To those whose minds have the vajra as their object,
Give the counsel: "Train in great prowess."
In the empowerment rows of the vajra assembly,
Unfold the great bundle of vajra meaning,
And distinguish prowess and levels.

The mudrās of the respective families
Are given either in common or else one by one.

Furthermore, the assembly of the dhāraṇīs of wisdom,
Just as with arranging the assembly of means:
Those who are endowed as yoginīs,
Vajradhāriṇī and the others,
Having been arranged as an assembly of goddesses,
Here, entry, joy and the rest,
Concealed in the signs of the mudrās of means,
The dhāraṇīs of vajra equality
Are to be pleased with offerings of equality.
With dance, song, verses and the rest,
Accomplish the vidyādhara yoginīs.

Furthermore, if one knows the four times as equal,
How could it be fitting to call them "times"?
If one fully knows the four times as equal,
That itself is the nature of equality.
The vajra goddesses, the assembly of the times,
The queens of equality who hold sway
Over the portions of past and present,
Future and undetermined,
In destruction, birth, ripening,
And becoming empty:
In these, the vajra liberations, the immeasurables,
Mind, and likewise the wisdom of equality,
The retinue and the excellent center,
In their due order, with vajra
Songs, dances and other requisites,
Offerings and modes of entry as they should be,
Not letting the portions pass beyond their times,
On the days of the deities.
Great bliss and the rest,
The clusters or else the mudrās,
Are to be applied in common or one by one.
Creating the assembly of liberations for the past,
And for the present and the future

Creating immeasurable minds and liberations,
One becomes the king of equality.

Furthermore, the yogic mind of awakening,
Perfected in sixteen like the waxing moon:
When compassion and primordial wisdom dawn,
Like the sun rising in the sky,
The yogin perfected in the excellent
Is one who stands on the ground of true certainty.
To traverse to the thirteenth,
Apply the continuous assemblies of the vajra times.
Just as the full moon amid the host of stars
Is completed in sixteen days,
Since the thirteenth ground, of perfected great prowess,
Is completed through the sixteen assemblies,
By the sixteen moons that have changed,
That bliss, beautifully adorned
Upon the mudrā of the sun's clear light,
Brings about the perfection of the sixteen assemblies.
In perfection itself there is no reference point;
Because it has been purified into suchness,
In what has become empty through equality,
Everything is perfect awakening as the dharmakāya.
Suffering and awakening are not two;
Having generated the marvelous mind, perform the great activity.
When the subtle has become warmth,
If one practices the excellent, the sun rises.
If at this time the continuity is interrupted,
It is hard to turn back even with pleasing words.
If an interruption occurs, perform the rite of fulfillment and restoration.
Just as the bright moon in the sky grows full in its horns,
On earth, practice yoga so that it grows full.
When this has grown full, acts of merit
And of great dedication are to be done.
Through that, from dwelling on the ground of the vidyādharas
Who travel riding the sun and moon, onward,
Great bliss is accomplished on the thirteenth ground.

Furthermore, what is to be done continually:
All phenomena are the nature of the Victors,
Appearing as the Victors' body, speech and mind.
The mudrās of body, speech and mind
Are complete in the garland of letters itself.
The primordial wisdoms of the letters and mudrās
Are to be practiced in an unbroken stream.
Through that, one obtains unbroken meditative absorption.
Without cutting off the unbroken stream,
At the vajra hours of night and day,
Generate and apply the assembly of letters,
And likewise apply offering and approach together.
This is the path close to the ultimate,
For it brings about the excellent.
Here, through that unbroken assembly,
That itself becomes the most excellent of the excellent.

Furthermore, the expanse of the vajra net,
This secret, the great secret of the mind:
Since vajra is vajra,
Through the connection of vajra faculties and objects,
Everything arises; therefore it is called the expanse.
Vajradhāriṇī together with the perfected holder,
Their embrace in equality is likewise:
The images abide as the nature of meditative absorption.
If one applies them in due order,
Then just as one wishes,
It is taught to be equal, just like the desire realm.

Furthermore, the maṇḍala of the excellent great secret,
In which whatever is connected wherever it may be:
This nature of all phenomena,
Linked to one another as in a net,
From the space-like nature of emptiness,
Koṭis of emanations appear as anything at all,
Linked in the manner of a nondual net.
That very domain of the great yoga:
For one endowed with prowess who stands at the secret door,
For such a one the secret door should be opened.

The children who have entered this secret,
Having great intelligence and possessing means,
Are not afraid; joyful wonder arises in them.
This maṇḍala of the great secret:
The Vajra Kings together with their queens,
Five times two, embracing in pairs,
Are arranged in the manner of embrace from right to left.
The right holds the vajra of awakening,
Each one's own emblem blazing.
The left holds the echoing bell,
Clearly beautified with insignia,
Radiant with swaying and bowing,
In a manner passionate and moving,
In a manner moving like great lions,
On great lions, bulls and the rest,
On thrones that are the bodies of lesser beings,
Seated in perfect majestic poise,
Blazing with light of five colors,
Graceful in the thirteen kinds of attire:
Generate them gradually or all at once.
Here the faculties that are attached and clinging
To the desire realm are to be purified in stages.
Apart from that, not even father and mother are taken as a reference.
The retinues of the secret assembly, too,
By their nature of transformation,
The mudrā kings together with their queens,
Eight times two, are arranged in entwined, embracing pairs:
Kṣitigarbha, Ākāśagarbha, Avalokiteśvara, Vajrapāṇi,
Maitreya, Vajra, Samantabhadra and Mañjuśrī.
The inner and outer requisites
Are applied by the four pairs to give delight,
And so too visualization and the rest.

Together with the vajra gates,
The secret assembly in vajra embrace,
Through the application of great yogic enjoyments,
Is offered to in sequence, to please them and to bring union.

Through the secret mode of entry and the rest,
The secret aims are to be accomplished.
With entrance, conduct and view in harmony,
All having become one,
Endowed with causes and conditions in perfect abundance,
With the condition of loving harmony and with blissful union,
Deities, vidyādharas and yogins, all of them,
Gathering without exception, practice this Dharma.
An instant, a moment, a short while,
A moment, a single day, each month,
The auspicious days of the year,
The great festivals when their time has come:
These are the great occasions of blessing.
Whatever requisites one can afford,
Distinguished as pure and impure,
Clean food and the like,
And the nectars that conquer the illness of conceptual thought,
To the assembly of the Victors and to the bhūtas,
Offer earnestly, as one's wealth allows.
Acting for oneself, for others, for both,
And what does not serve the purpose of the Dharma:
Abandoning these four faults, apply the means of reversal.
Toward yogins, as toward one's own heart and eyes,
Establish the attitude of tender affection,
And provide for their ease as they wish.
To please the deities,
To pacify the obstructors,
To accomplish aims, and to revive the dead,
Performing this rite is most precious.
These are fit to be told
Before newcomers of small understanding.
All substances and requisites, too,
Should be combined with prowess, according to whatever will tame.
Therefore this rite in particular
Builds accumulation upon accumulation and purifies obscurations;
Having grown familiar with the approach,
Through accomplishment the fruit is brought to culmination.

Thus did Vajrasattva
Speak to the great assembly.
The whole assembly, having seen the meaning,
Addressed Vajradhara:
"Great Being, we have
Certainly seen that the nature of all phenomena,
The arrangement of means itself and wisdom itself,
The all-equal and the sixteen portions,
The assembly of letters and the expanse of arising,
Their linking in a nondual net and the rest,
Appears as the images of the meditative absorption of intrinsic nature."
When they had said this, he replied:
"All of you who are gathered here in this assembly,
It is just as you have seen.
Primordially unfabricated, just as it is,
The maṇḍala of intrinsic nature is suchness itself.
The excellent intention, spontaneously present,
Is itself the excellent maṇḍala of meditative absorption.
Since mind itself is their root,
Sentient beings are clear as the maṇḍala of images.
Into the maṇḍala of the meditative absorption of intrinsic nature,
All have primordially entered, been arranged, and been completed.
Beyond that, especially for fortunate people,
There are images that have become their sphere of experience:
On fine, soft cloth, well proportioned and the like,
In five colors or in twenty-five,
They are depicted so that the bewildered who have not seen may rely on them.
With unimpaired marks, they become delightful.
Relying on them, in a gentle shrine,
Depict the forms in blazing colors;
If their mudrās are unimpaired and they are beautiful,
They can display miraculous signs.
In gold, silver, copper, iron and the like,
Casting images of the Victors,
If they have unimpaired mudrās,
They too become supports for signs.

In crystal, stone, conch and the like,
If one makes images of the Victors in relief,
And likewise makes them unimpaired and full,
They become supports from which signs arise.
In plakṣa wood, bodhi-tree wood and the like,
With images carved by a skilled craftsman,
If their mudrās are unimpaired and all complete,
These too become supports for signs.
Making the mudrās in clay and the like,
And giving them beautiful colors,
They are supports from which signs arise:
Through signs, one knows signs to be liberated.
Those who make the shapes of the Victors from clay,
Finely formed in every way,
If they beautifully adorn them with the five pigments,
They become supports for knowing liberation.
Since whatever is the image of whomever
And that one's nature are one,
There is not the slightest difference here;
Through this one comes to know liberation.

"Whatever palace of the Sugatas
One makes in the manner of a maṇḍala:
In a pleasing, well-qualified, secluded place,
Making it beautiful and even all around,
Provide it with eight lines,
Beautified by the activity of the means of attraction.
Then encircle it with a single line.
When it has taken the form of a maṇḍala,
Inside, with eight even lines,
It becomes nine sections.
Having divided the periphery into thirds,
Within them all, three
Fine lines beautifully adorn it.
Having divided it into ninths,
Make the gates and gate-frames a third.
Beautify it with eight pillars,

And within the jewel pillars
Make the buddha palace with its pinnacle.
The gates of the means of attraction, the immeasurables and the liberations,
Beautiful in three tiers,
Are adorned with archways and steps as well.
The central palace and its sections,
Wheels, śrīvatsa knots, lotuses,
Eight-faceted jewels and the rest,
Draw them as is fitting.
The ornaments are various jewels,
pañcarakatvarana,
Adorned with garlands and with nets,
Fringes and hanging tassels,
Bells, small bells and little pendants hanging.
Many sons of the gods, sounding music,
From the sky within and without,
Draw them presenting various offerings.
Richly adorned with great supporting beams,
With jeweled cornices and stūpas,
And jeweled victory banners blazing with light,
The celestial palace, beautifully adorned,
Just as the palace of the Dharma is,
Draw it so as to represent exactly that.
Whatever is placed in the celestial palace,
Let all of it beautify and finely adorn it.
All offerings, surpassable and unsurpassable,
Offer earnestly, as one's wealth allows.
Kingdoms together with their riches,
Together with song, dance and music,
Medicines that destroy poison, and nectars,
Offer to Victors as numerous as the ocean.
By applying the offering of equality,
All purified mind-streams become equal."

When he had said this, the whole assembly,
All of them, their mind-streams purified, knew liberation.

Friends, these should be known as the thorough purification through the activity of arrangement.

Friends, what here is thorough purification through the activity of fire? It is this: in order to purify all phenomena into the nature of reality, all things were blessed as the nature of fire, and so the whole gathered assembly saw all phenomena appearing as the nature of fire. Utterly overwhelmed, they praised him in wonder:

"How wonderful! Sattva, great sattva!
Greatest of the great, great in blessing!
Great in meditative absorption, great in illumination!
Great in miracles, great in variety!
The supreme means cannot be measured:
All phenomena appear as a blazing mass of fire.
That very expanse of clear primordial wisdom,
Having become blazing, radiant and clear,
Burns all things, both dark and bright;
That all be perfected in the expanse of great bliss
Is what you, O Hero, have done.
Great blaze, a la la!
Splendor radiating rays, a la la!
Gatherer of all the infinite, a la la!
Burner of all, a la la!
Great devourer, a la la!
Without edge or center, a la la!
Compassion, Cakrasaṃvara, a la la!
Īśvara, the Terrifying, a la la!
Through the marvelous blessing of the supreme secret,
The great nature of fire,
Please explain it to us."

When the assembly had requested this,
He himself, delighted, spoke these words:
"Yogins of the great assembly,
The nature of the vajra fire
I shall explain definitively; listen with respect.
Through this supreme path, especially unsurpassed,
By applying bliss as the yogic means,
All the Victors are pleased, all is burned and purified,

Purified into the supreme activity that accomplishes aims.
In the fire pit of things as they are,
Upon the kindling of things in all their multiplicity,
The fire of suchness arises,
And everything, everything, is burned, purified and dissolved.
In the pure fire pit of the unborn,
Upon the kindling of the four kinds of birth,
The unborn fire free of elaboration arises,
And the habitual tendencies of signs are burned, purified and dissolved.
In the fire pit beyond thought,
Upon the inconceivable kindling,
The fire of Amitābha arises,
And infinite things, numerous as atoms, are burned, purified and dissolved.
In the pure fire pit of the nature of reality,
Upon the kindling of various phenomena,
The fire of the primordial wisdom of emptiness blazes,
And the habitual tendencies toward things are burned, purified and dissolved.
In the pure fire pit of mind itself,
Upon the kindling of sentient beings and migrators,
The fire of self-arisen primordial wisdom blazes,
And the habitual tendencies of saṃsāra are burned, purified and dissolved.
In the fire pit of the bhaga of the ground of all,
Upon the kindling of the five afflictions,
The fire of the five primordial wisdoms arises,
And the concepts of apprehended and apprehender are burned, purified and dissolved.
In the fire pit of the space of appearance and existence,
Upon the kindling of the four elements,
The fire of the blazing mudrā arises,
And the things of appearance and existence are burned, purified and dissolved.
In the fire pit of the four kinds of activity,
Upon the kindling of four and four,
The fire of the four blazing families arises,
And the substances of the sacrifice are burned, purified and dissolved.

"This too, according to the distinctions of each,
In direction, color, shape and substance,
Is to be applied as is fitting.
East, south, west and north; white, yellow, red,
Dark blue, black and ash-colored are applied.
Round, with a lotus of four sections;
The wheel; square and eight-cornered for increase;
A half-moon, truncated and bow-shaped, for magnetizing;
Triangular, the space of the bhaga, for the fierce rite.
Three-tiered, beautiful with radiance and designs,
Adorned with the kindling and substances of the rite,
Endowed with the activity lineage of the wisdom vajra,
Apply the supreme means of the three masters.
Holding the supreme that delights the pure limit,
With secret vajra songs and dances,
Apply the abundant assemblies of the appointed offerings.
Apply the blessing of the vajra activity.
One who possesses the secret sequence of activity,
Having set out in order the sequence of peaceful deities,
And explained the sequences for increase and magnetizing,
Should make complete the deities, the mantras, the mudrās,
And likewise the sequence of songs.
The five lineages of the families,
Each set out in order in its own family,
In the fire pit swirling with the vast expanse,
With sacred substances and blazing nectar,
Are fit to be burned, in order to purify and to attain.
The immeasurable, ocean-like assembly of the Victors,
And the great qualities of the mantra practitioners,
Having been proclaimed in vajra song,
Undertake the great means of pleasing them.
When the acts of pleasing are complete,
Whatever great aims have not yet been purified,
Whether they are accomplished or not,
The wise should examine in the fire.
The two sounds of the fire, its two colors,
Its two modes of blazing, and its six shapes:
These should be thoroughly known.

If the signs are unattractive,
Since these are unpleasing signs,
Expand the rite with a great burning purification.
Then pleasing and desired results arise:
Of the desired signs in the fire,
Take whichever of the three kinds is accomplished.

"Great assembly, furthermore,
When burning and purifying the substances of the corpse,
Having struck the corpse with mantra,
With various most fragrant things
Anoint the corpse and wash it.
Smearing cloth with the essence of the great melted nectar,
Wrap the corpse in it.
On whatever places of the corpse there are,
Having arranged all the applications of mantra,
Seal them with the signs of the mudrās.
Whatever arrangement of the Victors' maṇḍala there is,
Its emblem mudrās,
Wherever they are arranged, in that very place
Set the heart mantras in the same number.
For the heart mantras, the individual,
Unerring root syllables
Are written on cloth or wood and set in place.
When the preparation of the corpse is complete,
All over the outside and back of the corpse
Arrange all of afflicted saṃsāra:
On cloth or on bark,
Set out all the seeds of saṃsāra.
The five afflictions together with the three poisons,
The four births, the five karmas and the six classes of beings,
Having made them into names and forms,
Are to be set out each in its own place.
Seeds, formations and the five things,
Together with the names of apprehended and apprehender,
Having been arranged as symbols,
Are to be set out so as to cover the corpses.

Then that body of the corpse,
Supported on a platform of planks,
Should be placed on top by the wise.
The rite of the hearth, too:
On a maṇḍala of suitable circumference,
Dig and make the rim according to tradition.
The palaces where the mudrās reside
Are divided into their separate areas with lines.
On top of that, build up the firewood.
Its shape is filled in according to the four families,
Its corners firmly supported by pillars,
Three-tiered, with an upper story and a middle chamber,
The lowest filled with kindling packed tight.
On the planks of the middle chamber,
The corpse's face is displayed toward the four directions.
In the upper story above the corpse,
The maṇḍala of mudrās drawn on cloth and the like
Is to be clearly set in place.
Opening four windows in the corpse chamber,
With four cords of vajra dhāraṇī thread,
Having tied them, offer them into the master's hands.
When the work with the wood is complete,
On the platform at its outer edge
Set out the deities of the four kinds of activity.
When the platform has been completed,
Established in particular through the vajra activity,
Upon the master, the Vajra King,
Confer the authority to burn saṃsāra,

With the unwavering, one-pointed great fire,
Continuously perform the gathering and radiating for the person.
Applying the activities of the vajra mantra,
Confer the authority of the four kinds of activity,
And bring the garland of rites to completion.
A master, a holy vajra one,
Having taken up the tally of the corpse's faults,
Counts what was amassed through karma, and proceeds.

The vajra master who conducts the occasion
Should continuously make unsurpassed offerings.
With dance, with songs, and with great rhythmic steps,
Present offerings and music of every kind.
Make the aspiration of vajra activity;
Do this at the end of the rite, at the time of offering.
The one who holds the register of vajra activity,
Taking up the register of the white tally of deeds,
Offers the sum of the good to the holy ones.
The one who holds the tally of the corpse's faults
Burns the black marks as firewood
In the expanse of the fire of primordial wisdom.
The deities abiding in the fire for the fire rite,
The buddha of fire, Amitābha,
And the goddess of fire, Pāṇḍaravāsinī,
Are the light of all the Victors.
They hold mastery over the element of fire,
And are the lords of the warmth of all things.
They have pledged to burn the three realms of existence.
Their enlightened activity of burning things
They do not transgress, by the power of their sacred commitment.
They know precisely whose obscurations are burned.
Whether or not the corpse's consciousness has been purified,
One skilled in fire should examine accordingly.
If unpleasant signs arise, perform the burning purification.
If the signs are good, confer the fire empowerment.
With the ashes, the bone remains and the relics,
Make maṇḍalas of mudrās and the like.
If it was a holy being, enshrine the remains
And offer them as a support of the master.
This is the supreme of all practices.
Thus spoke that supreme being.

Friends, these should be fully understood through the fire rite.

Vajra brothers and sisters in the secret Dharma,
That which comes from the fire rite,
The bone remains known as śarīram:

From immeasurable ages, for as long as time has been,
After countless emanated Victors
Have passed into nirvāṇa,
The bodily remains that arise from nothing,
Called bodily remains and relics,
Are renowned as supports for the merit of beings.
Since the Victors are without substantial existence,
Though bodily remains and relics are impossible,
For the sake of benefiting sentient beings
They set forth, out of nothing, a miracle of compassion.
Likewise, wherever and whatever lamps have arisen
And appear here in this world,
Their remains after nirvāṇa as well
Come to be known as śarīram,
And their function is the same.
Those Victors and others,
Together with the self-arisen ones and those who remain after them,
Having become one in harmonious manner,
Their bodily remains, seeds blessed with power,
Multiply as elixir from portions of their qualities,
And appear pervading the land of Jambudvīpa.
Because they come from bone, they are hard, firm and round,
And conventionally they are well known as vajras.
Some are small pods, three-cornered, like sesame pods.
When young, they appear as butter or as milk;
When grown, the sign of ripening is that they are hard and firm,
Like the grains of the chickpea,
White, with the clear color of red sandalwood.
The benefits of eating them are inconceivable;
They are renowned as the supreme nectar medicine.
Likewise, the vidyādhara heroes
Emanated in human bodies,
Individuals on the grounds who possess the Dharma eye,
Pure fields of merit and glory:
After their bodily frame has been purified into its essence,
What appears to the fortunate
Is, to some, śarīram,

And to some, relic bodies.
To the unfortunate they do not appear.
And even when they do appear to some,
For those who practice they remain long and lasting,
While for the impure they wane and flee away.
They show the omens of what is to come,
Both pleasing and displeasing.
They are not permanent as existent things,
Nor are they destroyed into nonexistence.
Yoga practices and prosperity
Accord with the mode of purity or impurity.
Moreover, if through pure merit
One has vast devotion to the path,
If one is helmeted in one-pointed yoga,
If one is bound by the vajra and one's karma is in accord,
They descend upon those whose mindstreams are completely pure.
Further, in the order of their distinctions:
The śarīram, the bodily remains of the Victors,
Pervading all the buddha fields,
As if rounded by a smith or a craftsman,
Appear though no one has made them,
White and shining, clear in color, like drops,
Luminous with the radiance of red sandalwood,
And fall like rain, filling the sky.
The remains of emanated vidyādhara heroes
Arise white and clear, only a few here and there.
The great signs of individuals on the grounds
Are of even color: one, three, two, three, one;
In some cases five or ten appear,
And such are their qualities.
They too are hard and firm like a vajra;
Even an iron pestle cannot break them.
And the benefits of their arrival:
In all those lands and regions,
Wherever they descend,
Illness, calamity and obstructors are pacified.
Even savage yakṣas and rākṣasas,

Wrathful and fierce, become calm and gentle.
Strife among kings, disturbance of the elements,
And turmoil in the land are pacified.
Fruits and crops increase and ripen,
And everything pleasing comes about.
In that land, the seed of commoners and kings
All becomes sons.
Sons who are happy, bearing the marks, of high lineage,
All of these will be born.
Those who teach these things to others
Share equal fortune with the level of the vidyādharas.
Their merit in this world, too,
Equals that of the universal monarchs (cakravartins).
All their intentions will be fulfilled;
Long life, restoration and their activities will be accomplished.
From then on, this is the great sign
Of touching the ground of unsurpassed awakening.
Besides this, their qualities are inconceivable:
These are the qualities that abide
In their own intrinsic nature.

If one practices with them, their qualities are inconceivable.
Since in sentient beings of every kind
The very essence of awakening is present,
When the five aggregates are purified
Through the work of the fire rite, it is impossible that none should appear.
As for how these are to be practiced:
Gather them inside a crystal casket,
Seal it with the seal of the mudrā,
And set it inside a crystal amulet box.
The practitioner should make aspirations to them,
And, to purify obscurations and to restore, perform the radiating and gathering.
The rite for the radiating and gathering is this:
From the Victors who fill the buddha fields,
Śarīram filling the sky
Fall upon it like a stream of rain.

With one-pointed recitation, a stream of speech,
mahā śarīram gyili hūṃ
Recite it countless times without interruption.
They become supremely clear and shining,
With garlands of light rays like the rays of the sun,
And appear scattered in profusion.
Outside the casket
They will appear clearly.
They move and multiply abundantly,
And Victors, heroes and vidyādharas,
As reflections in the crystal and out of it,
Will clearly show themselves to me.
The first sign is that the vessel is filled;
The second, that half of it is, or a hundred and eight;
Even at the least, they increase by some number.
These are the great signs of accomplishment;
At that time one should receive the siddhis.
The qualities attained are inconceivable:
In this very life one abides on the level of a vidyādhara
And becomes equal to the Victors.
As for the qualities that arise incidentally,
One who acts for the benefit of all beings
Will succeed like a great being.
One must make offerings to them continually;
If one makes offerings, excellent qualities arise.
The rite for making the offerings is this:
Having purified obscurations and generated a mass of merit,
And having made one's own mindstream pure,
At every time of the moon
When its sixteenth digit is full,
Having made oneself alone the focus of the mind,
Make the offering: with the casket,
Tie them to the top of a victory banner,
And make aspirations for whatever one wishes.
By this, all wishes are fulfilled.
For the fortunate yogin, that is
The precious wish-fulfilling jewel.

As the supreme substance for yogic practice,
One must not be without it even in name.
Just as corpses are turned into gold,
And just as they are purified by being burned in fire,
However much one engages with things,
One does not waver from that holy reality itself.
That and other boundless conduct,
Conduct that abides in the four things,
Is the very nature of Vajrasattva.
Of the holy and wondrous conduct:
Just as an elephant that has entered the water,
Without obstruction, attachment or fear,
In the manner of one who joyfully delights in enjoyment,
Like one who has gone beyond, never to turn back,
So too the yogin's definitive conduct,
Entering the waters of the ocean of discipline,
In the joyful manner of one training great prowess,
Crosses over without obstruction or attachment.
As for the means of making one's conduct complete,
What matters is that familiarity becomes the expanse.

Friends, these should be understood as the crossing over.

This was the seventy-first chapter, called Entering Yogic Conduct, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then again the Lord of Secrets spoke to those of lesser capacity: O friends, that by which one is to cut through is this: the holy intention, suchness. Why is that? By training in the single suchness of the intention, one has trained in inconceivable dharmas. If one is skilled in the single suchness, one is skilled in the inconceivable. If one is familiar with that suchness, one meditates on the inconceivable. If one does not transgress that suchness, one has kept the inconceivable sacred commitment. If one enters that suchness, one has entered the inconceivable door. If one engages in that suchness, one enjoys inconceivable requisites. If one actualizes suchness, one has done as much as an inconceivable ocean. If one teaches that suchness without error, one has taught immeasurable doors of the Dharma. If one hears that suchness without distortion, one has heard inconceivable doors of the Dharma. If that suchness becomes manifest, one will see immeasurable Victors. Why is that? Because

what is to be made the quintessence or the essence of all of them is suchness, and there is nothing other than it.

Friends, therefore it is like this:
If one sees the meaning of suchness,
Then, by that seeing, all is illusion.
If that state itself is the supreme and noble one,
All unsurpassed heights and dignities are false.
From the moment one is certain of suchness,
There is no discouragement or shrinking before whatever is lesser.
If one has come to a decisive conclusion on suchness,
Though dwelling in the world, one is the dharma body.
Though certain of the holy, one engages with the world,
And has no weariness even at the very limits of saṃsāra.
Though it is boundless, it is perfected as one.
One is not daunted by the realm of the māras,
And not afraid of the unbearable realms.
The things of desire are joined with the expanse.
If one sees the definitive meaning all at once,
Gradual practice is like deceit and enticement.
Even through mere devotion to it
One will outshine the three realms;
What need is there to speak of its having become the expanse?
For example, a lion cub or a garuḍa chick,
Though its eyes are not yet open and it is taken up by its mother,
Terrifies all, like one that goes straight from the egg into the sky.
Those who have become certain of that very reality,
Though they dwell and engage in the world,
In that very holy state
Are without fear of anything at all.
Those who practice with signs in stages,
And, with nonexistence, with object and without object,
With accomplishing and with traversing,
Enter into conceptual thought with no discernment,
Those fools are empty;
How could they be certain of the holy?
Like the young of the lowest beasts of prey,
Their nature is to be frightened and terrified.

Just as the intrinsic nature
Of all the boundlessly many phenomena abides,
Uncontrived and without distortion,
That is coming to a decisive conclusion on suchness.
Just as the great garuḍa soaring in the sky
Ranges the heights of the sky by the strength of its wings,
And though mountains, crags and rivers are boundless,
All are encompassed beneath the beat of its wings,
So the yogin soaring in the sky of the nature of reality,
Though the doors of conduct of the vehicles are boundless,
Through the meaning that is just as it is and uncontrived,
Settles the state with a single beat of the wings.
This is the certainty that cuts through
The doubts of hope and fear.
To cut through to the state of the view
Of the holy itself is most precious.

Friends, these should be understood as the discussion on cutting through to the ground completely.

When he had said this, those of lesser capacity attained the state of deciding without hope or fear.

This was the seventy-second chapter, called Cutting Through Doubt Completely, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then again the Lord of Secrets spoke to those of lesser capacity: O friends, that by which experience is to be found is this:
For entering the holy intention that gathers all,
The chief thing is meditative concentration.
Just as a universal monarch holds sway,
Concentration holds sway over all phenomena.
This great concentration of yoga,
Like turning poison and darkness into gold,
Is the concentration that holds sway over all.
Therefore practice the holy concentration.
If this concentration is absent,
Like a boulder in the depths of the ocean,

Though one has cut through countless doors,
It is meaningless, its core dried up.
The concentration of great yoga
Is to rest the mind, uncontrived,
In reality just as it is,
Undistracted, without arising or ceasing.
The holy yoga, just as it is,
Is the very nature of mind itself.
What cannot be observed, called suchness,
Is the root all-knowing, the all-ground itself.
Why? Because it is unmade and uncontrived,
Self-arisen, it is called suchness.
That which appears as everything
Is the engaging consciousness, merely momentary.
Why? Because it engages in appearing as everything,
It is explained as appearing outside and inside.
The array of causes
Is the five doors of the engaging consciousness.
Because it is set out as the cause of everything,
It is called the cause from which all arises.
The holy intention
Is not empty, and has no permanence;
In the middle, unobservable, all-knowing and clear,
It transcends both existence and nonexistence.
Base people who here pursue feeling,
Those whose domain is the cessation of the childish,
Those with perverse craving who have fallen from this,
The faded and the slack, are one in having an object.
Those here who are blinded by views,
Relying on a self, establish extremes;
Those inclined to nonexistence, thinking that beings do not exist,
Go immediately to the lower realms.
All those of slight devotion
See selflessness as dependent arising.
That which has stopped, with conception but no analysis,
Is only the first concentration.
From the subtle emptiness, all-empty,

Abiding without conception but with analysis is the second.
Settled with certainty in emptiness,
With joy stirred up, is the third.
Shown through the power of oneself or of another,
Flawless and unmoving, is the abiding of the fourth.
Whatever exists may change in the end,
But what does not exist, without abiding, does not change in the end.
Like what does not exist, it is not seen and not known;
Though one seeks it, one will not find it,
Yet that very reality does not become nonexistent;
Though without cause and effect, it is not meaningless.
For example, just as burned iron is without luster,
And though the four great elements are absent and it becomes empty,
Just as that and space are not nonexistent,
So that very reality is not destroyed and is not nonexistent.
The domain of the six is signs.
Since signs appear as things,
When left as they please, there is nothing to reverse;
Their emptiness is abandoned and cannot be reversed.
If, through the wordless view, one has decided
That all is the very nature of mind,
Uncontrived and undistracted, with distraction itself made even,
Where is there effort, accomplishment, hope or fear?
There is no need to cultivate antidotes to discordant factors.
Faults and virtues, rejecting and adopting, dullness and agitation:
If here they are indivisible and united,
Calm abiding and insight arise from the mind.
Through destruction, space does not become nonexistent;
Through wandering, the mind of awakening is not lost;
Through abandoning, boundless phenomena are not abandoned;
Through washing, the expanse of emptiness is not cleansed.
As for empty and existent, annihilation and permanence:
Since all is awareness, it is not empty;
Since it is without things, it is not permanent;
Since it is nothing at all, there is nothing to practice.
If all activities are entirely let go,
If one rests there, uncontrived from the very beginning,

Since that is absent, that too is absent.
That is the finding of the holy experience.
Here, in the holy Great Vehicle,
The illness is not overcome in stages;
The virulent poison of the gradualist
Is that very reality which dawns all at once.
Therefore, whoever they may be,
According to how they understand and are inclined,
Whatever teachings they follow,
Let each make them an object of confidence.
Thus the holy teachings, however many,
Spoken by the immeasurable lamps,
Are not settled as one, nor uncertain;
As they arise, so they are certain.
What cuts one off from entering this:
Laziness, many activities, agitation,
Distraction, torpor and desire,
Sleep, hope and fear, doubt,
The activity of gathering and radiating, and joy.
Their nature, too, is suchness.
The five poisons and the rest are the very origin;
Self-arising and self-pacifying, they are suchness.
What obscures the holy meaning:
Unmoving stillness, clarity, bliss and suffering,
Arising, clarity and bringing forth,
Gentleness and pride in distinction: their arising and pacifying itself.
What appears through these in great concentration
Is never impaired, without hope or fear:
Not producing faith, unmoving,
Unattached, not cut off, without grasping;
If there is no agitation, it is the intrinsic nature itself.
The domain of the māras for the yogin:
Seeing the holy before one, and speaking as the holy;
Seeing countless emanations sent forth;
Seeing clearly all that the holy ones say;
Seeing clearly the knowledge of all times;
All appearing by way of the six classes of beings;

A surge of longing arising for that;
Seeing all appearances clearly;
Going unobstructed through anything;
Moving and staying in the sky like a bird;
Prophecy through the mudrā of the holy;
Teaching the Dharma in the languages of all;
Seeing things displayed, moving, and places of worship;
Setting all out evenly;
The clear appearance of that very nature;
Pliancy and freedom from obstruction;
Being exhorted toward the holy meaning;
And offerings made by the lords of the world:
If one knows their nature, they are signs of the holy;
If one does not know, they are the māras of error.
Whatever signs arise through the six doors,
Self-arising and self-pacifying, leave them as they will.
Since they are unborn, there is nothing to reverse;
That too is suchness itself.
Toward past, future and present,
Toward any faults or good deeds,
There are no thoughts of delight or regret:
Self-arising and self-pacifying, that is reality itself.
Here, whatever is certain of the holy
Is the forerunner among the signs of yoga.
Just as, wherever there are rivers, fire or gold,
Their gathering, spreading, arising and essence are certain,
If one is certain of the holy, it arises as the holy;
If one is not certain of the holy, all is māra.
If one is certain of the holy, even something small
That arises is a forerunner of the holy.

Whoever hears of the holy itself
Is not afraid, is not terrified, and joy arises.
Whoever views the holy itself
Sees everything as the holy itself.
Whoever has entered the expanse of the holy
Gathers the many categories into the holy.

When one sees the holy with certainty,
It does not follow along the path of words.
Seeing it, all is clear as the holy.
The holy, which is without appearance,
Comes to see what has no appearance.
That itself is the cause of all,
And all the moving miraculous displays arise from it:
Movement, the attaining of warmth, and stability;
Clarity, the attaining of signs, and stability;
Sunbeams, motes of dust and mirages;
Ocean waves, wind and streams of rain;
Clouds hovering, rising up as high as a palm tree;
The earth moving, and the sense bases of the elements appearing;
The flow of the elements, piercing pains and the like.
That by which illness is wholly pacified,
The sense base of darkness is overcome,
Bodily forbearance is attained,
And all is at ease, just as it is;
Turning what is not into whatever one will,
And bringing forth whatever from what is not;
Finding pleasing, wish-fulfilling, supreme substances;
All delighting, all bowing, all pleasing to the mind,
And mastery over all: these are omens of supreme accomplishment.
Omens that come a moment beforehand:
Appearing naked and washing constantly,
Being carried off by pure rivers and swimming in them,
Streams of rain and vase water arising,
Scattering, dispersing and strewing about:
These are omens of the purity of whatever is being cleansed.
And here, being free from fear:
Battles subsiding and thorns drawn out,
Finally being released and freed from the executioner,
Being free of vicious hordes, poison and disease pacified,
Release from bonds and from captivity: these are good omens.
In particular, the forerunners of the holy:
Climbing the legs of a throne, trees and ladders,
And going upward;

Stūpas on mountain peaks and ladders to the sky:
Omens of rising higher and higher.
Signs of where one abides and what one mounts:
Sitting on a high throne, riding an elephant,
A great lion, a soaring garuḍa, or birds;
Sitting on the tops of stūpas and the crests of mountains,
And in the expanse of the sky;
Clouds emerging from one's body, and sitting on the sun and moon:
These are signs of where one abides.
The forerunners of the holy family:
Wielding authority over Indra with a seal of command,
Bringing the world down by a ladder,
Gathering power and being victorious in battle,
And flowers growing as a crown upon the head.
The forerunners of mastery over the Dharma:
Finding volumes, writing and using them,
Teaching them to others and establishing them;
Looking into a mirror or a full vase, examining and drinking;
Gathering jewels, and wheels descending;
Seizing the sun and moon, and circling Mount Meru;
Filling the trichiliocosm with a hundred sounds;
Seeing all things as letters;
Producing every wonder through one's renown;
And a rain of flowers falling from the sky.
The forerunners of seeing the holy:
Seeing lands one has not seen before,
Seeing the trichiliocosm and traversing the continents,
Reaching the summit of Mount Meru and seeing everything,
Seeing boundless space,
Reaching the depths of the ocean,
Holding a lamp and examining the world of appearance and existence:
They are like the very heart of the sun.
The forerunners of attaining the great transmission:
Music, thunder and lions,
Hearing discussion of the Dharma,
Images smiling and emitting light,
Hearing the speech of the holy ones but not seeing their bodies,

Goddesses proclaiming songs,
Sounds arising in celestial palaces,
And the words "holy friend" arising,
Which make one go on to that very reality.
When the omens of a holy vidyādhara dawn,
The miracles of the power of blessing as well:
Riding on the sun and moon and traveling,
Stirring Mount Meru from its waist,
Hurling the world far off,
Extinguishing the eon of burning,
And all such miracles
One is able to display with special prowess.
To all beings to be tamed,
In their own languages and in accord with the Dharma,
Through various doors of taming,
One is able to teach accordingly.
Through the special prowess of yoga,
Shaking all the world systems,
One makes all greatly amazed,
And they taste the flavor of delight and joy.
From garlands of golden letters,
By proclaiming the sound of the Dharma miraculously,
All the many categories of dharmas that the mind sees
Appear as mantra; none fails to become mantra.
The stages of greater and lesser yoga
Arise from distinctions in prowess.
Gradual entry and instantaneous entry:
The domain of breath, and feeling,
Hearing, seeing and the rest,
The domain of mind, and the expanse of space,
To the boundless limits of the expanse of phenomena;
The letters of the nature, the letters of transformation,
The letters of the limbs, each with its
Root and so on, together with a single basis;
The measure of radiating and gathering, the scope of the mudrās,
And the number of clusters likewise.
This is the first order of entry:

Becoming acquainted and habituated step by step.
The letters are created from primordial wisdom,
And accomplishing aims arises as mudrā:
Pressing down the ocean, ladders to the sky,
Binding the wind and turning back streams,
Extinguishing the eon of burning,
Riding the sun and moon and hurling the world,
Entering the earth and lifting Mount Meru,
Placing the trichiliocosm inside a mustard seed,
Demolishing, raising up and the rest:
What is thought of, inconceivable,
Is simply training in the great prowess of yoga
Made pliant through habituation.
Accomplishing recitation to its end,
Perfecting the binding completely,
Making one's intention pliant,
Seeing the meaning and accomplishing the words,
And activities that are completely pure:
The one meaning appears in distinct ways to its objects.
Therefore, although the special concentrations
Are cultivated on that one reality alone,
The distinctions in yogic prowess
Are that the objects of intention are various.
The yogin who abides on the first ground
Through the work of seeking,
In the six yogas, the yoga of the aspiring mind and the rest,
Since the reach of the prowess of wisdom is weak,
Has little prowess in concentration as well.
Since one does not come to see reality itself,
Whatever one's own inclination focuses on,
Whatever is its seed,
Distinguish it by color and shape,
Make it move with the breath of the nose,
And, to the extent that it has become its object,
From the clear blazing and radiating of light rays,
Generate the radiating and gathering at its place.
The extent of the body, matched to one's own measure, is that much.

The four yogas that abide on the second ground,
The yoga of the activity of the attendant and the rest,
Through the special prowess of concentration,
On the seed, the letter of the nature,
Together with its blazing light rays,
Up to the door from which smell arises,
Generate radiating and gathering clearly;
The extent of the body, twice one's own measure, is that much.

The three yogas that abide on the third ground,
The yoga of the command door of transmission and the rest,
Hold the absorption of focusing to be like this:
Whatever is the seed of the deity,
Transform it into the letter of the nature,
And with its blazing light rays,
Up to the range of hearing,
Make the radiating and gathering clear;
Then about four times one's own measure
Is the extent of the body.
Likewise, following the stages of yoga,
Whatever the distinctions of deity may be,
Apply them according to the order of the letters,
And the measure of radiating and gathering is likewise.
Applying them in their proper order,
When the radiating and gathering has become clear,
As far as the domain of the mind extends,
So far is the distinction in the extent of the body:
Since it reaches to the limits of the expanse of phenomena,
It is filled with the extent of the body.
Just as refined gold shines,
By refining mind itself, that very reality becomes clear.
This absorption of applying radiating and gathering
Is trained in gradually, while its warmth comes all at once.
Lord of Laṅkā, it is like this:
This great stream of the Dharma, the holding of it,
Was taught by the holy Vajrasattva.
All of this is called the stream of radiating and gathering.

On the volume of the meaning of space
Are written the letters of manifold knowledge.
Through the proclaiming of the sound of the four great elements,
The stream of the secret mantra of the Great Vehicle is unbroken.
The intrinsic nature of all phenomena
Has not moved from suchness,
So all is nectar, an unbroken stream.
The requisites of the ocean of saṃsāra
Have the nature of an ocean of offerings;
The whole boundless ocean of existence
Is an unbroken stream of Samantabhadra's offering clouds.
From the expanse that is the suchness of all,
Sentient beings are taught to be the essence of buddhahood.
Beings, inconceivable in number,
Are an unbroken stream of self-arisen buddhas.
The inconceivable sounds and languages
Of things stable and moving and all the rest
Are all the secret words of secret mantra,
An unbroken ocean of recitation.
In the very expanse of each and every thing,
Whatever means one applies,
Since from the beginning there is neither meeting nor parting,
The great union is unbroken.
These fields of the three realms of existence to be liberated,
Slain without substance
By the king of weapons, emptiness,
Are an unbroken great primordial liberation.
In the celestial palace of pure appearance and existence,
On the glorious maṇḍala of the all-ground,
With the eight threads of the great chalk lines of consciousness,
The maṇḍala laid out from the beginning is unbroken.
On Mount Meru, the foundation that is the desire realm,
The form realm is the terraces, the firm steps of the throne,
And the formless realm the vase base together with the vase:
The great reliquary, the dharmakāya, is unbroken.
Space, fire, water, earth and wind
Appear as the four foundations, the support of Mount Meru.

The terraces together with the seven mountains
Are its terraces, the firm steps of the throne;
The mountain is the vase base together with the vase.
This too is the great reliquary, unbroken.
The limbs of its construction: the support of the foundation,
The support of the joints of the wheels, the firm steps of the throne,
The first limb together with the vase base,
Covered with branches, crowns and garlands.
On the ground of suchness
Stands the celestial palace just as it is:
Its great foundation unmistaken, uncontrived and firm,
Filled in with the great walls of the mind of awakening,
With clear skylights of the five wisdoms,
The means of attraction and the immeasurables as the doors of liberation,
The eight stairs of right mindfulness,
And adorned with porticoes of miraculous power.
On the great beams of the fearless awarenesses,
It is beautified by the pillars of the eight right factors;
The pinnacle of self-arisen wisdom is exalted,
And it is surely beautified by the courtyard of the two truths.
From wisdom, compassion and good qualities
It is beautifully adorned with the ornaments of blessing;
The canopy of the waves of the nature of reality is stretched out,
And cymbals proclaim the sound of the mantra of the Great Vehicle.
In this palace of the Dharma just as it is,
The Victors reside in this order:
From the nature of the mind of Samantabhadra,
The all-ground, unmixed, the fully perfected Dharma;
Since the heroes attain certainty in an instant,
The ocean of the teaching is unbroken.
Having climbed the ladder of vajra space,
Abiding in the center of the expanse of space,
Look upon appearance and existence, which has no limit or end;
Through this, that domain becomes vast.
Having filled the ocean with vajras,
And having made Vajrasattva firm
In the beings who dwell there,

Make all into holy vajras.
On the emblem of the expanse of space,
Abiding in the center of the moon maṇḍala,
By the swift momentum of the moon in water,
One should travel to all the buddha fields.
On the emblem of the expanse of space,
Abiding in the center of the sun maṇḍala,
When it has become utterly certain,
All the places of darkness are illuminated.
On the tip of the yogin's threatening forefinger,
The clear light of the moon maṇḍala blazes;
When this is attained with great stability,
That water extinguishes the eon of burning.
In the maṇḍala of the yogin's hand,
The trichiliocosm with its encircling ring
Is hurled into the expanse of space,
And raised from place to place.
On the yogin's threatening forefinger,
From the clear sun maṇḍala,
A hundred thousand suns radiate from its rays,
Dispelling all outer and inner darkness.
From the maṇḍala of the yogin's hand,
The maṇḍala of the moon in water shines brightly;
A stream like a river of nectar comes forth
And quenches the great fires of the burning hells.

Moreover, Lord of Laṅkā, since it is taught that the sūtras of absorption are gathered in this alone, it should be understood exactly like this.

Mind is illusory by nature;
As it is imagined, so it appears.
Even if it does not happen at once,
Whatever it imagines, so it appears.
Though it does not appear in the domain of the material,
Mental form, higher perception and omniscience appear.
Once one has looked thus at whatever one imagines,
It comes to be clearly present to direct perception.
The natures of existence and nonexistence, good and bad,

Are simply like the element of water congealed.
All of them will be brought about by this.
Therefore in absorption, mind itself is chief.
For example, people who take jewels from the ocean
Face snakes, sea monsters, bees
And every suffering from vicious creatures;
Practicing with hardship, they succeed.
Likewise, yogins seeking ease
Face the enemies of conceptual thought, dullness and torpor, agitation and distraction;
If they put into practice
These deeds that are hard to conquer, they find and attain bliss.
This is the holy absorption,
The training put into practice.
From habituating oneself to mind itself,
Becoming familiar with it is most precious.

Friends, these should be understood as the very finding of experience.

When he had said this, those of lesser capacity found the experience and warmth of the holy intention.

This was the seventy-third chapter, called Mastery of Yoga, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then again the Lord of Secrets spoke these words to the beings of lesser body: Friends, what is it that makes this effortless? It is this: having nothing at all to do. What is that in which there is nothing to do? It is this: suchness.

Why is that? It is like this: a disease that is wholly seized by mantra cannot harm anyone.

Those who are held by suchness
Are not harmed by the three poisons or the five poisons.
If one is not held by suchness,
Though one practices every factor of the path,
One will surely emerge only into the higher realms;
How could one reach the supreme state?
Whoever knows that suchness abides in all
Is fully liberated from the afflictions.
Whoever does not know that it is so held

Will not be liberated by the holy paths.
For the yogin who has insight into that very suchness,
Since the afflictions are held, whatever he does,
Liberation is self-arising, it is nirvāṇa,
Effortless, at ease, and of great meaning.
Whoever lacks this insight,
Whatever he does in the manner of the insightful,
Will not be liberated in the supreme sense.
Bondage, release, or the things of saṃsāra:
One with the insight that knows all of them as empty
Has passed into nirvāṇa,
Free of the exhausting deeds of activity,
Of great toil and hardship.
Without the means of holy insight,
Even for holy persons,
To take a lesser body for the sake of taming beings
Becomes a downfall.
If one has the means of holy insight,
Even the lowly things of saṃsāra
Are liberated into a holy person;
Liberation is self-arising, not from another.
Liberated, not liberated, and the like:
All conceptions of two are extremes.
The omniscient do not abide even in the middle.
That is liberation without liberation.
This is the supreme secret;
Keep it secret from all of small mind who do not realize it.
This is not because it is flawed or wrong,
But in order to benefit those of small mind.
Therefore, for those endowed with insight and means,
Exertion, practice, and implements were not taught as the main thing.
Even if they are done, there is no obstruction;
Even if they are not done, it is just so, with certainty.
Thus, if one is endowed with insight and means,
All sentient beings of the five deeds of immediate retribution,
Slain with the weapon of awakening and compassion,
Turn into immeasurable virtue. If they are not slain,

That which all pursue as their aim,
The very expanse of one's own mind,
Is not known, though one churn the three realms of existence
For countless aeons.
Here, for one endowed with insight and means,
Without action, at ease, through self-awareness,
The noble consort of the yoga of great meaning
Is never parted, and is spontaneously present.
Just as darkness, poison, and base substances
Are turned into light, medicine, and gold:
A person without the instructions for the elixir,
Though he performs many great and difficult deeds
And endures suffering, will not succeed;
But a person who has the instructions,
Effortlessly and at ease,
Transmutes them into medicine, light, and gold.
Just so the great yoga accomplishes its aim.
Those who lack that very insight and means,
Though they practice austerities, will not succeed.
Whoever sees this secret of the mind
Is endowed with insight and means;
Whatever supreme aims are desired,
These are accomplished effortlessly and at ease.
Whatever brings aims to accomplishment
Does so because it is accomplished by insight and means;
These trainings, by which aims come to be accomplished,
Are most precious.

Friends, these are called little effort and great meaning.

When he had said this, the lesser beings came to possess insight, were cut free by it, and were held by skillful means.

This was the seventy-fourth chapter, called Definitive Accomplishment of the Meaning, from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

Then again the Lord of Secrets called out in a most majestic manner to the beings of lesser body, the Lord of Laṅkā and the rest, and said: O friends, what

is the sūtra condensed into one? It is this: Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One of all the tathāgatas, having gathered all the tathāgatas so that they became the purity of essential nature, explained how all the tathāgatas are gathered into a single intention:

Because the nature of reality is completely pure,
All phenomena are completely pure by intrinsic nature.
Of all the tathāgatas
It is the very supreme treasure of the heart commitment.

Thus it comes from the Blessed One, the purity of essential nature.

Moreover, it is like this:

The indestructible vajra commitment
Arises from vajra suchness.
The vajra commitment of the nature of reality,
Once accomplished, knows no time of destruction.

Friends, thus spoke the Blessed One, from the completely pure essential nature.

Again, friends, it is like this:

The heart commitment of all the victors,
From that very supreme of all,
Is not other; there is no other; it is not existent;
Nothing whatsoever passes beyond it.

Thus spoke the Blessed One, the pure essential nature of perfect enjoyment.

Again, friends, it is like this:

The word spoken by the holy ones,
The vajra armor that was vowed,
This most sacred oath:
If one transgresses it, one will burn.

Thus spoke the Blessed One, the pure essential nature of the secret body.

Again, friends, it is like this:

This sacred word of the victors,
Having been spoken, all the endless commitments,
Each and every one, are kept;
Such keeping is hard to find.

Thus spoke the Blessed One, the pure essential nature of continuous arising.

O friends, it is like this:

Aversion, distinct in its essence,
Being equal as the mind of awakening,
Is other than suchness:
Unabandoned, unpurified, the vajra commitment.

Thus spoke the Blessed One Vajrasattva, pure in essential nature.

Friends, it is like this:

The very objects of desire and attachment,
Whatever their intrinsic nature, are suchness.
Enjoyment, experience, and feeling are completely pure;
Unattached in conduct: the vajra commitment.

Thus spoke the Blessed One Amitābha, pure in essential nature.

Again, it is like this:

Since all are alike, equal in that suchness,
Without distinction, particularity, or division,
Through the luminosity of vajra space
The black darkness of delusion is purified and cleared.

Thus spoke the Blessed One Vairocana, pure in essential nature.

Again, it is like this:

Pure, without limit or boundary,
Free of the verbal extremes of wide and narrow,
One in Samantabhadra's vast path,
The expanse of great bliss is also the vajra commitment.

Thus spoke the Blessed One, the All-Accomplished.

Again, it is like this:

Since there is nothing apart from suchness,
It is beyond the two of is and is not.
Selflessness is vajra suchness;
Without an I, unchanging: the vajra commitment.

Thus spoke the Blessed One, the pure essential nature of the source of all qualities.

Friends, furthermore, it is like this:

All phenomena, whatever exist, are seen, appear, or are heard,
Though distinct, various, and endless,
Are by intrinsic nature unfabricated suchness,
The unobscured, luminous, pure realm.

Thus spoke the Blessed One, the pure essential nature of stainless sound.

Likewise, it is like this:

This wisdom of Samantabhadra
Is made by no one; it is self-arising.
Since it is the root from which all arises,
The maṇḍala that arises from itself is complete.

Thus spoke the Blessed One Jewel Cloud, pure in essential nature.

Furthermore, the explanation of the intention is this:

Primordially unfabricated, just as it is,
It is the essence of all phenomena.
From what does not exist, various appearances arise;
Without appearance, the maṇḍala of suchness is complete.

Thus spoke the Blessed One Source of Arrays, pure in essential nature.

Furthermore, it is like this:

Through the very mind of self-arisen awareness,
The meaning of the unfabricated expanse of the nature of reality,
From spontaneously present means and wisdom,
The maṇḍala of the true intrinsic nature shines clear.

Thus spoke the Blessed One Lion's Roar, pure in essential nature.

Furthermore, the Blessed One Beautiful Crest, pure in essential nature, said:

All the kinds of pleasure and displeasure
Of the world and of what transcends the world,
Being of one taste in suchness,
There is no feeling of pleasure or pain whatsoever.

Furthermore, the Blessed One Beautiful Ornament, pure in essential nature, said this:

To teach the meaning as suchness:
Since all are one in suchness,
Who teaches what to whom?
It is nothing but itself speaking of itself.

Furthermore, the Blessed One King, pure in essential nature, said this:

In the very expanse of suchness,
Three times or four times do not apply.
Through the distinction of wisdom awareness,
An instant is an aeon, and that aeon an instant.

Furthermore, the Blessed One King of Compassion, pure in essential nature, said this:

Saṃsāra is forever nirvāṇa
In the very expanse of suchness.
Since it is primordially beyond sorrow,
The two accumulations are by nature spontaneously complete.

Again, the Blessed One, the purity of essential nature, said this:

As for the intrinsic nature of all phenomena,
From the unborn, everything is born;
In being born itself, there is no birth:
The supreme family, the sacred vajra place of birth.

Again, the Blessed One King of Complete Intention, pure in essential nature, said this:

If one knows all as suchness,
Wherever it pervades is a buddha field.
Arrays of clouds of precious qualities:
There is nothing whatever to be arranged.

Again, the Blessed One Golden Light Rays, pure in essential nature, said this:

The immeasurable victors
Abide in suchness, just as it is.
Suchness and all things as well
Are nondual: that very suchness.

Again, the Blessed One Glorious Light, pure in essential nature, said this:

Saṃsāra and nirvāṇa
Do not appear as separate.

Since it is suchness, just as it is,
In it there is no nature of saṃsāra.

Again, the Blessed One Lord of Peace, pure in essential nature, said thus:

The very reality of suchness,
Being boundless to estimate and measure,
Is the palace of the immeasurable king.
From there, all is arrayed, being one in it.

Again, the Blessed One Glorious Cloud, pure in essential nature, said this:

Even the miraculous display from which all arises
Is wisdom that turns into anything at all.
Since there are no material phenomena,
It arises just as it is focused upon.

Again, the Blessed One Pleasing Melody, pure in essential nature, said this:

Through the continuous chain of the world's saṃsāra,
The essence of ignorance, and likewise the I,
Is a groundless, rootless instant.
If one knows that very thing, one abides in great bliss.

Again, the Blessed One Mirror Light, pure in essential nature, said this:

To conceive of the afflictions as the five wisdoms:
Both of these obscure it as it is.
Conceiving and not conceiving are not two;
That very conception is the true path.

Again, the Blessed One Glorious Moonlight, pure in essential nature, said this:

Even the teaching of countless vehicles,
According to people's differing inclinations,
Is merely a means of guiding them;
There is nothing but the Vajra Vehicle itself.

Again, the Blessed One Glorious Sun Essence, pure in essential nature, said this:

Whoever sees that, the moment he sees it,
Cuts through the net of unknowing,
Just like the garuḍa and the lion,
Though veiled by the womb of the body as by a womb.

Again, the Blessed One King of Fragrance, pure in essential nature, said this:

Through the wisdom of the means of mastery,
Having gained mastery over illusory phenomena,
Just as light arises in darkness,
Mastery over all is self-awareness.

Again, the Blessed One King of Former Joy, pure in essential nature, said this:

The illusion of pure wisdom
And the illusion of wrong conception and signs, these two:
Since their intrinsic nature is pure as that very reality,
The very knowing of them as two completes the accumulations.

Again, the Blessed One Jewel King, pure in essential nature, said this:

Since these inconceivable phenomena
Are one in suchness,
Whoever knows that suchness
Has attained mastery over all.

Again, the Blessed One Glorious Light Rays, pure in essential nature, said this:

Whoever, having understood this intention of the buddhas,
Abides in it,
Having gained mastery over self-awareness itself,
Is likewise truly a vidyādhara.

Again, the Blessed One King of Austerity, pure in essential nature, said this:

When that very reality becomes manifest, just as it is,
The stream of great qualities,
In which the inexhaustible arises from nothing, is never broken:
A treasure of jewels from which arises whatever appears.

Again, the Blessed One Uṣṇīṣa Essence, pure in essential nature, said this:

In that very reality, unfabricated just as it is,
Abides the mind that is suchlike.
Where could there be accomplishing and things to accomplish
That are not that very suchness?

Again, the Blessed One Definitively Gone, pure in essential nature, said this:

Just as clouds suddenly gather in the sky,
So it is veiled by sudden thoughts.

Just as clouds clear within the pure sky,
When concepts clear, it clears of itself.

Again, the Blessed One Definitively Spoken, pure in essential nature, said this:

However many pure utterances are spoken,
In vajra speech there is no elaboration.
Unelaborated speech itself clearly pervades all;
The very unspoken is explained at length.

Again, the Blessed One, the purity of essential nature, said this:

With the unobstructed, unattached, suchlike mind
That engages all objects,
All things, as many as there are, are transformed into suchness itself:
A jewel arises that holds an inexhaustible treasure.

Again, the Blessed One Melodious Lord of Flowers, pure in essential nature, said this:

Since they abide in suchness itself,
Although they do not say "this" in words,
Through the blessing of oneness that pervades all,
Each meets them just as he wishes.

Again, the Blessed One Glorious Renown, pure in essential nature, said this:

Buddhas, sentient beings, and the rest,
All without exception, with none left over,
Self-awareness, ignorance, and conceptuality itself:
All of them are self-arisen wisdom.

Again, the Blessed One King of Emanation, pure in essential nature, said this:

Letters, mudrās, and wisdom too
Are the ground from which words arise.
Since that very reality is pure, all is pure;
Speech does not abide in speech itself.

Again, the Blessed One Inexhaustible Melodious Sound, pure, said this:

Suchness too, by its intrinsic nature,
Is the complete purity of the five aggregates and the afflictions:
Free of the dust of concepts, without arising or ceasing,
All are vanquished in essential nature.

Again, the Blessed One King of Medicine, pure in essential nature, said this:

In immeasurable worlds as many as atoms,
Among inconceivable beings as numerous as particles,
Suchness appears in each particular,
Abiding as oil pervades the sesame seed.

Again, the Blessed One Radiant Golden Light, pure in essential nature, said this:

Intending a person as small as a single particle,
He utters speech before him;
Yet immeasurable, boundless beings, as many as atoms,
All of them, are liberated by hearing it.

Again, the Blessed One King of Arrays, pure in essential nature, said this:

One speech is inexhaustible, boundless speech;
Without edge or center, it pervades all.
Pervading and not pervading: vajra speech.
The various are without entity: suchness.

Again, the Blessed One Golden Speech, pure in essential nature, said this:

In that very reality, not fabricated at all,
There is no direction, no before and after, no time.
All is the expanse of suchness;
That very reality is self-awareness, itself.

Again, the Blessed One Glorious King, pure in essential nature, said this:

That very reality is the nature of all those things;
Though all those things are that very reality,
The childish grasp them as two;
In it there is nothing to be divided into two.

Again, the Blessed One Glorious Heaped Light, pure in essential nature, said this:

In emptiness, whose nature is space,
The adverse factors and the antidotes, these two,
Are primordially indivisible and one;
So how could there be fear of harm?

Again, the Blessed One Glorious Purity of Essential Nature, pure in essential nature, said this:

It is the unchanging nature of space.
To the pure, it is purity itself;
To the conceptual, it appears as concepts.
It appears as whatever will tame; in itself there is nothing at all.

Again, the Blessed One Glorious Supreme Joy, pure in essential nature, said this:

Intrinsic nature, unfabricated by itself,
Luminous of itself, is suchness.
Since that is the essence of all,
It is the great space obscured by nothing.

Again, the Blessed One Glorious Splendor, pure in essential nature, said this:

Suchness itself is the supreme ground.
Through the supreme wisdom that knows it,
One abides primordially in suchness;
How could there be anything left to traverse now?

Again, the Blessed One Spiritual Friend of All Buddhas, pure in essential nature, said this:

The essence of emptiness
Is surrounded by a retinue of various appearances;
Made by no one, self-arising,
It is the very maṇḍala of things just as they are.

So he spoke, in secret words.

Again, the Blessed One Purifier of All Lower Realms, pure in essential nature, said this in secret:

The accomplishment of inexhaustible wisdom,
Being accomplished as suchness,
Neither diminishes nor increases;
How could there be anything left to accomplish now?

So he spoke, in secret words.

Again, the Blessed One of All Worlds, pure in essential nature, said this:

The very absence of intrinsic nature in all phenomena
Is what is called nirvāṇa.
In emptiness, whose nature is completely pure,
Not abiding even in that: this is the mind of awakening.

So he spoke, in secret words.

Again, the Blessed One Completely Victorious, pure, said this:

Concepts are the headwaters of a channel;
If they are not turned into the field of emptiness,
They become the distracted ocean of saṃsāra.
To one who does not know this, it appears that way.

So he spoke, in secret words.

Again, the Blessed One King of Flower Arrays, pure in essential nature, said this:

Suchness, just as it is,
Is the mother from which all arises:
Samantabhadra, the perfection of wisdom,
The abode of all sentient beings and buddhas.

So he spoke, in secret words.

Again, the Blessed One All-Illuminating, pure in essential nature, said this:

The buddhas of Ghanavyūha
And sentient beings of every kind,
Things stable and moving, and all the rest,
Arise from that very reality: the body without entity.

So he spoke, in secret words.

Again, the Blessed One Mind, pure in essential nature, said this:

Since the root of self-arisen wisdom
Is the mind of awakening itself,
Its root is compassion,
Brought to perfection through means.

So he spoke, in secret words.

Again, the Blessed One Lion of a Hundred Thousand Forms, pure in essential nature, said this:

The meaning of suchness in all its multiplicity
Is indicated by letters, collections of names, and sounds.
Without relying on names and sounds,
There is no knowing it through the mind of experience and warmth.

So he spoke, in secret words.

Again, the Blessed One Lord of Sages, pure in essential nature, said this:

The nature of all phenomena, of every dharma,
Is not other than suchness;
Therefore that itself is the path of awakening,
And that path is the abode of Ghanavyūha.

So he spoke, in secret words.

O friends, furthermore, these and others, the pure essential natures of the emanated lamps of Vajrasattva, as many as tens of millions and millions, and the pure essential natures of the boundless ones who dwell in the palace of the Dharma, spoke these secret words thus. Some spoke like this:

The nonconceptual, self-aware instant
Is the expanse of both sentient beings and buddhas.
Merely the two, awareness and unawareness,
Appear as the two, pure and impure.

Thus they extolled it as the supreme secret. Some spoke like this:

That very reality is beyond speech and expression;
In order to indicate it, distinctions are spoken.
Whatever is spoken is suchness itself;
That very reality is the unelaborated vajra meaning.

Thus they extolled it as the supreme secret. Some spoke like this:

When that very reality does not appear as anything at all,
It is merely those very concepts,
The adventitious and differing concepts, that appear.
In appearance itself there is no appearance.

Thus they extolled it as the supreme secret.

Some spoke like this:

If even the buddhas cannot make
The reality that is just as it is,

By what was it fabricated, and who made it?
How could there be any maker?

Thus they extolled it as the supreme secret. Some spoke like this:

Since the domain of those who have wisdom
Is that very suchness,
All phenomena pervaded by it,
Pure by intrinsic nature, are unobscured.

Thus they extolled it as the supreme secret. Some spoke like this:

From that very reality without characteristics,
Various characteristics appear;
Being of the nature of the expanse from which all arises,
It is a treasury, nonexistent yet inexhaustible.

Thus they extolled it as the supreme secret. Some spoke like this:

The views of the various vehicles
And all the activities of guarding vows,
Though they are not things to be practiced,
Are all perfectly complete, unmixed.

Thus they extolled it as the supreme secret. Some spoke like this:

In it there is no direction and no time;
To whoever imagines directions and times,
That very reality appears in those forms.
The buddhas do not know it so.

Thus they extolled it as the supreme secret. Some spoke like this:

Having known all that is inconceivable,
If one rests it without thinking,
Immeasurable qualities arise:
This is omniscience.

Thus they extolled it as the supreme secret. Some spoke like this:

Whoever, not knowing the inconceivable,
Rests in a state without thought,
That childish one is a fool
And becomes the very sense base of darkness.

Thus they extolled it with supreme, all-embracing love. Some spoke like this:

Those who, having seen with insight
The unthinkable, inconceivable phenomena,
Abide in calm and make concepts
Of rejecting and adopting: their obscurations are boundless.

Thus they advised as supreme spiritual friends. Some spoke like this:

Though one knows all the various things individually,
If one lacks the completely pure path of total liberation,
One strays far from the supreme itself
And never finds certainty.

Thus they advised with a supreme command. Some spoke like this:

The various gradual approaches
And thought-based conduct remain within the intellect.
To the meaning of thought-free total perfection,
The gradual approach is a great poison.

Thus they advised with supreme distinction. Some spoke like this:

Without knowing the various things individually,
One does not find certainty in suchness.
If one has not found certainty in that very reality,
It is not fitting to speak of the various.

Thus they advised with supreme earnestness. Some spoke like this:

Just as a rainbow appears in the sky,
So the inconceivable appears as thought.
The speech that is not fixed as one
Is just as it arises.

Thus they spoke of it as the supreme that is hard to fathom. Some spoke like this:

Since the root of all is explained here,
Whoever knows its meaning has the supreme of learning.
Since all arises from this,
To know this is to know all: supreme wisdom.

Thus they extolled it as supreme wisdom. Some spoke like this:

This great secret within the secret
Does not see even itself by itself;
How could it be seen by another?
That very reality is extolled by the holy ones.

Thus they extolled it as the supreme secret. Some spoke like this:

This essence of all phenomena
Is unchanging, like gold and like space;
Because it neither sets, nor is emptied, nor is parted,
It is the supreme of the Dharma, the highest meaning.

Thus they extolled it as the great supreme. Some spoke like this:

The immeasurable banks of the clouds of concepts,
Accumulated from beginningless time,
Are completely released into suchness
By the instantaneous awareness of emptiness.

Thus they extolled it as the supreme secret. Some spoke like this:

If one knows with certainty that all phenomena,
However many, inconceivable, are empty,
This union equal with all the buddhas
Is the meditative concentration of great yoga.

Thus they advised it as the supreme yoga. Some spoke like this:

For as long as saṃsāra exists,
The sun of the essence of the teaching has risen;
This wheel of intrinsic nature, the nature of reality,
Turns without setting, without interruption.

Thus they extolled it as the vehicle of the supreme secret. Some spoke like this:

The vajra meaning, unchanging and indestructible;
The jewel from which all the various things arise;
The lotus itself, unattached and completely pure;
The great activity that accomplishes all spontaneously;
Suchness, unmistaken and unfabricated.

Thus again they taught it as supreme certainty. Some spoke like this:

Emptiness, the formless body of reality;
Wishlessness, the speech beyond the mind;

Signlessness, the heart beyond concepts;
Nonconceptual, the wish-fulfilling treasury of qualities;
The dance of means, the treasury of enlightened activity.

Thus they extolled it as the arising of various miracles. Some spoke like this:

The clear mirror of nonconceptual Dharma;
All equal, because nondual;
Knowing the various characteristics unmixed;
Great diligence that accomplishes all-pervasively;
Knowing the nature of all as primordial itself.

Thus they extolled it as wisdom dawning continuously. Some spoke like this:

Space that opens room for appearance and emptiness, pervading all;
Earth, on which all abide in the expanse of the vehicle;
The great water of completely pure calm abiding;
The fire blazing with the light of insight's wisdom;
The wind that scatters the knowable without obstruction.

Thus they extolled it as that from which all arises. Some spoke like this:

Form, unmixed, totally complete, clear and empty;
Sound, the voice of beings, pervasive and clear by nature;
The fragrance of the Dharma, refreshing with its clarity;
The taste of experiencing the ten meanings;
The very touch of the meaning of supreme bliss.

Thus they extolled it as supreme qualities. Some spoke like this:

Delusion, which thinks of nothing at all;
Aversion itself, which vanquishes all things;
Pride, the great self, primordially all-pervading;
Passion, whose nature is great bliss;
Jealousy, never turning into anything other.

Thus they extolled it as being without adopting or rejecting. Some spoke like this:

By knowing the one nature of all,
Everything gathers under that very power;
Since one attains mastery over all,
The great primordial empowerment is complete.

Thus they extolled it as the supreme empowerment. Some spoke like this:

The sūtra of awareness in which all is gathered,
Abiding pervasively in all, hard to examine,
Is the profound domain of the buddhas,
The yoga scripture of the Vajra Array.

Thus they extolled it as the supreme word. Some spoke like this:

Since all are one in that very reality,
Nothing appears as self and other.
In the completely pure space of emptiness,
There is not even a speck of distinction between clean and foul.

Thus they extolled it as the supreme nectar. Some spoke like this:

On the supreme heart of awakening,
How could the dust of concepts settle?
Being encompassed within the great reality,
It is moved by nothing and is unafraid.

Thus they extolled it as being without hope and fear. Some spoke like this:

This mountain of concepts and signs
Is like a lion's carcass, which decays only from within:
If emptiness itself does not destroy it,
How could it be destroyed by another?

Thus they extolled it as the supreme intrinsic nature.

Some spoke like this:

Those who conceptualize completely pure great bliss
Conceive of both good and bad.
When one has entered the wind of definitive great bliss,
Here there is no conceptualization.

Thus they extolled it as beyond all conceptualization. Some spoke like this:

That very reality, unerringly:
What is to be guarded is not to conceptualize and not to abide.
Guard against the enemies, laziness and distraction,
And likewise do not transgress it.

Thus they extolled it as the supreme commitment. Some spoke like this:

In immeasurable worlds,
Through inconceivable lamps,
The Dharma taught in all its multiplicity,
With its boundless meanings, is gathered into one.

Thus they extolled it. Some spoke like this:

If one does not stray from that very reality,
Moral discipline, meditative absorption, and wisdom,
Free of memory, thought, and illusion,
The three trainings are perfectly complete.

Thus they extolled it as the supreme training. Some spoke like this:

When, from that very reality, the three collections,
In which final calm abiding is mingled
With the seeing of the higher meaning, are definitively complete,
Even boundless hundreds of thousands cannot express it.

Thus they extolled it as the supreme lineage of guidance. Some spoke like this:

If one transforms words through mastery over words,
Though words are endless, when condensed they are gathered;
If a single word is elaborated,
It will not be exhausted by speaking.

Thus they extolled it as supreme inexhaustible speech. Some spoke like this:

Since they are pure in speech, expression, and word,
Their intention cannot be fathomed by anyone.
To hear an ocean of collections of words is not hearing;
To hear a single word is the supreme of hearing.

Thus they extolled it as the supreme of an ocean of learning. Some spoke like this:

Pervading and not abiding, nonconceptual,
Never parted, unmoving, unattached:
There is nothing other than that very reality;
That alone is the perfection that has gone beyond.

Thus they extolled it as the supreme that has reached the end. Some spoke like this:

To recite, utter, inquire, and read for the sake of meaning
Is like a blind man running headlong.
Whoever knows the meaning written by the expanse upon the expanse
Has the supreme of recitation, utterance, inquiry, and reading.

Thus they extolled it as supreme conduct. Some spoke like this:

What is made into signs, and the supreme of appearances,
Unmixed and perfectly complete,
Known to be like space and like a rainbow:
Unsurpassed dedication is awakening itself.

Thus they extolled it as the supreme dedication. Some spoke like this:

Whoever, in the reality of mind of any phenomenon,
Views duality or extremes
Is inverted through the delusion of ignorance
And has turned away from the path of the Great Vehicle's secret mantra.

Thus they spoke it as the supreme instruction. Some spoke like this:

Causes, conditions, and dependent origination in stages
Are means for guiding the small-minded and deluded.
In this unfabricated suchness
There is no dependent origination, no cause and effect, and no stages.

Thus they extolled it as supreme certainty. Some spoke like this:

In this unfabricated suchness,
Through the arising of miracles
That, like a wish-fulfilling gem, arise as anything at all,
Sentient beings see, hear, and perceive whatever will tame them.

Thus they extolled all as being without cause. Some spoke like this:

The profound domain of the buddhas,
The very essence of the secret of all
That abides in the secret expanse:
By seeing it, the benefit of beings is perfected like an ocean.

Thus they extolled all as spontaneously present. Some spoke like this:

The essential nature that is without entity:
Seeing it, no essential nature is observed.
Without memory, without act or agent,
This is the recollection of the equality of the three spheres.

Thus they extolled it as the supreme meditative absorption. Some spoke like this:

Without the perception that focuses on the three spheres,
Nameless, free from the path of words,
The unsurpassed, unconditioned offering
Is declared the true and supreme offering.

Thus they extolled it as the supreme offering. Some spoke like this:

The three darknesses of perversity and clinging,
Over countless tens of millions of aeons,
Are entirely cleared by that very reality as it truly is,
By a single all-illuminating instant.

Thus they extolled it as the supreme secret. Some spoke like this:

Those who are enveloped in darkness
Should look upon that very reality, unmoving and nonconceptual.
Seeing it, the darkness is completely purified and cleared;
This is declared the supreme of all confession and purification.

Thus they extolled it as supreme purity. Some spoke like this:

Those who abide in the nature of reality, emptiness,
In which adverse factors and antidotes are not observed,
Have no antidote at all
To teach.

Thus they extolled it as the supreme resolution. Some spoke like this:

All things are by nature unfabricated;
Just so, as they are,
To generate the mind toward the supreme awakening
Of unsurpassed self-awareness.

Thus they extolled the generation of the mind. Some spoke like this:

Thinking of nothing at all, unmoving,
Nonconceptual and undistracted,
The expanse spread out, pervading all,
Accommodating all, without action: the supreme Great Vehicle.

Thus they extolled it as the supreme secret of the Great Vehicle. Some spoke like this:

This essence of the secret of the Great Vehicle
Is not observed as a middle and transcends the extremes.
Those here who hold to a middle,
How could they transcend the extremes?

Thus they extolled it as observing neither middle nor extremes. Some spoke like this:

Not seeing any phenomena, not seeing
Even the nature of reality, not seeing the minds of sentient beings,
Not seeing the buddhas: whoever sees in this way
Truly sees its ultimate meaning.

Thus they extolled it as complete seeing. Some spoke like this:

Primordially unfabricated, just as it is,
Unborn, unceasing, knowing all aspects,
Made by no one, self-arisen:
Conceptual thoughts are adventitious.

Thus they extolled it as supreme and unadulterated. Some spoke like this:

Whoever possesses that very reality
Is a buddha, even in a lesser body.
Apart from that, where
Could there be anything called a buddha?

Thus they extolled it as primordial awakening. Some spoke like this:

The stable and the moving are the complete maṇḍala and mudrā;
Thought and grasping, and the limits of sound, are meditative absorption and mantra;
What does not exist, causes, signs, and attachments are words that indicate;
Accomplishing and the accomplished, looking and appearance, are the result.

Thus are the supreme words of secret mantra.

Friends, in this way, from that very reality, the supreme intention of all the tathāgatas, this was spoken:

All, everything, however much there is,
Is nothing but the conventions of words.
In this there is nothing at all to do;
That very nature is primordially awakened.

a ho With this, all passed beyond the tathāgatas and became great bliss, spontaneous and clear.

Then the Lord of Secrets himself spoke in verse:

For example, a person who wanders everywhere
Goes to whatever land he desires;
Though the kinds of land are endless,
The destination, the path, and the abode are only one.
Likewise, however many inconceivable
Enumerations and doors of Dharma there may be,
They are words that lead by guiding;
The object of the intention is one.

The meanings gathered into one
Are the sublime thing to be trained in;
Because, definitively, there is nothing but one,
The sublime training that gathers all is precious.
If one knows all as gathered in this sublime one,
That person's wisdom is limitless;
Because he is omniscient in all aspects,
The meaning of the sūtras is taught as gathered into one.

Friends, these things were spoken by all the tathāgatas, gathered together, so that the intention of all the tathāgatas is gathered into the one suchness. You should know that all the sūtras are gathered into suchness.

When he had said this, the lowly ones found the sublime certainty of oneness. Then the lowly ones rejoiced in the Lord of Secrets himself and praised him:

How wonderful! Great being, Lord of Secrets,
Great in prowess, lion's roar of speech,
Heart of all the tathāgatas,
Arisen primordially, before all buddhas!
You are the forefather of all buddhas,
Greatest and supreme, venerable, sublime body,
Supreme spiritual friend of all the sugatas,
The very reality of all bodhisattvas and buddhas,
Source of all, clear mirror,
Definitive sūtra clarifying and explaining every direction,
Great Vehicle of wondrous renown, how marvelous!
The way the great secret arose, how marvelous!

Crying "a ho!", they praised the sublime certainty. Then nothing at all remained perceptible, and the sublime secrets that had been definitively discussed there became widely renowned and universally renowned throughout the worlds of gods and humans.

This is the seventy-fifth chapter, called "The Gathering of the Intention of All Buddhas," from the Great Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas.

From the definitive emergence of the Great Vehicle: the discussion of the wisdom of the Dharma seal, which relates the account of what also occurred when the intention of each was discussed. This is the conclusion of the twelfth section, which teaches the manner of occurrence.

The Sūtra of the Gathering of the Intentions of All Buddhas, the clear realization of the Great Vehicle, the mirror of all phenomena, the commentary on all the Buddha's words, the sublime secret intention of all the tathāgatas, discussed at length by the Blessed One, the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi, on the summit of the fierce Mount Malaya, to the Lord of Laṅkā and the other beings of lowly body, was translated and finalized from the Bruzha script, in the town of the land of Bruzha, by the Indian preceptor Dharmabodhi, the great master Dānarakṣita, and the chief editor-translator Ché Tsenkyé.

This scripture contains, from beginning to end, twelve sections on the manner of occurrence, seventy-five chapters, ten fascicles, and two hundred and fifty-two ślokas.

ye dharmā hetu prabhabā hetunteṣān tathāgato hyabadad teṣāñca yo nirodha evaṃ bādī mahāśramaṇaḥ

Translator's Notes

• The Drusha (Burushaski) title is given as a plain sound-rendering of the Tibetan spelling. The sentence on the Lord of Secrets near the beginning is long and loosely constructed; it is taken as describing the setting in which the teaching is heard and expounded across all realms. The phrase rendered "after the teacher has passed into complete nirvāṇa" could also be read as the bodhisattvas themselves having passed beyond. The names of several realms and mountains (Utterly Pure, Summit Arrayed with Various Jewels, Lofty Beryl Light, Lofty through Dharma, Possessing the Essence of Awakening) are translated rather than given in Sanskrit, as no standard Sanskrit forms could be confirmed.
• The lists of designations and the "five bases" are highly technical and terse; they appear to enumerate the stages and paths of the vehicles, including the five yogas of Anuyoga (aspiration, opening the great family, drawing the great breath, attaining the great prophecy, perfecting great skill). The Lord of Laṅkā, Matyaupāyika, is one of the "five of the sacred

lineage" known in this tradition; the Sanskrit form is the conventional reconstruction. The answer to the first question is cut off at the end of the piece and continues in the next.

• "Eight and twelve years" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ literally; it may be meant as a total of twenty years. □□□□□□□ is read as Malaya (□□□□□□□□), the mountain in Laṅkā where, in this tradition, the five sacred ones gathered after the Buddha's passing. In the third answer, the line on "calm abiding, insight, and action, these three ends" appears to correlate the three baskets with these three, but the phrasing is compressed. □□□□□ in the sentence after the fourth and fifth questions is read as □□□□□, "cut off," as in the parallel sentences.

• The mountain □□□□□□□□□□ is rendered by its meaning, "Ferocious," as I cannot identify a Sanskrit name for it with confidence. The prince's name □□□□□□□□□ is likewise translated by meaning ("Gift of the Victor"); it may stand for Jinadatta or Jayadatta. In the line □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, the word □□□□ is obscure; I have read the line as "the great one of royal caste among humans." □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, "the King Who Tames the Harmful," is an epithet of Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets.

• In the line □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, □□□□ makes little sense; I read it as □□□□, giving "chronic illness." The word □□□□□□ in "the refuge of beings" is obscure; I take it as a place of shelter, in keeping with the fortress image. In □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ the phrase □□□□□ is unclear; I render the sense as "the secrets locked within the casket of the Word." Here □□□□□□□ has its ordinary sense, "to ferry across," not its sense in wrathful rites.

• "Heroic beings in the bodies of beings" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, the sacred ones who took birth in various classes of beings. The phrase □□□□□□□□□□ is taken as the name of a ground or stage, "Supreme Illumination"; it could instead refer to a place or person, and is uncertain. The world □□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("Array of Flowers") and the buddha □□□□□□□□ ("Unrenowned") are translated by meaning, since I cannot confidently identify their Sanskrit forms. In the line about objects of offering, □□□□□□□□□□ is obscure; I have rendered it as "proclaiming scriptures." The sentence about rice and sesame describes an impossibility: relics in a definitive sense do not exist.

• □□□□, "the Authoritative One," is taken as an epithet of the Buddha as the embodiment of valid authority (pramāṇabhūta). In □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ the word □□□ is unclear and is not rendered separately. In □□□□□□□□□□□□□, □□□□□□□ makes no sense; I read it as □□□□□□, "proclaimed." The names of the six sages are not the usual ones (the usual list has Śakra for the gods, for example); I have given Vijaya, Śākyasiṃha, Vairocana and Dharmarāja for the standard renderings, and translated □□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("Holder of Mastery over Existence") and □□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("Subjugator") by meaning, since I cannot identify their Sanskrit forms with confidence. The world realms □□□□□□□□□□□ ("Stainless") and □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("Source of Qualities") and the buddha name □□□□□□□□□□□ ("Stainless Voice") are also translated by meaning.

• The many names of world realms and buddhas in this passage are translated by meaning, since I cannot confidently identify their Sanskrit forms; several may correspond to names known elsewhere (for example, □□□□□□□□□□ to Siṃhanāda or Siṃhaghoṣa, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ resembles but is not the same as Abhirati). The Lord of Secrets is still speaking, continuing the speech begun in the previous piece.

• Most field and buddha names are translated by meaning, as they have no securely identifiable Sanskrit forms. The phrase "proceeds to the ground of exhortation" renders an obscure line (skul ba'i sa la gzhes) whose sense is uncertain. In the list of births, "Eager to Enter" translates 'jug sred, an epithet I cannot identify with confidence (possibly a name of Viṣṇu or Agni); Nara (sred med), Balabhadra (stobs ldan) and Vasudhara (nor 'dzin) are tentative identifications. "Sheep" for lu 'de is a guess for an unclear animal name, and "one endowed with patience" (bzod ldan) and "wondrous being" (ya mtshan can) are literal renderings of unclear class names.

• "Neither frightened nor alarmed" renders mi skrag mi dbang gi, where the second verb is unclear and may be a scribal slip. The phrase sha stag pas bsngags kyi ngo bo nyid is read as "all of them ... the very essence of mantra" (taking bsngags as a slip for sngags). "That embodied being" (lus kyi sems dpa') presumably refers to the Lord of Laṅkā, to whom the speech is addressed. "Figurative designation" renders bla dgas (upacāra), a merely conventional or metaphorical label. "The Explanation of the Intention" (dgongs pa nges par 'grel pa) may be a title (cf. the Saṃdhinirmocana) or simply "the definitive explanation of the intention"; the sentence in which it occurs is syntactically difficult.
• "Delivers all beings completely" reads yo bsgral as yongs su bsgral. The phrase srog bton pa is taken as "rescue the lives" in parallel with "bring out to freedom"; it could also mean "take the lives," which would bear on the following statement about killing without actual killing. The heading "the account of the Complete Array of the Lamp ... the second part, showing how it came about" is a section colophon of the text's larger structure, and "the twelve statements about past events" refers back to an earlier list in the text.
• In this passage de bzhin nyid is rendered "suchness" and de kho na nyid "reality," to keep the text's distinction between them. "Desiring Inclusion" translates gtogs 'dod, apparently the name of a god listed among Īśvara, Brahmā, Indra and Gaṇapati, which I cannot identify with confidence. "Water wheel" for zo chu and "descending flame" for lce 'bab pa are tentative. The list of kinds of mind continues into the next piece.
• Several items in the long list are obscure and rendered tentatively or left in phonetics: ligri (lig ri) and khrimön (khri mon) are unidentified objects; jagak (bya gag) is an unidentified bird; "emanation" (sprul pa) may be a slip for sbrul, "snake," given the surrounding animals; "maternal uncle" renders zhang, which may instead denote an object; "mildness" renders sla ba among the tastes. "The great affair of the realm" renders yul gyi don srid chen po, apparently addressed to the Lord of Laṅkā as a ruler. "Those who dwell on the grounds, one after another" reads sa dang sa la gnas pa as the bodhisattvas on the successive grounds.
• The questioning of whether mind can see mind (the sword that cannot cut itself, the fingertip that cannot touch itself) parallels the Kāśyapaparivarta. In the verse lines the text reads □□□□□□□□ ("being"), which here evidently stands for □□□□□□, "the mind"; translated accordingly. □□□□□□□□□□□ and □□□□□□□□□□ are read as □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ and □□□□□□□□□□□ ("those on the grounds"), matching the preceding passage. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as "you yourself" (□□□□□□□□), as the reply in the first person requires. □□□□□□ ("awe, intimidating presumption") is somewhat uncertain in this context.
• The stages named here (aspiration or the beginner, opening the great lineage, great confidence, the great prophecy, perfecting great power) are the five yogas of the Anuyoga path, with their associated grounds. The boys' names Bliss Protector and Dumbur could not be identified with confidence: the first is translated, the second (□□□□□□□) is given as written since its meaning is unclear; Tralita is spelled as in the Tibetan. The universal monarch's name □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered Vairocana, distinct from the buddha Vairocana (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□). The names of his five sons are translated from the Tibetan. The last line of the third verse, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, is compressed; "the ten directions and the times" is a probable reading.
• "The Blessed One, that being of vajra essence" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, taken here as an epithet of Vajrasattva, who is the speaker throughout, not the separate bodhisattva Vajragarbha. □□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("directly seen"). In the clause "the holy beings who dwell on the tenth ground", □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as ending the previous phrase with □□, followed by "dwelling on the tenth", that is the tenth ground. □□□□ at the start of the beings' question is taken as an interrogative ("how").
• In the verse, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□□, addressing Vajrasattva

("from you, holy spiritual friend"); as written it would be "from those two". □□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□□, "those on the grounds". □□□□□□□□□□ at the start is taken as "but here is the Teacher".
• □□□□□□□□□□ in the opening simile is unclear; it is rendered "great personages", reading it as a term for nobles or eminent people. □□□□□□□ here is taken as the ten masteries (vaśitā), not ten empowerments. The heaven of mastery over others' emanations (□□□□□□□□□) is Paranirmitavaśavartin.
• Lha ne in the verse on signs is read as lhan ne, "vivid." In the prophecy to Sattvavajra, bya bar 'gyur is read as the parallel zhes bya bar 'byung bar 'gyur ("will appear as the buddha called"). The second set of five families (Forbearing, All-Tormented, Six-Arising, Lineage-Holding, Abode-Holding) and the third (All-Illumining and the rest) are translated literally; I could not identify their Sanskrit equivalents with confidence.
• "Essence of awakening" renders snying po byang chub / byang chub kyi snying po, which also names the seat of awakening (bodhimaṇḍa); the text plays on both senses. The sentence contrasting those "swollen with doctrines of action" (las kyi chos kyis bsgyings pa) with those who "have not reached the supreme" is syntactically loose; it is read here as a contrast between long effortful practice and instant devotion to the secret. "Wedded to" renders bag ma pa (literally "bride-like"), read as intimate union with Vajrasattva as emptiness; the sense is somewhat uncertain. The final verse line's lhan ne is taken as "vividly present."
• To the question "do you wish for the essence of awakening?" the reply as written is "it is already fully ripened" (yongs su smin to), although the follow-up asks "why do you not wish for it?"; it is translated as it stands. In "We do not see them" (ma mthong legs so), legs so is read as the evident slip for lags so. In the reply about great compassion, the line "Because all is nothing but buddhahood" lacks the usual "they replied" but is evidently their answer. Several of the examples in the list (the heart of stone, what overpowers by its prowess, what enters into objects, what arouses delight) are given literally, as their exact referents are uncertain. The passage ends mid-list; the lines continue in the next piece.
• "Heavens of the Thirty-Three" renders lha gnas gsum (literally "the three abodes of the gods"); the referent is uncertain and may instead mean three divine realms. The phrase yum gtsug tor 'khor los sgyur ba'i lhums is taken as "the wombs of mothers of uṣṇīṣa wheel-turning monarchs"; it may instead refer to the deity Uṣṇīṣacakravartin. In the closing word analysis, "definitive" glosses nges pa in the title dgongs pa nges par 'grel pa, rendered as the Explanation of the Intention.
• The list "like beryl, like kaṅkari, like lac dye" contains two uncertain items: kaṅkari is left in its Indic form, and le brgan is taken as a red dye. In the list of manners, bdud pa'i tshul is taken as "the enchanting manner"; several of these manners (cam me, ma le, lhan ne, sal le) are expressive adverbs whose renderings are approximate. The opening reference to "four births" (skye ba bzhi) is translated as written, though the following exposition is framed in terms of four miracles. The two closing lists correspond to the seven factors of awakening and the eightfold path, given in this text's own order and wording.
• The arithmetic of the conceptions is obscure. The text first speaks of "ninety, or eighty-one" mountains, then calls the nine "the mountains of ten times nine" (ri bo bcu dgu pa), and then asks about "the eighteen and the one" (bcwa brgyad pa dang gcig pa), concluding "eighteen in general"; the numbers are translated as written, though they do not obviously sum to eighty-one. "The six continua" and "the six limits" (rgyud drug, mtha' drug) are rendered literally; their exact referents here are uncertain.
• The text announces "twelve splendors" but then lists twenty; the number is translated as written. In the seed-syllable list, "the unmoving" and "the infinite," standing beside Amoghasiddhi, likely allude to Akṣobhya and Amitābha among the five buddha families, but they are rendered literally. "Consideration" renders rtog pa, which may here carry the sense of

a topic or section of exposition.
• In the seed-syllable list, the entry for kṣaṃ speaks of the "defining characteristic" of abandonment rather than its "nature of reality," as the other entries do; this is translated as written. After kṣaḥ, the Tibetan word ni is taken as a topic particle rather than as part of the syllable. In the run "the powers, the faculties, miraculous power," the word dbang po is read as "faculties" (indriya), among the factors of awakening, rather than as the name Indra.
• The second stanza on "perception" probably stands for "formations" (the fourth aggregate, which would follow perception in the list), but the Tibetan repeats "perception" and is translated as written. Likewise, "form is fear itself" may reflect the etymology of form as "that which perishes," with a near-homophone; it is rendered as written. The phrase rendered "beyond doubt" for the powers is the Tibetan idiom meaning "certainly, without fail."
• Several evident scribal variants are read in their plain sense: chan as chad ("cut off") in "when definitively cut off," bsnyes as brnyes ("found"), and gseng as gsang ("secret"). The phrase rendered "in the vajra essence itself" (rdo rje snying po) could alternatively be read as the name of the bodhisattva Vajragarbha as the one addressed; it is taken here in its descriptive sense. "The lesser, the bodhisattva, and the yoga of conduct" appear to name lower vehicles and approaches that have no place in the great maṇḍala.
• In one refrain the Tibetan reads "the speech of all perfect buddhas" instead of "the secret"; it is translated as written. The line on the origin of the tantras appears to name the classes of tantra in compressed form (atiyoga as "yoga free of activity," anuyoga as "concordant engagement," and caryā, yoga, upāya, and kriyā); this reading is likely but not certain. The scribal forms dra pa and gnos are read as dra ba "net" and gnas "abide."
• The "four things" in the monk's verse are traditionally understood in this narrative as the four root transgressions (killing, stealing, sexual misconduct and lying), which Black Liberation, the future Rudra, takes literally as license. The monk's name, Youthful Hard to Subdue, is translated from the Tibetan since its Sanskrit form cannot be identified with confidence; Keukaya and Denbak are given in phonetics for the same reason. In Liberation's complaint, the text's □□□□ is read as □□□□ ("both").
• "The two measures" are presumably the two kinds of valid cognition, scripture and reasoning. Several animal, bird and insect names (nele bird, rutsé bird, puka worm) and the tree Nalabi cannot be identified with confidence and are given descriptively or in phonetics. In the hell list, "Lesser Heat" and "Blazing" render tsha ba chung ngu and 'bar ba literally, since this text's list does not match the standard eight one for one. "This is your very own karma" reads □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ as □□□□□□□□□□□□□□, his own karma. The name □□□□□□□□□□□ is given as "Mother-Eater Mataṅka": ma zan means "mother-eater," and Mataṅka is the Sanskrit-derived part of the name; it is the figure better known as Matram Rudra.
• The text's □□□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□□□, matching the parallel phrases around it. The meaning of □□□□□ in the preta's boast is uncertain; it is rendered "domain." "The eon of the three eons" probably refers to the eons of famine, disease and weapons mentioned earlier in the account. The passage ends in mid-verse; the next piece continues it.
• The place description in Laṅkā (Tsoko Katangmar, Kinnara's Leap, Where the Sky Iron Is) is obscure; the names are rendered partly in phonetics and partly by meaning, and Kinnara's Leap translates □□□□□□□□□□□□ tentatively. The account of the duel with Mataṅka Runa uses archaic and unusual wording (□□□, □□□□□□□□□□, □□□□□□, □□□) and is rendered by its evident sense. The corpse appearing as "the eight lands of the abodes of virtue" probably refers to the traditional eight great charnel grounds. Mataṅka Runa, the god-leader, is kept in phonetic form since it cannot be confidently identified.
• Karuna (□□□□□□) is the god-leader called Mataṅka Runa in the previous piece; the verse spells his name differently and it is kept as written. Several phrases in Rudra's boast are archaic and obscure, notably □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("crying hri, tried to bring me under his

control"), □□□□□□ ("cut the cord") and □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("I have gathered them all in and laid them bare"); these are rendered by their probable sense. Here "mudrā" means the form of a deity arising from emptiness, as in Mahāyoga.

• □□□□□□□□ in the epithet list is rendered "supreme bliss" rather than as the deity Cakrasaṃvara, since it is one of a string of epithets of suchness addressed in praise. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ "Source of Qualities" stands in the position of the Ratna family (Ratnasambhava) in the five-family sequence; □□□□□□□□□□ "Amogha" stands for the Karma family (Amoghasiddhi). Read □□□□□□□□ as □□□□□□□□ "chronic disease". □□□□□□□□ here reflects the stock formula "attained one's own aim" (anuprāptasvakārtha), not post-meditation. The palace is named □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ "Seen Through the Dharma" in the verse and □□□□□□□□□□□□□ "Height of the Dharma" in the prose; both are translated as written, though they are probably one name. □□ is uncertain; rendered "the sign of the vajra opening that gathers all together".

• Several Old Tibetan or colloquial expressions in the narrative are uncertain: □□□□□ is taken as "encampment"; □□□□□□□□□□ as "retorted scornfully"; □□□□□□□ and □□□□□□ as "come under your power / subdue"; □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ as "robe and necklace"; □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ as "scattered in confusion"; □□□□□□□ as a cry of pain, "Ah, the agony!". □□□□ □□□□□□ "his place of pleasure" is obscure; in the traditional account Hayagrīva enters Rudra from below and emerges at his crown, which the following sentence describes. The emanation called □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ "Vajra Horse-Face" is the Hayagrīva figure of this narrative; □□□□□□□□ "Little Neck" appears to be Rudra's mocking name for him. "The four things" (□□□□□□□□□□□) is left literal; its reference here is unclear.

• □□□□□□□□□□□□□ in the last stanza, "the great and supreme Blazing One," may allude to the heruka Che mchog (Mahottara); it is rendered by meaning. In the final line, □□□□□ is read as □□□□□, matching the refrain throughout. □□□□□□□□□ is taken as "stable and firm"; it may instead mean "stable and moving".

• The bodhisattva's name □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is translated by meaning ("Armor of Exhortation, Intelligence Endowed with Means"); I could not identify a Sanskrit form. The narrator ("I") is the Lord of Secrets, telling the story to the Lord of Laṅkā. Several rare words are uncertain: □□□□□□□ ("unrestrained"), □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("whose slopes and plains run down to the ocean's shore"), □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("great haunt in the dreadful wilds"), □□□□□□□□ ("bird-lamps"), □□□□□□□□ ("sets right the crookedness"). In the list beginning "Vajradharma, the Wheel of Great Joy," it is unclear whether each line names a separate figure or gives epithets of the Horse-Face emanations; it is rendered literally. □□□□□□ is taken in its usual sense of "thoroughbred steed" (ājāneya).

• The names of the four gatekeepers, the charnel-ground ladies and the Greedy Mistress of Desire are translated by meaning; I could not securely identify Sanskrit forms. □□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered Ucchuṣma, as the mantra confirms. Several lines are obscure: □□□□□□□□□ ("ready to be unleashed"), □□□□□□□□□ (taken as "the five impure substances"), □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("drawn forth from the youth's lap"), and □□□□□□□ ("turned to"). The three lines given in romanization in the Mistress's speech appear to be in a non-Tibetan language, possibly Bruzha, and are left untranslated. □□□□□□□□ in "a sound resounding three times" is read as □□□□□□□, as in the earlier "rākṣasa cry three times".

• The line "Avalokiteśvara with twenty-seven eyes" plays on the name, literally "the one who looks with eyes": twenty-seven eyes fit nine three-eyed heads. Several items in the opening description are uncertain: the word rendered "vermin" (smigs) and the implement "stira" (sti ra) are not securely identified. The phrase rendered "by the strength of their vajra stamping" (rdo rje stam pa na'i stobs) is obscure and may conceal a name. "Lord of Joy" (dga' dbang) and "the Mighty One" (mthu chen) are translated literally as names not identified with confidence; "Madana" renders myos byed, an epithet of Kāmadeva.

• Several phrases in the verse on Rudra's purification are obscure: "the mountain of the putra" (bu tra'i ri bo) and "purified him outright" (phyal du sbyangs) are tentative, as is "those with the branches" (yal gam can), which may denote a class of practitioners. In Rudra's lament, "your compassion is small" is a reproachful plea to be liberated quickly.
• Rudra's address "you attendants" (nye gnas) in the first speech is to his own retinue; in the lament the phrase "through the blessing of your compassion, my attendant" is addressed to Vajrasattva and is somewhat unusual; it may reflect the earlier narrative in which the deity appeared as Rudra's servant. The line "the worldly time will not stand empty" (mi stongs) is obscure; a reading "will not wait" is possible.
• "The great eightfold reviling" renders spyo ba'i brgyad chen po; the number may refer to the series of "surely the fault" verses, and the phrase is uncertain. The four steps of Rudra's fall (going against the command, piling up the mountain of the manifest, burning the wish-fulfilling jewel, engaging in the four acts) are translated literally; they allude to the earlier narrative of his transgressions. "Mixed practice" renders phra men, here in the sense of a hybrid or adulterated practice.
• The verse passage at the start continues Rudra's song begun in the preceding piece. "Black Throat" (mgrin nag po) and the rākṣasa king "Shatrang Sengbu" (sha trang gseng bu) are names not identified with confidence; the first is translated, the second given in phonetics because its sense is opaque. "Lord of Dance" renders gar gyi dbang phyug.
• "The host of those with perverse craving" renders log sred can literally; I could not identify it with confidence as a standard name for a class of beings. In Vajra Rākṣasa's reply, the repeated particle re after "you" could also be read as making each line a rhetorical question ("Is it the rudras that drive you round?"); I have taken the lines as statements. "The scripture of accomplishment" probably echoes the siddhi-yoga-āgama of the text's Sanskrit title.
• The five yogas named here (aspiration, opening the great family, great reassurance, receiving the great prophecy, perfecting great power) correspond to the five yogas or paths of Anuyoga. "The upāsaka called Black Excellent One" renders dge bsnyen legs ldan nag po, the form of Mahākāla known in Tibetan as Legden Nakpo; I have not given a Sanskrit form. The vajra names (Vajra Sprout and the rest) and the buddha name "Voice of the Lord of Ashes" are translated by meaning. In "pleasure grove of supreme bliss," bde mchog is read as "supreme bliss" rather than as the deity Cakrasaṃvara. In "so that it is hard to transgress," bka' bas is read as dka' bas ("since it is hard").
• "Black Liberation" renders thar pa nag po, the name of the Rudra figure of this narrative (often left as Tharpa Nakpo); "Vajra Great Might" renders rdo rje mthu bo che, possibly Vajramahābala, which I have not asserted. "Savage Vajra" (rdo rje ma rungs pa) is taken as an epithet of the great being who tamed Rudra. "The four points of the body" renders lus kyi bag bzhi, whose exact sense is uncertain. In the last question, ya gyung is read as yang byung ("also arose"), as in the line it quotes. "Without fail" renders dmyags ma mchis par, which is uncertain.
• The four consciousnesses here (root, referential, all-appearing and engaging) are matched with the five wisdoms, the wisdom of the dharma expanse arising from the mind's nature of reality itself. The five lineages listed are vajra, elephant, jewel, lotus and youthful, which is not the usual list of five families. Gdung dang sde is rendered "lineage and class."
• The figures for atoms in a league render the Tibetan units as they stand: mi 'khrugs khrag khrig as "one akṣobhya of niyutas," bye ba khrag khrig 'bum phrag sum cu as "thirty hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas," bye ba drug cu phrag brgya as "a hundred times sixty koṭis," then thirty-two koṭis, five hundred thousand, and twelve thousand (khri nyis stong). The exact values of the higher units are uncertain. Several of the thirteen words describing shapes are rare, and their English renderings are approximate. "Wisdom like the vast" renders chen po lta

bu'i ye shes, whose noun ("great ...") may have been dropped.
• The refrain □□□□

• The six seed syllables called the "root" are not listed here. The simile of "a single gourd" by whose blessing a tongue becomes a thousand renders ku ba literally; its intended image is uncertain. In the verse on holding the vajra essence, the lines about riding a chariot or horse and the Victors honoring "his mount" (rta stegs, literally a horse platform) are obscure and rendered tentatively. In this text the Middle Way (Madhyamaka) is presented as a lower approach surpassed by secret mantra. The last four verses correlate the four tantric activities (pacifying, enriching, bringing under control, and fierce subjugation) with the four eons of emptiness, abiding, formation, and destruction. The second chapter title reads "conduct" (spyod pa), though the chapter concerns activities; it is translated as written.
• This passage begins the account of the taming of the Black One, evidently the Rudra figure of Nyingma narrative; "the Black One, bound to saṃsāra by his own rope" renders nag po rang thag literally, and "the Black Captain" (nag po'i ded dpon) is the same figure with his retinue. Vajragarbha renders rdo rje snying po as a name here. The classes of beings (those given to conceptual rites, the low-born marked with moles, the vomit-eaters, those with perverse craving) are rendered by sense where no Sanskrit class name could be identified. The phra men ma are given as "sorceresses" per the house glossary. "Women who may be approached and who may not" interprets rgyu dang mi rgyu, which could also mean "moving and unmoving."
• This passage continues a narrative in which the converts of the Black One offer their antinomian "samayas," which the Blessed One then restates in nondual terms before showing that the beings' own versions are binding knots. The interpretive renderings are tentative in places: "the two kinds of action" (great and small, presumably virtuous and nonvirtuous), "soot-water" for sol khu, "the eight abuses" for spyo brgyad, and the verse on cutting the effigy's births and "joining that very one to that," which describes the liberation rite in compressed language. "The great self" renders bdag nyid chen po, the tantric "great identity."
• Several images in these verses are compressed and rendered tentatively: "great stolen bait" (rku ba'i rngad zas), "scent-eaters" for beings who live on smell (gandharvas or similar spirits), the line listing "sandalwood, venomous snakes, and the like," and the verse on "effigies of signs bearing ransom figures" whose holders are reborn as "great predators of the toll-gate places" (sho gam). The Blessed One's final speech continues into the next passage.
• "Dhāraṇī of suchness" renders gzungs; in this context the sense is likely the consort ("retainer"), mother, daughter and sister being reinterpreted as the nature of reality and wisdom. The phrase "the seven and the five of desire" (’dod pa bdun lnga) is obscure and is translated literally. The question "are these samayas not admitted within the Great Vehicle" renders ma gsol tam, which the answer ("not excluded") suggests means "not permitted/included." "Drew in their four limbs" renders bag bzhi bskums, an unusual phrase whose literal sense is uncertain. The plant lang thang tse is identified as henbane (Hyoscyamus).
• Several lines are obscure and are rendered closely. "As with the spray scattered by a sneeze" renders gang gi sbrid bsangs, whose sense is uncertain. The groups named in the "times past" verses (e.g. "false speakers who held sway over the practice of causes," "those in whom something other arose," "the corrupters through whom this was not passed on in between") are not identifiable with confidence and are translated literally. □□□□□□□□□□ is given as "the Black Carakas" (wandering ascetics), an uncertain identification. The exclamation □□□□□□ is here rendered "Ah," since the context is a lament.
• The two yogins' names, □□□□□□□□□□□ and □□□□□□□□ (later □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, "Endowed with the Manner of Renown"), are translated literally, as their Sanskrit forms cannot be confirmed. "Hair-splitters" renders □□□□□□□□, whose sense is uncertain. "Brood" renders □□□□□, also uncertain. The verse "looking at that itself, in that, as that" is deliberately cryptic in the Tibetan

and is rendered literally.
• Most names in this passage are translated literally, as their Sanskrit forms cannot be confirmed: the eon Fully Arrayed, the buddha King of Manifest Arising, the yogins Endowed with Excellence, Stainless Conduct and Auspicious Bliss, and the woman Excellent Ornament. □□□□□□□□ is given as Śrīdatta. □□□□□□ and □□□□□□ are transliterated names that could not be identified (Nashina, Pramata). "Tamer of the Harmful" renders □□□□□□□□□, apparently an epithet of the Lord of Secrets. "Act the part of cotton-clad yogins" renders □□□□□□□□, whose sense is uncertain. The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is obscure; it is read as a command to leave ("get out now"), which fits the context.
• Several names are translated literally because their Sanskrit forms cannot be confirmed: Giver of Bliss (□□□□□□□□□), Holder of Great Clarity (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□), Endowed with Light (□□□□□□□), Endowed with Love (□□□□□□□□). □□□□□□□□ is transliterated as Penapaya, unidentified. □□□□□□□□ and □□□□□□□□ are given as Mati and Abhaya. □□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as the heaven of the Thirty-Three (Trāyastriṃśa), a probable but uncertain reading. In "Lord of Secrets, listen" for □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, □□□□ appears to be a slip for □□□ or a similar particle, and is not translated.
• The glossary rendering "fierce rites" is used for □□□□□□□□□□, but in this context, rejoicing in others' practice of the Great Vehicle, it may simply mean the "manifest practice" of the Great Vehicle. The names King of Virtue, Endowed with Light, Mighty Lord Endowed with Light, Bright Gift, Endowed with Virtue and Endowed with Clarity could not be identified with confidence and are translated by meaning; Kalya is given as transliterated. The line rendered "who pervade all with their minds" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) may be a slip for "inconceivable" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□). The closing colophon phrase "It arose again" (□□□□□□□□□) seems to be a heading word of this section, as the next piece also cites it.
• "Limit of action" renders □□□□□□, which may mean the culmination or boundary of karmic action; the sense in this context is not certain. In the list of the bodies "shown as three," the Tibetan names four items (none, coarse, male and female, neuter); this is kept as written. The sequence ending "granting, and entering into ten millions, as many as ten millions" (□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is obscure; □□□□□ might instead mean "division" or "opening." In the passage on the door of the secret, "for the sake of appearance" occurs twice, as in the Tibetan.
• Several items in the closing list are rare or colloquial words whose exact sense is uncertain: "deceit" (□□□□□□□□), "boasting" (□□□□□), "insistence" (□□□□□□), "cajoling" (□□□□), "mire" (□□□), "obscuring" (□□□□□), and "prevailing over them" (□□□□□□). In the envy verse, the line about the "all-restraining vajra" (□□□□□□□□) is kept as written though it contrasts with "all-agitating" in the next line. "Drinking them is the means for the uncertain" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) may rather mean "the means of drinking without fixed rules."
• Several buddha names here could not be identified with confidence and are translated by meaning: King of Manifest Emergence (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□), Friend of All (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□), Glorious Excellent Ornament (□□□□□□□□□□□□□). The eon name Endowed with Perfection (□□□□□□□□□) is the usual term for the Kṛta age. The line "The Fierce One gave the blessing and the prophecy" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is obscure; "the Fierce One" may be an epithet of the Lord of Secrets. In the "Renowned" prophecy, the relation between the learned brahmin woman and Tamer of the Harmful is ambiguous in the Tibetan.
• Ratnaśrī is given for □□□□□□□□□□□□□ as the usual Sanskrit equivalent; King Protector of Bliss (□□□□□□□□□□) and the place name Sale (□□□□, possibly "pure gold") are uncertain. King Ja is the king of Nyingma tradition who first received the Mahāyoga tantras. In "the eight hundred forty million kings of complete awakening" the Tibetan could also be read as a single name. In the wind verse, □□□□□□□□ is read in its literal sense "all-pervading" rather than as the name Viṣṇu. The three vehicles of the definitive ultimate correspond, in Nyingma doxography, to the causal

vehicles, the outer tantras of austerity, and the inner tantras of skillful means.
• "The vehicle of the awareness of austerity" (dka' thub rig byed) and "the vehicle of the means of mastery" (dbang sgyur thabs) follow this text's scheme of the outer tantras and inner tantras respectively; rig byed can also mean "Veda." In "endowed with yoga and samādhi" the Tibetan reads mar ldan, where mar ("butter") makes no sense; the general sense has been translated, and a reading such as gnyis ldan ("endowed with both," i.e. the dual tantra) is possible. "The universal mount" renders the obscure spyir chib, which is uncertain. The seven "eons" (famine, stupor, weapons, fire, water, wind, space) play on the eons of decline and destruction; "stupor" for rmongs pa is uncertain (it may stand for the eon of disease). The chapter title reads cho 'phrul sngon byung, "Miracles of the Past," whereas the vehicle in the verses is cho 'phrul mngon byung, "manifestation of miracles"; the title has been translated as written.
• The four verse sections beginning "Thus" play on the opening formula of the sūtras, "Thus have I heard at one time," read in four senses: the definitive meaning, the secret words, the reasoning of scripture, and words that serve a wish. In the line "Belongs to those of intelligence, yogins endowed with the qualities of practice," blo gros is taken here as the common noun "intelligence," not as the name Mati, since no such person is addressed in this dialogue. Several items in the lists of the bases (for example dong ba, "penetrating," and spyir phyin pa, "general completion") are terse technical terms whose exact sense is uncertain.
• In the branch of retention, pha ma pa ("the parental") is obscure and may be a scribal slip; it is translated as written. The verb jen pa, rendered "inclines," is uncertain. The lists of reasonings and of pure and impure proofs parallel the Yogācāra discussion of the four kinds of reasoning (dependence, function, proof, and the nature of reality) and of valid and invalid proof, but are translated here as this text gives them. The phrase phyogs kun bkod ("sets out all aspects") is a common phrase here, not the name Fully Arrayed.
• "The imputed," "the dependent," and "the perfected" render the three natures of Yogācāra (parikalpita, paratantra, pariniṣpanna). The three roots are here called "the key of opening," although the scheme set out earlier assigns the roots to drawing out; the text has been translated as it stands.
• The opening verses are a highly compressed summary list whose individual items cannot all be identified with confidence; they are translated literally. In the description of the mansion, rdo rjes kun du smras pa ("spoke everywhere with vajras") is taken as a slip for spras pa, "adorned everywhere with vajras." Several architectural terms (the reliquary ornaments in triple lines, the fringes, the vajra lattices) are rare and their exact sense is uncertain. The name of the tathāgata king of form, rnam mi rig, is rendered literally as "Imperceptible"; it could not be identified with a Sanskrit name.
• The two "Heard at one time" sections play on the opening formula of the sūtras, giving an outer, intentional reading and an inner, self-appearing reading; "the two are simply two expressions of whatever occurred" seems to refer to these two readings. The names of the buddha-fields (Endowed with Inclination, Treasury of Merit, Endowed with Lotuses) and of the ten secret beings (Swift Vajra, Great Vajra Rapid, and so on) are translated by meaning, as I could not identify standard Sanskrit forms with confidence. "Press forward to ask" renders zhu bar sdog pa, whose verb is uncertain. "Horns" renders ke ra go, an instrument I cannot identify precisely. Here nyi ma'i snying po is the "heart of the sun" in a simile and an image of the rising sun, not the bodhisattva Sūryagarbha named elsewhere in the text.
• Several names in the list of beings pacified are uncertain: 'jug sred ("Entering Craving") and sred med ("Craving-Free") may be epithets of Hindu gods (sred med kyi bu is a known rendering of Nārāyaṇa), but I could not identify them with confidence, so they are translated by meaning; dbang phyug is taken as Īśvara and stobs ldan as Balin. Lu 'de and me khyer ("fire-bearers") are unidentified classes of beings. The phrase ched du 'gro ba ched du brjod par bya in the definition of the branch of connection is obscure and is rendered literally. "Placed

my tongue upon a lotus" follows the Tibetan literally.
• The opening line addresses the Lord of the Supreme Secret as "Vajra King, Lord of the Assembly" (rdo rje rgyal po tshogs bdag); in this context tshogs bdag is an epithet of the one being supplicated, the lord of the assembled gathering, not the god Gaṇapati. "Turned it five times, that is, in twelve ways, and changed it into two and five" follows the Tibetan literally; its ritual sense is unclear.
• These three chapters set out a hermeneutic of the text's own "branches" (yan lag) in extremely terse verse, and many lines, especially in the chapters on certainty and on the means of entry, can only be rendered literally; their exact technical sense is uncertain. Rendering "guiding" ('dren pa), "certainty" (nges pa) and "full unraveling" (yongs su dgrol ba) follows the plain sense of the Tibetan. In the four sūtras at the end, nges par 'byung ba is taken as "release" (renunciation, emergence).
• In the list of the qualities of space, several items are double negatives in the Tibetan (ma khyab pa med pa, mi 'byung ba med pa, ma chub pa med pa, stong pa med pa) and are rendered literally as "without anything it does not pervade," and so on. Chags pa med pa, between "without stirring" and "without abiding," is taken in the cosmological sense of formation (as in formation, abiding and destruction).
• The line "'Why not strive?' That itself is the māra" renders a terse Tibetan line whose sense is uncertain; it may instead mean "Why so? Because not striving is itself [free of] the māra." "The secret essence" and "this very gathering of the secret" may allude to the titles Guhyagarbha and Guhyasamāja but are rendered by their sense. "Ripened from false thought and from right thought" reorders the first line of that stanza for English syntax.
• The verses play on the word for yoga (literally "joining in the natural state"), contrasting yogins whose conduct is "joined" with their not being "joined" to the genuine meaning. The line rendered "Tear down the piled clutter" is obscure in the Tibetan and its exact sense is uncertain. In "The center is not clear," the text reads "troop" or "mass," evidently a slip for the similar-sounding word for "center." In "thought arises from marks," the syllable as written is meaningless and is read as "marks"; the reading is uncertain. In "Within mind itself," the text reads "illness of mind itself," evidently a slip for "within." The phrase "the abodes of the four streams" is translated literally; its intended referent is unclear. The doubled syllable in the line on the two kinds of valid cognition is a scribal duplication. The line "Since they stand on that ground, look to that" is uncertain. The six distractions listed correspond to the classical Yogācāra list (intrinsic, external, internal, distraction of signs, of attention, and of negative tendencies).
• In "Whoever enters that bliss all at once," the text reads "that māra," which makes little sense here; it is taken as a slip for the similar-looking word for "bliss," and the reading is uncertain. In "It is the limbs, the sūtra, and the root," the word rendered "sūtra" may here rather mean a junction or main trunk, set beside limbs and root. The opening line completes the sense of the preceding piece: one who teaches it wrongly falls into the vajra hell.
• The word glossed in the house glossary as Viṣṇu is here used in its literal sense of "all-pervading," describing the ground among a series of qualities, and is translated accordingly. "Luminous of itself" reads a syllable that literally means "again" as the similar "by itself." Several lines in the account of the ground, notably those on "the five" and on "generating and the rest," are terse and their exact sense is uncertain. "Fifty-six" renders the Tibetan number literally.
• This piece is extremely terse and many lines are open to more than one construal; the translation stays close to the Tibetan. The word glossed in the house glossary as Viṣṇu occurs in the final verse in its literal sense of "pervading and engaging," and is translated so. In "Because they are unlike, that is the sign," the text has a meaningless syllable read as the similar word for "sign." Several images are uncertain: "acquire depth" for the crystal ball,

"made one" for earth and stone, "tongs that hold fire, that hold that, that hold a leaf," "snow, grime," and "haze."

• This passage is a terse enumeration, apparently of the occasions of death and rebirth, and many lines admit more than one reading; the translation keeps close to the Tibetan. The word listed earlier in the text as the name Balin occurs here in its ordinary sense, "having the strength of," and is translated so. "Signs" in "Signs, and whatever here is cleared away" reads a meaningless syllable as the similar word for "signs." "The sevenfold intermediate state" may refer to the seven weekly periods of the intermediate state. "Those who were loving" renders a word that is also the name Maitreya; here it plainly means loved or loving ones.

• The passage closely follows the Abhidharma account of the intermediate being (antarābhava), including its alternative names (gandharva, abhinirvṛtti, "the existence that links," that is, pratisaṃdhi) and the seven-day and seven-week periods. "The being of the intermediate seven" renders bar bdun pa, the text's own term for this being. The line rendered "an emanated form, the size of a five-year-old" is compressed and its reading (literally "of the final measure, emanation, source, five in measure") is uncertain; it is taken in light of the Abhidharma statement that the intermediate being is the size of a young child. □□□□□□□□□□□□ here is an epithet of the intermediate being ("the one who hovers near" food), not the name Upāli. □□□□□□□□ is taken here as "all-pervading" rather than as the name Viṣṇu, since the context is the intermediate being's unobstructed movement. The phrase rendered "scents of its own and not its own" (□□□□□□□□□□) is uncertain; it may refer to the two parents, toward whom attachment and aversion arise at their union, as in the Abhidharma account.

• The verses on conception and gestation are highly compressed; several lines are obscure, in particular the lines on the position of the embryo ("If it is the abiding kind ... on the left; if the arising kind ... on the right"), which are rendered literally, and "it gathers as warmth settles." "Stages of the embryo" takes □□□□□□□ / □□□□□□□ as the first embryonic stages (mer mer po and nur nur po). "The all-encompassing one" (□□□□□□□□) is understood as the consciousness of the intermediate being entering the womb. In "Whoever has such thoughts and asks this," the text reads □□□□□□□ ("whatever six"), which makes little sense here; it is taken as a slip for □□□□□□□ ("whoever asks"). In "In which all of birth and self are gathered," □□□□□□□□ might instead be read as Prajāpati, the lord of creatures, but the context does not support a divine name.

• "Totally Pure" is taken as the name of the buddhafield (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□). "The all-gathering" renders □□□□□□□□, the short form of the text's own name, the Gathering of the Intentions of All. In "the subtle aspect that distinguishes extremes and middle," □□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□, "extremes and middle."

• "The jewel on the crown of Indra" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, taking □□□□□□ as Indra; it could also be read as "the jewel on the crown of a lord." In the line "Is a mighty lord," □□□□□□□□ is taken as a description of the practitioner rather than as the god Īśvara. "Holding to measures" reads □□□□□□□ as □□□□□□□. "It becomes a fault" takes □□□□□□ (literally "burnt") in the sense of a breach. The recurring closing formula □□□□□□□□□□...□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered "This is how what they had heard was discussed"; its exact sense is uncertain.

• "That essence of space" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, which here describes mind itself rather than naming the bodhisattva Ākāśagarbha. "Since in it there is no I or no I" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□ literally; the second term may be meant as "no non-I." The ten occasions of application and the closing lists are compressed enumerations, and the grouping of their items is uncertain.

• The verse sequence maps the stages of the mind of awakening (moving, aspiring, arising, applying, entering, joy, not changing, awareness, abiding, completion) onto visionary signs compared to stars, lamps, and the waxing moon by day of the lunar month. "Defiled meat" renders □□□□□, a term for impure or polluted flesh used among the antinomian substances; its exact referent is uncertain. "Body of essential nature" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□

(svābhāvikakāya).
• "The Gathering of the Intentions of All" in the later verses renders the variant phrasing □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, taken as a reference to this sūtra; it could also be read simply as "the gathering of all intentions." The verse on discipline plays on the two syllables of brtul zhugs (vrata), "tamed" and "entered." The line "and even for one who is not such, once it is grasped" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is obscure and the rendering is tentative.
• □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, elsewhere in this text the name Sūryagarbha, is here used in a simile beside the jewel lamp and is rendered "the heart of the sun." The second of the six kinds of knowing is listed as □□□□□□□□ ("astonished") but explained as □□□□□□□□□□□ ("perverse craving"); both are translated as written. The verses on cause, action, enumeration and so forth are terse and their syntax is uncertain; the rendering follows the Tibetan closely. "Target" renders □□□□□□□□, the aim or focus point of the gaze.
• This verse section is terse and many lines are obscure; the rendering follows the Tibetan closely. The ground names (Uncertain and Subject to Change, Foundation through Reliance, Conduct of Great Importance, Continuous Training, Treasury of Merit, Going Distinctively through Reliance, Arising of the Focused Result, Unchanging through Abiding, All-Pervading Nature of Reality, Mounted upon Completion) are translated by meaning. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is here "the heart of space," an image of the vast expanse, not the bodhisattva Ākāśagarbha. "Wandering ascetic and youth" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, apparently examples of one thing known by different names.
• Several verses are obscure and the renderings are tentative, in particular "together with ordinary people in the four secret domains," the turtle simile, and "there is no protector or noble one for him apart from that; whatever is not held, the rope is cut" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□). "The wheel of time" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, which here appears to mean offerings made according to the cycle of the calendar rather than the Kālacakra Tantra. □□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□ "now, anew." "The fourfold fire rite" is the fire offering for the four activities.
• In the simile of the sun, nyi ma'i snying po is here the core or orb of the sun examined by the eye, not the bodhisattva name Sūryagarbha used elsewhere in the text. The opening list of ten "correspondences" is terse; its items are given in the Tibetan order, and they correspond only loosely to the ten similes that follow.
• Several lines in the section beginning "For example, in the realms of darkness" are extremely compressed (notably the line on "dedicating the rising and the rest" and the lines with 'on pas ... 'on cing, here taken as "nonetheless"); the rendering follows the most plausible construal. "Danced their steps in pairs" renders the obscure dgyes pa chen po'i gnyis pas bstabs.
• The animal and warrior images in the first verse section are terse and in places obscure; lines such as "fierce and squat, a great trunk, terrifying and coiled," "the gold of the ocean," "a mind that devours, like jealous rivalry," and "mastering the land, taking a bride, moving in the royal court" render the Tibetan words as closely as possible without a commentary to fix their reference. "Root of disease" reads □□□□□□ for the list's □□□□□□□, as the explanation that follows has it; likewise "guarding the regimen" reads □□□□□ for □□□□ in the explanation, following the list. The sage's name □□□□□□□□□ is rendered "Black Kāla"; its Sanskrit original is not certain.
• "The tenth section, placed at the end" renders a division marker (Tibetan bampo, a unit of text length) inserted at this point; its exact wording is terse. The verse line "the heir who had gathered in that retinue, you yourself" addresses the listener directly, as the Tibetan does; who is meant is not made explicit. The eight alternative names correspond to elements of the Sanskrit title of the work, and "Vajra Array" reads dgod pa in the sense of "arranging" (vyūha) rather than "laughter." "The later outflows" refers to bodily excretions, the five substances of tantric samaya.
• The verse is terse and several lines admit more than one reading. "The excellent Subhūti of

the future" renders rab 'byor dam pa, which could also be read as "the excellent ones, richly endowed"; the reference to Subhūti here is not certain. "Ruined in this life and the long term" renders mthong yun phung byed, taken as this visible life and the long future. In "they speak in praise of this secret" the first line reads sngags pa as bsngags pa ("praise"), as in the parallel lines that follow.

• "The elephant Enaya" renders glang po e na ya; the name is not securely identified, and the point is the bezoar (a prized medicinal substance) obtained from the elephant even after death. "There is one who is supreme against harm to practice" renders the terse sgrub pa'i gnod mchog gcig; the sense, from what follows, is the qualified disciple to whom the secret may be opened. "Fiery bolts" renders the obscure dur mo.

• The line "going against the command and engaging in malicious deeds" appears twice in the Tibetan, first in a shortened form; it is translated once as an evident scribal repetition. Several lines are terse and their exact sense uncertain: "the enemy that, breaking, falls into the six" (perhaps the six realms of rebirth), the lines on "yearning" ('un pa), and "lamenting constantly without ceasing" (rma ga chad pa). The figure for incidental degeneration, "fifteen, one and three," is given literally as the Tibetan states it.

• Throughout, "the excellent one" renders dam pa, here the holy master or guru. The glossary entry for bde mchog (Cakrasaṃvara) has not been applied: in this passage the word plainly means "supreme bliss" (a quality of the guru and of the path), not the deity. The name of the hell-dog, Lu de, could not be identified and is given in phonetics. The line containing "gyin da gyin da" is obscure; it has been taken as a colloquial expression for grumbling or petty complaint. Several other verse lines (for example "the object of his gaze is not the base" and "it is not a matter of lacking the lesser requisites") are terse and their exact sense is uncertain.

• The verses on killing father, mother, brahmins and kings illustrate teaching with hidden intent (abhiprāya): in the tradition such statements are read figuratively, for instance as slaying craving, karma and the like, not literally. The glossary rendering of bde mchog as Cakrasaṃvara has not been applied, since here it means "supreme bliss," not the deity. The exchange with "those with perverse craving" is terse; the attribution of the lines to questioner and answerer is interpretive. "Vajrasattva, Vajradhara" renders sems dpa' rdo rje 'dzin pa, which might also be read as a single epithet, "the vajra-holding sattva."

• Throughout, "the excellent one" renders dam pa, the holy master. This section is a detailed code of conduct toward the master, written in terse verse; several lines are obscure and their rendering is interpretive, notably "Not a single sesame seed is lost or fails to increase" (the Tibetan reads literally "a sesame seed is not lost, does not increase," taken here as an emphatic double negative), the lines on carrying out the master's word "as it names" and giving up the post, the list beginning "Covering the head," the line "As the act arises, so the action arises," and the line read as "In the very presence of true austerity." "Good conduct in the three doors" reads sbo gsum as sgo gsum, the three doors of body, speech and mind; the written form makes no sense. "The four modes of conduct" are walking, standing, sitting and lying down.

• "The excellent one" renders dam pa, the holy master. "Well composed" reads rab bsgribs ("thoroughly obscured") as rab bsgrims, which plainly fits the context. "At the end" reads mthar chib as mthar phyin. The chapter colophon has lés for las ("from"), an evident slip. The second half is a terse doxography of mistaken views; several lines are obscure and are rendered literally, notably "simply not being what it is not," the list of six kinds of going astray, the subdivisions of secret mantra, and "those who overthrow kings and those of royal methods" (rgyal dbog pa, rgyal thabs pa), which could not be identified with confidence. "Extremists" renders mur thug pa, a Tibetan doxographical label for a non-Buddhist school whose Sanskrit name is uncertain. The list of views includes items resembling the sixty-two views of the Brahmajāla discourse but is translated as this text gives it.

• The opening verses are a terse doxographical summary and several lines are rendered interpretively, especially "Holding to the side that joins outer and inner as one" (snrel zhir, of uncertain sense) and the line on the four modes of teaching, which appears to correspond to the familiar fourfold scheme of intentional, hidden-intent, provisional and definitive teaching. "Entering inward" reads nad 'jug as nang 'jug, and "most precious" reads ba tu as rab tu, both evident slips. The three yogas (action, performing action, non-action) may correspond to the classes of outer and inner tantra in Nyingma doxography, but the text is translated as it stands.
• The four yogins in the verse (of aspiration, of great reassurance, of the great prophecy, and of perfected great prowess) correspond to the four yogas of the Anuyoga path in this sūtra; the "yogin of application" is inserted among them as the text has it. The phrase rendered "the blazing emptiness of thought" (rtog stong 'bar ba) is uncertain; it parallels the cakravartin's precious wheel in the following simile and may refer to a blazing thousand-spoked wheel. Here dbang po is taken as "sovereign lord" rather than the god Indra, since it describes a king installed by the people. The "four rivers" in the definition of renown likely refer to the four great streams of transmission of this tradition.
• Bsnyen pa, nye bar bsgrub pa and sgrub pa chen po are taken as the stages of approach, close accomplishment and great accomplishment in deity practice. "The lords of the world" renders 'jig rten dbang po, here understood as the worldly gods whose customs of worship are adopted, rather than Indra specifically. The rite of raising the dead is presented as a symbol for raising beings from the death of extreme views into the unborn; it is translated literally as the text gives it. The line "shoots arrows, then before they fall to the ground" has one syllable fewer than its neighbors, and its sense is taken from context.
• The dhāraṇīs here are the female consort deities. The eight bodhisattvas at the end are given in the Tibetan by abbreviations (Earth, Space, Eye, Vajra, Loving, Vajra, Samantabhadra, Glorious); the identifications Kṣitigarbha, Ākāśagarbha, Avalokiteśvara, Vajrapāṇi, Maitreya and Mañjuśrī are standard, but the second "Vajra" is uncertain and is left as it stands. The line "in a manner moving like great lions" appears to be a duplicated line in the source and is translated as written. The sense of "hard to turn back even with pleasing words" (snyan pa dag gis) is uncertain.
• "Plakṣa wood" takes blag sha as the plakṣa fig tree; the identification is not certain. "The means of attraction" takes bsdu ba as the four means of attracting disciples, which with the immeasurables and the liberations are assigned to the maṇḍala's gates.
• "Cakrasaṃvara" renders bde mchog in the praise, following the house glossary; it may here simply mean "supreme bliss," an epithet of the fire as compassion. In "the wise should examine in the fire," the text reads mi la ("in the person"); the following lines on the sounds, colors and shapes of the fire show that me la ("in the fire") is meant. The line rendered "the corpse's face is displayed toward the four directions" (ro bzhir bstan) is uncertain.
• "Tally" and "register" render □□□ and □□ in the lines on the white and black accounts of the deceased's deeds; the image appears to be of good and bad deeds reckoned like counted pebbles, with the black ones burned in the wisdom fire, but these readings are interpretive. □□□□□ in "those whose mindstreams are completely pure" is taken in its sense of mental continuum, not tantra. The phrase □□□□□□□□□, rendered "helmeted," is obscure. □□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□ "white and clear," □□□□□□□ as □□□□□ "cannot break," and □□□□□ is rendered loosely as "calamity." "Lamps" probably refers figuratively to buddhas, and "the self-arisen ones and those who remain after them" may refer to pratyekabuddhas and the elders or arhats who remain after a buddha, but the referents are not certain.
• "Corpses are turned into gold" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ literally; it may instead allude to an alchemical elixir that turns base metal into gold. "Those of lesser capacity" renders □□□□□□□□□□, the audience addressed by the Lord of Secrets. In the verse on the fearless, □□□□□

is read as □□□□□.
• This passage is terse and in places obscure. The lines on the boulder in the ocean, the line "the faded and the slack, are one in having an object," the couplet on "empty and existent, annihilation and permanence," and the lines on rivers, fire and gold are interpretive renderings of very compressed verse. The description of the four concentrations follows this text's own scheme, not the standard Abhidharma one. □□□ is read as □□□ ("delight"). Where the text says the illness is not overcome in stages (□□), the word may be a slip for a similar-looking syllable, but it is translated as written.
• This passage is a list of dream and meditative signs and stages of yogic prowess. Many lines are terse, and the translation is necessarily interpretive in places, especially "wielding authority over Indra with a seal of command," "bringing the world down by a ladder," and the technical terms for the letters (nature, transformation, limbs). □□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□□□ ("its seed"). "Measure" renders □□□□□, taken as one's own bodily size.
• The "emblem (liṅga) of the expanse of space" here is not a ritual effigy but appears to mean a sign or figure visualized in space. □□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered "the element of water congealed"; the sense of □□□□□ is uncertain. The architectural terms in the description of the reliquary and palace (vase base, throne steps, joints of the wheels) follow stūpa terminology and are interpretive in places.
• The expression rendered "at ease" (gyin da, also in "effortless and at ease") is an uncommon, probably archaic word; its sense is inferred from its pairing with "effortless."
In "to take a lesser body for the sake of taming beings," the word normally meaning "discipline" (vinaya) is taken in its sense of "taming, converting" beings, which fits the context of beings in lesser bodies.
The line "the noble consort of the yoga of great meaning" is obscure; the rendering is tentative.
"Were cut free by it": the Tibetan here appears slightly disordered (blo dang ldan gros kyis chod); the evident reading, that they gained insight and were held by means, is translated.
The verse on aversion reads "is other than suchness" as written; doctrinally one might expect "is not other than suchness," but the text is translated as it stands.
"All-Accomplished," "source of all qualities," "stainless sound," "perfect enjoyment," "secret body," and "continuous arising" are translated by meaning, as they could not be confidently identified as fixed Sanskrit names of particular buddhas.
• The names of the Blessed Ones in this sequence (Jewel Cloud, Source of Arrays, Lion's Roar, Beautiful Crest, King of Former Joy, and the rest) are translated by meaning, since they could not be confidently matched to fixed Sanskrit names; several may correspond to buddha names such as Ratnamegha or Siṃhanāda.
"Cuts through the net of unknowing": the Tibetan reads "cuts the net that is cut of unknowing," where the first "cut" appears to be a scribal repetition; the evident sense is translated.
• As in the preceding passages, the names of the Blessed Ones are translated by meaning, since most could not be confidently matched to fixed Sanskrit names; Lord of Sages renders the common epithet Munīndra.
"Luminous of itself": the Tibetan reads yang gis, evidently a slip for rang gis, "by itself."
The name rendered "Mind" (yid dang) may be a slip for yid dga', "Joyful Mind"; it is translated as written.
In "Suchness ... is the mother from which all arises," the phrase ma yin pas is read as "being the mother," which suits the identification with the perfection of wisdom in the following line; it could also be read as a negation.
• In the verse beginning "By knowing the one nature of all," the Tibetan reads thos pas, "by hearing," which makes little sense here; the evident reading thob pas, "since one attains," is translated.
In the verse on the five senses, bde mchog is rendered "supreme bliss" rather than as the deity

name Cakrasaṃvara, since the context is the sense of touch.
"Being encompassed within the great reality" renders the uncommon 'ub chung, read as 'ub chub, "gathered in, encompassed."
The lion's carcass alludes to the familiar image of a lion's body, which no other animal will eat and which is consumed only by worms from within.
• In the verse beginning "The stable and the moving," the Tibetan reads bsngags, "praise," which is taken as sngags, "mantra," fitting the series of maṇḍala, mudrā, meditative absorption, and mantra.
The sentence after "a ho" is terse and its subject is not stated; it is rendered as describing the whole assembly passing beyond the tathāgatas into spontaneous great bliss, but the sense is uncertain.
The sentence "Thus they extolled it" after the verse on the lamps lacks a qualifying word in the Tibetan.
• "The lowly ones" renders □□□□□, referring as elsewhere in this text to the beings of lowly body (the Lord of Laṅkā and his companions) to whom Vajrapāṇi teaches. "Nothing at all remained perceptible" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, which has no stated subject; it may mean that the Lord of Secrets vanished from sight. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, applied to Dānarakṣita, is an old title of uncertain exact sense (perhaps a ritual officiant or senior master); rendered "great master".
The figure of 252 ślokas is given as the Tibetan states it, though it seems small for a text of this length.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.